PATHOLOGY

Rapid Revision Notes · NEET PG & INI-CET

How to read these notes :

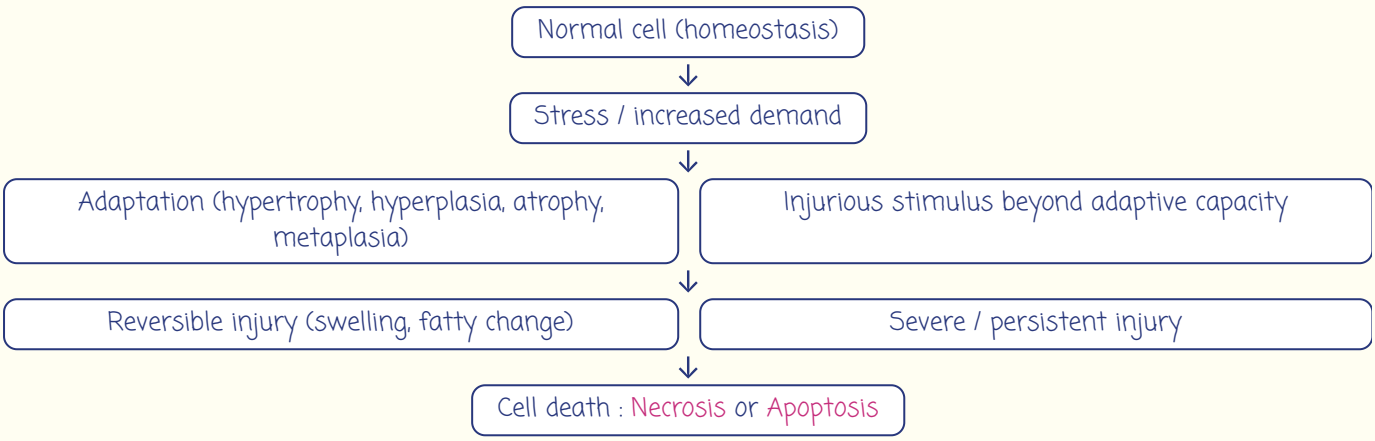
- Navy ink → core content.
- Pink ink → key terms, buzzwords, most-asked facts.
- Dark green ink / green boxes ("Filled") → filled-in high-yield points for a top rank.
- Dashed pink box → mnemonic.
- Yellow box → exam pearl / recent-pattern question.
- Numbered lists → causes, risk factors and criteria, one per line.

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CELL INJURY, ADAPTATION & CELL DEATH

Overview



Cellular Adaptations

Adaptation	Definition	Physiological example	Pathological example
Hypertrophy	↑ cell size → ↑ organ size	Uterus in pregnancy (also hyperplasia), skeletal muscle in body-builders	LVH in hypertension, aortic stenosis
Hyperplasia	↑ cell number (only in dividing cells)	Breast at puberty / lactation, liver regeneration after partial hepatectomy	Endometrial hyperplasia (unopposed estrogen), BPH, warts (HPV)
Atrophy	↓ cell size and number	Thymus after puberty, uterus after delivery	Disuse, denervation, ↓ blood supply, pressure, ↓ nutrition, ↓ endocrine
Metaplasia	One adult differentiated cell type replaced by another	—	Barrett esophagus, squamous metaplasia in smokers' bronchi
Hypoplasia	Incomplete development of an organ (fewer cells)	—	Unilateral renal hypoplasia
Agenesis / Aplasia	Complete absence of organ / its primordium; aplasia = primordium present but no development	—	Renal agenesis (Potter sequence)
Dysplasia	Disordered growth: loss of uniformity and architectural orientation	—	CIN, Barrett with dysplasia

Hypertrophy :

- Seen in permanent cells (cardiac, skeletal muscle) which cannot divide.
- Mechanism : mechanical sensors + growth factors (TGF-β, IGF-1, FGF) + vasoactive agents (α-adrenergic agonists, endothelin-1, angiotensin II).
- Signal pathways : PI3K/AKT (physiological), G-protein coupled receptor signalling (pathological).
- Switch of contractile proteins to fetal forms : α-myosin heavy chain → β-MHC (slower, energy-efficient contraction).
- ↑ ANP (atrial natriuretic peptide) gene expression in hypertrophied ventricle.

Filled

- Pure hypertrophy example : skeletal muscle, heart. Pure hyperplasia : liver regeneration. Both together : gravid uterus (smooth muscle).
- Selective hypertrophy of an organelle : ↑ smooth ER in hepatocytes with barbiturates / phenobarbital (CYP450 induction).
- Cardiac myocyte hypertrophy limit → myofibril fragmentation, loss of contractile elements → cardiac failure.

Hyperplasia :

- Occurs only in tissues capable of division (labile and stable cells).
- Driven by growth factors and stem-cell recruitment.
- Pathological hyperplasia is a fertile soil for cancer : endometrial hyperplasia → endometrial carcinoma; HPV papillomas.
- BPH is NOT pre-malignant for prostatic carcinoma.

Atrophy :

Causes :

1. Decreased workload (disuse atrophy)
2. Loss of innervation (denervation atrophy)
3. Diminished blood supply (senile atrophy of brain)
4. Inadequate nutrition (marasmus, cachexia — TNF-α)
5. Loss of endocrine stimulation (endometrium after menopause)
6. Pressure (erosion of vertebra by aortic aneurysm)

Mechanism :

- ↓ protein synthesis + ↑ protein degradation via ubiquitin-proteasome pathway.
- Autophagy (self-eating) → autophagic vacuoles.
- Residual bodies contain lipofuscin → brown atrophy (heart, liver of elderly).

Metaplasia :

- Reversible; reprogramming of stem cells, not change of differentiated cells.
- Driven by cytokines/growth factors + retinoic acid; transcription factors (SOX, CDX2).

Type	Example	Cause
Columnar → squamous (most common)	Bronchus	Cigarette smoking, vitamin A deficiency
Columnar → squamous	Endocervix (transformation zone)	Low vaginal pH
Transitional → squamous	Urinary bladder	Schistosoma haematobium, stones
Squamous → columnar (intestinal)	Barrett esophagus	GERD (acid reflux)
Gastric → intestinal	Stomach	H. pylori, autoimmune gastritis
Connective tissue	Myositis ossificans (bone in muscle)	Trauma / hemorrhage

Exam pearl

- Epithelial metaplasia is reversible; dysplasia may be reversible (low grade); carcinoma in situ is not invasive but irreversible.
- Myositis ossificans : "zonal pattern" — mature bone at periphery, immature fibroblasts at centre (opposite of osteosarcoma).
- Apocrine metaplasia in fibrocystic breast — not pre-malignant.

Cell Injury — Causes

1. Oxygen deprivation (hypoxia, ischemia) — the most common cause.

2. Physical agents (trauma, temperature, radiation, electric shock).
3. Chemical agents and drugs.
4. Infectious agents.
5. Immunologic reactions.
6. Genetic derangements.
7. Nutritional imbalances.

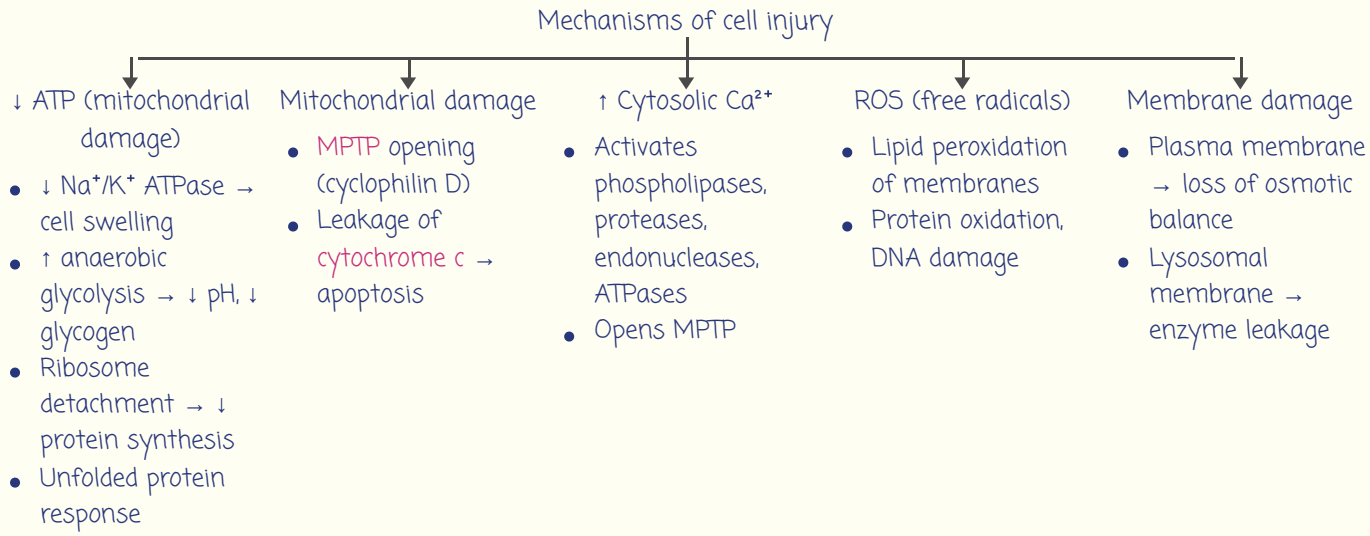
> Filled : Hypoxia vs ischemia
> - Ischemia injures tissues faster than hypoxia — loss of both O2 and metabolic substrates (glucose) + accumulation of toxic metabolites.
> - In hypoxia, anaerobic glycolysis continues; in ischemia it stops once substrates are exhausted.

Susceptibility of cells to ischemia :

Cell	Time to irreversible injury
Neurons	3-5 min
Myocardium	20-30 min (irreversible); hepatocytes 1-2 h
Fibroblasts, skeletal muscle	Many hours

- Most vulnerable neurons : CA1 of hippocampus (Sommer sector) → Purkinje cells of cerebellum → pyramidal cells of neocortex (layers 3, 5, 6).
- Most sensitive renal segment : proximal tubule (S3 segment) and thick ascending limb.
- Liver : zone 3 (centrilobular) most vulnerable to ischemia.

Mechanisms of Cell Injury



Free radicals (ROS) :

Generation :

1. Normal metabolism (reduction-oxidation reactions)
2. Absorption of radiant energy (UV, X-rays → hydrolysis of water)
3. Leukocyte respiratory burst (NADPH oxidase)
4. Enzymatic metabolism of chemicals (CCl_4 → CCl_3•)
5. Transition metals : Fenton reaction ($Fe^{2+} + H_2O_2 \rightarrow Fe^{3+} + OH\bullet + OH^-$)
6. Nitric oxide (NO) → peroxynitrite ($ONOO^-$)

Removal (antioxidants) :

1. Antioxidants : vitamin E (lipid-soluble, membrane), vitamin A, ascorbic acid, glutathione.

2. Storage/transport proteins that bind free iron and copper : transferrin, ferritin, lactoferrin, ceruloplasmin.
3. Enzymes :
   - Superoxide dismutase : $O_2^- \rightarrow H_2O_2$
   - Catalase (peroxisomes) : $2H_2O_2 \rightarrow O_2 + 2H_2O$
   - Glutathione peroxidase : $H_2O_2 + 2GSH \rightarrow GSSG + 2H_2O$

> Exam pearl
> - Most reactive (damaging) free radical : hydroxyl radical (OH•).
> - Superoxide dismutase is mitochondrial (Mn-SOD) and cytosolic (Cu/Zn-SOD).
> - Free-radical injury examples : CCl_4 hepatotoxicity, reperfusion injury, radiation, oxygen toxicity (retinopathy of prematurity, BPD), acetaminophen (NAPQI), aging.

Ischemia-reperfusion injury :

1. ↑ ROS generation by damaged mitochondria and leukocytes.
2. Intracellular calcium overload (MPTP opening).
3. Inflammation : neutrophil influx with cytokines.
4. Complement activation (IgM deposits in ischemic tissue).

- Morphology in heart : contraction band necrosis (hyper-contracted myofibrils due to Ca^{2+} influx).

Chemical injury :

Direct acting	Indirect (converted to toxic metabolites by CYP450)
Mercuric chloride — binds SH groups (kidney, GI)	$CCl_4 \rightarrow CCl_3$• — fatty liver, centrilobular necrosis
Cyanide — inhibits cytochrome oxidase	Acetaminophen → NAPQI — zone 3 necrosis, ↓ glutathione
Chemotherapeutic agents	Bromobenzene, vinyl chloride

Reversible Cell Injury

Two main features :

1. Cellular swelling (hydropic change / vacuolar degeneration) — earliest change; failure of Na^+/K^+ ATPase.
2. Fatty change (steatosis) — liver, heart, kidney (organs in lipid metabolism).

Ultrastructural changes (reversible) :

1. Plasma membrane alterations : blebbing, blunting, loss of microvilli.
2. Mitochondrial changes : swelling, small amorphous densities.
3. Dilatation of ER with detachment of polysomes.
4. Nuclear alterations : disaggregation of granular and fibrillar elements.
5. Myelin figures : phospholipid whorls from damaged membranes.

> Filled : Reversible vs irreversible — point of no return
> - Two phenomena characterize irreversibility : (1) inability to restore mitochondrial function (lack of oxidative phosphorylation) even after reperfusion, (2) profound disturbances in membrane function.
> - Large flocculent amorphous densities in mitochondria → irreversible (ischemic myocardium).
> - Leakage of enzymes (troponin, CK-MB, ALT) indicates membrane damage → irreversible injury.

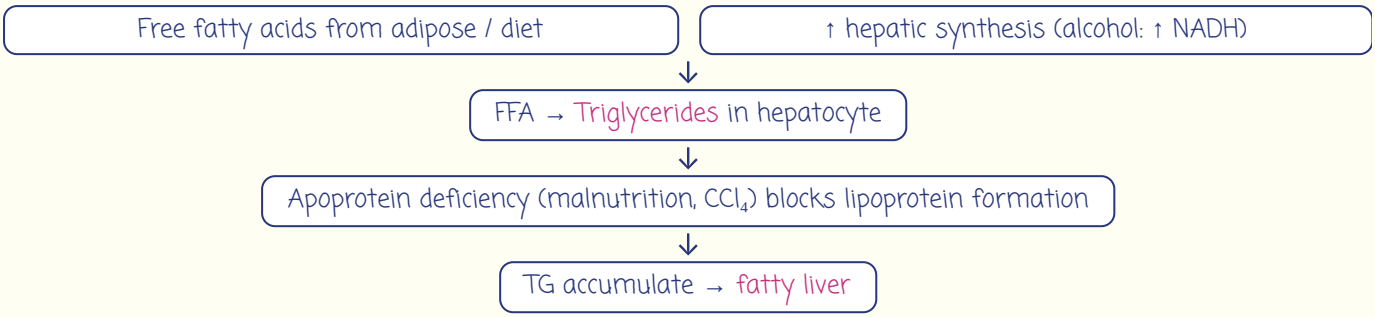
Fatty change (steatosis) — liver :

Causes :

1. Alcohol (most common in developed countries)
2. Non-alcoholic fatty liver disease (obesity, diabetes, metabolic syndrome)
3. Protein malnutrition (kwashiorkor — ↓ apoprotein)

4. Toxins (CCl_4), drugs (tetracycline, valproate)
5. Starvation, hypoxia, pregnancy (acute fatty liver of pregnancy)
6. Reye syndrome (aspirin in children, microvesicular)

Pathogenesis of fatty liver



Feature	Microvesicular	Macrovesicular
Appearance	Many small droplets, central nucleus	Single large vacuole, nucleus pushed to periphery
Causes	Reye syndrome, acute fatty liver of pregnancy, valproate, tetracycline	Alcohol, obesity, diabetes, malnutrition
Significance	Mitochondrial dysfunction; can be severe	Usually benign, reversible

- Stains : fat dissolved in routine paraffin sections (clear vacuoles); demonstrated by Oil Red O and Sudan III/IV on frozen sections; osmium tetroxide (black).
- Heart : fatty change in prolonged moderate hypoxia (profound anemia) → tigered effect / "thrush-breast" heart (bands of yellow myocardium alternating with red-brown) in the papillary muscles.

Hyaline change :

- Homogeneous, glassy, pink (eosinophilic) appearance on H&E — a descriptive term, not a specific lesion.

Intracellular hyaline	Extracellular hyaline
Mallory-Denk bodies (alcoholic hepatitis — keratin)	Hyaline arteriolosclerosis (benign HTN, diabetes)
Russell bodies (immunoglobulin in plasma cells)	Hyaline in old scars, corpora albicantia
Councilman bodies (apoptotic hepatocytes)	Hyaline membranes (ARDS, HMD of newborn)
Hyaline droplets in PCT (proteinuria)	Amyloid (hyaline-like)
Zenker's hyaline degeneration of muscle (typhoid)	Hyaline cartilage-like scar

Other intracellular accumulations :

Substance	Examples
Cholesterol	Atherosclerosis (foam cells), xanthomas, cholesterolosis (strawberry gallbladder), Niemann-Pick type C
Proteins	Russell bodies, Mallory hyaline, α1-antitrypsin globules (PAS +, diastase-resistant)
Glycogen	Diabetes (Armanni-Ebstein lesion — PCT/loop of Henle), glycogen storage diseases (stain : PAS + diastase-sensitive, Best carmine)
Pigments	Lipofuscin, melanin, hemosiderin, bilirubin, carbon (see Pigments chapter)

Irreversible Injury — Necrosis

- Necrosis : death of cells in a living organism due to severe injury, always pathological, with inflammation.

Morphology of necrotic cell :

- Cytoplasm : ↑ eosinophilia (loss of RNA + denatured proteins), glassy, myelin figures, calcification.
- Nucleus :

Pyknosis (shrinkage, ↑ basophilia) → Karyorrhexis (fragmentation) → Karyolysis (fading; DNase)

Patterns of necrosis :

Type	Mechanism / features	Classic examples
Coagulative	Protein denaturation > enzymatic digestion; architecture preserved for days ("ghost cells")	Infarcts of all solid organs except brain (heart, kidney, spleen)
Liquefactive	Enzymatic digestion dominates; tissue becomes liquid, creamy (pus)	Brain infarct, abscess (bacterial/fungal)
Caseous	"Cheese-like", friable white; granuloma with central amorphous granular debris	Tuberculosis, histoplasmosis, coccidioidomycosis
Fat necrosis	Lipases release FA → combine with Ca^{2+} (saponification) → chalky white	Acute pancreatitis, traumatic fat necrosis of breast
Fibrinoid	Immune complexes + fibrin in vessel walls; bright pink, amorphous	Malignant hypertension, vasculitis (PAN), Aschoff body, preeclampsia
Gangrenous (clinical term)	Usually coagulative necrosis of limb (dry), + bacterial liquefaction (wet)	Diabetic foot, intestinal gangrene

Filled : Extra high-yield

- Gumma (tertiary syphilis) — rubbery necrosis, architecture of vessels partially preserved (ghost outlines) — vs caseation where outlines are lost.
- Caseation without TB : histoplasmosis, coccidioidomycosis, sarcoid (rarely, no), tularemia, cat-scratch (stellate microabscess).
- Fibrinoid necrosis in placenta (normal finding at term — Nitabuch layer).
- Fat necrosis in breast can mimic carcinoma clinically (hard lump + skin retraction) — history of trauma.

Apoptosis

- Programmed cell death; membrane intact, no inflammation.
- Hallmark morphology : cell shrinkage, chromatin condensation (pyknosis, most characteristic), cytoplasmic blebs, apoptotic bodies, phagocytosis by macrophages.
- DNA fragmentation : step-ladder pattern on agarose gel (internucleosomal, 180-200 bp multiples) vs smear pattern in necrosis.

Causes :

Physiological :

1. Embryogenesis (implantation, organogenesis, involution — e.g., interdigital webs)
2. Hormone-dependent involution (endometrium in menstruation, ovarian follicular atresia, breast after weaning)
3. Cell turnover in proliferating populations (intestinal crypt epithelium)
4. Elimination of self-reactive lymphocytes (negative selection in thymus)
5. Death of host cells that have served their purpose (neutrophils after acute inflammation)

Pathological :

1. DNA damage (radiation, cytotoxic drugs)
2. Accumulation of misfolded proteins (ER stress)
3. Infections — viral hepatitis (Councilman bodies)
4. Pathological atrophy in parenchymal organs after duct obstruction (pancreas, kidney, parotid)
5. Cell death by cytotoxic T cells (graft rejection)

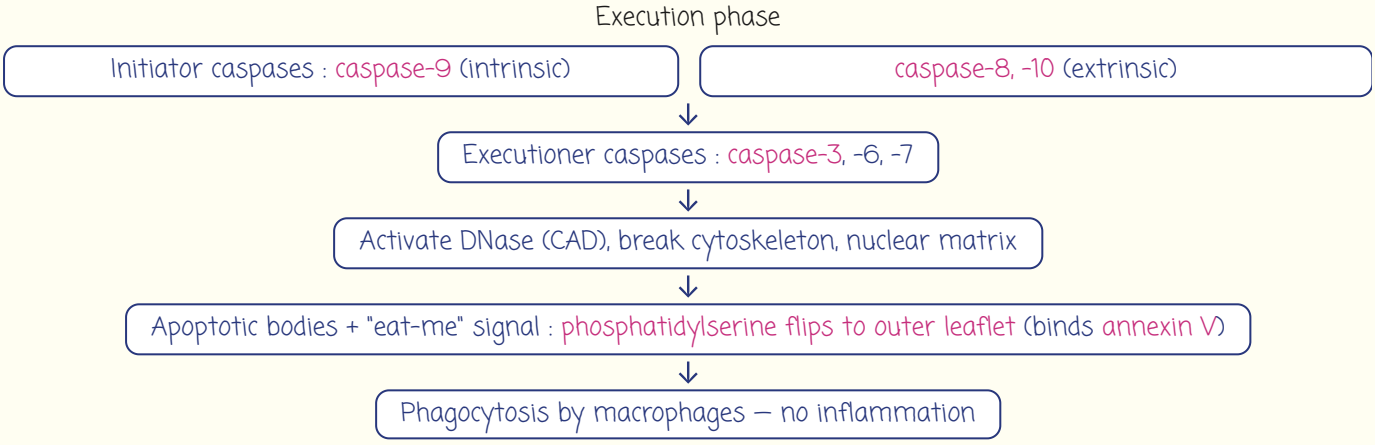
Pathways :

Intrinsic (mitochondrial) pathway :

- Most common pathway.
- Trigger : ↓ growth factors, DNA damage (p53), misfolded proteins.
- BH3-only sensors (BIM, BID, BAD, PUMA, NOXA) ↑ → activate BAX/BAK (pro-apoptotic).
- ↓ BCL-2, BCL-XL, MCL-1 (anti-apoptotic).
- Cytochrome c release → binds APAF-1 → apoptosome → caspase-9 (initiator).

Extrinsic (death receptor) pathway :

- Death receptors : TNFR1, Fas (CD95) — have death domain.
- FasL (on activated T cells) binds Fas → adaptor FADD → caspase-8 (also caspase-10).
- Inhibitor : FLIP (viral and cellular).
- Role : eliminating self-reactive lymphocytes, CTL killing.
- Defect → autoimmune lymphoproliferative syndrome (ALPS).



Filled : Rank boosters — apoptosis

- Caspase = cysteine protease that cleaves after aspartic acid.
- BCL-2 overexpression by t(14;18) → follicular lymphoma (failure of apoptosis).
- IAP (inhibitor of apoptosis proteins) block caspases; SMAC/DIABLO from mitochondria neutralize IAP.
- Markers of apoptosis : annexin V, TUNEL assay, caspase-3 cleavage, DNA ladder.
- Granzyme B from CTL activates caspases directly (and BID); perforin makes pores.
- p53 → PUMA/NOXA → BAX/BAK; also arrests cell cycle via p21.

Necrosis vs Apoptosis :

Feature	Necrosis	Apoptosis
Cell size	Enlarged (swelling)	Reduced (shrinkage)
Nucleus	Pyknosis → karyorrhexis → karyolysis	Fragmentation into nucleosome-size pieces
Plasma membrane	Disrupted	Intact; altered structure (lipid orientation)
Cellular contents	Enzymatic digestion; may leak out	Intact; released in apoptotic bodies
Inflammation	Frequent	None
Role	Always pathological	Often physiological; may be pathological
DNA on gel	Smear	Ladder
ATP	Not required	Energy-dependent

Other Forms of Cell Death

Type	Key molecules	Features / examples
Necroptosis	RIPK1, RIPK3 → MLKL	Programmed necrosis, caspase-independent; TNF; Crohn disease, pancreatitis, reperfusion; CMV inhibits
Pyroptosis	Inflammasome → caspase-1 (also 4, 5, 11) → gasdermin D pores	Fever (IL-1β, IL-18); infected cells (Salmonella, Shigella)

Type	Key molecules	Features / examples
Ferroptosis	Iron-dependent lipid peroxidation; ↓ GPX4 / glutathione	Stroke, neurodegeneration, cancer; inhibited by ferrostatin
Autophagy	Beclin-1, LC3, ATG genes; mTOR inhibition	Starvation survival; defects in Crohn (ATG16L1), Alzheimer, Huntington
Entosis	Cell engulfed by neighbour	"Cell-in-cell" in tumours
Anoikis	Loss of integrin-matrix attachment	Prevents metastasis; resistance in cancer
NETosis	Neutrophil extracellular traps (PAD4)	Sepsis, SLE, thrombosis
Parthanatos	PARP-1 overactivation, AIF	Stroke, DNA damage

Mnemonic : Ferroptosis

"Ferro = Fe, peroxidation, GPX4 guards" — iron + lipid ROS; not apoptosis (no caspases).

Autophagy

- "Self-eating" — delivers cytoplasmic materials to lysosomes.
- Types : macroautophagy (main), microautophagy, chaperone-mediated autophagy.
- Steps : nucleation (Beclin-1 / VPS34) → elongation (ATG genes, LC3) → autophagosome → fusion with lysosome → autophagolysosome.
- Induced by nutrient deprivation (mTOR inhibition).

Cellular Aging

1. DNA damage (accumulated mutations; defective repair — Werner syndrome: DNA helicase, Bloom syndrome).
2. Replicative senescence — telomere shortening (Hayflick limit); telomerase active in germ/stem/cancer cells.
3. Defective protein homeostasis (↓ chaperones, ↓ proteasome).
4. Dysregulated nutrient sensing : caloric restriction ↑ lifespan via ↓ IGF-1 and ↓ mTOR, ↑ sirtuins (NAD-dependent deacetylases).
5. Persistent inflammation ("inflammaging"), ROS.

Filled : Progeria syndromes

Syndrome	Defect
Werner syndrome	WRN — DNA helicase (RecQ) — adult-onset premature aging
Hutchinson-Gilford progeria	LMNA (lamin A) — progerin — childhood aging
Bloom syndrome	BLM helicase
Ataxia telangiectasia	ATM kinase — radiation sensitivity
Dyskeratosis congenita	Telomerase (TERC/TERT/DKC1)

CALCIFICATION & AMYLOIDOSIS

Pathological Calcification

- Abnormal tissue deposition of calcium salts with small amounts of iron, magnesium and other minerals.
- Stain : von Kossa (black — actually stains phosphate/carbonate), Alizarin red S (red-orange, calcium). On H&E : basophilic, amorphous, granular.

Feature	Dystrophic	Metastatic
Serum calcium	Normal	Hypercalcemia
Tissue	Dead / dying (necrotic) tissue	Normal (viable) tissue
Common sites	Atheroma, damaged / aging heart valves, caseous TB, infarcts, dead parasites	Interstitial tissue of gastric mucosa, kidneys, lungs, systemic arteries, pulmonary veins
Mechanism	Initiation in membrane-bound vesicles (phospholipids + phosphatase) or extracellular	Loss of acid (H^+) → alkaline compartment favours deposition
Clinical	Usually a marker of prior injury	Nephrocalcinosis, respiratory deficits

Mnemonic : Sites of metastatic calcification

"Calcium loves alkaline tissues" — tissues that excrete acid have an internal alkaline compartment : gastric mucosa (HCl), kidney (H^+), lung (CO_2).

Causes of metastatic calcification (hypercalcemia) :

1. ↑ Parathyroid hormone — primary hyperparathyroidism, PTHrP from tumours (squamous cell lung carcinoma)
2. Bone destruction — multiple myeloma, leukemia, skeletal metastases, Paget disease (accelerated turnover), immobilization
3. Vitamin D-related — vitamin D intoxication, sarcoidosis (macrophages activate vitamin D), idiopathic hypercalcemia of infancy (Williams syndrome)
4. Renal failure — phosphate retention → secondary hyperparathyroidism
5. Milk-alkali syndrome (excess calcium + absorbable antacids)
6. Aluminium intoxication (chronic dialysis)

Dystrophic calcification — examples :

1. Atherosclerotic plaques (advanced atheroma)
2. Aging or damaged heart valves (calcific aortic stenosis, bicuspid aortic valve)
3. Caseous necrosis in TB (Ghon complex, calcified lymph nodes)
4. Fat necrosis (pancreatitis — "chalky white")
5. Mönckeberg medial calcific sclerosis (medium muscular arteries, > 50 y)
6. Dead parasites — hydatid cyst wall, cysticercus, Schistosoma eggs
7. Thrombi (phleboliths in veins)
8. Tumours — psammoma bodies

Psammoma bodies :

- Laminated, concentric calcified structures (dystrophic) formed by progressive deposition on single necrotic cells.

Mnemonic : Psammoma bodies — "PSaMMOMa"

Papillary carcinoma of thyroid · Serous cystadenocarcinoma of ovary · Meningioma · Malignant Mesothelioma · also prolactinoma, papillary RCC, somatostatinoma (duodenum), endometrial serous carcinoma.

Filled

- Calciphylaxis (calcific uremic arteriolopathy) — end-stage renal disease, ↑ Ca × P product, medial calcification of small arteries → painful skin necrosis.
- Calcinosis cutis in CREST / limited scleroderma, dermatomyositis (children).
- Heterotopic ossification = bone formation (not just calcium) in soft tissue — myositis ossificans.
- Michaelis-Gutmann bodies (target-like, calcified, PAS+, von Kossa +) — malakoplakia of bladder (defective macrophage lysosomal killing of E. coli).
- Schaumann bodies (laminated calcium + protein) and asteroid bodies — sarcoidosis.

Amyloidosis

- Extracellular deposition of misfolded proteins which aggregate into insoluble fibrils with a β-pleated sheet configuration.
- All amyloid : ~95% fibril protein + 5% P component (serum amyloid P, pentraxin) + glycosaminoglycans (heparan sulfate).

Physical nature :

- EM : non-branching fibrils, 7.5-10 nm diameter, indefinite length.
- X-ray crystallography / infrared spectroscopy : cross-β-pleated sheet conformation (responsible for Congo red birefringence).

Staining :

Stain	Result
H&E	Pale eosinophilic, amorphous, hyaline extracellular material
Congo red (light microscopy)	Pink / red (salmon-pink)
Congo red under polarized light	Apple-green birefringence (most specific)
Gross (Lugol's iodine)	Mahogany brown → blue-violet with dilute H_2SO_4 (starch-like, hence "amyloid" by Virchow)
Thioflavin T / S	Fluorescence (UV)
Crystal violet / methyl violet	Metachromasia (rose-pink on violet)
Immunohistochemistry / mass spectrometry	Typing of amyloid (gold standard for type)

Classification of amyloid proteins :

Protein	Precursor	Clinical setting
AL (amyloid light chain)	Ig light chains (λ > κ)	Primary / plasma cell dyscrasia — multiple myeloma, B-cell neoplasms
AA (amyloid-associated)	SAA (acute phase, liver; IL-1/IL-6)	Reactive systemic (secondary) — chronic inflammation
Aβ2m (β2-microglobulin)	β2-microglobulin (MHC-I)	Long-term hemodialysis — carpal tunnel, joints
ATTR	Transthyretin (normal or mutant)	Familial amyloid polyneuropathy; senile systemic amyloidosis (heart, wild-type TTR)
Aβ (amyloid β)	APP (amyloid precursor protein)	Alzheimer disease, cerebral amyloid angiopathy
ACal	(Pro)calcitonin	Medullary carcinoma thyroid
AIAPP	Amylin (islet amyloid polypeptide)	Type 2 diabetes (islets)

Protein	Precursor	Clinical setting
AANF	Atrial natriuretic factor	Isolated atrial amyloidosis (elderly)
APrP	Prion protein	Spongiform encephalopathies
AA (mutant pyrin)	SAA	Familial Mediterranean fever (MEFV — pyrin)
ALys / AFib / AApoA1	Lysozyme, fibrinogen, apo A1	Hereditary renal amyloidosis

Causes of reactive systemic (AA) amyloidosis :

1. Tuberculosis (most common in India), bronchiectasis, chronic osteomyelitis, lepromatous leprosy
2. Rheumatoid arthritis (most common in West), ankylosing spondylitis
3. Inflammatory bowel disease (Crohn > UC)
4. Skin popping (s.c. heroin abuse)
5. Non-immunocyte tumours : renal cell carcinoma, Hodgkin lymphoma
6. Familial Mediterranean fever, other auto-inflammatory syndromes

Pathogenesis :

Normal protein that misfolds (↑ production or ↑ tendency)

Mutant protein prone to misfolding

↓

Misfolded proteins escape proteasomal / chaperone degradation

↓

Aggregation into oligomers → fibrils (β-pleated sheet)

↓

Extracellular deposition → pressure atrophy of adjacent cells; oligomers are toxic

Exam pearl

- Primary AL amyloid : most common form in developed countries; occurs in 5-15% of multiple myeloma.
- Bence Jones protein (free light chains) in urine/serum in AL amyloidosis — even without overt myeloma ("monoclonal gammopathy").
- AL amyloidosis = Congo red + ; AA = Congo red loses affinity after potassium permanganate ($KMnO_4$) treatment; AL is permanganate-resistant.

Morphology (organ involvement) :

Organ	Features
Kidney (most common, most serious)	Enlarged, pale, waxy; deposits in glomeruli (mesangium, subendothelial) → nephrotic syndrome; later shrunken. Peritubular and vessel walls.
Spleen	Sago spleen (deposits in splenic follicles — tapioca-like granules); Lardaceous spleen (deposits in red pulp / sinusoid walls — map-like).
Liver	Hepatomegaly; deposits in space of Disse → pressure atrophy of hepatocytes; liver function usually preserved.
Heart	Restrictive cardiomyopathy, conduction disturbances, low voltage ECG with thick walls; "sparkling / granular" echo; most common cause of death in AL amyloid. Subendocardial deposits.
Others	Macroglossia (AL), carpal tunnel syndrome, adrenal insufficiency, GI malabsorption, periorbital purpura ("raccoon eyes", AL), pinch purpura

Diagnosis — biopsy sites :

1. Abdominal fat pad aspiration — preferred screening (simple, safe)
2. Rectal biopsy (submucosal vessels) — 75% positive

3. Gingival / labial salivary gland biopsy
4. Renal biopsy — most sensitive in renal disease
5. Bone marrow biopsy (AL)
6. Serum / urine immunofixation and free light chain assay; scintigraphy (SAP scan, Tc-PYP for ATTR cardiac)

Filled : Rank boosters

- Localized amyloidosis : nodular lung, larynx, skin, bladder, tongue; endocrine amyloid (medullary Ca thyroid, islet in T2DM, pituitary prolactinoma).
- Senile cardiac amyloidosis (wild-type ATTR) — men > 70 y; ATTR V122I mutation in 4% African Americans.
- Drug for ATTR : Tafamidis (TTR stabilizer), Patisiran (siRNA), Inotersen.
- β2-microglobulin is not removed by cuprophane dialysis membranes.
- Amyloid in Alzheimer : Aβ42 — neuritic plaques; APP gene on chromosome 21 → early Alzheimer in Down syndrome.
- Hereditary : Familial Mediterranean fever — autosomal recessive, MEFV (pyrin), AA amyloid; Muckle-Wells (cryopyrin) — AA.
- Most common cause of death in systemic amyloidosis overall : renal failure (AA) / cardiac (AL).

INFLAMMATION

Overview

- Protective response involving host cells, blood vessels, proteins and mediators, intended to eliminate the initial cause and the necrotic cells, and initiate repair.
- Cardinal signs : Rubor, Calor, Tumor, Dolor (Celsus) + Functio laesa (loss of function — Virchow).

Feature	Acute	Chronic
Onset	Fast : minutes-hours	Slow : days
Cellular infiltrate	Mainly neutrophils	Monocytes / macrophages, lymphocytes, plasma cells
Tissue injury, fibrosis	Usually mild, self-limited	Often severe and progressive
Local & systemic signs	Prominent	Less
Hallmark	Exudation (edema)	Tissue destruction + repair (angiogenesis, fibrosis) simultaneously

Stimuli for acute inflammation :

1. Infections (bacterial, viral, fungal, parasitic) and microbial toxins
2. Tissue necrosis (ischemia, trauma, burns)
3. Foreign bodies (splinters, sutures, urate / cholesterol crystals)
4. Immune reactions (hypersensitivity, autoimmunity)

Recognition of microbes and damaged cells :

Receptor	Ligand / function
Toll-like receptors (TLRs)	PAMPs; TLR4 → LPS (with CD14), TLR2 → peptidoglycan/lipoteichoic acid, TLR5 → flagellin, TLR3 → dsRNA, TLR7/8 → ssRNA, TLR9 → CpG DNA
NOD-like receptors / inflammasome (NLRP3)	DAMPs — urate crystals (gout), cholesterol, ATP, K^+ efflux → caspase-1 → IL-1β
C-type lectin receptors	Fungal glycans (Dectin-1)
RIG-like receptors	Viral RNA (cytosol)

Filled

- Gain-of-function NLRP3 (cryopyrin) mutations → cryopyrin-associated periodic syndromes (Muckle-Wells, FCAS) → treated with anakinra (IL-1R antagonist).
- TLRs : all are on cell surface except TLR3, 7, 8, 9 (endosomal — nucleic acids).

Vascular Events

1. Transient vasoconstriction (seconds) — first, neurogenic.
2. Vasodilation (histamine, NO) — erythema, warmth (earliest consistent change).
3. Increased vascular permeability → exudate → hallmark of acute inflammation.
4. Stasis (slowing of circulation, ↑ viscosity) → margination of leukocytes.

Mechanisms of increased vascular permeability :

Mechanism	Mediators	Vessel	Timing
Endothelial cell contraction (most common)	Histamine, bradykinin, leukotrienes, substance P	Post-capillary venules	Immediate transient (15-30 min)
Endothelial retraction (cytoskeletal reorganization)	IL-1, TNF, IFN-γ	Venules	Delayed (4-6 h), prolonged (24 h+)

Mechanism	Mediators	Vessel	Timing
Direct endothelial injury	Burns, toxins	All (venules, capillaries, arterioles)	Immediate sustained
Delayed prolonged leakage	Mild thermal injury, X-rays, UV (sunburn), some bacterial toxins	Venules + capillaries	Begins 2–12 h, lasts hours–days
Leukocyte-mediated injury	ROS, proteases	Venules, pulmonary capillaries	Late
Transcytosis (VVO)	VEGF	Venules	—
Leakage from new vessels	VEGF (angiogenesis)	Regenerating vessels	Until mature

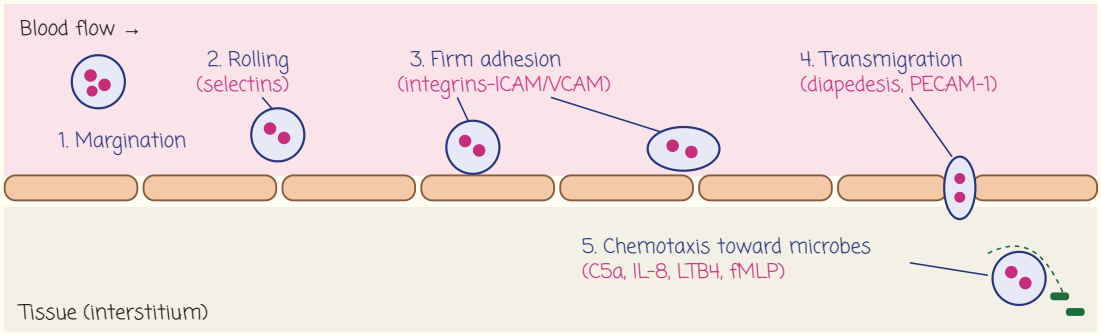
Exudate vs transudate :

Feature	Exudate	Transudate
Mechanism	↑ vascular permeability (inflammation)	↑ hydrostatic / ↓ oncotic pressure
Protein	> 3 g/dL	< 3 g/dL
Specific gravity	> 1.020	< 1.012
Cells	Many (inflammatory)	Few
Light's criteria (pleural)	Fluid/serum protein > 0.5; fluid/serum LDH > 0.6; fluid LDH > 2/3 upper limit of normal serum LDH	Not met

Exam pearl

- Lymphatics proliferate in inflammation; lymphangitis (red streaks) + lymphadenitis — e.g., streptococcal cellulitis.
- Edema due to inflammation = exudate; pus = purulent exudate rich in neutrophils, dead cells, microbes.

Cellular Events — Leukocyte Recruitment



Endothelium of post-capillary venule (main site of leukocyte exit)

Steps of leukocyte extravasation (labelled)

Adhesion molecules :

Endothelial molecule	Leukocyte ligand	Role
P-selectin (CD62P) — from Weibel-Palade bodies (histamine, thrombin)	Sialyl-Lewis X (PSGL-1)	Rolling
E-selectin (CD62E) — induced by IL-1, TNF	Sialyl-Lewis X	Rolling, adhesion
GlyCam-1, CD34	L-selectin (CD62L)	Rolling (homing of lymphocytes to HEV)

Endothelial molecule	Leukocyte ligand	Role
ICAM-1 (Ig family)	LFA-1 (CD11a/CD18), Mac-1 (CD11b/CD18) — β2 integrins	Firm adhesion, arrest, transmigration
VCAM-1	VLA-4 (β1 integrin)	Adhesion (eosinophils, monocytes, lymphocytes)
PECAM-1 (CD31)	PECAM-1	Transmigration (diapedesis)

- Integrin affinity ↑ by chemokines (IL-8) displayed on endothelium ("inside-out" signalling).
- Leukocytes pierce basement membrane by collagenases.
- Neutrophils dominate first 6-24 h, replaced by monocytes in 24-48 h (exception : Pseudomonas — neutrophils persist; viral — lymphocytes first; allergy — eosinophils).

Leukocyte adhesion deficiency (LAD) :

Type	Defect	Features
LAD-1	β2 integrin (CD18) — ITGB2	Delayed separation of umbilical cord (> 30 days), recurrent bacterial infections without pus, neutrophilia, periodontitis
LAD-2	Sialyl-Lewis X (fucosyl transferase — fucose metabolism)	Milder infections, Bombay blood group, mental retardation, short stature
LAD-3	Kindlin-3 (integrin activation)	LAD-1 like + bleeding (Glanzmann-like)

Chemotaxis :

- Exogenous : N-formyl methionine peptides (bacterial), lipids.
- Endogenous : C5a, LTB4, IL-8 (CXCL8), kallikrein, platelet activating factor.
- Receptors : 7-transmembrane G-protein coupled; movement via actin polymerization at leading edge (filopodia).

Phagocytosis & killing :

Recognition & attachment (opsonins : IgG Fc, C3b, collectins/MBL) → Engulfment (phagosome) → Fusion with lysosome (phagolysosome) → Killing & degradation

Killing mechanism	Details
Oxygen-dependent (respiratory burst)	NADPH oxidase (phagocyte oxidase) : $O_2 \rightarrow O_2^- \rightarrow H_2O_2$; Myeloperoxidase (MPO) : $H_2O_2 + Cl^- \rightarrow$ HOCl (hypochlorous acid / bleach) — most potent bactericidal system
Nitric oxide	iNOS (macrophages) → $NO + O_2^- \rightarrow$ peroxynitrite
Oxygen-independent	Lysozyme, lactoferrin, major basic protein (eosinophils), defensins, BPI, elastase, cathelicidins
NETs	Extracellular chromatin + granule proteins (PAD4 → citrullinated histones); anti-NET antibodies in SLE

Defects in leukocyte function :

Disease	Defect	Key features
Chronic granulomatous disease (CGD)	NADPH oxidase (gp91phox — X-linked, CYBB, 70%; autosomal recessive p47phox)	Infections with catalase-positive organisms (S. aureus, Aspergillus, Nocardia, Serratia, Burkholderia); granulomas. Test : NBT test (no blue), dihydrorhodamine (DHR) flow cytometry (preferred)
Chédiak-Higashi syndrome	LYST — lysosomal trafficking (AR)	Giant granules in neutrophils, partial albinism, peripheral neuropathy, bleeding, NK defect
Myeloperoxidase deficiency	MPO	Most common inherited phagocyte defect; mostly asymptomatic; Candida infections in diabetics; NBT normal
LAD 1/2	Integrins / selectin ligands	See above

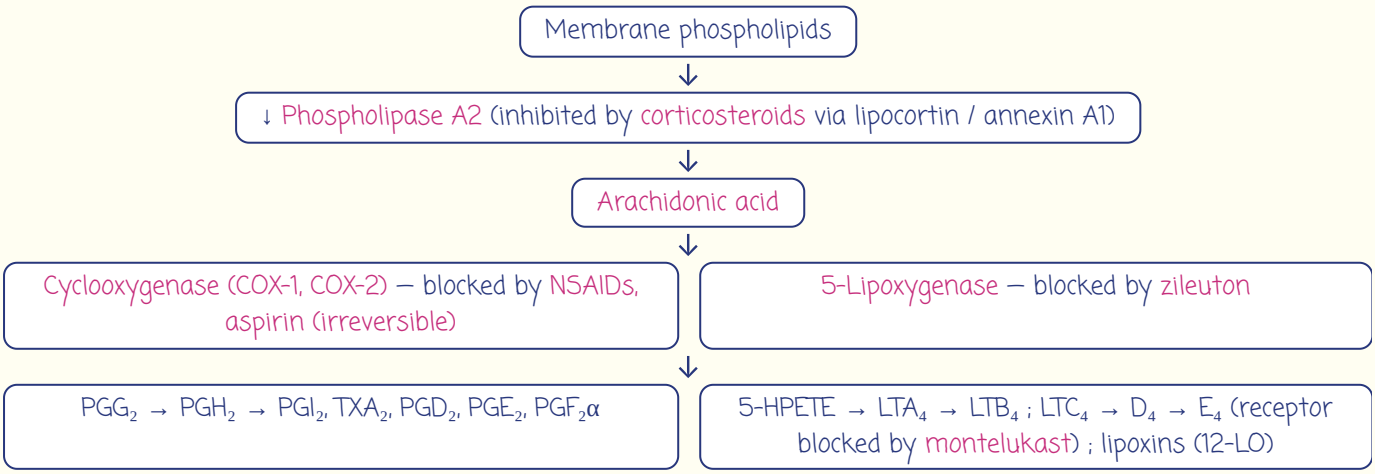
Disease	Defect	Key features
Hyper-IgE (Job) syndrome	STAT3 (AD)	Cold staphylococcal abscesses, eczema, ↑ IgE, retained primary teeth, coarse facies, ↓ Th17

Mnemonic : Catalase-positive organisms in CGD — "Cats Need PLACESS"
Nocardia, Pseudomonas, Listeria, Aspergillus, Candida, E. coli, Staph aureus, Serratia (+ Burkholderia cepacia).

Chemical Mediators

Mediator	Source	Principal actions
Histamine	Mast cells, basophils, platelets	Vasodilation, ↑ permeability (immediate), endothelial activation
Serotonin (5-HT)	Platelets, enterochromaffin cells	Vasoconstriction, ↑ permeability
PGI_2 (prostacyclin)	Endothelium	Vasodilation, inhibits platelet aggregation
TXA_2	Platelets	Vasoconstriction, platelet aggregation
PGE_2	Mast cells, leukocytes	Pain, fever, vasodilation
PGD_2	Mast cells	Vasodilation, ↑ permeability, chemotaxis
LTB_4	Leukocytes	Chemotaxis, leukocyte activation
LTC_4, D_4, E_4 (SRS-A)	Leukocytes, mast cells	Bronchospasm, ↑ permeability, vasoconstriction
Lipoxins (LXA_4, B_4)	Leukocytes + platelets (transcellular)	Anti-inflammatory — inhibit neutrophil recruitment
PAF	Leukocytes, mast cells	Platelet aggregation, bronchospasm, ↑ permeability, vasodilation (low dose)
TNF, IL-1	Macrophages, endothelium, mast cells	Endothelial activation, fever, acute phase response, cachexia (TNF)
IL-6	Macrophages	Acute phase proteins (liver)
Chemokines (IL-8)	Leukocytes, macrophages	Chemotaxis
Bradykinin	Plasma (kininogen)	↑ Permeability, pain, vasodilation, bronchoconstriction
C3a, C5a	Plasma (complement)	Anaphylatoxins → mast cell histamine release; C5a : chemotaxis
C3b	Complement	Opsonin
NO	Endothelium (eNOS), macrophages (iNOS)	Vasodilation, microbial killing, ↓ platelet adhesion

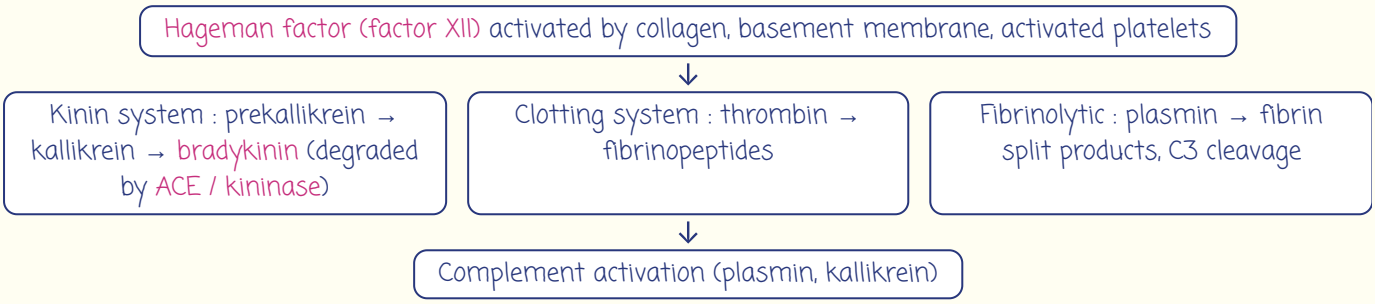
Arachidonic acid pathway :



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- Aspirin acetylates COX → also triggers aspirin-triggered lipoxins (15-epi-LX) — anti-inflammatory.
- Resolvins, protectins (from omega-3 fatty acids) → resolution of inflammation.
- Aspirin-exacerbated respiratory disease (Samter triad) : asthma + nasal polyps + aspirin sensitivity — shunting to LT pathway.
- Most important mediators of fever : IL-1, TNF, IL-6 → COX in hypothalamus → PGE_2 (reset thermostat).

Plasma protease systems :



- ACE inhibitors → ↑ bradykinin → cough, angioedema.
- C1-inhibitor deficiency → hereditary angioedema (↑ bradykinin; ↓ C4).

Complement system :

Pathway	Trigger	Key steps
Classical	Antigen-antibody (IgM > IgG3 > IgG1), $C1q$	C1 → C4, C2 → C3 convertase (C4b2a)
Alternative	Microbial surfaces (LPS), spontaneous C3 hydrolysis	C3b + factor B, factor D → C3bBb (stabilized by properdin)
Lectin	Mannose-binding lectin on microbes	MASP → C4, C2

- Common : C3 convertase → C5 convertase → C5b-C9 (MAC) → lysis.
- Regulators : C1 inhibitor, DAF (CD55) and CD59 (MIRL) (↓ in PNH), factor H, factor I.

Deficiency	Result
$C1q$, C2, C4 (early classical)	SLE-like immune complex disease (C2 = most common deficiency)
C3	Severe pyogenic infections, immune complex GN
C5-C9 (MAC)	Recurrent Neisseria infections
C1 inhibitor	Hereditary angioedema
DAF / CD59	PNH
Factor H / I	Atypical HUS, C3 glomerulopathy

Morphologic Patterns of Acute Inflammation

Pattern	Features	Examples
Serous	Thin, cell-poor fluid	Skin blister (burn), serous effusions, viral
Fibrinous	Fibrin deposition in body cavities	Bread-and-butter pericarditis (rheumatic, uremic), lobar pneumonia, fibrinous pleuritis
Suppurative / purulent	Pus — neutrophils, necrotic debris	Abscess (S. aureus), acute appendicitis
Ulcer	Local defect / excavation of surface	Peptic ulcer, aphthous ulcer
Pseudomembranous	Necrotic epithelium + fibrin + exudate membrane	C. difficile colitis, diphtheria
Catarrhal	Mucus hypersecretion	Common cold, allergic rhinitis

Pattern	Features	Examples
Hemorrhagic	Exudate with RBCs	Plague, anthrax, meningococcal septicemia, influenza pneumonia
Membranous (croupous)	Fibrin + necrotic cells on surface	Diphtheria (also pseudomembranous)
Cellulitis	Diffuse spread through tissue planes	Streptococcus pyogenes (hyaluronidase, streptokinase)

Exam pearl

- Abscess : central necrosis + neutrophils, surrounded by zone of preserved neutrophils → vascular dilatation → fibroblast proliferation (pyogenic membrane).
- Outcome of acute inflammation : resolution, chronic inflammation, fibrosis (scarring), abscess.

Chronic Inflammation

Causes :

1. Persistent infections — TB, Treponema, fungi, viruses, parasites (delayed-type hypersensitivity)
2. Hypersensitivity diseases — autoimmune (RA, IBD), allergic (asthma)
3. Prolonged exposure to toxic agents — exogenous (silica), endogenous (cholesterol in atherosclerosis)
4. Some diseases not conventionally inflammatory — Alzheimer, metabolic syndrome, cancer

Cells of chronic inflammation :

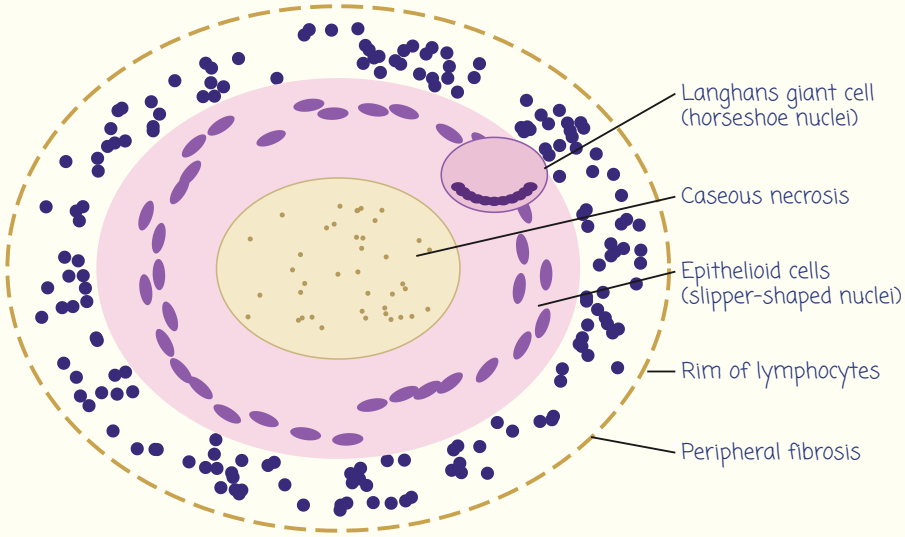
Cell	Key points
Macrophage (dominant cell)	Monocyte → tissue; half-life of monocyte ~1 day, macrophage months-years. M1 (classical) : IFN-γ, LPS → microbicidal (NO, ROS). M2 (alternative) : IL-4, IL-13 → repair, fibrosis (TGF-β), anti-inflammatory (IL-10)
Lymphocytes	Th1 (IFN-γ) → macrophage activation; Th2 (IL-4, 5, 13) → eosinophils; Th17 (IL-17) → neutrophils
Plasma cells	Antibody production; Russell bodies; "cartwheel / clock-face" chromatin
Eosinophils	Eotaxin (CCL11) chemotaxis; major basic protein — toxic to parasites, epithelium
Mast cells	FcεRI (IgE); histamine — allergy, anaphylaxis
Neutrophils	Chronic osteomyelitis, chronic lung damage (smoking) — "acute on chronic"

Tissue macrophage names :

Tissue	Name
Liver	Kupffer cells
Spleen, lymph nodes	Sinus histiocytes
Lung	Alveolar macrophages (dust cells)
CNS	Microglia
Bone	Osteoclasts
Skin	Langerhans cells (dendritic; Birbeck granules, CD1a, S100, langerin CD207)
Connective tissue	Histiocytes
Kidney	Mesangial cells
Placenta	Hofbauer cells

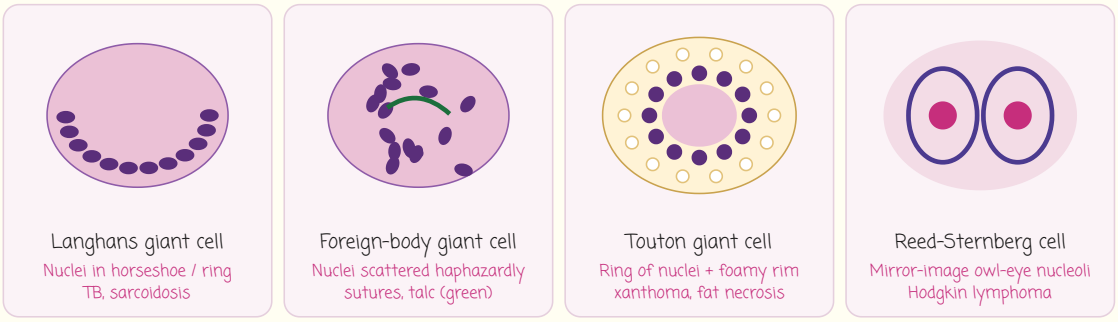
Granulomatous Inflammation

- Granuloma : focus of chronic inflammation consisting of aggregates of activated macrophages (epithelioid cells) ± giant cells, rim of lymphocytes ± plasma cells, ± central necrosis.
- Epithelioid cells : activated macrophages with abundant pink cytoplasm, slipper/shoe-sole shaped nuclei.
- Key mediators : IFN-γ (Th1) converts macrophages to epithelioid cells; TNF-α maintains granuloma (anti-TNF therapy → TB reactivation).



Caseating (tuberculous) granuloma — non-caseating (sarcoid) lacks the central necrosis

Anatomy of a caseating granuloma (labelled)



Giant cells — distinguishing nuclear arrangement (labelled)

Types of giant cells :

Giant cell	Features	Seen in
Langhans giant cell	Nuclei in horseshoe / peripheral arrangement	TB, sarcoidosis
Foreign body giant cell	Nuclei scattered haphazardly	Sutures, talc, foreign bodies
Touton giant cell	Ring of nuclei + foamy (lipid) cytoplasm outside ring	Xanthoma, xanthogranuloma, fat necrosis
Reed-Sternberg cell	Owl-eye nucleoli, bilobed nucleus	Hodgkin lymphoma
Aschoff giant cell	Multinucleate Anitschkow cells	Rheumatic heart disease
Warthin-Finkeldey cell	Grape-like nuclei	Measles, lymphoid tissue
Tumour giant cells	Pleomorphic, hyperchromatic	Malignant tumours
Osteoclast-like giant cells	Many nuclei, uniform	Giant cell tumour of bone

Types of granuloma & examples :

Category	Examples
Caseating	Tuberculosis, histoplasmosis, coccidioidomycosis
Non-caseating	Sarcoidosis, Crohn disease, berylliosis, leprosy (tuberculoid), foreign body
Suppurative (stellate)	Cat-scratch disease (Bartonella henselae), LGV (Chlamydia L1-L3), tularemia, yersinia, melioidosis
Foreign body	Sutures, talc (IV drug use), silica
Immune granuloma	TB, leprosy, syphilis, sarcoid, schistosomiasis
Necrotizing granulomatous vasculitis	Granulomatosis with polyangiitis (Wegener)
Palisading granuloma	Rheumatoid nodule, granuloma annulare, necrobiosis lipoidica

Mnemonic : Causes of granulomas — "TB SCHLEP"
Tuberculosis · Berylliosis, Brucella · Sarcoidosis, Syphilis, Schistosoma · Crohn, Cat-scratch · Histoplasma & other fungi · Leprosy, LGV · EGPA & GPA (vasculitis) · Parasites, foreign Particles (talc, sutures, silica).

Filled : Rank boosters — granuloma

- Granulomatous mastitis, orchitis — idiopathic types.
- Hepatic granulomas : TB, sarcoidosis, drugs (allopurinol, quinidine), Q fever (fibrin-ring / doughnut granuloma), PBC.
- Fibrin-ring (doughnut) granuloma : Q fever (Coxiella), also Hodgkin, CMV, EBV, allopurinol.
- Chronic granulomatous disease — granulomas due to failure of killing, not a "granuloma disease" in the classical sense.
- Sarcoid granulomas : asteroid bodies, Schaumann bodies, Hamazaki-Wesenberg bodies; ACE ↑, hypercalcemia (1α-hydroxylase in macrophages).

Systemic Effects of Inflammation (Acute Phase Response)

1. Fever — pyrogens (LPS → IL-1, TNF → PGE_2 in hypothalamus)
2. Acute phase proteins (liver, IL-6) :
   - C-reactive protein (CRP) — opsonin, activates complement (pentraxin)
   - Fibrinogen → ↑ ESR (rouleaux formation)
   - Serum amyloid A (SAA) — AA amyloid
   - Hepcidin — ↓ iron absorption/release → anemia of chronic disease
   - Ferritin, haptoglobin, ceruloplasmin, α1-antitrypsin, complement
   - Negative acute phase reactants : albumin, transferrin, transthyretin
3. Leukocytosis (↑ release from marrow — IL-1, TNF; later CSFs) :
   - Neutrophilia — bacterial infection
   - Lymphocytosis — viral (mumps, rubella), pertussis, TB
   - Eosinophilia — asthma, allergy, parasites
   - Leukopenia — typhoid, some viruses, rickettsiae, protozoa
   - Leukemoid reaction : > 40,000-100,000/μL
4. ↑ heart rate, BP; ↓ sweating; rigors; anorexia; somnolence
5. Septic shock — TNF, IL-1 → DIC, hypotension, metabolic disturbances

Exam pearl

- ESR is ↑ by fibrinogen (most), globulins; ↓ by sickle cells, polycythemia, spherocytes, hypofibrinogenemia, CHF.
- Procalcitonin ↑ specifically in bacterial sepsis (not viral).
- hs-CRP : cardiovascular risk marker.

TISSUE REPAIR & HEALING

Overview

- Repair = restoration of tissue architecture and function after injury.
- Two processes : Regeneration (replacement by same cells) and Scar formation (fibrosis) (connective tissue deposition).

Cell cycle & proliferative capacity :

Tissue type	Cell cycle	Examples
Labile (continuously dividing)	Continuously cycling	Surface epithelia (skin, GIT, urinary), bone marrow / hematopoietic cells, endometrium
Stable (quiescent)	G0, enter G1 when stimulated	Liver, kidney, pancreas, endothelium, fibroblasts, smooth muscle
Permanent	Terminally differentiated, non-dividing	Neurons, cardiac muscle, (skeletal muscle – limited via satellite cells)

Cell cycle checkpoints

G1 – restriction point (Rb) : most important, cyclin D-CDK4/6 phosphorylates Rb → releases E2F

↓

G1/S checkpoint – p53 → p21 halts damaged cells (DNA repair or apoptosis)

↓

S (DNA synthesis) → G2/M checkpoint (DNA damage)

↓

M (mitosis) – spindle assembly checkpoint

Stem cells :

- Embryonic stem cells – pluripotent; induced pluripotent stem cells (iPSC) created by Oct3/4, Sox2, KLF4, c-MYC (Yamanaka factors).
- Adult (tissue) stem cell niches :

Tissue	Niche
Skin	Bulge of hair follicle, basal layer
Intestine	Crypt base (above Paneth cells; Lgr5+)
Liver	Canals of Hering (oval cells)
Cornea	Limbus
Brain	Subventricular zone, dentate gyrus
Muscle	Satellite cells
Bone marrow	Hematopoietic (CD34+) and mesenchymal stem cells

Growth factors :

Factor	Main actions
EGF / TGF-α	Epithelial and fibroblast mitogen; re-epithelialization, granulation tissue
HGF (scatter factor)	Hepatocyte, epithelial proliferation; cell motility (c-MET receptor)
VEGF	Angiogenesis (most important), ↑ permeability; induced by hypoxia (HIF-1α)
PDGF	Chemotactic for neutrophils, macrophages, fibroblasts, SMC; fibroblast proliferation

Factor	Main actions
FGF (basic, FGF-2)	Angiogenesis, wound contraction, ECM synthesis, migration
TGF-β	Most important fibrogenic agent; ↑ collagen, fibronectin; ↓ MMP; anti-inflammatory
KGF (FGF-7)	Keratinocyte migration, proliferation
Angiopoietin 1/2	Vessel maturation and stabilization (Tie2)

Extracellular Matrix (ECM)

Component	Key facts
Collagen	Most abundant protein. Type I — skin, bone, tendon (most common); type II — cartilage; type III — granulation tissue, blood vessels (reticulin); type IV — basement membrane; type VII — anchoring fibrils
Elastin	Fibrillin-1 scaffold (Marfan)
Fibronectin	Adhesion of cells to ECM; granulation tissue, provisional matrix
Laminin	Most abundant glycoprotein in basement membrane
Proteoglycans	Hyaluronan (cushioning), heparan sulfate
Integrins	Cell-ECM attachment, signalling

Mnemonic : Collagen types — "SCAB"

Type I : Skin, bone, tendon (bone) · Type II : Cartilage (cartwolage) · Type III : Arteries, granulation ("three", reticulin) · Type IV : Basement membrane ("under the floor").

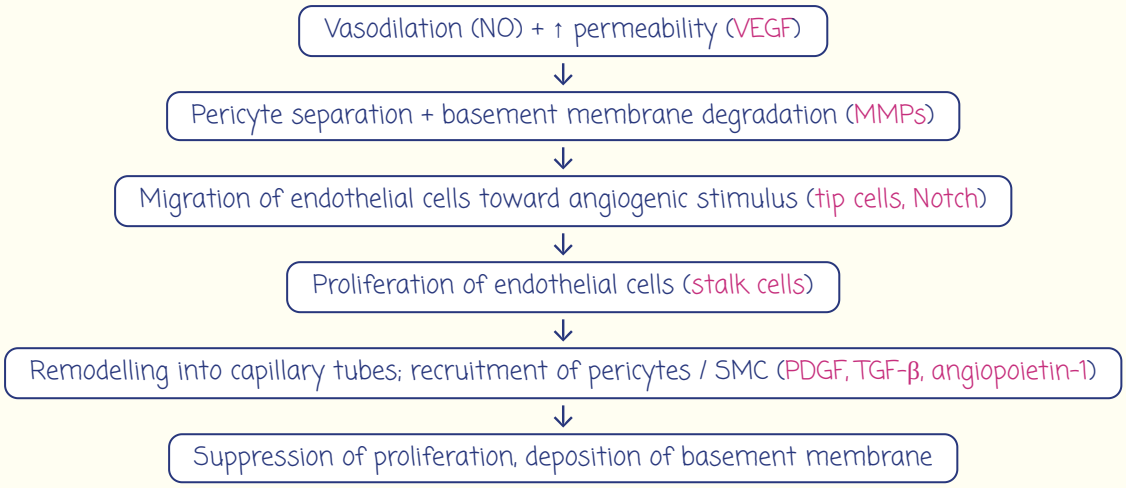
Filled : Collagen synthesis — disorders

Step	Location	Defect
Hydroxylation of proline/lysine	RER	Scurvy (vitamin C)
Glycosylation, triple helix (procollagen)	RER	Osteogenesis imperfecta (COL1A1/A2)
Cleavage of terminal propeptides	Outside cell	Ehlers-Danlos (dermatosparaxis type)
Cross-linking by lysyl oxidase (Cu^{2+})	Outside cell	Menkes disease (ATP7A), EDS
- Alport syndrome — type IV collagen (α5, X-linked). Vascular EDS — type III collagen (COL3A1) — arterial / uterine rupture.		

Liver Regeneration

- After partial hepatectomy (up to 60%) liver regenerates by compensatory hyperplasia of remaining hepatocytes (priming : TNF, IL-6 → G0→G1; growth factors : HGF, TGF-α → progression).
- If hepatocyte proliferation impaired (chronic injury) → regeneration from progenitor (oval) cells in canals of Hering.

Angiogenesis



Scar Formation

Granulation tissue :

- Hallmark of healing; pink, soft, granular gross appearance.
- Microscopy : proliferating fibroblasts + new thin-walled capillaries (angiogenesis) in loose ECM, with macrophages; type III collagen.
- Appears by 3-5 days.

Steps :

1. Angiogenesis
2. Formation of granulation tissue (fibroblast migration and proliferation)
3. Remodelling of connective tissue (type III → type I collagen by MMPs (zinc-dependent); inhibited by TIMPs)

> Exam pearl
> - Myofibroblasts (α-SMA +) → wound contraction (most important in secondary intention).
> - Tensile strength : 10% at 1 week; 70-80% at 3 months (maximum, never reaches 100%).
> - Fibronectin forms provisional scaffold; collagen type III first, then type I.

Cutaneous Wound Healing

Feature	Primary union (first intention)	Secondary union (second intention)
Wound	Clean, surgical, edges approximated	Large, gaping, tissue loss, infection
Inflammation	Less	More intense
Granulation tissue	Scanty	Abundant
Wound contraction	Absent / minimal	Prominent (myofibroblasts)
Scar	Thin, linear	Large, may be deforming
Infection risk	Low	High
Healing time	Short	Long

Timeline of healing by first intention :

Time	Event
24 h	Neutrophils at margins; blood clot (fibrin) + scab; basal cells begin mitosis
24-48 h	Epithelial cells migrate from edges, fuse in midline under scab → thin continuous layer

Time	Event
Day 3	Neutrophils replaced by macrophages; granulation tissue invades incision; collagen fibres vertical, do not bridge
Day 5	Neovascularization maximal; collagen fibrils bridge the incision; epidermis normal thickness
Week 2	Continued collagen accumulation, fibroblast proliferation; "blanching" (↓ vessels, ↓ edema)
End of 1 month	Cellular connective tissue without inflammatory cells, covered by intact epidermis; dermal appendages lost permanently

Factors Affecting Healing

Local :

1. Infection — most important cause of delayed healing
2. Mechanical factors — early motion, tension
3. Foreign bodies — sutures, fragments
4. Size, location and type of wound (face heals faster; poor blood supply delays)
5. Ischemia / poor perfusion (atherosclerosis, venous stasis)

Systemic :

1. Nutrition — protein deficiency, vitamin C deficiency (scurvy), zinc deficiency
2. Glucocorticoids — ↓ TGF-β, ↓ collagen, anti-inflammatory (but useful to ↓ fibrosis in corneal infections)
3. Diabetes mellitus — microangiopathy, ↓ neutrophil function, infection
4. Age, anemia, uremia, malignancy, chemo- and radiotherapy

Complications of wound healing :

Complication	Key features
Deficient scar	Wound dehiscence (abdominal surgery — vomiting, coughing, ileus), ulceration
Hypertrophic scar	Excess collagen, confined to wound margins, regresses over time
Keloid	Collagen extends beyond original wound margins, does not regress, recurs after excision; thick, glassy, hyalinized type I and III collagen bundles; African descent, earlobes, sternum
Exuberant granulation (proud flesh)	Protrudes above skin, blocks re-epithelialization — cauterize / excise
Desmoid (aggressive fibromatosis)	Locally aggressive fibroblast proliferation; β-catenin / APC (Gardner syndrome)
Contracture	Exaggerated contraction — burns, palms, soles, anterior thorax
Marjolin ulcer	Squamous cell carcinoma in chronic scar/burn

Filled

- Keloid — ↑ TGF-β; treatment : intralesional triamcinolone, silicone sheeting, radiotherapy after excision.
- Mast cells are numerous in keloids (pruritus).
- Fibrosis in parenchymal organs (cirrhosis, IPF) driven by TGF-β — "persistent repair".
- Hepatic stellate (Ito) cells → myofibroblasts → collagen in space of Disse (cirrhosis).

Healing at Specific Sites

Fracture healing :

Hematoma formation (fibrin clot) — immediate, platelets release PDGF, TGF-β, FGF

↓

Soft (procallus) callus — granulation tissue; osteoprogenitor cells; end of 1st week

↓

Hard (bony) callus / provisional callus — woven bone + hyaline cartilage; maximum at end of 2-3 weeks

↓

Remodelling — woven → lamellar bone along lines of weight-bearing (osteoclasts + osteoblasts); months

- Complications : malunion, delayed union, non-union → pseudarthrosis (cleft lined by synovial-like cells), infection (open fracture), fat embolism.
- Factors impairing : movement at fracture site, poor blood supply (scaphoid, femoral neck, talus), infection, interposition of soft tissue, nutrition.

Other sites :

Site	Healing features
Nervous system (CNS)	No regeneration of neurons; gliosis by astrocytes (gemistocytes) — not fibroblasts
Peripheral nerve	Wallerian degeneration distal; Schwann cell guidance; regrowth 1-3 mm/day; traumatic (amputation) neuroma if misdirected
Cardiac muscle	Fibrous scar (no regeneration)
Skeletal muscle	Limited regeneration from satellite cells
Liver	Regeneration (if framework intact) or fibrosis
Kidney	Tubular epithelium regenerates (ATN — if basement membrane intact); glomeruli do not
Lung	Type II pneumocytes regenerate alveolar epithelium (stem cells for type I)
Cartilage	Poor healing (avascular) — fibrocartilage
Mucosa (GIT)	Rapid regeneration from crypt stem cells
Cornea	Limbal stem cells

Exam pearl

- Healing of nerve : Bands of Büngner (Schwann cell columns guiding axons).
- Chromatolysis — swelling of neuron cell body, dispersion of Nissl substance, nucleus pushed to periphery — axonal reaction.

HEMODYNAMIC DISORDERS, THROMBOSIS & SHOCK

Edema

- Accumulation of excess fluid in interstitial tissue or body cavities.
- Generalized severe edema = anasarca. In cavities : hydrothorax, hydropericardium, hydroperitoneum (ascites).

Pathophysiologic categories :

Mechanism	Causes
↑ Hydrostatic pressure	Impaired venous return : CHF, constrictive pericarditis, ascites in cirrhosis, venous obstruction (DVT), external pressure; arteriolar dilation (heat)
↓ Plasma oncotic pressure (hypoproteinemia)	Nephrotic syndrome (most common), cirrhosis, protein malnutrition (kwashiorkor), protein-losing gastroenteropathy
Lymphatic obstruction	Inflammatory (filariasis → elephantiasis), neoplastic, post-surgical (axillary dissection → arm edema), post-irradiation; peau d'orange in breast cancer
Sodium retention	Excessive salt intake with renal insufficiency, ↑ renin-angiotensin-aldosterone (CHF), acute GN
Inflammation	Acute & chronic inflammation, angiogenesis (exudate)

Exam pearl

- Renal edema (nephrotic) : generalized, first appears in loose connective tissue — periorbital (eyelids), morning.
- Cardiac edema : dependent (legs in standing, sacrum in recumbent).
- Pulmonary edema : left ventricular failure (most common) — heavy wet lungs (2-3× normal), frothy, blood-tinged fluid on cut section.
- Brain edema : flattened gyri, narrowed sulci, compressed ventricles → herniation.
- Pitting edema — interstitial fluid; non-pitting — lymphedema, myxedema.

Hyperemia & Congestion

Feature	Hyperemia (active)	Congestion (passive)
Mechanism	Arteriolar dilation → ↑ inflow	Impaired venous outflow
Colour	Red (erythema) — oxygenated blood	Blue-red (cyanosis) — deoxygenated
Examples	Exercise, inflammation, blushing	CHF (systemic), venous obstruction (local)

Chronic venous congestion (CVC) — organs :

Organ	Cause	Morphology
Lung	Left heart failure, mitral stenosis	Acute : engorged alveolar capillaries, septal edema. Chronic : thick fibrotic septa, hemosiderin-laden macrophages ("heart failure cells") in alveoli → brown induration of lung
Liver	Right heart failure, (Budd-Chiari)	Nutmeg liver : congested red-brown centrilobular areas (zone 3) alternating with pale/fatty periportal areas. Centrilobular hemorrhagic necrosis; cardiac sclerosis / cardiac cirrhosis (long-standing)
Spleen	Right heart failure, portal hypertension	Congestive splenomegaly (up to 500-1000 g), firm; Gamna-Gandy bodies (siderofibrotic nodules — hemosiderin + calcium on collagen)
Kidney	Right heart failure	Enlarged, cyanotic; medulla congested

Filled

- Heart failure cells — demonstrated with Perls Prussian blue (hemosiderin, blue).
- Zone 3 necrosis : congestion (RHF), shock, acetaminophen, CCl_4, alcohol, halothane. Zone 1 : phosphorus poisoning, eclampsia (periportal fibrin). Zone 2 : yellow fever.

Hemorrhage

Term	Size / site
Petechiae	1-2 mm — ↑ capillary pressure, thrombocytopenia, platelet dysfunction
Purpura	≥ 3 mm (up to 1 cm) — trauma, vasculitis, vascular fragility
Ecchymoses (bruise)	> 1-2 cm subcutaneous hematomas; colour changes : red-blue (Hb) → blue-green (bilirubin) → golden-brown (hemosiderin)
Hematoma	Blood accumulation within tissue
Hemothorax, hemopericardium, hemoperitoneum, hemarthrosis	Blood in cavities

- Clinical significance : volume (> 20% rapid loss → hemorrhagic shock), site (intracranial), chronic → iron deficiency anemia.

Hemostasis — Normal

Arteriolar vasoconstriction (reflex + endothelin)

↓

Primary hemostasis : platelet adhesion (vWF-GpIb) → shape change, granule release (ADP, TXA_2) → aggregation (GpIIb/IIIa - fibrinogen) → platelet plug

↓

Secondary hemostasis : tissue factor (factor III) → coagulation cascade → thrombin → fibrin

↓

Clot stabilization & resorption : fibrin polymerization (factor XIIIa), platelet contraction; t-PA → plasmin limits clot

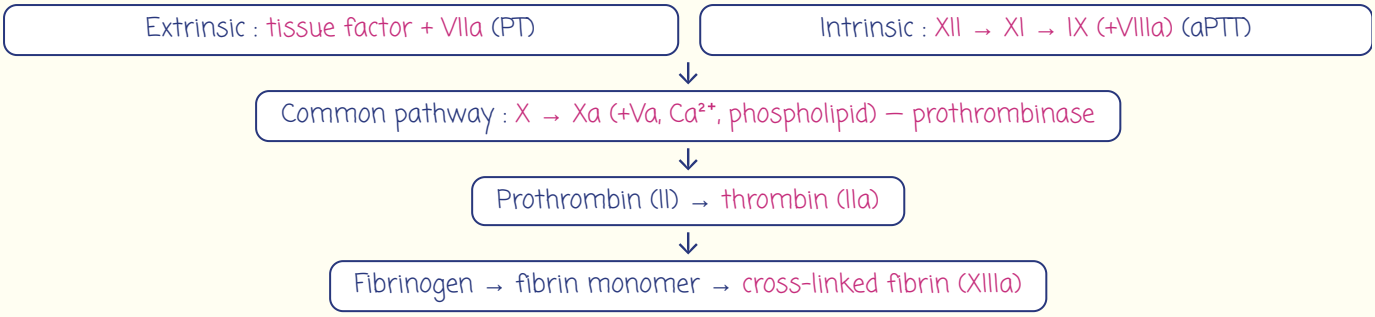
Endothelium — anti- vs pro-thrombotic :

Antithrombotic (normal)	Prothrombotic (injured / activated)
PGI_2, NO (inhibit platelets); ADPase (CD39)	vWF (platelet adhesion)
Thrombomodulin → thrombin activates protein C	Tissue factor (induced by TNF, IL-1, LPS)
Heparin-like molecules → ↑ antithrombin III	PAI-1 (↓ fibrinolysis)
TFPI (tissue factor pathway inhibitor)	
t-PA (fibrinolysis)	

Platelets :

- α-granules : fibrinogen, fibronectin, factor V, vWF, PF4, PDGF, TGF-β, P-selectin.
- Dense (δ) granules : ADP, ATP, Ca^{2+}, serotonin, histamine, epinephrine.
- Disorders : Bernard-Soulier (GpIb) — giant platelets, no ristocetin aggregation; Glanzmann thrombasthenia (GpIIb/IIIa) — no aggregation with ADP, normal ristocetin.

Coagulation cascade :



- Vitamin K-dependent factors : II, VII, IX, X, protein C, protein S (γ-carboxylation of glutamate). Shortest half-life : factor VII (~6 h) → PT prolongs first with warfarin.
- Thrombin : most important — converts fibrinogen, activates V, VIII, XI, XIII, platelets (PAR receptors); with thrombomodulin activates protein C.
- Natural anticoagulants : antithrombin III (inhibits IIa, IXa, Xa, XIa, XIIa; ↑ by heparin), protein C + S (inactivate Va and VIIIa), TFPI.

Thrombosis

Virchow's triad :

1. Endothelial injury — most important; dominant in heart and arterial circulation (MI, ulcerated plaque, vasculitis, hypertension, toxins of smoking)
2. Abnormal blood flow (stasis or turbulence) — stasis : venous thrombi; turbulence : arterial and cardiac thrombi
3. Hypercoagulability (thrombophilia)

Hypercoagulable states :

Primary (genetic) :

1. Factor V Leiden (Arg506Gln; resistance to activated protein C) — most common inherited cause
2. Prothrombin G20210A mutation (↑ prothrombin) — second most common
3. Deficiency of antithrombin III (heparin resistance), protein C, protein S
4. ↑ factor VIII, IX, XI, fibrinogen
5. Hyperhomocysteinemia (MTHFR — also acquired : folate / B12 / B6 deficiency)

Secondary (acquired) :

1. Prolonged bed rest / immobilization, surgery, fractures, burns
2. Malignancy (Trousseau syndrome — migratory thrombophlebitis; mucin-secreting adenocarcinomas — pancreas)
3. Antiphospholipid antibody syndrome
4. Heparin-induced thrombocytopenia (HIT) — antibodies to heparin-PF4 complex, day 5-14
5. Pregnancy & postpartum, oral contraceptives, estrogen therapy
6. Nephrotic syndrome (loss of antithrombin III)
7. Myeloproliferative neoplasms (polycythemia vera, JAK2), PNH, sickle cell
8. Smoking, obesity, cardiomyopathy, atrial fibrillation, prosthetic valves, DIC

Filled : Antiphospholipid syndrome

- Antibodies : lupus anticoagulant, anticardiolipin, anti-β2-glycoprotein I.
- In vitro : prolonged aPTT (paradoxically) ; in vivo : thrombosis.
- Features : recurrent arterial/venous thrombosis, recurrent miscarriages, thrombocytopenia, false-positive VDRL, livedo reticularis.
- Catastrophic APS — multiorgan microvascular thrombosis.
- Treatment : lifelong warfarin (not DOACs in triple-positive).

Morphology of thrombi :

- Lines of Zahn — alternating pale layers of platelets + fibrin and dark layers of RBCs — indicate thrombosis in flowing blood (antemortem).

Feature	Antemortem thrombus	Postmortem clot
Lines of Zahn	Present	Absent
Attachment	Firmly attached to vessel wall	Not attached; gelatinous
Appearance	Dry, granular, friable, grey-red	Rubbery, dark red "currant jelly" dependent portion + yellow "chicken fat" supernatant
Shape	Shape of vessel ± tail	Cast of vessel

Type	Features
Arterial / cardiac (mural)	Endothelial injury/turbulence; begin at injury; grow retrograde; white / pale (platelet-rich); occlusive in coronary, cerebral, femoral arteries
Venous (phlebothrombosis)	Stasis; grow in direction of flow (toward heart); red / stasis thrombi (RBC-rich); deep veins of leg (90%)
Vegetations	Thrombi on heart valves — infective endocarditis, NBTE (marantic), Libman-Sacks (SLE)

Fate of thrombus :

1. Propagation — accumulates more platelets, fibrin → obstruction
2. Embolization — dislodges, travels
3. Dissolution — fibrinolysis (recent thrombi)
4. Organization and recanalization — ingrowth of endothelial cells, SMC, fibroblasts; new capillary channels
5. Septic infection → mycotic aneurysm

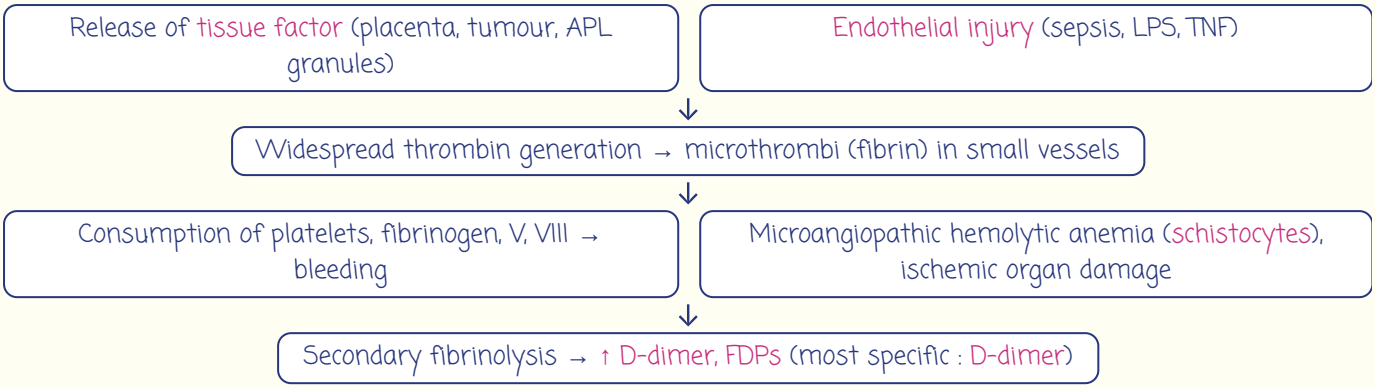
> Exam pearl
> - Most common site of DVT : deep veins of calf; most significant (embolism) : popliteal, femoral, iliac veins (above knee).
> - Superficial thrombophlebitis (saphenous varicosities) rarely embolize.
> - Phlegmasia alba dolens (milk leg) — iliofemoral thrombosis in pregnancy.

Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation (DIC)

- Consumption coagulopathy : widespread microvascular thrombi → consumption of platelets and factors → bleeding.

Causes :

1. Obstetric complications — abruptio placentae, retained dead fetus, amniotic fluid embolism, septic abortion, eclampsia
2. Infections — Gram-negative sepsis (most common), meningococcemia, malaria, Rocky Mountain spotted fever
3. Neoplasms — acute promyelocytic leukemia (M3), adenocarcinomas (pancreas, prostate, lung)
4. Massive tissue injury — trauma, burns, extensive surgery
5. Others — snake bite, acute intravascular hemolysis, shock, giant hemangioma (Kasabach-Merritt), heat stroke



- Lab : ↓ platelets, ↑ PT and aPTT, ↓ fibrinogen, ↑ D-dimer, schistocytes.
- Organs : kidney (cortical necrosis), adrenal (Waterhouse-Friderichsen in meningococcemia), pituitary (Sheehan), brain, lungs.

Embolism

- Detached intravascular solid, liquid or gaseous mass carried by blood to a distant site. 99% from thrombi (thromboembolism).

Pulmonary thromboembolism :

1. Source : 95% from deep leg veins (above knee)
2. 60-80% clinically silent (small)
3. Occluding > 60% of pulmonary circulation → sudden death, acute right heart failure (cor pulmonale), cardiovascular collapse
4. Saddle embolus – at bifurcation of main pulmonary artery
5. Small-medium artery obstruction → hemorrhage (bronchial circulation intact); infarction only when circulation compromised (LVF)
6. Paradoxical embolism – venous embolus via ASD / PFO into systemic circulation
7. Multiple emboli over time → pulmonary hypertension

Systemic thromboembolism :

- 80% from intracardiac mural thrombi (2/3 due to LV wall infarcts, 1/4 left atrial dilation + atrial fibrillation).
- Sites : lower extremities (75%), brain (10%), intestines, kidneys, spleen.

Other emboli :

Type	Key features
Fat & marrow embolism	Long bone fractures (tibia, femur), burns, CPR; syndrome after 1-3 days : pulmonary insufficiency, neurologic symptoms, anemia, thrombocytopenia, petechial rash (upper body, axilla); Oil Red O / Sudan stain on frozen section; fatal in ~10%
Air embolism	> 100 cc needed for clinical effect; obstetric procedures, chest wall injury, IV lines. Decompression sickness (caisson disease) – nitrogen bubbles : bends (joints), chokes (lungs); chronic : aseptic necrosis of femoral head, tibia, humerus
Amniotic fluid embolism	Mortality ~80%; sudden dyspnea, cyanosis, shock, seizures, coma, DIC; fetal squamous cells, lanugo hair, fat (vernix), mucin in maternal pulmonary microcirculation
Tumour, bone marrow, atheromatous (cholesterol), foreign body (talc), septic	Atheroembolism : cholesterol clefts, after angiography; livedo reticularis, renal failure, eosinophilia

Infarction

- Area of ischemic necrosis caused by occlusion of either arterial supply or venous drainage. 99% due to thrombotic or embolic events.

Feature	Red (hemorrhagic) infarct	White (anemic / pale) infarct
Circulation	Venous occlusion; dual blood supply; loose tissues; previously congested tissue; reperfusion	Arterial occlusion in solid organs with end-arterial circulation
Examples	Lung, small intestine, ovarian torsion, testicular torsion, liver (dual), brain (embolic, reperfusion)	Heart, spleen, kidney
Shape	Wedge-shaped with occluded vessel at apex, periphery as base	
Histology	Coagulative necrosis (except brain : liquefactive)	Coagulative necrosis

Factors affecting development of infarct :

1. Anatomy of vascular supply — dual (lung, liver) or parallel (radial + ulnar artery) supply protects; end-arteries (kidney, spleen) do not
2. Rate of occlusion — slow occlusion allows collaterals (coronary)
3. Tissue vulnerability to hypoxia — neurons (3-4 min) > myocardium (20-30 min) > fibroblasts
4. Oxygen content of blood — anemia, cyanosis, CHF worsen

- Septic infarction → abscess (infected emboli from IE).
- Earliest histologic change in infarct : none in 4-12 h; acute inflammation at margins within hours to 1-2 days.

Gangrene

Feature	Dry gangrene	Wet gangrene	Gas gangrene
Mechanism	Arterial occlusion, slow	Venous + arterial occlusion, infection (putrefaction)	Clostridium perfringens (α-toxin, lecithinase)
Site	Limbs (toes)	Bowel (strangulated hernia, volvulus), diabetic foot, lung	Contaminated deep wounds, muscle (myonecrosis)
Line of demarcation	Clear	Poorly defined	Absent
Appearance	Dry, shrunken, black (iron sulfide from Hb)	Moist, swollen, foul-smelling	Crepitus, gas bubbles
Spread	Slow	Rapid	Very rapid
Prognosis	Good	Poor (septicemia)	Poor

- Examples : Fournier gangrene (scrotum/perineum — synergistic), noma (cancrum oris) (malnourished children), Meleney's synergistic gangrene.

Shock

- State of cellular hypoperfusion due to ↓ cardiac output or ↓ effective circulating blood volume → impaired tissue perfusion and hypoxia.

Type	Mechanism	Examples
Cardiogenic	Myocardial pump failure	MI, arrhythmias, cardiac tamponade, pulmonary embolism (obstructive)
Hypovolemic	Inadequate blood or plasma volume	Hemorrhage, burns, vomiting, diarrhea
Septic (distributive)	Peripheral vasodilation + pooling, endothelial activation/injury, DIC	Gram-negative > Gram-positive sepsis, fungi
Neurogenic	Loss of vascular tone	Spinal cord injury, anesthetic accident
Anaphylactic	IgE-mediated systemic vasodilation, ↑ permeability	Drugs, insect stings, foods

Pathogenesis of septic shock :

1. Inflammatory mediators — PAMPs (LPS) → TLRs → TNF, IL-1, IL-6, IFN-γ, HMGB1; complement C3a, C5a
2. Endothelial activation and injury — capillary leak, edema, ↑ tissue factor → DIC
3. Immune suppression — CARS (compensatory anti-inflammatory response) — IL-10, lymphocyte apoptosis
4. Metabolic abnormalities — insulin resistance, hyperglycemia; relative adrenal insufficiency
5. Organ dysfunction — ARDS, AKI, liver, heart (↓ contractility)

Stages of shock :

Nonprogressive (compensated) : ↑ sympathetic (tachycardia, peripheral vasoconstriction, cool skin), RAAS, ADH — vital organ perfusion maintained

↓

Progressive : tissue hypoperfusion → anaerobic glycolysis → lactic acidosis → arteriolar dilation, blood pooling; DIC, ARDS

↓

Irreversible : lysosomal enzyme leakage, myocardial depression, ischemic bowel → bacteremia; ATN — death

Morphology of shock :

Organ	Change
Brain	Ischemic encephalopathy — watershed infarcts
Heart	Subendocardial hemorrhage, necrosis, contraction band necrosis
Kidney	Acute tubular necrosis (most common cause of oliguria)
Lung	Relatively resistant in hypovolemic shock; DAD (shock lung, ARDS) in septic shock — hyaline membranes
Adrenal	Lipid depletion of cortical cells (stress); Waterhouse-Friderichsen hemorrhage
GIT	Patchy mucosal hemorrhages, necrosis (hemorrhagic enteropathy)
Liver	Fatty change, central (zone 3) hemorrhagic necrosis

Filled : Warm vs cold shock

- Septic shock — early "warm" shock: vasodilation, warm flushed skin, ↑ cardiac output.
- Cardiogenic / hypovolemic — "cold" shock : cool clammy skin, ↓ CO, ↑ SVR.
- qSOFA : RR ≥ 22, altered mentation, SBP ≤ 100. Septic shock = vasopressors to keep MAP ≥ 65 + lactate > 2 mmol/L despite fluids.

Fluid & Electrolyte Derangements

Disorder	Key causes	Key features
Hyponatremia (< 135)	SIADH (small cell lung Ca, CNS, drugs), CHF, cirrhosis, diuretics, Addison	Cerebral edema, seizures; too-rapid correction → osmotic demyelination (central pontine myelinolysis)
Hypernatremia (> 145)	Water loss, diabetes insipidus	Brain shrinkage, hemorrhage
Hypokalemia	Diuretics, vomiting, hyperaldosteronism, insulin, β-agonists	U waves, flat T, muscle weakness, ileus
Hyperkalemia	Renal failure, Addison, ACEi, tissue lysis, acidosis	Peaked T waves, wide QRS, arrhythmia
Hypocalcemia	Hypoparathyroidism, CKD, vitamin D deficiency, pancreatitis	Tetany (Chvostek, Trousseau), prolonged QT
Hypercalcemia	Hyperparathyroidism, malignancy	"Stones, bones, groans, moans", short QT
Metabolic acidosis (↑ AG)	MUDPILES : methanol, uremia, DKA, paraldehyde, isoniazid/iron, lactic, ethylene glycol, salicylates	Kussmaul breathing

Disorder	Key causes	Key features
Metabolic alkalosis	Vomiting, diuretics, hyperaldosteronism	Hypokalemia

Mnemonic : Normal anion gap acidosis — "HARDASS"
Hyperalimentation · Acetazolamide · RTA · Diarrhea · Addison · Spironolactone · Saline infusion.

NEOPLASIA

Definitions & Nomenclature

- Neoplasia : "new growth" — disorder of cell growth triggered by acquired (or inherited) mutations affecting a single cell and its clonal progeny; growth is autonomous and persists after the stimulus is removed (Willis).
- Components : parenchyma (neoplastic cells — determine behaviour and name) + stroma (connective tissue, vessels — support). Abundant collagenous stroma = desmoplasia → scirrhous (stony hard) tumours, e.g. breast carcinoma.

Tissue of origin	Benign	Malignant
Fibrous tissue	Fibroma	Fibrosarcoma
Fat	Lipoma (most common soft tissue tumour)	Liposarcoma (most common adult soft-tissue sarcoma along with UPS)
Cartilage	Chondroma	Chondrosarcoma
Bone	Osteoma	Osteosarcoma
Smooth muscle	Leiomyoma	Leiomyosarcoma
Skeletal muscle	Rhabdomyoma	Rhabdomyosarcoma (most common sarcoma of childhood)
Blood vessels	Hemangioma	Angiosarcoma
Squamous epithelium	Squamous papilloma	Squamous cell carcinoma
Glandular epithelium	Adenoma, cystadenoma	Adenocarcinoma
Melanocytes	Nevus	Melanoma
Hematopoietic	—	Leukemia, lymphoma
Germ cells	Mature teratoma	Immature teratoma, seminoma

Misnomers (malignant despite benign-sounding names) :

1. Lymphoma 2. Melanoma 3. Mesothelioma 4. Seminoma 5. Hepatoma (HCC) 6. Astrocytoma, glioma 7. Myeloma

Tumour-like lesions :

Term	Definition	Example
Hamartoma	Disorganized mass of mature tissue indigenous to the site	Pulmonary hamartoma (cartilage — "popcorn calcification"), Peutz-Jeghers polyp
Choristoma (heterotopia)	Normal tissue at an abnormal site	Pancreatic rest in stomach wall, Meckel's gastric mucosa
Teratoma	From totipotent germ cells — tissues of more than one germ layer	Ovarian mature cystic teratoma (dermoid)
Mixed tumour	Divergent differentiation of one germ layer	Pleomorphic adenoma of salivary gland, fibroadenoma
Blastoma	Tumour of embryonic tissue	Retinoblastoma, nephroblastoma

Benign vs Malignant

Feature	Benign	Malignant
Differentiation	Well differentiated, resembles tissue of origin	Varies; anaplasia in poorly differentiated
Rate of growth	Slow, may stop	Erratic, rapid; ↑ mitoses
Local invasion	Encapsulated, expansile, cohesive	Locally invasive, infiltrative, no capsule

Feature	Benign	Malignant
Metastasis	Absent	Frequently present — the single most definitive feature

Anaplasia (lack of differentiation) — features :

1. Pleomorphism — variation in size and shape of cells and nuclei
2. Abnormal nuclear morphology — hyperchromasia, ↑ N:C ratio (up to 1:1, normal 1:4–1:6), coarse chromatin, prominent nucleoli
3. Mitoses — numerous, atypical (tripolar, quadripolar, multipolar spindles)
4. Loss of polarity
5. Tumour giant cells, ischemic necrosis

Dysplasia :

- Disordered growth : pleomorphism, hyperchromasia, ↑ mitoses, loss of architectural orientation.
- Carcinoma in situ : dysplastic changes involve the full thickness of epithelium, but basement membrane intact.
- Dysplasia ≠ cancer; low-grade dysplasia may regress.

Filled : Exceptions to "benign never metastasizes / malignant always metastasizes"

- Malignant tumours that rarely metastasize : basal cell carcinoma of skin, gliomas (primary CNS tumours), verrucous carcinoma, dermatofibrosarcoma protuberans.
- "Benign" tumours that may metastasize : pleomorphic adenoma (metastasizing PA), giant cell tumour of bone (lung), leiomyoma (benign metastasizing), ameloblastoma.
- Most common malignant tumour of liver, lung, brain, bone, adrenal = metastasis.

Invasion & Metastasis

Steps of invasion of ECM :

1. Loosening of tumour cells — ↓ E-cadherin (cell-cell adhesion; CDH1 mutation in diffuse gastric cancer, lobular breast cancer), epithelial-mesenchymal transition (EMT) — SNAIL, TWIST
2. Local degradation of basement membrane / ECM — MMP-2 & MMP-9 (type IV collagenases), cathepsin D, uPA
3. Changes in attachment to ECM — integrins, laminin receptors
4. Migration (locomotion) — autocrine motility factors (HGF/c-MET), cleavage products of ECM

Routes of spread :

Route	Typical tumours
Seeding of body cavities	Ovarian carcinoma (peritoneum), CNS tumours (CSF — medulloblastoma), pseudomyxoma peritonei (appendiceal mucinous), Krukenberg tumour (gastric → ovary, transcoelomic/lymphatic)
Lymphatic spread	Carcinomas (most common route). Sentinel lymph node biopsy — breast, melanoma
Hematogenous spread	Sarcomas; carcinomas : RCC (renal vein), HCC (portal / hepatic vein), follicular thyroid, choriocarcinoma

Exam pearl

- Sarcomas spread via blood; carcinomas via lymphatics — exceptions : carcinomas via blood : RCC, HCC, follicular Ca thyroid, choriocarcinoma; sarcomas via lymph : rhabdomyosarcoma, synovial sarcoma, epithelioid sarcoma, clear cell sarcoma, angiosarcoma.
- Most common sites of hematogenous metastasis : liver and lung. Bone metastasis : prostate (osteoblastic), breast (mixed), lung, kidney (lytic), thyroid (lytic).
- Virchow's node (left supraclavicular) — gastric carcinoma; Sister Mary Joseph nodule — umbilical metastasis.
- Seed and soil hypothesis — Paget; CXCR4-CXCL12 guides breast cancer to bone / lung.

Molecular Basis of Cancer — Hallmarks

Mnemonic : Hallmarks of cancer (Hanahan & Weinberg)

1. Self-sufficiency in growth signals (oncogenes)
2. Insensitivity to growth-inhibitory signals (tumour suppressors)
3. Altered cellular metabolism (Warburg effect)
4. Evasion of apoptosis
5. Limitless replicative potential (telomerase)
6. Sustained angiogenesis
7. Invasion and metastasis
8. Evasion of immune surveillance — Enabling : genomic instability, tumour-promoting inflammation.

Oncogenes (gain of function — one allele sufficient) :

Category	Oncogene	Mechanism	Associated tumours
Growth factor	SIS (PDGF-β)	Overexpression	Astrocytoma, osteosarcoma
Growth factor receptor	ERBB2 (HER2/neu)	Amplification	Breast, gastric, ovarian
	EGFR (ERBB1)	Point mutation / amplification	Lung adenocarcinoma (non-smoking women), GBM, SCC head/neck
	RET	Point mutation / rearrangement	MEN 2A, 2B, familial medullary thyroid; papillary thyroid (RET/PTC)
	KIT	Point mutation	GIST, mastocytosis, seminoma
	ALK	Translocation	Lung adenocarcinoma (EML4-ALK), anaplastic large cell lymphoma (NPM-ALK), neuroblastoma
Signal transduction (GTP binding)	KRAS	Point mutation	Pancreas (>90%), colon, lung
	NRAS / HRAS	Point mutation	Melanoma, hematologic / bladder, kidney
Signal transduction (kinase)	BRAF (V600E)	Point mutation	Melanoma, hairy cell leukemia, papillary thyroid, colon (serrated)
Non-receptor tyrosine kinase	ABL	t(9;22) BCR-ABL	CML, some ALL
	JAK2 (V617F)	Point mutation	Polycythemia vera, ET, myelofibrosis
Nuclear transcription factor	c-MYC	t(8;14)	Burkitt lymphoma
	N-MYC	Amplification	Neuroblastoma
	L-MYC	Amplification	Small cell carcinoma lung
Cell cycle	Cyclin D1	t(11;14) / amplification	Mantle cell lymphoma, breast, esophagus
	CDK4	Amplification	Melanoma, sarcoma (liposarcoma)
Anti-apoptotic	BCL-2	t(14;18)	Follicular lymphoma

Tumour suppressor genes (loss of function — "two-hit hypothesis", Knudson) :

Gene	Function	Familial syndrome	Sporadic tumours
RB (13q14)	Inhibits G1→S (binds E2F)	Familial retinoblastoma, osteosarcoma	Retinoblastoma, osteosarcoma, breast, colon, lung
TP53 (17p13)	"Guardian of the genome" — cell cycle arrest (p21), apoptosis, senescence	Li-Fraumeni syndrome (sarcomas, breast, brain, adrenocortical, leukemia)	Most common mutated gene in human cancer (>50%)

Gene	Function	Familial syndrome	Sporadic tumours
APC (5q21)	Inhibits WNT/β-catenin	Familial adenomatous polyposis	Colon (70–80%), stomach, pancreas
NF1 (17q11)	Neurofibromin — GAP for RAS	Neurofibromatosis type 1	Neuroblastoma, JMML
NF2 (22q12)	Merlin (cytoskeleton, contact inhibition)	NF2 (bilateral acoustic schwannoma)	Schwannoma, meningioma
WT1 (11p13)	Transcription factor	WAGR, Denys-Drash	Wilms tumour
VHL (3p)	Ubiquitin ligase — degrades HIF-1α	von Hippel-Lindau (hemangioblastoma, clear cell RCC, pheochromocytoma)	Clear cell RCC
BRCA1 (17q21), BRCA2 (13q12)	DNA repair (homologous recombination)	Familial breast and ovarian carcinoma; BRCA2 — male breast, pancreas, prostate	Rare
PTEN (10q23)	Inhibits PI3K/AKT	Cowden syndrome	Endometrial, prostate, GBM
CDKN2A (9p21)	p16/INK4a (CDK inhibitor), ARF	Familial melanoma	Pancreas, esophagus, melanoma, GBM
SMAD4 (DPC4, 18q)	TGF-β signalling	Juvenile polyposis	Pancreas (55%), colon
STK11 (LKB1)	Kinase (AMPK)	Peutz-Jeghers syndrome	—
PTCH (9q22)	Inhibits Hedgehog	Gorlin syndrome (basal cell nevus)	Basal cell carcinoma, medulloblastoma
CDH1	E-cadherin	Familial gastric (diffuse) carcinoma	Gastric, lobular breast
TSC1/TSC2	Hamartin / tuberin — inhibit mTOR	Tuberous sclerosis	—
MEN1	Menin	MEN 1	Parathyroid, pituitary, pancreatic NET

RB and the cell cycle

Growth factors → cyclin D - CDK4/6

↓

Hypophosphorylated RB (active) binds E2F → blocks G1→S

↓

CDK4/6 phosphorylates RB → hyperphosphorylated RB releases E2F → S-phase genes (cyclin E)

↓

Inhibitors : p16 (INK4), p21, p27 (CIP/KIP) ; HPV E7 binds RB

p53 response to DNA damage

DNA damage (radiation, UV, chemicals) → ATM / ATR kinases activate p53 (releases from MDM2)

↓

p21 → cell cycle arrest (G1) + DNA repair (GADD45)

PUMA, NOXA, BAX → apoptosis

Senescence (miR-34)

↓

Repair successful → cell resumes

Repair fails → apoptosis/senescence

↓

HPV E6 degrades p53 ; MDM2 amplification in sarcomas (liposarcoma)

DNA repair defects :

Defect	Syndrome / tumour
Mismatch repair (MLH1, MSH2, MSH6, PMS2)	Lynch syndrome (HNPCC) — colon (right-sided), endometrium, ovary; microsatellite instability
Nucleotide excision repair	Xeroderma pigmentosum (UV — pyrimidine dimers) — skin SCC, BCC, melanoma
Homologous recombination	BRCA1/2, Bloom (BLM), ataxia telangiectasia (ATM), Fanconi anemia
Base excision repair	MUTYH-associated polyposis

Warburg effect, telomerase, angiogenesis :

- Warburg effect (aerobic glycolysis) — cancer cells use glycolysis even with adequate oxygen; basis of FDG-PET; driven by PI3K/AKT, MYC; IDH1/2 mutation → oncometabolite 2-hydroxyglutarate (gliomas, AML, cholangiocarcinoma).
- Telomerase reactivation in 85-95% cancers (TERT promoter mutations — melanoma, GBM).
- Angiogenic switch — VEGF, bFGF; inhibitors : angiostatin, endostatin, thrombospondin-1 (p53 induces). Drug : bevacizumab (anti-VEGF).

Carcinogenesis

Multistep carcinogenesis (chemical)

Initiation — exposure to carcinogen → permanent, irreversible DNA damage (mutation); initiator alone is not sufficient

↓

Promotion — promoters (phorbol esters (TPA), hormones, phenols, drugs) induce proliferation of initiated cells; reversible, non-mutagenic

↓

Progression → benign → malignant tumour; additional mutations (tumour heterogeneity)

Chemical carcinogens :

Class	Agent	Cancer
Direct-acting	Alkylating agents (cyclophosphamide, busulfan, nitrosoureas)	AML / MDS, lymphoma
Indirect (procarcinogens)	Polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons (benzo[a]pyrene — tobacco, smoked food)	Lung, oral, larynx, bladder
	Aromatic amines, azo dyes (β-naphthylamine — aniline dye, rubber)	Bladder (urothelial)
	Aflatoxin B1 (Aspergillus flavus — ground nuts, grain)	HCC (TP53 codon 249 G:T mutation)
	Nitrosamines (smoked fish, preserved foods)	Gastric, esophageal
Others	Vinyl chloride	Angiosarcoma of liver
	Asbestos	Mesothelioma, lung carcinoma (synergistic with smoking)
	Arsenic	Skin SCC, lung, angiosarcoma liver
	Benzene	AML
	Chromium, nickel	Lung, nasal sinus
	Betel nut (areca)	Oral SCC (submucous fibrosis)
	Diethylstilbestrol (DES) in utero	Clear cell adenocarcinoma of vagina
	Naphthylamine, cyclophosphamide (acrolein)	Bladder carcinoma

Radiation carcinogenesis :

- UV-B → pyrimidine (thymine) dimers → skin cancer (SCC, BCC, melanoma); xeroderma pigmentosum.
- Ionizing radiation → leukemias (most common; AML, CML — except CLL), papillary thyroid carcinoma (children), breast, lung; latent period leukemia 7-12 years; solid tumours decades.

Oncogenic viruses & microbes :

Agent	Mechanism	Cancers
HPV (16, 18 — high risk)	E6 → degrades p53; E7 → binds and inactivates RB; integration into host genome	Cervical carcinoma, anal, oropharyngeal (tonsil), penile, vulvar
EBV	LMP-1 (mimics CD40) → NF-κB; EBNA-2	Burkitt lymphoma (endemic), nasopharyngeal carcinoma, Hodgkin (mixed cellularity), post-transplant lymphoproliferative disorder, gastric carcinoma
HBV, HCV	Chronic inflammation, regeneration; HBx protein	Hepatocellular carcinoma (HCV also → B-cell lymphoma)
HTLV-1	Tax protein (activates transcription, inactivates p16)	Adult T-cell leukemia/lymphoma (Japan, Caribbean)
HHV-8 (KSHV)	vFLIP, vGPCR	Kaposi sarcoma, primary effusion lymphoma, multicentric Castleman
Merkel cell polyomavirus	Large T antigen	Merkel cell carcinoma
H. pylori	CagA; chronic inflammation	Gastric adenocarcinoma, MALT lymphoma
Schistosoma haematobium	Chronic inflammation	Squamous cell carcinoma of bladder
Clonorchis sinensis / Opisthorchis	Chronic inflammation	Cholangiocarcinoma

Hereditary predisposition :

Category	Examples
Autosomal dominant cancer syndromes	Retinoblastoma, Li-Fraumeni, FAP, Lynch, MEN, NF1, NF2, VHL, BRCA
Defective DNA repair (AR)	Xeroderma pigmentosum, ataxia telangiectasia, Bloom, Fanconi
Familial cancers (uncertain inheritance)	Breast, ovary, colon (non-syndromic)

Grading & Staging

Feature	Grading	Staging
Based on	Degree of differentiation (histology) + number of mitoses	Size of primary, lymph node spread, distant metastasis (TNM)
Clinical value	Less	Greater prognostic value
Examples	Gleason (prostate), Nottingham / Bloom-Richardson (breast), Fuhrman / WHO-ISUP (RCC)	TNM (AJCC/UICC), Dukes (colon), FIGO (gynaecological), Ann Arbor (lymphoma), Clark & Breslow (melanoma)

Clinical Aspects — Host Effects

Cancer cachexia :

- Loss of body fat, lean mass, weakness, anorexia, anemia; TNF-α (cachectin), IL-1, IL-6, proteolysis-inducing factor, lipid-mobilizing factor.

Paraneoplastic syndromes :

Syndrome	Mechanism	Tumour
Cushing syndrome	ACTH / ACTH-like	Small cell carcinoma lung, pancreatic, neural tumours, carcinoid
SIADH (hyponatremia)	ADH / ANP	Small cell carcinoma lung, intracranial neoplasms
Hypercalcemia	PTHrP, TGF-α, TNF, IL-1, calcitriol (lymphoma)	Squamous cell carcinoma lung, breast, renal, ovarian; Hodgkin / T-cell lymphoma (1,25-OH vitamin D)
Hypoglycemia	Insulin / IGF-2	Fibrosarcoma, mesothelioma, HCC, other mesenchymal tumours
Carcinoid syndrome	Serotonin, bradykinin	Carcinoid tumour (with liver metastases), pancreatic, gastric, small cell
Polycythemia	Erythropoietin	Renal cell carcinoma, cerebellar hemangioblastoma, HCC, leiomyoma uterus, pheochromocytoma
Lambert-Eaton myasthenic syndrome	Antibodies against presynaptic voltage-gated Ca^{2+} channels	Small cell carcinoma lung
Myasthenia gravis	Anti-AChR antibodies	Thymoma
Paraneoplastic cerebellar degeneration	Anti-Yo (Purkinje cells), anti-Hu, anti-Tr	Ovarian, breast; SCLC (Hu); Hodgkin (Tr)
Anti-NMDA receptor encephalitis	Anti-NMDAR	Ovarian teratoma
Acanthosis nigricans	? EGF	Gastric carcinoma, lung, uterus
Leser-Trélat sign	Sudden eruption of multiple seborrheic keratoses	GI adenocarcinoma (gastric)
Dermatomyositis	Immunologic	Lung, breast, ovary
Hypertrophic pulmonary osteoarthropathy (clubbing)	Unknown	Lung carcinoma (adenocarcinoma)
Trousseau phenomenon (migratory thrombophlebitis)	Hypercoagulability (mucin, TF)	Pancreatic carcinoma, lung
NBTE (marantic endocarditis)	Hypercoagulability	Advanced mucin-secreting adenocarcinomas
Pure red cell aplasia	Immunologic	Thymoma
Opsoclonus-myoclonus	Anti-Ri / Hu	Neuroblastoma (children), breast
Hyperthyroidism (TSH-like)	hCG	Choriocarcinoma, hydatidiform mole

Mnemonic : Lung carcinoma paraneoplastics

- Small cell → "ACTH, ADH, Antibodies" : Cushing, SIADH, Lambert-Eaton (VGCC), anti-Hu encephalomyelitis / sensory neuropathy.
- Squamous cell → Stones : PTHrP → hypercalcemia.
- Adenocarcinoma → Arthropathy : clubbing / hypertrophic pulmonary osteoarthropathy, Trousseau.

Laboratory Diagnosis of Cancer

1. Histologic examination — excision / incision / core biopsy; frozen section (intra-operative, quick — margins, nature of lesion)
2. Cytology — FNAC (breast, thyroid, lymph nodes, salivary); exfoliative (Pap smear, sputum, urine, effusions)
3. Immunohistochemistry (IHC) — identify cell of origin, prognostic/predictive markers
4. Flow cytometry — leukemias, lymphomas (CD markers), DNA ploidy
5. Molecular diagnosis — PCR (BCR-ABL monitoring), FISH (HER2, N-MYC, translocations), NGS, liquid biopsy (ctDNA)
6. Tumour markers (serum)

Immunohistochemistry markers :

Marker	Tumour / cell type
Cytokeratin	Carcinomas, mesothelioma (epithelial)
Vimentin	Sarcomas (mesenchymal), RCC, endometrial, melanoma
Desmin	Muscle tumours (rhabdomyosarcoma, leiomyosarcoma)
Myogenin, MyoD1	Rhabdomyosarcoma (most specific)
S-100	Melanoma, schwannoma, Langerhans cell histiocytosis, neural, chondroid
HMB-45, Melan-A, SOX10	Melanoma
LCA (CD45)	Lymphomas / leukocytes
CD20 (B), CD3 (T), CD15 & CD30 (Reed-Sternberg)	Lymphomas
CD31, CD34, ERG, Factor VIII	Vascular tumours (angiosarcoma)
Chromogranin, synaptophysin, CD56, INSM1	Neuroendocrine tumours (carcinoid, SCLC)
GFAP	Glial tumours (astrocytoma)
CD117 (c-KIT), DOG-1	GIST
TTF-1	Lung adenocarcinoma, small cell carcinoma, thyroid
Thyroglobulin, PAX8	Thyroid (PAX8 also kidney, Müllerian)
CK7+/CK20−	Lung, breast, ovary (non-mucinous), thyroid, endometrium
CK7−/CK20+	Colorectal carcinoma (CDX2 +), Merkel cell (dot-like)
ER, PR, HER2, GATA3	Breast carcinoma
PSA, NKX3.1	Prostatic carcinoma
Calretinin, WT1, D2-40	Mesothelioma
CD99 (MIC2) + FLI-1	Ewing sarcoma / PNET
AFP, Glypican-3, HepPar-1, Arginase-1	HCC
p63, p40, CK5/6	Squamous cell carcinoma
CD1a, langerin (CD207)	Langerhans cell histiocytosis
Inhibin	Sex-cord stromal tumours (granulosa cell), adrenocortical
PLAP, OCT3/4, SALL4	Seminoma / dysgerminoma (germ cell)
Ki-67 (MIB-1)	Proliferation index

Tumour markers (serum) :

Marker	Tumour
α-fetoprotein (AFP)	HCC, yolk sac (endodermal sinus) tumour, (NTDs in pregnancy)
β-hCG	Choriocarcinoma, hydatidiform mole, germ cell tumours (seminoma – low)
CEA	Colorectal, pancreas, stomach, breast, lung (monitoring recurrence)
CA-125	Ovarian (serous) carcinoma
CA 19-9	Pancreatic, biliary, colon
CA 15-3 / CA 27-29	Breast carcinoma
PSA	Prostate carcinoma (also BPH, prostatitis)
Calcitonin	Medullary carcinoma of thyroid
Thyroglobulin	Follow-up of differentiated (papillary, follicular) thyroid Ca after thyroidectomy
Catecholamines, VMA, metanephrines	Pheochromocytoma, neuroblastoma (HVA, VMA)
5-HIAA (urine)	Carcinoid syndrome
LDH	Lymphoma, dysgerminoma, Ewing, germ cell tumours

Marker	Tumour
Immunoglobulins (M-band), β2-microglobulin	Multiple myeloma
S-100, LDH	Melanoma
Neuron-specific enolase (NSE)	Small cell carcinoma, neuroblastoma
Placental ALP	Seminoma
HE4	Ovarian cancer (with CA-125 – ROMA)
Bombesin	Small cell lung Ca, neuroblastoma, gastric

Filled : Rank boosters – neoplasia

- Tumour of highest incidence in India : males – lip/oral cavity & lung; females – breast > cervix (GLOBOCAN).
- Most common cancer worldwide (incidence) : lung (2022 now breast close second); most common cause of cancer death : lung.
- Cancer stem cells – CD133 (brain), CD44+/CD24– (breast).
- Driver vs passenger mutations ; kataegis, chromothripsis (catastrophic shattering).
- Oncogene addiction – basis of targeted therapy (imatinib – BCR-ABL, KIT; trastuzumab – HER2; vemurafenib – BRAF; crizotinib – ALK).
- Immune checkpoints : PD-1/PD-L1, CTLA-4 – tumours evade T cells; drugs : pembrolizumab, nivolumab, ipilimumab; MSI-high tumours respond best.
- Tumour antigens : products of mutated genes (neoantigens), overexpressed (HER2, tyrosinase), viral (HPV E6/E7), oncofetal (AFP, CEA), cancer-testis antigens (MAGE), differentiation antigens (CD20, PSA).
- Effector cells against tumours : CD8+ CTL (most important), NK cells, macrophages (M1).

IMMUNOPATHOLOGY

Organisation of the Immune System

Feature	Innate immunity	Adaptive immunity
Specificity	Pathogen-associated molecular patterns (PAMPs)	Highly specific antigens
Memory	None (trained immunity limited)	Memory
Cells	Neutrophils, macrophages, NK cells, dendritic cells, mast cells, ILCs	T and B lymphocytes
Molecules	Complement, TLRs, antimicrobial peptides, cytokines (IFN-α/β)	Antibodies, TCR, BCR
Speed	Minutes-hours	Days

Lymphocytes :

Cell	Markers	Key functions
T cells	CD3, TCR (αβ – 95%; γδ – mucosal)	Cell-mediated immunity; mature in thymus
CD4+ helper T	CD4, recognize antigen on MHC class II	Help B cells, macrophages; CD4:CD8 = 2:1
CD8+ cytotoxic T	CD8, recognize MHC class I	Kill virus-infected / tumour cells (perforin, granzyme, FasL)
Treg	CD4, CD25 (IL-2Rα), FOXP3	Suppress immunity (IL-10, TGF-β, CTLA-4); FOXP3 mutation → IPEX
B cells	CD19, CD20, CD21 (EBV receptor, CR2), surface IgM & IgD	Humoral immunity → plasma cells (CD138)
NK cells	CD16 (FcγRIII), CD56; no TCR	Kill cells lacking MHC-I ("missing self"); ADCC; IL-12 activates; produce IFN-γ
Dendritic cells	CD11c, MHC II	Most potent antigen-presenting cells; follicular DC (antigen display for B cells, CD21, CD35 – not APC proper)

CD4+ T helper subsets :

Subset	Induced by	Signature cytokines	Functions / disease
Th1	IL-12, IFN-γ (T-bet)	IFN-γ, IL-2	Activate macrophages (M1), granulomas, DTH; IgG opsonizing
Th2	IL-4 (GATA-3)	IL-4, IL-5, IL-13	IgE switching, eosinophils, helminths, allergy, asthma, M2
Th17	IL-1, IL-6, IL-23, TGF-β (RORγt)	IL-17, IL-22	Neutrophil recruitment, extracellular bacteria & fungi; psoriasis, IBD, RA; ↓ in hyper-IgE (STAT3)
Tfh	IL-6, IL-21 (Bcl-6)	IL-21, IL-4	Germinal centre B-cell help
Treg	TGF-β, IL-2 (FOXP3)	IL-10, TGF-β	Tolerance

MHC (HLA) molecules – chromosome 6 :

Feature	Class I	Class II
Loci	HLA-A, B, C	HLA-DP, DQ, DR
Distribution	All nucleated cells + platelets (not RBCs)	APCs (dendritic cells, macrophages, B cells), activated T cells, thymic epithelium
Structure	α chain + β2-microglobulin	α + β chains
Antigen	Endogenous (cytosolic) – proteasome → TAP	Exogenous – endocytosed, invariant chain

Feature	Class I	Class II
Presents to	CD8+ T cells	CD4+ T cells

- Class III region : complement (C2, C4, factor B), TNF, HSP70.

HLA associations :

HLA	Disease
B27	Ankylosing spondylitis (90%), reactive arthritis, psoriatic arthritis, IBD arthritis ("PAIR")
DR3	Type 1 DM, Graves, SLE, celiac, myasthenia, Addison, Sjögren, dermatitis herpetiformis
DR4	Rheumatoid arthritis, type 1 DM, pemphigus vulgaris
DR3/DR4 heterozygote	Highest risk of type 1 DM
DQ2 / DQ8	Celiac disease (DQ2 in 95%)
DR2 (DR15)	Multiple sclerosis, Goodpasture, SLE, narcolepsy, hay fever
DR5	Pernicious anemia, Hashimoto, JRA
B51	Behçet disease
Cw6	Psoriasis
B*57:01	Abacavir hypersensitivity
B*15:02	Carbamazepine SJS/TEN (Asians)
B*58:01	Allopurinol SJS/TEN
A3	Hemochromatosis (HFE linked)

Immunoglobulins :

Ig	Key features
IgG	Most abundant in serum (75%); crosses placenta; opsonization, complement (IgG3 > IgG1), secondary response; 4 subclasses (IgG4-related disease)
IgA	Most produced overall; secretory IgA (dimer + J chain + secretory component) in mucosa, colostrum; most common primary Ig deficiency
IgM	Pentamer; first antibody in primary response; best complement activator; largest; B-cell receptor (monomer); isohemagglutinins
IgE	Binds FcεRI on mast cells, basophils; type I hypersensitivity, helminths; lowest serum concentration; heat labile
IgD	B-cell receptor (naive B cells)

Hypersensitivity Reactions

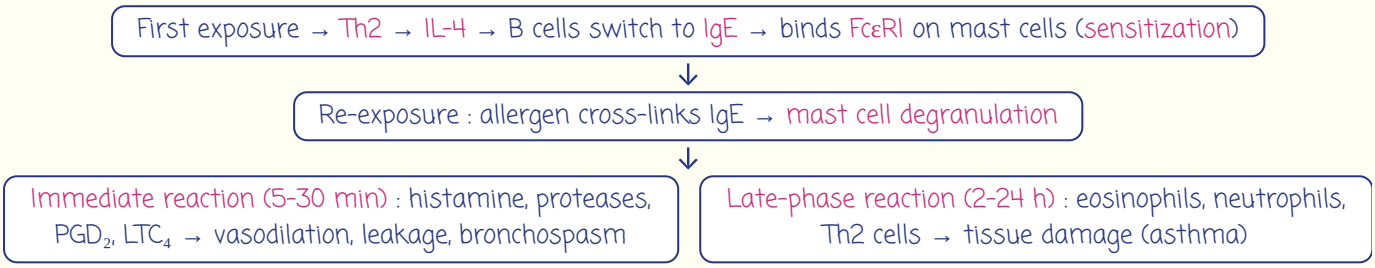
Type	Mechanism	Mediators	Examples
Type I (immediate / anaphylactic)	IgE on mast cells cross-linked by allergen; Th2	Histamine, leukotrienes, PGD_2, cytokines	Anaphylaxis, bronchial asthma (atopic), allergic rhinitis, urticaria, food allergy, Casoni test
Type II (antibody-mediated / cytotoxic)	IgG / IgM against fixed antigens on cells or ECM	Complement (MAC), opsonization, ADCC, receptor dysfunction	AIHA, transfusion reactions, HDN (Rh), ITP, Goodpasture, Graves (stimulating), myasthenia gravis (blocking), pemphigus vulgaris, bullous pemphigoid, acute rheumatic fever, pernicious anemia, hyperacute rejection
Type III (immune complex)	Antigen-antibody complexes deposit in vessels → complement activation → neutrophils	Complement (C3a, C5a), neutrophil enzymes	SLE, post-streptococcal GN, PAN, serum sickness, Arthus reaction, reactive arthritis, HSP (IgA), cryoglobulinemia, hypersensitivity pneumonitis (III + IV)

Type	Mechanism	Mediators	Examples
Type IV (T-cell / delayed)	CD4+ (DTH — Th1/Th17) and CD8+ (cytotoxicity); no antibodies	IFN-γ, IL-17, TNF; perforin/granzyme	Tuberculin (Mantoux) test, contact dermatitis (poison ivy, nickel), type 1 DM, MS, RA, IBD, Hashimoto, granulomas (TB), acute cellular graft rejection, Lepromin test, patch test

Mnemonic : Hypersensitivity — "ACID"

Type I : Anaphylactic / Allergic · Type II : Cytotoxic (antibody) · Type III : Immune complex · Type IV : Delayed (cell-mediated). Antibody in I, II, III; no antibody in IV.

Type I — phases :



Type III — systemic vs local :

- Serum sickness (systemic) : 5-10 days after foreign protein (horse anti-thymocyte globulin) — fever, urticaria, arthralgia, proteinuria, lymphadenopathy, ↓ C3.
- Arthus reaction (local) : localized necrotizing vasculitis at site of injection (hours) in previously immunized host — fibrinoid necrosis; e.g. after tetanus booster.
- Lesions : fibrinoid necrosis of vessels; immunofluorescence : granular deposits (lumpy-bumpy) vs linear in anti-GBM (type II).

Filled

- Type V hypersensitivity (some texts) : stimulatory antibodies — Graves disease (TSH receptor) (classified under type II in Robbins).
- Type II drugs : penicillin-induced hemolysis (hapten), methyldopa (autoimmune), quinidine (immune complex/innocent bystander).
- Contact dermatitis is type IV but is mediated by both CD4 and CD8 T cells; Langerhans cells are the APCs.
- Jones-Mote reaction (cutaneous basophil hypersensitivity) — variant of type IV.

Autoimmunity

Mechanisms :

1. Failure of central tolerance — AIRE mutation (thymic expression of tissue antigens) → APS-1 (APECED)
2. Failure of peripheral tolerance — anergy, Tregs (FOXP3 → IPEX), CTLA-4, PD-1, deletion by apoptosis (Fas/FasL → ALPS)
3. Genetic susceptibility — HLA, PTPN22 (most common non-HLA; RA, T1DM), NOD2 (Crohn), IL-23R
4. Infections — molecular mimicry (rheumatic fever — streptococcal M protein); polyclonal B-cell activation (EBV); epitope spreading
5. Tissue injury releasing sequestered antigens (sympathetic ophthalmia, post-vasectomy anti-sperm)
6. Female predominance (hormones, X-chromosome genes)

Autoantibodies — high yield :

Antibody	Disease
ANA	SLE (95-100%, sensitive), other CTDs
Anti-dsDNA, anti-Smith (Sm)	SLE (specific); anti-dsDNA correlates with nephritis / activity
Anti-histone	Drug-induced lupus (hydralazine, procainamide, isoniazid)
Anti-Ro (SS-A), anti-La (SS-B)	Sjögren; neonatal lupus (congenital heart block)
Anti-centromere	Limited scleroderma (CREST)
Anti-Scl-70 (topoisomerase I)	Diffuse systemic sclerosis (lung fibrosis)
Anti-RNA polymerase III	Diffuse SSc — scleroderma renal crisis
Anti-U1 RNP	Mixed connective tissue disease
Anti-Jo-1 (histidyl-tRNA synthetase)	Polymyositis / dermatomyositis (antisynthetase — ILD)
Anti-Mi-2	Dermatomyositis
Anti-CCP (ACPA)	Rheumatoid arthritis (most specific); RF (IgM anti-Fc of IgG) — sensitive
c-ANCA (PR3)	Granulomatosis with polyangiitis (Wegener)
p-ANCA (MPO)	Microscopic polyangiitis, EGPA (Churg-Strauss), UC, PSC, crescentic GN
Anti-GBM (α3 chain of type IV collagen)	Goodpasture syndrome
Anti-mitochondrial (AMA, M2)	Primary biliary cholangitis
Anti-smooth muscle, anti-LKM1	Autoimmune hepatitis type 1, type 2
Anti-TPO, anti-thyroglobulin	Hashimoto thyroiditis
TSH receptor (TRAb / TSI)	Graves disease
Anti-AChR (85%), anti-MuSK	Myasthenia gravis
Anti-VGCC	Lambert-Eaton
Anti-GAD65, anti-islet, anti-insulin, ZnT8	Type 1 DM
Anti-tTG, anti-endomysial (IgA), anti-deamidated gliadin	Celiac disease
Anti-intrinsic factor, anti-parietal cell	Pernicious anemia
Anti-desmoglein 3 (& 1)	Pemphigus vulgaris
Anti-BP180, BP230 (hemidesmosome)	Bullous pemphigoid
Anti-phospholipase A2 receptor (PLA2R)	Primary membranous nephropathy
Anti-aquaporin-4	Neuromyelitis optica

ANA immunofluorescence patterns :

Pattern	Antigen	Disease
Homogeneous / diffuse	dsDNA, histones	SLE, drug-induced lupus
Rim / peripheral	dsDNA	SLE (most specific pattern)
Speckled (most common, least specific)	Sm, RNP, Ro, La	SLE, MCTD, Sjögren
Nucleolar	RNA	Systemic sclerosis
Centromeric	Centromere proteins	CREST

Systemic Lupus Erythematosus (SLE)

- Prototype multisystem autoimmune disease (type III > type II); F : M = 9 : 1; reproductive age.
- Defective clearance of apoptotic bodies (nuclear antigens) + type I interferon signature + UV light, drugs.
- Libman-Sacks endocarditis : small, sterile vegetations on both surfaces of valve (mitral).

- LE cell : neutrophil engulfing denatured nucleus (hematoxylin body).
- Onion-skin lesion of spleen (periarterial fibrosis).

Lupus nephritis (ISN/RPS classes) :

Class	Features
I	Minimal mesangial
II	Mesangial proliferative
III	Focal (< 50% glomeruli)
IV	Diffuse proliferative (≥ 50%) — most common and most severe; wire-loop lesions (subendothelial deposits), full-house immunofluorescence (IgG, IgA, IgM, C3, C1q)
V	Membranous — nephrotic syndrome
VI	Advanced sclerosing (≥ 90%)

Mnemonic : SLE criteria (classic 11) — "SOAP BRAIN MD"

Serositis · Oral ulcers · Arthritis · Photosensitivity · Blood disorders · Renal disorder · ANA · Immunologic (dsDNA, Sm, aPL) · Neurologic (seizure, psychosis) · Malar rash · Discoid rash. (EULAR/ACR 2019 : ANA ≥ 1:80 entry criterion.)

Other Autoimmune Diseases

Disease	Key pathology
Sjögren syndrome	Lymphocytic sialadenitis (focus score ≥ 1), dry eyes / mouth; anti-Ro/La; ↑ risk of marginal zone (MALT) B-cell lymphoma (40×)
Systemic sclerosis	Fibrosis (TGF-β), microvascular damage; skin, GIT (esophageal dysmotility — lower 2/3), lung (ILD — leading cause of death), kidney (renal crisis — onion-skinning); CREST : calcinosis, Raynaud, esophageal dysmotility, sclerodactyly, telangiectasia
Inflammatory myopathies	Dermatomyositis — perifascicular atrophy, CD4 + B cells, complement on capillaries, heliotrope rash, Gottron papules, malignancy association. Polymyositis — CD8 T cells endomysial. Inclusion body myositis — rimmed vacuoles, >50 y
Polyarteritis nodosa	Necrotizing vasculitis of medium arteries, spares lungs, HBV (30%), segmental, transmural fibrinoid necrosis — lesions of different stages, microaneurysms ("rosary beads")
IgG4-related disease	Storiform fibrosis, obliterative phlebitis, IgG4+ plasma cells (>30-50/HPF); autoimmune pancreatitis type 1, Riedel thyroiditis, retroperitoneal fibrosis, Mikulicz

Transplant Rejection

Type	Timing	Mechanism	Morphology
Hyperacute	Minutes-hours	Pre-formed antibodies (ABO, anti-HLA from transfusions, pregnancy, previous transplant) — type II	Thrombosis, fibrinoid necrosis, infarction; cyanotic, mottled graft; prevented by cross-match
Acute cellular	Weeks-months (usually < 6 months)	CD8+ CTL and CD4+ (type IV)	Interstitial mononuclear infiltrate, tubulitis, endotheliitis (endarteritis)
Acute antibody-mediated (humoral)	Days-months	Donor-specific antibodies (DSA)	Vasculitis, glomerulitis, peritubular capillaritis, C4d deposition in peritubular capillaries
Chronic	Months-years	T cells (IFN-γ) + antibodies	Arteriosclerosis (intimal thickening — graft vasculopathy), interstitial fibrosis, tubular atrophy; transplant glomerulopathy; bronchiolitis obliterans (lung)

Graft-versus-host disease (GVHD) :

- Requirements (Billingham criteria) : 1. immunocompetent graft (T cells) 2. host antigens recognized as foreign 3. immunocompromised host.
- Settings : allogeneic hematopoietic stem cell transplant (most common), liver/small bowel transplant, transfusion of non-irradiated blood to immunodeficient recipients.
- Acute GVHD (< 100 days) : skin (rash), liver (jaundice — bile duct damage), GIT (bloody diarrhea) — epithelial cell apoptosis.
- Chronic GVHD : scleroderma-like skin, sicca, obliterative bronchiolitis.
- Prevention : irradiation / leukoreduction of blood products, T-cell depletion.

Filled

- Most immunogenic graft : bone marrow > skin > ...; cornea — immunologically privileged (avascular).
- Order of importance in HLA matching (kidney) : HLA-DR > B > A.
- C4d — marker of antibody-mediated rejection.
- CMV is the most common opportunistic infection after solid organ transplant; EBV → PTLD.
- Graft-versus-leukemia effect — beneficial T-cell action in allogeneic HSCT.

Primary Immunodeficiencies

Disease	Defect	Key features
X-linked agammaglobulinemia (Bruton)	BTK (tyrosine kinase) — B-cell maturation arrest (pre-B)	Boys after 6 months (maternal IgG wanes); absent B cells (CD19), all Ig ↓, absent germinal centres, tonsils; recurrent bacterial (sinopulmonary), enteroviral (polio vaccine-paralysis, echovirus encephalitis), Giardia
Common variable immunodeficiency (CVID)	Heterogeneous (TACI, ICOS); B cells present, defective differentiation	Onset after 2nd decade; ↓ IgG ± IgA, IgM; ↑ autoimmunity, lymphoma, gastric Ca; hyperplastic B-cell follicles
Selective IgA deficiency	IgA	Most common PID (1:700); mostly asymptomatic; sinopulmonary, Giardia; anaphylaxis on blood transfusion (anti-IgA antibodies); ↑ celiac, autoimmunity
Hyper-IgM syndrome	CD40L (X-linked, T cell) or CD40, AID	↑ IgM, ↓ IgG/A/E; Pneumocystis pneumonia, Cryptosporidium
DiGeorge syndrome (22q11.2 deletion)	Thymic hypoplasia (3rd & 4th pharyngeal pouches)	CATCH-22 : cardiac (truncus, TOF, interrupted aortic arch), abnormal facies, thymic aplasia (↓ T cells), cleft palate, hypocalcemia (absent parathyroids — tetany); TBX1
SCID	X-linked (most common, 50-60%) : common γ chain (IL-2Rγ); AR : ADA deficiency (adenosine deaminase) — toxic dATP	Thrush, diaper rash, failure to thrive, opportunistic (Candida, Pneumocystis, CMV); absent thymic shadow, ↓ T cells; BCG-osis; treatment : HSCT, gene therapy (ADA)
Wiskott-Aldrich syndrome	WAS gene (X-linked) — cytoskeleton	Thrombocytopenia (small platelets), eczema, recurrent infections; ↓ IgM, ↑ IgA & IgE; ↑ lymphoma
Ataxia telangiectasia	ATM (DNA repair) AR	Cerebellar ataxia, oculocutaneous telangiectasia, IgA deficiency, ↑ AFP, radiation sensitivity, lymphoma
Chronic mucocutaneous candidiasis	T-cell defect to Candida (AIRE, STAT1 GOF, IL-17)	Candida skin, nails, mucosa
IPEX	FOXP3 (Treg)	Immune dysregulation, polyendocrinopathy, enteropathy, X-linked
ALPS	Fas / FasL	Lymphadenopathy, splenomegaly, autoimmune cytopenias; ↑ double-negative (CD4–CD8–) T cells
Bare lymphocyte syndrome	MHC class II (CIITA, RFX)	↓ CD4 T cells, SCID-like
Complement / phagocyte defects	See Inflammation chapter	C5-C9 → Neisseria; CGD; LAD

Mnemonic : B vs T-cell deficiency infections

- B cell (antibody) : encapsulated bacteria — "SHiN SKiS" (S. pneumoniae, H. influenzae b, N. meningitidis, Salmonella, Klebsiella, GBS) + enteroviruses + Giardia.
- T cell : viruses, fungi (Candida, Pneumocystis), intracellular bacteria (Mycobacteria, Listeria), protozoa.

Secondary Immunodeficiency & HIV / AIDS

Causes of secondary immunodeficiency :

1. HIV infection (most important)
2. Malnutrition (most common worldwide), aging
3. Malignancy — leukemia, lymphoma (Hodgkin — T-cell defect), myeloma
4. Drugs — corticosteroids, chemotherapy, immunosuppressants, biologics (anti-TNF)
5. Diabetes mellitus, chronic renal failure, cirrhosis
6. Splenectomy — encapsulated organisms (OPSI)
7. Protein loss — nephrotic syndrome, protein-losing enteropathy, burns

HIV — virology :

- Retrovirus (Lentivirus); HIV-1 (worldwide; group M — subtype C most common in India), HIV-2 (West Africa).
- Genes : gag (p24 capsid, p17 matrix), pol (reverse transcriptase, integrase, protease), env (gp120 — binds CD4; gp41 — fusion). Regulatory : tat, rev, nef (↓ CD4 and MHC-I), vif, vpr, vpu.
- Receptor : CD4 + co-receptor CCR5 (macrophage-tropic, R5 — early, transmission) or CXCR4 (T-tropic, X4 — late). CCR5 Δ32 homozygous → resistance.

Transmission :

1. Sexual contact (most common worldwide) — heterosexual in India
2. Parenteral — IV drug users (needle sharing), blood transfusion (risk ~90-95% per unit — highest per-exposure), hemophiliacs (factor concentrates)
3. Mother-to-child (vertical) — intrapartum (most common), transplacental, breast milk
4. Occupational — needle-stick injury (~0.3%); mucous membrane (0.09%)

Natural history :

Acute (primary) HIV syndrome : 3-6 weeks — fever, sore throat, lymphadenopathy, rash; high viremia, ↓ CD4; seroconversion

↓

Chronic (clinical latency) phase : 7-10 years; persistent generalized lymphadenopathy; virus replicates in lymphoid tissue (follicular dendritic cells); slow CD4 decline

↓

AIDS : CD4 < 200/μL or AIDS-defining illness — opportunistic infections, tumours, wasting, encephalopathy

Lab diagnosis :

1. ELISA (4th gen : p24 antigen + antibody) — screening; window shortened to ~2-3 weeks
2. Rapid tests (3 different antigen principles — NACO strategy III)
3. Western blot (confirmatory, historical) — p24 + gp41 + gp120/160
4. HIV RNA PCR (viral load) — most sensitive; diagnosis in infants < 18 months (DNA PCR), monitoring therapy
5. p24 antigen — earliest marker (before antibodies)
6. CD4 count — staging, prophylaxis (Pneumocystis prophylaxis at CD4 < 200)

Opportunistic infections by CD4 count :

CD4/ µL	Infections
< 500	Tuberculosis (any CD4 — most common OI in India), oral candidiasis, herpes zoster, Kaposi sarcoma, oral hairy leukoplakia (EBV)
< 200	Pneumocystis jirovecii pneumonia, HIV encephalopathy, histoplasmosis, coccidioidomycosis
< 100	Toxoplasma encephalitis (ring-enhancing lesions), Cryptococcal meningitis, esophageal candidiasis, cryptosporidiosis, PML (JC virus), primary CNS lymphoma (EBV)
< 50	CMV retinitis, Mycobacterium avium complex (MAC), bacillary angiomatosis

HIV-associated neoplasms :

1. Kaposi sarcoma (HHV-8) — most common in untreated
2. B-cell lymphomas — DLBCL, Burkitt, primary CNS lymphoma (EBV), primary effusion lymphoma (HHV-8), plasmablastic lymphoma
3. Invasive cervical carcinoma (HPV) — AIDS-defining
4. Anal carcinoma (HPV)

Morphology :

- Lymph nodes : follicular hyperplasia (early) → follicular involution / "burnt-out" lymphocyte depletion (late).
- CNS : microglial nodules, multinucleated giant cells (HIV encephalitis); vacuolar myelopathy; HIV-associated neurocognitive disorder.

Filled : Handling of infected material & universal precautions

- Treat all specimens as potentially infectious (standard precautions); gloves, gown, mask, eye shield.
- Sharps in puncture-proof containers; never recap needles.
- Disinfection : 1% sodium hypochlorite (spills, 10,000 ppm with organic matter), 2% glutaraldehyde, 70% alcohol; autoclaving for reusable instruments; HIV is heat-labile (56 °C for 30 min).
- Biomedical waste (India, 2016 rules) : yellow — anatomical, soiled; red — contaminated recyclable plastics; white (translucent) — sharps; blue — glassware.
- Post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP) : start within 2 h (ideally), up to 72 h; TDF + 3TC + DTG for 28 days; test at baseline, 6 weeks, 3 months, 6 months.
- Health education : condoms, safe blood (screening all units for HIV, HBV, HCV, syphilis, malaria), harm reduction for IDUs, PPTCT — lifelong ART for pregnant women + infant nevirapine prophylaxis.

INFECTIOUS DISEASES

Patterns of Tissue Response to Infection

Pattern	Features	Examples
Suppurative (purulent)	Neutrophils, pus, abscess	Pyogenic bacteria — S. aureus, Streptococci, Gram-negative rods
Mononuclear / granulomatous	Lymphocytes, plasma cells, macrophages, granulomas	Viruses, intracellular bacteria (TB), spirochetes, fungi, helminths
Cytopathic-cytoproliferative	Cell necrosis / proliferation, inclusion bodies, multinucleated cells	Viruses — herpes, CMV, HPV (koilocytes), adenovirus
Tissue necrosis	Rapid, severe necrosis	Clostridium perfringens, Entamoeba histolytica, HSV encephalitis (temporal lobes)
Chronic inflammation & scarring	Fibrosis	HBV (cirrhosis), Schistosoma (pipe-stem fibrosis)
No reaction	Immunosuppression	PCP, MAC in AIDS

Special stains for organisms :

Stain	Organisms
Gram stain	Bacteria
Ziehl-Neelsen (acid-fast)	Mycobacteria, Nocardia (modified — weakly AF), Cryptosporidium, Isospora, Cyclospora (modified)
Fite-Faraco	M. leprae (weakly acid fast)
Auramine-rhodamine	Mycobacteria (fluorescent — sensitive screening)
GMS (Grocott methenamine silver)	Fungi, Pneumocystis (black)
PAS	Fungi, Whipple disease (Tropheryma — PAS+ macrophages), glycogen, Entamoeba trophozoites
Mucicarmine / India ink / Alcian blue	Cryptococcus capsule
Warthin-Starry / Dieterle silver	Spirochetes (Treponema), Bartonella, H. pylori, Legionella
Giemsa	Malaria, Leishmania (LD bodies), Toxoplasma, Chlamydia, Borrelia, Rickettsia, H. pylori
Toluidine blue	Pneumocystis cysts

Tuberculosis

- Mycobacterium tuberculosis — slender, acid-fast (mycolic acid), aerobic, cord factor (trehalose dimycolate) — virulence, serpentine cords; sulfatides prevent phagolysosome fusion; lipoarabinomannan (LAM) — inhibits macrophage activation.
- India : highest burden worldwide (~27% global cases).

Pathogenesis (immunity & hypersensitivity) :

Inhaled bacilli → alveolar macrophages → bacilli multiply (block phagolysosome maturation — ESX-1 secretion system)

↓

Week 3 : macrophages present antigen (MHC II) + IL-12 → Th1 cells → IFN-γ

↓

IFN-γ → macrophage activation : NO (iNOS), ROS, autophagy, defensins (cathelicidin — vitamin D dependent)

↓

TNF → granuloma formation (epithelioid cells, Langhans giant cells) + caseous necrosis (hypersensitivity)

↓

Containment (latent TB) — positive tuberculin test

Failure (HIV, ↓ IFN-γ / IL-12 pathway, anti-TNF) → progressive disease

Filled : Genetic susceptibility

- Mendelian susceptibility to mycobacterial disease (MSMD) : IFN-γ receptor, IL-12/IL-12R, STAT1 defects → disseminated BCG / NTM.
- NRAMP1 (SLC11A1) polymorphisms; vitamin D receptor polymorphisms.

Primary vs secondary TB :

Feature	Primary TB	Secondary (post-primary / reactivation) TB
Host	Unsensitized (first exposure), children	Previously sensitized
Site	Ghon focus : lower part of upper lobe / upper part of lower lobe (subpleural)	Apex of upper lobes (Simon / Assmann focus) — high O_2 tension
Lymph nodes	Hilar lymphadenopathy prominent	Minimal
Lesion	Ghon complex = Ghon focus + hilar node; calcified = Ranke complex	Cavitation (caseous necrosis erodes into bronchus)
Course	95% heal (fibrocalcification); progressive primary TB in immunocompromised	Cavitary, fibrocaseous; spread

Complications / patterns of progression :

1. Progressive pulmonary TB — apical cavities, fibrocaseous TB
2. Tuberculous bronchopneumonia (galloping consumption)
3. Miliary TB — hematogenous (pulmonary vein → systemic : liver, bone marrow, spleen, adrenals, meninges, kidneys, fallopian tubes, epididymis); millet-seed 2 mm lesions; choroid tubercles on fundoscopy
4. Isolated organ TB — meninges, kidneys, adrenals (Addison disease), bones (Pott disease — spine, thoracolumbar), fallopian tubes (tubal infertility)
5. Lymphadenitis (scrofula) — most common extrapulmonary TB; cervical nodes; collar-stud abscess
6. Intestinal TB — ileocecal; transverse (girdle) ulcers, strictures
7. Pleural — effusion (exudate, lymphocytic, ↑ ADA > 40 U/L), empyema, tuberculous pleuritis
8. Laryngitis, Rasmussen aneurysm (pulmonary artery in cavity wall → massive hemoptysis), aspergilloma in old cavity, amyloidosis (AA)

Diagnosis :

1. Sputum smear (ZN) — needs 10^4 bacilli/mL
2. Culture — Löwenstein-Jensen (gold standard, 4-8 weeks), MGIT (liquid, faster)
3. CBNAAT / GeneXpert MTB/RIF — rpoB mutation (rifampicin resistance); 2 h; Truenat (India)
4. Tuberculin skin test (Mantoux, 5 TU PPD) — type IV; read at 48-72 h; ≥ 10 mm positive (≥ 5 mm in HIV)
5. IGRA (QuantiFERON-TB Gold) — ESAT-6, CFP-10 (not in BCG — not affected by BCG vaccination)

6. Histopathology — caseating granulomas; LAM urine test (HIV)

> Exam pearl
> - False negative Mantoux : HIV / immunosuppression, sarcoidosis, measles, Hodgkin lymphoma, malnutrition, miliary TB (overwhelming).
> - Lupus vulgaris — cutaneous TB (apple-jelly nodules on diascopy); scrofuloderma, erythema induratum (Bazin) — tuberculid.
> - Atypical (NTM) mycobacteria : M. avium-intracellulare (AIDS), M. kansasii (lung), M. marinum (fish tank granuloma), M. ulcerans (Buruli ulcer), M. fortuitum/chelonae (post-surgical).

Leprosy (Hansen Disease)

- Mycobacterium leprae — weakly acid-fast (5% H_2SO_4 decolorization); grows at low temperature (30-33 °C) → skin, peripheral nerves, nose, testes, anterior eye; cannot be cultured in vitro (armadillo, mouse footpad); globi = clumps of bacilli in macrophages.
- Spread : respiratory droplets (nasal secretions) — most important.

Feature	Tuberculoid (TT)	Lepromatous (LL)
Immune response	Strong Th1 (IFN-γ, IL-2)	Th2 (IL-4, IL-10) — weak CMI, ↑ antibodies
Lesions	Few, well-defined, hypopigmented, anaesthetic macules	Multiple, symmetric nodules, leonine facies, madarosis (eyebrow loss), saddle nose
Nerves	Early asymmetric nerve involvement (thickened)	Late, symmetric glove-and-stocking
Histology	Well-formed non-caseating granulomas, nerve destruction; few/no bacilli	Foamy macrophages (lepra / Virchow cells) packed with bacilli (globi); Grenz zone (clear subepidermal zone)
Lepromin test	Positive	Negative
Bacillary index	0	5-6+

- Ridley-Jopling classification : TT - BT - BB - BL - LL (+ indeterminate).
- Lepra reactions : Type 1 (reversal reaction — type IV) — in borderline; Type 2 — erythema nodosum leprosum (ENL) — immune complex (type III) in LL/BL; treat with thalidomide.
- Lucio phenomenon — diffuse LL, necrotizing vasculitis.

Bacterial Infections

Pyogenic infections :

Organism	Lesions
Staphylococcus aureus	Abscesses, furuncle, carbuncle, impetigo, osteomyelitis, acute IE (normal valves, IV drug users — tricuspid), TSS (TSST-1), scalded skin syndrome (exfoliatin — desmoglein 1), food poisoning (enterotoxin B, 1-6 h), necrotizing pneumonia (PVL)
Streptococcus pyogenes	Pharyngitis, cellulitis, erysipelas, necrotizing fasciitis, scarlet fever (erythrogenic toxin); sequelae : rheumatic fever, PSGN
Streptococcus pneumoniae	Lobar pneumonia, otitis, meningitis (adults)
Viridans streptococci	Subacute IE (damaged valves), dental caries (S. mutans)

Typhoid (enteric) fever :

- Salmonella Typhi (and Paratyphi A, B) — fecal-oral; enters via M cells of Peyer patches → mononuclear phagocytes → bacteremia → gallbladder (carrier state).
- Pathology : hyperplasia of Peyer patches → oval ulcers along the long axis of ileum (vs transverse in TB) → perforation (3rd week), hemorrhage; typhoid nodules (aggregates of macrophages — liver, spleen, marrow) ; Zenker's degeneration of rectus abdominis; rose spots; relative bradycardia; leukopenia.
- Diagnosis : blood culture (1st week — best), bone marrow culture (most sensitive), Widal (2nd week onward), stool/urine culture (3rd–4th week).

Mnemonic : Typhoid diagnosis by week — "BASU"
Week 1 Blood culture · Week 2 Antibodies (Widal) · Week 3 Stool culture · Week 4 Urine culture.

Diphtheria :

- Corynebacterium diphtheriae — exotoxin (phage-encoded, tox gene) — ADP-ribosylation of EF-2 → inhibits protein synthesis.
- Grey-white pseudomembrane on tonsils / pharynx / larynx — bleeds on removal; bull neck; toxin → myocarditis (most common cause of death), polyneuropathy (palatal palsy).
- Lab : Albert stain (metachromatic / volutin granules), Loeffler serum slope, potassium tellurite medium; toxigenicity — Elek test.

Gram-negative infections & bacillary dysentery :

Disease	Organism	Pathology
Bacillary dysentery	Shigella (S. dysenteriae type 1 — Shiga toxin)	Colon (rectosigmoid); M cell entry; superficial irregular ulcers, pseudomembranes; HUS; reactive arthritis
Cholera	Vibrio cholerae	Toxin → ↑ cAMP (Gs); no mucosal damage, "rice-water stools"
Plague	Yersinia pestis	Hemorrhagic lymphadenitis (bubo), pneumonia
Pseudomonas	P. aeruginosa	Burns, CF, necrotizing vasculitis (ecthyma gangrenosum), otitis externa (diabetics)
Klebsiella	K. pneumoniae	Lobar pneumonia in alcoholics — "red currant jelly" sputum, cavitation
Whooping cough	Bordetella pertussis	Lymphocytosis, laryngotracheobronchitis
Melioidosis	Burkholderia pseudomallei	Pneumonia, abscesses — diabetics (India — rising)

Syphilis :

- Treponema pallidum — spirochete; dark-field microscopy; silver stain; cannot be cultured.

Stage	Features	Pathology
Primary (~3 weeks)	Hard (indurated), painless chancre, regional lymphadenopathy	Plasma cell-rich infiltrate, obliterative endarteritis
Secondary (2–10 weeks)	Generalized maculopapular rash (palms & soles), condyloma lata, mucous patches, lymphadenopathy	Plasma cells, endarteritis; most infectious
Latent	Asymptomatic	—
Tertiary (5–20 y)	Cardiovascular (aortitis → ascending aortic aneurysm, aortic regurgitation), neurosyphilis (tabes dorsalis, general paresis, Argyll Robertson pupil), gumma	Endarteritis obliterans of vasa vasorum → "tree-bark" aorta; gumma — rubbery necrosis
Congenital	Early : snuffles, rash, hepatosplenomegaly; late : Hutchinson triad (notched incisors, interstitial keratitis, 8th nerve deafness), saber shins, saddle nose, mulberry molars	Diffuse fibrosis (pneumonia alba), osteochondritis, periostitis

- Serology : non-treponemal (VDRL, RPR — screening, follow-up; biological false positive : SLE, APS, pregnancy, malaria, leprosy, IV drug use), treponemal (FTA-ABS, TPHA — confirmation; remain positive for life).

Viral Infections

Virus	Inclusion / histology	Key pathology
Poliovirus	–	Anterior horn cells → asymmetric flaccid paralysis; no sensory loss; enters via oropharynx/intestine (Peyer patches)
Herpes simplex (HSV-1, 2)	Cowdry type A (intranuclear) inclusions; multinucleated giant cells (Tzanck smear) — 3 Ms : multinucleation, molding, margination of chromatin	Vesicles, temporal lobe hemorrhagic necrotizing encephalitis (HSV-1), keratitis, neonatal herpes (HSV-2); latency in sensory ganglia (trigeminal, sacral)
VZV	Cowdry A, Tzanck +	Chickenpox; shingles (dermatomal), latency in dorsal root ganglia
CMV	"Owl-eye" intranuclear inclusion + cytoplasmic inclusions; cytomegaly	Most common congenital infection (periventricular calcification, deafness); retinitis, colitis, pneumonitis in AIDS / transplant
EBV	–	Infectious mononucleosis : atypical lymphocytes (Downey cells — reactive CD8 T cells), heterophile antibody (Paul-Bunnell, Monospot); splenic rupture; ampicillin rash
Rabies	Negri bodies — eosinophilic cytoplasmic inclusions in Purkinje cells (cerebellum) and pyramidal cells of hippocampus (Ammon horn)	Travels retrograde along nerves; encephalitis (furious — hydrophobia; paralytic) ; Babes nodules
Measles (rubeola)	Warthin-Finkeldey giant cells (lymphoid tissue), Koplik spots (buccal mucosa)	Pneumonia (giant cell pneumonia), SSPE (years later), immune amnesia; vitamin A ↓ mortality
HPV	Koilocytes (perinuclear halo, raisinoid nucleus)	Warts, CIN, cervical carcinoma
Adenovirus	Smudge cells (intranuclear)	Pharyngoconjunctival fever, hemorrhagic cystitis
Molluscum contagiosum	Molluscum (Henderson-Patterson) bodies — large eosinophilic cytoplasmic	Umbilicated papules
Parvovirus B19	Giant pronormoblasts with glassy intranuclear inclusions	Aplastic crisis (sickle cell, HS), hydrops fetalis, erythema infectiosum ("slapped cheek")
HBV	Ground-glass hepatocytes (HBsAg)	Hepatitis, cirrhosis, HCC
Smallpox / vaccinia	Guarnieri bodies (cytoplasmic)	–

Exam pearl

- Intranuclear inclusions : herpes (HSV, VZV, CMV), adenovirus, parvovirus, polyoma (JC — PML, oligodendrocytes), measles (both).
- Cytoplasmic inclusions : rabies (Negri), poxviruses (Guarnieri, molluscum), CMV (also), measles, RSV.
- Both nuclear + cytoplasmic : CMV, measles.

Rickettsial & Chlamydial infections :

Organism	Disease	Pathology
Rickettsia prowazekii	Epidemic typhus (louse)	Endothelial infection → vasculitis; typhus nodules (brain — microglial) ; rash starts on trunk
R. rickettsii	Rocky Mountain spotted fever (tick)	Rash begins on wrists/ankles → spreads centrally, palms & soles
Orientia tsutsugamushi	Scrub typhus (India — mite, chigger)	Eschar, lymphadenopathy, ARDS, myocarditis; Weil-Felix OX-K
Coxiella burnetii	Q fever (inhalation; no rash)	Fibrin-ring granulomas, culture-negative endocarditis
Chlamydia trachomatis A-C	Trachoma	Follicular conjunctivitis, scarring — leading infectious blindness

Organism	Disease	Pathology
C. trachomatis D-K	Urethritis, PID, inclusion conjunctivitis, neonatal pneumonia	Elementary body (infectious) / reticulate body (replicative); inclusions (Halberstaedter-Prowazek)
C. trachomatis L1-L3	Lymphogranuloma venereum	Stellate (suppurative) granulomas, inguinal buboes, groove sign, rectal strictures
Chlamydophila psittaci	Psittacosis	Atypical pneumonia (birds)

Fungal & Opportunistic Infections

Fungus	Morphology in tissue	Disease / notes
Candida albicans	Pseudohyphae + budding yeast; germ tube test +	Thrush, esophagitis, vaginitis, disseminated (neutropenia), endocarditis (IV drug use)
Aspergillus fumigatus	Septate hyphae branching at acute angles (45°)	Aspergilloma (fungal ball in old TB cavity — "air crescent"), ABPA (asthma, ↑ IgE, central bronchiectasis), invasive (angioinvasive, neutropenia — target lesions); aflatoxin (A. flavus)
Mucor / Rhizopus (Mucormycosis)	Broad, ribbon-like, aseptate (pauciseptate) hyphae, right-angle (90°) branching	Rhino-orbito-cerebral — diabetic ketoacidosis (COVID-associated outbreak in India), angioinvasion → infarction, black necrotic eschar
Cryptococcus neoformans	Yeast with thick mucoid capsule (India ink, mucicarmine); narrow-based budding	Meningitis in AIDS ("soap-bubble" lesions in brain), pigeon droppings; latex agglutination (capsular antigen)
Histoplasma capsulatum	Small intracellular yeasts in macrophages (2-5 μm)	Caseating granulomas, calcified, mimics TB; Ohio/Mississippi valley; bird/bat droppings
Blastomyces dermatitidis	Broad-based budding, thick double-contoured wall	Lung, skin (pseudoepitheliomatous hyperplasia)
Coccidioides immitis	Spherules with endospores (large)	Desert (San Joaquin valley fever), granulomas
Paracoccidioides	"Mariner's / pilot wheel" (multiple budding)	South America
Pneumocystis jirovecii	Foamy, frothy (cotton-candy) intra-alveolar exudate; cysts on GMS (crushed ping-pong ball / cup-shaped)	AIDS (CD4 < 200) — interstitial pneumonia; ↑ LDH; BAL; treat cotrimoxazole
Rhinosporidium seeberi	Large sporangia with endospores (strawberry-like polyps)	Nasal / ocular polyps — India (Tamil Nadu), pond bathing
Sporothrix schenckii	Cigar-shaped yeast, asteroid bodies	Rose gardener's disease — lymphocutaneous
Madurella / Nocardia (Mycetoma)	Grains (granules) in sinus tracts — black (eumycetoma), white/red (actinomycetoma)	Madura foot — swelling + sinuses + grains
Actinomyces israelii	Sulfur granules (Gram + filaments, not acid fast)	Cervicofacial (lumpy jaw), IUCD-associated pelvic

> Mnemonic : Aspergillus vs Mucor
> "Aspergillus = Acute angle, septate" · "Mucor = Massive ribbons, 90°, no septa, Metabolic (DKA)".

Parasitic Diseases

Parasite	Key pathology
Plasmodium falciparum	Cerebral malaria — cytoadherence (PfEMP1 binds ICAM-1, CD36) → sequestration in brain capillaries, ring hemorrhages, Dürck granulomas; black-water fever (massive hemolysis, hemoglobinuria); malarial pigment (hemozoin) in macrophages → slate-grey spleen, liver; multiple rings, appliqué (accolé) forms, banana-shaped gametocytes; all stages of RBC infected

Parasite	Key pathology
P. vivax / ovale	Hypnozoites (liver) → relapse; Schüffner dots; Duffy antigen receptor (vivax)
P. malariae	Quartan, nephrotic syndrome (immune complex)
Wuchereria bancrofti / Brugia malayi (Filaria)	Lymphatic obstruction → lymphedema, elephantiasis, hydrocele, chyluria; nocturnal periodicity; tropical pulmonary eosinophilia (↑ IgE, eosinophils)
Entamoeba histolytica (amoebiasis)	Flask-shaped ulcers (narrow neck, broad base) in cecum and ascending colon; trophozoites with ingested RBCs (erythrophagocytosis); amoebic liver abscess (right lobe, "anchovy sauce" pus); amoeboma
Leishmania donovani (Kala-azar)	LD bodies (amastigotes) in macrophages — spleen, liver, marrow; massive splenomegaly, hyperpigmentation, pancytopenia, hypergammaglobulinemia (aldehyde test); post-kala-azar dermal leishmaniasis; vector : sandfly (Phlebotomus argentipes); rK39 test
Taenia solium (Cysticercosis)	Neurocysticercosis — most common cause of acquired epilepsy in India; cysts with scolex (hooklets); "starry sky" on CT/MRI; calcified dead cysts
Echinococcus granulosus (Hydatid)	Cyst — outer laminated membrane (acellular, PAS +), inner germinal layer with brood capsules and protoscolices (hydatid sand), host fibrous pericyst; liver (right lobe) > lung; rupture → anaphylaxis; Casoni test (type I)
E. multilocularis	Alveolar hydatid — malignant-like infiltration
Schistosoma haematobium	Bladder — granulomas around terminal-spined eggs → SCC of bladder
S. mansoni / japonicum	Pipe-stem (Symmers) periportal fibrosis → presinusoidal portal HTN
Trichinella spiralis	Encysted larvae in skeletal muscle (diaphragm, extraocular), eosinophilia, periorbital edema
Toxoplasma gondii	Ring-enhancing brain lesions (AIDS); congenital : chorioretinitis, hydrocephalus, diffuse intracranial calcifications; lymphadenitis (Piringer-Kuchinka triad)
Trypanosoma cruzi	Chagas disease — myocarditis, megaesophagus, megacolon (destruction of myenteric plexus)
Strongyloides	Hyperinfection in steroid therapy / HTLV-1

Filled : Rank boosters — infections

- Most common opportunistic infection in AIDS in India : tuberculosis; worldwide (untreated) : PCP historically.
- Bacillary angiomatosis (Bartonella henselae) — vascular proliferation in AIDS; mimics Kaposi; neutrophils + clumps of bacteria (Warthin-Starry).
- Whipple disease — Tropheryma whipplei; PAS-positive foamy macrophages in lamina propria, arthritis, CNS, oculomasticatory myorhythmia.
- Leptospirosis (Weil disease) — jaundice, renal failure, conjunctival suffusion, pulmonary hemorrhage.
- Toxic shock syndrome — superantigen binds MHC-II + TCR Vβ outside groove → massive cytokine release.
- Cat-scratch disease — stellate necrotizing granulomas (B. henselae).
- Nipah virus (Kerala) — encephalitis, endothelial syncytia; bats (Pteropus).

GENETIC, NUTRITIONAL, ENVIRONMENTAL & PIGMENT DISORDERS

Modes of Inheritance

Mode	Key features	Examples
Autosomal dominant	Manifest in heterozygotes; 50% risk to offspring; variable expressivity, incomplete penetrance; usually structural proteins / receptors	Marfan, familial hypercholesterolemia, ADPKD, NF1, NF2, Huntington, hereditary spherocytosis, achondroplasia, VHL, FAP, tuberous sclerosis, myotonic dystrophy, osteogenesis imperfecta, acute intermittent porphyria, MEN, Li-Fraumeni
Autosomal recessive	Both alleles; 25% risk; consanguinity; complete penetrance, early onset; mostly enzyme defects	Cystic fibrosis, sickle cell, thalassemia, PKU, Wilson, hemochromatosis, α1-AT deficiency, lysosomal & glycogen storage diseases (except Hunter, Fabry), albinism, ARPKD
X-linked recessive	Males affected; no male-to-male transmission; carrier females	Duchenne/Becker, hemophilia A & B, G6PD deficiency, Fabry, Hunter, Lesch-Nyhan, Bruton, WAS, CGD (most), Ocular albinism, red-green colour blindness
X-linked dominant	Affected father → all daughters	Vitamin D-resistant (hypophosphatemic) rickets, Rett syndrome, fragile X (X-linked with anticipation), Alport (most)
Mitochondrial	Maternal inheritance; heteroplasmy	Leber hereditary optic neuropathy, MELAS, MERRF, Kearns-Sayre (ragged red fibres)

Single-gene disorders — mechanisms :

Mechanism	Disease
Enzyme defect	PKU (phenylalanine hydroxylase), Gaucher, Tay-Sachs, galactosemia
Receptor defect	Familial hypercholesterolemia (LDL receptor) — class 1 (no synthesis, most common), 2 (transport), 3, 4, 5
Transport defect	Cystic fibrosis (CFTR — ΔF508, class 2 misfolding)
Structural protein	Marfan (fibrillin-1, FBN1 — 15q21), Ehlers-Danlos (collagen), Duchenne (dystrophin)
Trinucleotide repeat	See below

Marfan syndrome :

- FBN1 (fibrillin-1) → ↑ TGF-β activity; AD.
- Skeletal : tall, long limbs (arm span > height), arachnodactyly, pectus, joint hypermobility, high-arched palate.
- Eye : bilateral ectopia lentis (upward & outward subluxation) — most characteristic.
- CVS : mitral valve prolapse (most common), aortic root dilation → cystic medial degeneration → dissection (most common cause of death).
- Losartan (blocks TGF-β signalling).

Filled : Marfan vs Homocystinuria vs Loeys-Dietz

Feature	Marfan	Homocystinuria	Loeys-Dietz
Gene	FBN1 (AD)	Cystathionine β-synthase (AR)	TGFBR1/2 (AD)
Lens	Upward / outward	Downward / inward	—
Others	Aortic root	Thrombosis, intellectual disability, osteoporosis	Bifid uvula, hypertelorism, arterial tortuosity, early dissection

Lysosomal storage diseases :

Disease	Enzyme deficiency	Accumulates	Key features
Tay-Sachs (GM2)	Hexosaminidase A	GM2 ganglioside	Cherry-red spot, no hepatosplenomegaly, onion-skin lysosomes (whorled), Ashkenazi Jews
Niemann-Pick A/B	Sphingomyelinase	Sphingomyelin	Cherry-red spot + hepatosplenomegaly, foam cells (zebra bodies)
Niemann-Pick C	NPC1/2 (cholesterol transport)	Cholesterol	Ataxia, dystonia, vertical gaze palsy
Gaucher (most common LSD)	Glucocerebrosidase (β-glucosidase)	Glucocerebroside	Gaucher cells — "crumpled tissue paper / wrinkled silk" cytoplasm (PAS+); hepatosplenomegaly, Erlenmeyer flask femur, aseptic necrosis; type 1 (non-neuronopathic) most common; enzyme replacement (imiglucerase)
Fabry (X-linked)	α-galactosidase A	Ceramide trihexoside (Gb3)	Angiokeratomas, painful neuropathy, renal failure, cardiac; zebra bodies in podocytes
Krabbe	Galactocerebrosidase	Galactocerebroside	Globoid cells, optic atrophy
Metachromatic leukodystrophy	Arylsulfatase A	Sulfatides	Metachromatic granules, demyelination
Hurler (MPS I)	α-L-iduronidase	Dermatan, heparan sulfate	Gargoylism, corneal clouding, hepatosplenomegaly, zebra bodies
Hunter (MPS II, X-linked)	Iduronate sulfatase	Dermatan, heparan sulfate	Milder, no corneal clouding, aggressive behaviour
Pompe (GSD II)	Acid maltase (α-1,4-glucosidase)	Glycogen (lysosomal)	Cardiomegaly, hypotonia; only GSD that is lysosomal

Mnemonic : "Hunters see clearly (no corneal clouding) and aim for the X (X-linked)"
Hunter = X-linked, no corneal clouding; Hurler = AR, corneal clouding.

Glycogen storage diseases :

Type	Enzyme	Features
I — von Gierke	Glucose-6-phosphatase	Severe fasting hypoglycemia, hepatomegaly, lactic acidosis, hyperuricemia, hyperlipidemia; doll-like face
II — Pompe	Lysosomal acid maltase	Cardiomegaly, infantile death
III — Cori	Debranching enzyme	Milder type I, normal lactate
V — McArdle	Muscle glycogen phosphorylase (myophosphorylase)	Exercise-induced cramps, myoglobinuria, no rise in lactate on ischemic forearm test, "second wind"

Mnemonic : GSD order — "Very Poor Carbohydrate Metabolism"
Von Gierke (I) · Pompe (II) · Cori (III) · McArdle (V).

Trinucleotide repeat disorders :

Disease	Repeat	Gene / location	Anticipation
Fragile X syndrome	CGG (> 200 full mutation)	FMR1 — 5′ UTR (methylation)	Maternal
Huntington disease	CAG (> 40)	HTT — coding (polyglutamine)	Paternal
Myotonic dystrophy	CTG	DMPK — 3′ UTR	Maternal (congenital)

Disease	Repeat	Gene / location	Anticipation
Friedreich ataxia	GAA (AR)	Frataxin — intron	—
Spinocerebellar ataxias, SBMA (Kennedy)	CAG	Coding	Paternal

- Fragile X : 2nd most common genetic cause of intellectual disability (after Down); macro-orchidism (post-pubertal), long face, large mandible, large everted ears, MVP; premutation carriers (55-200) → FXTAS (males), premature ovarian failure (females).

Cytogenetic Disorders

Disorder	Karyotype	Key features
Down syndrome	Trisomy 21 — 95% meiotic non-disjunction (maternal, ↑ age); 4% Robertsonian translocation t(14;21) (not age-related, recurrence risk ↑); 1% mosaic	Most common chromosomal disorder; flat facies, epicanthic folds, simian crease, endocardial cushion defects (AV canal — most common), duodenal atresia, Hirschsprung, ALL (10-20×), AML-M7 (megakaryoblastic) & transient myeloproliferative disorder, early Alzheimer (APP on chr 21), hypothyroidism, atlantoaxial instability. Screening : ↑ β-hCG, ↑ inhibin A, ↓ AFP, ↓ estriol, ↑ nuchal translucency, ↓ PAPP-A
Edwards syndrome	Trisomy 18	Rocker-bottom feet, clenched fists with overlapping fingers, micrognathia, prominent occiput, VSD; ↓ all screening markers
Patau syndrome	Trisomy 13	Cleft lip/palate, holoprosencephaly, polydactyly, microphthalmia, cutis aplasia, rocker-bottom
22q11.2 deletion	Microdeletion (FISH)	DiGeorge / velocardiofacial — CATCH 22
Klinefelter syndrome	47,XXY (most common cause of male hypogonadism)	Tall, eunuchoid habitus, gynecomastia, small firm testes, azoospermia, ↑ FSH, LH, ↓ testosterone; Barr body +; ↑ breast Ca, SLE
Turner syndrome	45,X (57%), mosaics	Short stature, webbed neck (cystic hygroma), coarctation of aorta, bicuspid aortic valve, streak ovaries (primary amenorrhea), horseshoe kidney, shield chest, lymphedema of hands/feet at birth; no Barr body
Cri-du-chat	5p deletion	Cat-like cry, microcephaly, VSD
Williams	7q11.23 deletion (elastin)	Elfin facies, hypercalcemia, supravalvular aortic stenosis, cocktail-party personality
Prader-Willi	15q11-13 deletion (paternal) or maternal uniparental disomy	Hyperphagia, obesity, hypogonadism, hypotonia
Angelman	15q11-13 deletion (maternal) or paternal UPD (UBE3A)	"Happy puppet" — inappropriate laughter, seizures, ataxia

Filled : Genomic imprinting & special mechanisms

- Imprinting — gene silenced by methylation depending on parental origin : Prader-Willi (paternal loss), Angelman (maternal loss), Beckwith-Wiedemann (11p15 — IGF2).
- Gonadal mosaicism — recurrence in sibs with normal parents (osteogenesis imperfecta).
- Lyonization — random X inactivation → manifesting female carriers (DMD, hemophilia).
- Investigations : karyotyping (G-banding), FISH (microdeletions), chromosomal microarray (CMA — first-tier for intellectual disability), NIPT (cell-free fetal DNA) — screening at ≥ 10 weeks.

Protein–Energy Malnutrition (PEM)

Feature	Marasmus	Kwashiorkor
Deficiency	Calories (total energy)	Protein (relative) with adequate calories
Weight for age	< 60%	60-80%
Edema	Absent	Present (hypoalbuminemia) — mask weight loss

Feature	Marasmus	Kwashiorkor
Serum albumin	Normal / mildly ↓	Markedly ↓
Appearance	"Old man" face, extreme muscle wasting, loss of subcutaneous fat, monkey face	Moon face, apathy, irritability
Skin	Loose folds	Flaky paint dermatosis, alternating zones of hyper/hypopigmentation
Hair	Normal / sparse	Flag sign (alternating bands of pale and dark hair)
Liver	Normal	Enlarged fatty liver (↓ apolipoprotein synthesis)
Other	—	Small bowel mucosal atrophy (reversible lactase deficiency), immune deficiency, anemia

- Secondary PEM — chronically ill, elderly, cancer (cachexia — TNF, proteolysis-inducing factor).
- Anorexia nervosa : amenorrhea (↓ GnRH), ↓ thyroid, osteoporosis, arrhythmias (hypokalemia) — most serious.
  Bulimia : hypokalemia, aspiration, Mallory-Weiss tears, Boerhaave, Russell sign.

Vitamin Deficiencies

Vitamin	Deficiency	Key pathology
A (retinol)	Night blindness (earliest), xerophthalmia, Bitot spots, keratomalacia (blindness)	Squamous metaplasia (respiratory, urinary — stones), follicular hyperkeratosis (phrynoderma), ↑ infections (measles mortality); ATRA treats APL
D	Rickets (children), osteomalacia (adults)	Excess unmineralized osteoid; rachitic rosary, Harrison groove, pigeon breast, craniotabes (earliest), frontal bossing, widened wrists, bowlegs; ↓ Ca, ↓ PO_4, ↑ ALP, ↑ PTH
C (ascorbic acid)	Scurvy	Defective collagen hydroxylation → perifollicular hemorrhages, corkscrew hairs, swollen bleeding gums, subperiosteal hemorrhage (children), poor wound healing, scorbutic rosary (sharp); Frankel white line, Wimberger ring
E	Spinocerebellar degeneration, hemolytic anemia (preterm)	Posterior column & spinocerebellar degeneration, retinopathy; fat malabsorption (abetalipoproteinemia, CF)
K	Bleeding diathesis — hemorrhagic disease of newborn	↓ II, VII, IX, X, protein C/S; ↑ PT; newborn (sterile gut, low placental transfer, breast milk) — prophylactic IM vit K at birth
B1 (thiamine)	Beriberi (dry — neuropathy; wet — high-output cardiac failure); Wernicke-Korsakoff (alcoholics)	Wernicke : ophthalmoplegia, ataxia, confusion — mammillary bodies hemorrhage, periaqueductal grey; Korsakoff — confabulation, memory loss
B2 (riboflavin)	Ariboflavinosis	Cheilosis, angular stomatitis, glossitis (magenta tongue), interstitial keratitis, seborrheic dermatitis
B3 (niacin)	Pellagra — "3 Ds" : dermatitis, diarrhea, dementia (+ death)	Casal necklace, Hartnup disease (tryptophan absorption ↓), carcinoid syndrome (tryptophan diverted), isoniazid, maize (jowar) diets
B6 (pyridoxine)	Seborrheic dermatitis, cheilosis, peripheral neuropathy, convulsions (infants), sideroblastic anemia	Isoniazid therapy
B12 / folate	Megaloblastic anemia	B12 also : subacute combined degeneration (posterior + lateral columns) — see Hematology
Biotin	Dermatitis, alopecia	Raw egg white (avidin)

Radiation Injury

- Ionizing radiation → direct DNA damage + free radicals (hydrolysis of water — OH•).
- Units : Gray (Gy) = absorbed dose (1 Gy = 100 rad); Sievert (Sv) = equivalent / effective dose (biological effect).

Radiosensitivity :

Highly radiosensitive	Radioresistant
Lymphocytes (most sensitive), hematopoietic cells, gonads (germ cells), intestinal epithelium, lens (cataract), lymphoid tissue, skin basal cells	Neurons, muscle, bone, cartilage, mature connective tissue
Tumours : seminoma, dysgerminoma, lymphoma, Ewing sarcoma, Wilms, myeloma	Melanoma, osteosarcoma, RCC, pancreas

- Law of Bergonié & Tribondeau — sensitivity ∝ mitotic activity and inversely ∝ differentiation; G2/M phase most sensitive, late S phase most resistant.
- Hypoxic cells are radioresistant (oxygen enhancement effect).

Morphology :

1. Vascular changes — endothelial swelling, fibrinoid necrosis, intimal fibrosis, hyalinization → obliterative ischemia (late)
2. Bizarre fibroblasts (radiation atypia) with enlarged hyperchromatic nuclei
3. Interstitial fibrosis (lung — radiation pneumonitis → fibrosis)
4. Cell death (apoptosis), chromosomal aberrations

Acute radiation syndrome (whole body) :

Dose	Syndrome
0.5–1 Sv	Subclinical / mild — lymphopenia
2–10 Sv	Hematopoietic syndrome — pancytopenia (2–3 weeks), infection, bleeding
10–20 Sv	Gastrointestinal syndrome — diarrhea, sepsis; death in 1–2 weeks
> 50 Sv	Cerebrovascular (CNS) syndrome — death in 1–2 days

- Earliest sign : lymphocyte depletion (absolute lymphocyte count at 48 h = best prognostic indicator).
- Late effects : cancer (leukemia — earliest, papillary thyroid Ca in children — Chernobyl), cataract, sterility, fibrosis, angiosarcoma (breast after RT).

Pigments

Pigment	Source / features	Conditions
Lipofuscin ("wear-and-tear" / age pigment)	Lipid peroxidation of membranes — residual bodies; yellow-brown, perinuclear; autofluorescent	Brown atrophy (heart, liver) of aging, cachexia; not injurious — marker of past free-radical injury
Melanin	Tyrosine → tyrosinase → DOPA → melanin (melanocytes); Masson-Fontana (black), bleached by H_2O_2	Hyperpigmentation : Addison, Peutz-Jeghers, melasma, McCune-Albright (café-au-lait). Hypopigmentation : albinism (tyrosinase deficiency), vitiligo, PKU
Homogentisic acid	Black pigment in connective tissue — ochronosis	Alkaptonuria (homogentisate oxidase deficiency, AR) — urine darkens on standing, arthropathy, ear/sclera pigmentation
Hemosiderin	Hb-derived; golden-yellow to brown granules; ferritin micelles; Perls Prussian blue — blue	Local : bruise, heart failure cells. Systemic (hemosiderosis) : ↑ absorption, hemolytic anemia, repeated transfusions; hereditary hemochromatosis (HFE C282Y) → cirrhosis, DM, skin pigmentation ("bronze diabetes"), cardiomyopathy
Bilirubin	Normal pigment of bile (heme → biliverdin → bilirubin); green-yellow; no iron	Jaundice; kernicterus (unconjugated bilirubin in basal ganglia of neonates); bile lakes, bile infarcts in obstruction
Hematin	Hb degradation (acid hematin)	Malaria pigment (hemozoin), gastric acid (coffee-ground vomitus)

Pigment	Source / features	Conditions
Carbon (anthracotic)	Coal dust (exogenous)	Anthracosis — black lungs, hilar nodes
Tattoo	Exogenous	Dermal macrophages
Argyria / plumbism	Silver / lead	Blue-grey skin; Burton line (lead) at gum margin

Exam pearl

- Hemosiderin (iron) vs lipofuscin (no iron) vs melanin : Perls positive only hemosiderin; melanin bleaches with $KMnO_4/H_2O_2$; lipofuscin stains with Sudan black / PAS and autofluoresces.
- Hemochromatosis : iron in hepatocytes (periportal, zone 1) and pancreatic acini/islets, heart; HFE on chromosome 6p (linked to HLA-A3); ↑ transferrin saturation (> 45%) — best screening; risk of HCC (200×).
- Transfusional (secondary) hemosiderosis — iron first in reticuloendothelial (Kupffer) cells rather than hepatocytes.

Environmental & Nutritional Miscellany

Agent	Key pathology
Lead	Microcytic hypochromic anemia with basophilic stippling, inhibits ALA dehydratase & ferrochelatase (↑ ZPP), ringed sideroblasts, Burton gum line, lead lines in metaphyses, wrist/foot drop, encephalopathy (children); Fanconi-like tubular damage
Mercury	Minamata disease (methylmercury — cerebral palsy, blindness); acrodynia (pink disease); PCT necrosis ($HgCl_2$)
Arsenic	Raindrop pigmentation, palmar/plantar hyperkeratosis, Mees lines (nails), skin SCC, Bowen disease, blackfoot disease; West Bengal groundwater
Cadmium	Itai-itai disease — osteoporosis + renal damage; lung (emphysema)
Carbon monoxide	Cherry-red discoloration; bilateral globus pallidus necrosis
Alcohol (ethanol)	Fatty liver, alcoholic hepatitis (Mallory-Denk bodies), cirrhosis, Wernicke, cardiomyopathy, pancreatitis, fetal alcohol syndrome (smooth philtrum, thin upper lip, microcephaly)
Tobacco	Most common avoidable cause of human death; lung, oral, larynx, esophagus, bladder, pancreas, kidney, cervix cancer; COPD, atherosclerosis
Obesity	Leptin (↓ appetite — from fat), adiponectin (↓ in obesity — insulin sensitizer), ghrelin (↑ appetite — stomach); metabolic syndrome, NAFLD, OSA, cancers (endometrium, breast, colon)

CARDIOVASCULAR SYSTEM

Blood Vessels — Atherosclerosis

- Disease of large and medium-sized elastic and muscular arteries characterized by intimal lesions (atheromas / fibrofatty plaques).
- Most commonly involved vessels (descending order) : abdominal aorta (infrarenal) > coronary arteries > popliteal arteries > internal carotid arteries > circle of Willis. Upper limb, renal, mesenteric arteries usually spared (except at ostia).

Risk factors :

Non-modifiable (constitutional) :

1. Age (40-60 years — increasing incidence)
2. Male gender (premenopausal women protected)
3. Genetics / family history (most important independent risk factor; familial hypercholesterolemia)

Modifiable (major) :

1. Hyperlipidemia (↑ LDL, ↓ HDL) — most important modifiable
2. Hypertension
3. Cigarette smoking
4. Diabetes mellitus (↑ MI 2×, ↑ gangrene of legs 100×)
5. Inflammation — ↑ CRP (hs-CRP)

Additional :

1. Hyperhomocysteinemia
2. Metabolic syndrome, obesity
3. Lipoprotein(a) (altered apo B with apo(a))
4. Factors affecting hemostasis (↑ PAI-1, fibrinogen)
5. Lack of exercise, stress (type A personality)

Pathogenesis — "response to injury" hypothesis :

Chronic endothelial injury / dysfunction (hyperlipidemia, HTN, smoking, turbulence — branch points) → ↑ permeability, leukocyte adhesion (VCAM-1)

↓

LDL accumulates in intima → oxidized LDL

↓

Monocytes adhere, migrate → macrophages ingest oxLDL via scavenger receptors (CD36, SR-A) → foam cells

↓

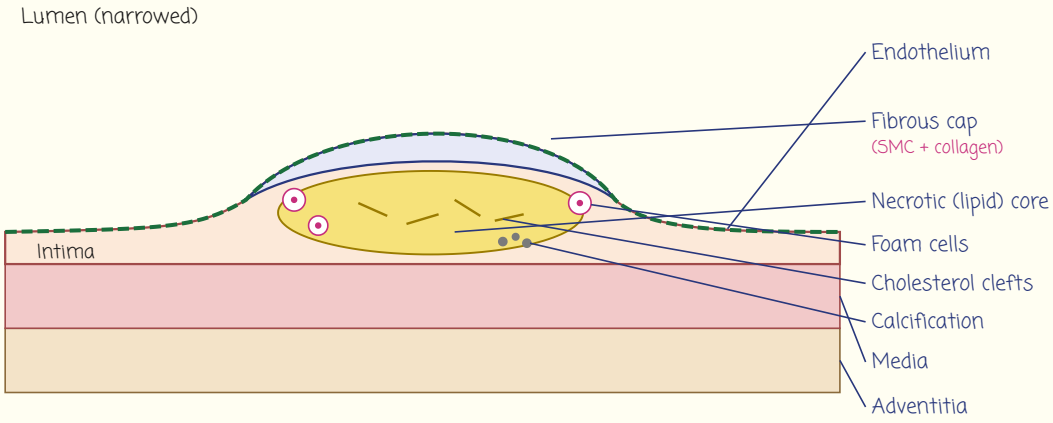
Fatty streak (earliest lesion) ; inflammasome (cholesterol crystals) → IL-1

↓

Platelet adhesion + cytokines (PDGF, FGF, TGF-β) → SMC migration from media to intima & proliferation + ECM (collagen)

↓

Fibrofatty atheroma : fibrous cap + necrotic core



Structure of a fibrofatty atheroma (labelled)

Morphology :

Lesion	Features
Fatty streak	Earliest lesion; flat yellow spots; lipid-filled foam cells; seen in children < 1 year (aorta); not raised, no flow disturbance
Atheroma (fibrofatty plaque)	Raised white-yellow plaque; superficial fibrous cap (SMC, collagen); shoulder (macrophages, T cells, SMC); necrotic core (lipid, cholesterol clefts, foam cells, debris); neovascularization
Complicated plaque	Rupture / ulceration / erosion → thrombosis; hemorrhage into plaque; atheroembolism; aneurysm (media atrophy); calcification

- Vulnerable (unstable) plaque : thin fibrous cap, large lipid core, many inflammatory cells (macrophages — MMPs) → rupture → acute coronary syndrome. Stable plaque : thick cap, small core.

Exam pearl
- Hallmark cell of atherosclerosis : foam cell (macrophage); key cell for plaque growth : smooth muscle cell.
- Statins stabilize plaque (↓ inflammation, ↓ LDL) in addition to lipid lowering.
- Mönckeberg medial calcific sclerosis — calcification of media of muscular arteries, does not narrow lumen, > 50 years; radiologic "pipe-stem".

Arteriolosclerosis & Hypertension

Type	Associated with	Morphology
Hyaline arteriolosclerosis	Benign (essential) hypertension, diabetes, aging	Homogeneous pink hyaline thickening of arteriolar walls (plasma protein leakage + ↑ ECM) → narrowed lumen → benign nephrosclerosis (granular contracted kidney)
Hyperplastic arteriolosclerosis	Malignant hypertension (> 180/120 mmHg)	"Onion-skin" concentric laminated thickening (SMC + reduplicated basement membrane) + fibrinoid necrosis (necrotizing arteriolitis) — "flea-bitten kidney" (petechiae)

Secondary causes of hypertension :

1. Renal — renal artery stenosis (atherosclerosis in elderly, fibromuscular dysplasia in young women — "string of beads"), GN, CKD, PKD, renin-producing tumours
2. Endocrine — primary aldosteronism (Conn — most common endocrine cause), Cushing, pheochromocytoma, acromegaly, thyroid disease, OCPs
3. Cardiovascular — coarctation of aorta (upper limb HTN, rib notching)
4. Neurologic — raised ICP, sleep apnea
5. Pregnancy — preeclampsia

Hypertensive heart disease :

- Systemic (left-sided) : concentric LVH (wall > 1.5-2 cm) without other cause + history/evidence of HTN; myocyte hypertrophy (boxcar nuclei), interstitial fibrosis → diastolic dysfunction, AF, CHF.
- Pulmonary (right-sided) — cor pulmonale : RVH due to pulmonary hypertension from lung disease (COPD — most common, ILD, PE, kyphoscoliosis, OSA).

Aneurysms & Dissection

Type	Cause / features
Abdominal aortic aneurysm (AAA)	Atherosclerosis; infrarenal, above bifurcation; > 50 y, men, smokers; rupture risk ↑ when > 5 cm (surgery at 5.5 cm); inflammatory AAA (IgG4)
Thoracic (ascending) aortic aneurysm	Hypertension, Marfan, Loeys-Dietz, bicuspid valve, tertiary syphilis (tree-bark intima, obliterative endarteritis of vasa vasorum)
Berry (saccular) aneurysm	Circle of Willis (anterior communicating artery most common); ADPKD, Ehlers-Danlos, coarctation; rupture → subarachnoid hemorrhage
Charcot-Bouchard (micro)aneurysm	Small penetrating arteries (lenticulostriate) — hypertension → intracerebral hemorrhage (basal ganglia)
Mycotic aneurysm	Infection of the wall (septic emboli in IE, Salmonella)
Pseudoaneurysm (false)	Breach in wall with extravascular hematoma communicating with lumen (post-MI ventricular rupture, catheterization)
Kawasaki	Coronary artery aneurysm in children

Aortic dissection :

- Blood enters media via intimal tear → separates layers.
- Causes : hypertension (> 90% in men 40-60 y); young — Marfan, Ehlers-Danlos, pregnancy, iatrogenic.
- Underlying lesion : cystic medial degeneration (mucoid degeneration) — fragmentation of elastic tissue + pooling of ground substance (no inflammation).
- Classification : Stanford type A (proximal — ascending ± descending; more common, more dangerous, surgery) ; type B (distal — beyond subclavian; medical management). DeBakey I, II (ascending), III (descending).
- Presentation : sudden excruciating tearing chest pain radiating to back, pulse deficit, widened mediastinum; death from rupture into pericardium (tamponade), pleural or peritoneal cavity.

Vasculitis

Vessel size	Disease	Key features
Large	Giant cell (temporal) arteritis	> 50 y, most common vasculitis in elderly; granulomatous inflammation of media with giant cells, fragmentation of internal elastic lamina; temporal artery — headache, jaw claudication, visual loss (ophthalmic artery); ↑ ESR; polymyalgia rheumatica; skip lesions (biopsy ≥ 1 cm); steroids
	Takayasu arteritis	Young Asian women (< 40 y); "pulseless disease", aortic arch and branches (subclavian); granulomatous; ↓ upper-limb pulses, BP difference; ocular disturbances
Medium	Polyarteritis nodosa (PAN)	Young adults; HBV (30%); renal, mesenteric, skin, nerves — spares lungs; segmental transmural necrotizing inflammation, fibrinoid necrosis; lesions in different stages; microaneurysms (rosary); ANCA negative; mononeuritis multiplex
	Kawasaki disease	< 4 years; mucocutaneous lymph node syndrome — fever > 5 days, conjunctival injection, strawberry tongue, cracked lips, desquamation of palms/soles, cervical lymphadenopathy; coronary artery aneurysm (MI); IVIG + aspirin
	Thromboangiitis obliterans (Buerger)	Heavy smokers (young men, India, bidi); tibial & radial arteries; segmental thrombosing acute & chronic inflammation, microabscesses in thrombus, extends to adjacent veins and nerves; Raynaud, superficial migratory thrombophlebitis, gangrene, claudication of instep

Vessel size	Disease	Key features
Small	Granulomatosis with polyangiitis (Wegener)	c-ANCA (PR3); triad : upper respiratory (nasal ulcers – saddle nose, sinusitis), lungs (nodules, cavities), kidney (crescentic GN – pauci-immune); necrotizing granulomas + vasculitis; cyclophosphamide/rituximab
	Microscopic polyangiitis	p-ANCA (MPO); no granulomas; lung capillaritis (hemoptysis) + necrotizing GN; leukocytoclastic
	EGPA (Churg-Strauss)	p-ANCA (40%); asthma, allergic rhinitis, eosinophilia, granulomas; heart (eosinophilic myocarditis – major cause of death), neuropathy
	IgA vasculitis (Henoch-Schönlein purpura)	Children; palpable purpura (buttocks, legs), arthralgia, abdominal pain (intussusception), GN (IgA mesangial) ; after URTI
	Cryoglobulinemic vasculitis	HCV – mixed cryoglobulins; purpura, arthralgia, MPGN
	Hypersensitivity (leukocytoclastic) vasculitis	Drugs, infection; all lesions same age; nuclear debris (leukocytoclasis)
	Behçet disease	HLA-B51; oral & genital aphthous ulcers, uveitis, pathergy

Mnemonic : ANCA
"C-ANCA = Cytoplasmic = PR3 = granulomatosis (Wegener)" · "P-ANCA = Perinuclear = MPO = MPA, EGPA, UC, PSC, crescentic GN".

Vascular tumours :

Tumour	Key features
Capillary hemangioma (juvenile/strawberry)	Most common tumour of infancy; grows rapidly, regresses by 7 years; GLUT-1 +
Cavernous hemangioma	Large dilated channels; von Hippel-Lindau (cerebellum, retina); does not regress
Pyogenic granuloma (lobular capillary hemangioma)	Rapidly growing, bleeds; pregnancy (granuloma gravidarum)
Glomus tumour	Painful, subungual; modified SMC of glomus body
Kaposi sarcoma	HHV-8; types : classic (elderly Mediterranean men, legs), endemic African, transplant, AIDS (most aggressive); spindle cells + slit-like vascular spaces with extravasated RBCs + hyaline globules; LANA-1 +
Angiosarcoma	Liver – vinyl chloride, arsenic, Thorotrast; breast – post-mastectomy lymphedema (Stewart-Treves), post-RT; CD31, ERG
Bacillary angiomatosis	Bartonella – AIDS; neutrophils
Hemangioblastoma	VHL – cerebellum; erythropoietin (polycythemia)

Ischemic Heart Disease

- > 90% due to coronary atherosclerosis; LAD (40-50%) > RCA (30-40%) > LCX (15-20%).

Territory	Infarct region
LAD	Anterior wall of LV, anterior 2/3 of interventricular septum, apex – "widow maker"
RCA	Posterior (inferior) wall of LV, posterior 1/3 septum, RV free wall; SA node (60%), AV node (90%) – bradyarrhythmias
LCX	Lateral wall of LV

Myocardial infarction – sequence of changes :

Time	Gross	Light microscopy	EM / other
0–30 min	None	None	Reversible — relaxation of myofibrils, glycogen loss, mitochondrial swelling
30 min–4 h	None	Usually none; waviness of fibres at border	Irreversible — sarcolemmal disruption, mitochondrial amorphous densities
4–12 h	Occasionally dark mottling	Early coagulation necrosis, edema, hemorrhage	TTC stain : unstained (pale) infarct
12–24 h	Dark mottling	Ongoing coagulation necrosis; pyknosis, hypereosinophilia; marginal contraction band necrosis; early neutrophilic infiltrate	
1–3 days	Mottling with yellow-tan center	Coagulation necrosis with loss of nuclei and striations; brisk neutrophilic infiltrate	Fibrinous pericarditis (day 2–3)
3–7 days	Hyperemic border, central yellow-tan softening	Beginning disintegration of dead fibres, dying neutrophils, early macrophage phagocytosis at border	Highest risk of free-wall rupture (3–7 days)
7–10 days	Maximally yellow-tan and soft, depressed red-tan margins	Well-developed phagocytosis; early granulation tissue at margins	
10–14 days	Red-grey depressed borders	Well-established granulation tissue, new vessels, collagen	
2–8 weeks	Grey-white scar, progressive from border to core	↑ collagen, ↓ cellularity	Dressler syndrome (2–10 weeks — autoimmune pericarditis)
> 2 months	Scarring complete	Dense collagenous scar	Ventricular aneurysm

Cardiac biomarkers :

Marker	Rises	Peaks	Returns to normal	Notes
Troponin I / T (cTnI, cTnT)	2–4 h (hs-Tn 1 h)	24–48 h	7–10 days (I), 10–14 days (T)	Most sensitive & specific; diagnosis of late MI
CK-MB	2–4 h	24–48 h	48–72 h	Best for re-infarction
Myoglobin	1–2 h (earliest)	6–12 h	24 h	Not specific
LDH-1 (flipped LDH 1>2)	24 h	3–6 days	8–14 days	Obsolete

Complications of MI :

1. Arrhythmias — most common cause of death in first hours (VF); most common complication
2. Contractile dysfunction / LV failure, cardiogenic shock (infarct > 40% of LV)
3. Myocardial rupture (3–7 days) :
   - Free wall rupture → hemopericardium, cardiac tamponade (most common rupture; elderly women, first MI, no LVH)
   - Interventricular septal rupture → left-to-right shunt
   - Papillary muscle rupture → acute mitral regurgitation (posteromedial — RCA)
4. Pericarditis — fibrinous (2–3 days); Dressler (weeks)
5. Right ventricular infarction (with inferior MI) — hypotension, clear lungs, ↑ JVP
6. Infarct expansion, mural thrombus → systemic embolism
7. Ventricular aneurysm (late) — persistent ST elevation
8. Papillary muscle dysfunction, progressive late heart failure

Filled : Rank boosters — MI & reperfusion

- Subendocardial infarct — inner 1/3-1/2 of wall; NSTEMI; hypotension, diffuse coronary disease. Transmural — STEMI.
- Reperfusion injury : contraction band necrosis (Ca^{2+} influx), hemorrhagic infarct, myocardial stunning (reversible dysfunction for days), reperfusion arrhythmias, microvascular obstruction (no-reflow).
- Hibernating myocardium — chronic ischemia, reduced function, recovers after revascularization.
- Sudden cardiac death : most common cause — coronary atherosclerosis (lethal arrhythmia); young — HOCM, myocarditis, long QT, Brugada, ARVC, anomalous coronary.
- Earliest histological change of MI on light microscopy : wavy fibres (within hours); earliest EM change : glycogen depletion / mitochondrial swelling.
- Takotsubo (stress) cardiomyopathy — apical ballooning, catecholamines, women.

Rheumatic Fever & Rheumatic Heart Disease

- Acute immune-mediated multisystem disease following group A β-hemolytic streptococcal pharyngitis (not skin infections) after 2-3 weeks; 5-15 years.
- Mechanism : molecular mimicry — antibodies & CD4+ T cells against streptococcal M protein cross-react with cardiac myosin, laminin, valve glycoproteins (type II + type IV hypersensitivity).

Jones criteria (revised 2015) :

Major (J♥NES)	Minor
Joints — migratory polyarthritis (large joints) — most common	Fever (≥ 38.5 °C)
♥ Carditis (pancarditis) — clinical / subclinical (echo)	Arthralgia
Nodules (subcutaneous) — painless, extensor surfaces	↑ ESR (≥ 60) / CRP (≥ 3)
Erythema marginatum — trunk, evanescent	Prolonged PR interval
Sydenham chorea — late, may be isolated	

- Diagnosis : evidence of preceding GAS infection (↑ ASO, anti-DNase B, throat culture) + 2 major or 1 major + 2 minor.

Morphology :

- Aschoff body (pathognomonic) : foci of fibrinoid necrosis surrounded by T lymphocytes, plasma cells, and plump macrophages — Anitschkow cells (caterpillar cells / owl-eye nuclei — chromatin condensed into central wavy ribbon); multinucleate = Aschoff giant cells. Found in any layer of heart (pancarditis).
- Pericardium : fibrinous / serofibrinous "bread-and-butter" pericarditis.
- Myocardium : myocarditis — interstitial Aschoff bodies → cardiac dilation, most common cause of death in acute RF.
- Endocardium & valves : verrucous vegetations — small (1-2 mm), warty, along lines of closure; MacCallum plaques — subendocardial lesions in left atrium (jet lesions).
- Chronic RHD : organization → fibrous thickening, commissural fusion, shortening & thickening of chordae → fish-mouth / buttonhole stenosis; neovascularization; mitral (65-70%) alone > mitral + aortic (25%) ; tricuspid less, pulmonary rarely.

Exam pearl

- Mitral stenosis — most common valvular lesion in RHD; virtually always rheumatic.
- MS → LA dilation → AF, mural thrombi (left atrial appendage) → embolism, pulmonary venous HTN → brown induration, RVH, hemoptysis, hoarseness (Ortner — recurrent laryngeal compression).
- Anitschkow cells = activated macrophages; Aschoff bodies are replaced by scar in chronic RHD.

Infective Endocarditis (IE)

Feature	Acute IE	Subacute IE
Organism	Staphylococcus aureus (highly virulent)	Viridans streptococci (S. sanguinis, mutans) (low virulence)
Valve	Previously normal valves	Previously damaged valves (RHD, congenital, MVP)
Course	Destructive, rapid (days), high mortality	Insidious (weeks-months); recovery after antibiotics
Vegetation	Large, destructive (ring abscess, perforation)	Smaller, less destructive

Other organisms :

1. IV drug users — S. aureus, tricuspid valve, also Pseudomonas, Candida
2. Prosthetic valve — Staph. epidermidis (CoNS) (early), streptococci (late)
3. Streptococcus gallolyticus (bovis) → colon carcinoma — colonoscopy mandatory
4. HACEK group (Haemophilus, Aggregatibacter, Cardiobacterium, Eikenella, Kingella) — culture-negative IE; also Coxiella, Bartonella, Brucella, fungi
5. Enterococci — elderly men after GU procedures

Morphology & complications :

- Friable, bulky, destructive vegetations (fibrin, inflammatory cells, bacteria) on atrial surface of AV valves / ventricular surface of semilunar valves; mitral > aortic.
- Cardiac : valvular insufficiency (perforation), ring abscess, suppurative pericarditis, conduction defects.
- Embolic : septic infarcts (brain, spleen, kidney), mycotic aneurysms.
- Immune complex : focal segmental (embolic) GN — "flea-bitten kidney"; Roth spots (retina), Osler nodes (painful, finger pads), Janeway lesions (painless, palms/soles — microemboli), splinter hemorrhages; clubbing, splenomegaly.
- Modified Duke criteria : major — positive blood cultures (typical organism, 2 separate), echo evidence of endocardial involvement; minor — predisposition, fever, vascular & immunologic phenomena.

Non-infective vegetations :

Type	Features	Associated with
Rheumatic (verrucous)	Small, warty, along lines of closure, non-destructive	Acute RF
Infective	Large, irregular, friable, destructive; bacteria	IE
NBTE (marantic)	Small, sterile, bland, loosely attached along lines of closure; no inflammation	Hypercoagulable states, mucin-secreting adenocarcinoma (pancreas), chronic debilitating illness; embolize
Libman-Sacks (SLE)	Small-medium, sterile, on both surfaces (undersurface) of valves, chordae; fibrinoid necrosis	SLE, APS
Carcinoid heart disease	Fibrous plaques on endocardium — right heart (tricuspid, pulmonary)	Serotonin from liver metastases of carcinoid (inactivated in lung)

Valvular Heart Disease — Other

Lesion	Cause	Key features
Calcific aortic stenosis	Age-related ("wear and tear", 70-80 y); bicuspid aortic valve (50-60 y)	Heaped-up calcified masses within cusps (sinuses of Valsalva), no commissural fusion (vs rheumatic); angina, syncope, CHF ; concentric LVH
Bicuspid aortic valve	Most common congenital heart anomaly (1-2%); NOTCH1	Premature calcific AS, aortic dilatation / dissection, coarctation, Turner
Mitral valve prolapse (myxomatous degeneration)	Marfan, idiopathic (2-3%), young women	Ballooning (hooding) of mitral leaflets into LA ; mid-systolic click; intercalated myxoid degeneration of spongiosa

Lesion	Cause	Key features
Mitral annular calcification	Elderly women	Calcium in annulus; arrhythmias, embolism

Cardiomyopathies

Feature	Dilated (DCM)	Hypertrophic (HCM)	Restrictive (RCM)
Function	Systolic dysfunction (↓ EF < 40%)	Diastolic dysfunction, outflow obstruction (asymmetric septal)	Diastolic dysfunction (stiff, non-dilated)
Causes	Idiopathic, genetic (TTN — titin; most common), alcohol, myocarditis (Coxsackie B), doxorubicin, trastuzumab, peripartum, Chagas, hemochromatosis, thyrotoxicosis, beriberi, cocaine, DMD	Genetic (AD) — mutations in sarcomere proteins : β-myosin heavy chain (MYH7 — most common), myosin-binding protein C (MYBPC3) ; Friedreich ataxia, Fabry, Pompe	Amyloidosis (most common), sarcoidosis, radiation, endomyocardial fibrosis (tropical — Kerala, children), Loeffler endocarditis (eosinophils), hemochromatosis, endocardial fibroelastosis (infants)
Morphology	Four-chamber dilatation, mural thrombi, flabby	Massive myocardial hypertrophy without dilation, asymmetric septal hypertrophy (septum : free wall > 1.3), banana-shaped LV cavity ; myocyte disarray (haphazard), interstitial fibrosis	Normal size, firm; biatrial dilation
Clinical	CHF, arrhythmias, embolism	Sudden death in young athletes, systolic murmur ↑ with Valsalva / standing (↓ preload); SAM of mitral valve	

- Arrhythmogenic RV cardiomyopathy (ARVC) : desmosomal protein mutations (plakoglobin, desmoplakin, plakophilin-2); fibrofatty replacement of RV myocardium; Naxos syndrome (palmoplantar keratoderma + woolly hair); sudden death.
- Left ventricular non-compaction — spongy trabeculated myocardium.

Myocarditis :

Cause	Features
Viral (Coxsackie A & B — most common), enteroviruses, CMV, HIV, influenza, SARS-CoV-2	Lymphocytic myocarditis with myocyte necrosis (Dallas criteria)
Hypersensitivity (drug)	Eosinophils, perivascular
Giant cell myocarditis	Multinucleate giant cells, eosinophils, necrosis — poor prognosis
Chagas disease (T. cruzi)	Parasites in myofibres, Latin America
Diphtheria	Toxin — myocyte necrosis
Lyme disease	Conduction block

Pericardial Disease

Type	Causes / features
Serous	Non-infectious — RF, SLE, scleroderma, tumours, uremia
Fibrinous / serofibrinous	Most common type — acute MI, Dressler, uremia, radiation, RF, SLE, trauma ; friction rub
Purulent (suppurative)	Bacterial, fungal, parasitic invasion

Type	Causes / features
Hemorrhagic	Malignancy (most common), TB, bleeding diathesis, post-cardiac surgery
Caseous	Tuberculosis — leads to constrictive pericarditis
Chronic constrictive pericarditis	TB (India), post-surgical, radiation; thick dense fibrous / calcified "concrete" pericardium (up to 1 cm) → impaired diastolic filling, Kussmaul sign, pericardial knock, pulsus paradoxus (less)
Cardiac tamponade	Beck triad (hypotension, ↑ JVP, muffled heart sounds), pulsus paradoxus, electrical alternans

Cardiac Tumours

Tumour	Features
Metastasis	Most common cardiac tumours (lung, breast, melanoma, lymphoma)
Myxoma	Most common primary cardiac tumour in adults; left atrium (90%), fossa ovalis; pedunculated, gelatinous; "ball-valve" obstruction, tumour plop, syncope, embolism, constitutional symptoms (IL-6); Carney complex (PRKAR1A)
Rhabdomyoma	Most common primary cardiac tumour in children/infants; tuberous sclerosis; spider cells; ventricles; regress
Papillary fibroelastoma	Most common tumour of valves; "sea anemone"
Lipoma, angiosarcoma (most common primary malignant — right atrium)	—

Congenital Heart Disease

Category	Lesions
Left-to-right shunts (acyanotic, late cyanosis)	VSD (most common CHD overall), ASD (most common in adults; secundum type), PDA, AV septal defect (Down)
Right-to-left shunts (cyanotic — early)	"5 Ts" : Tetralogy of Fallot (most common cyanotic), Transposition of great arteries (most common cyanotic at birth), Truncus arteriosus, Tricuspid atresia, TAPVC
Obstructive	Coarctation of aorta, pulmonary stenosis, aortic stenosis/atresia

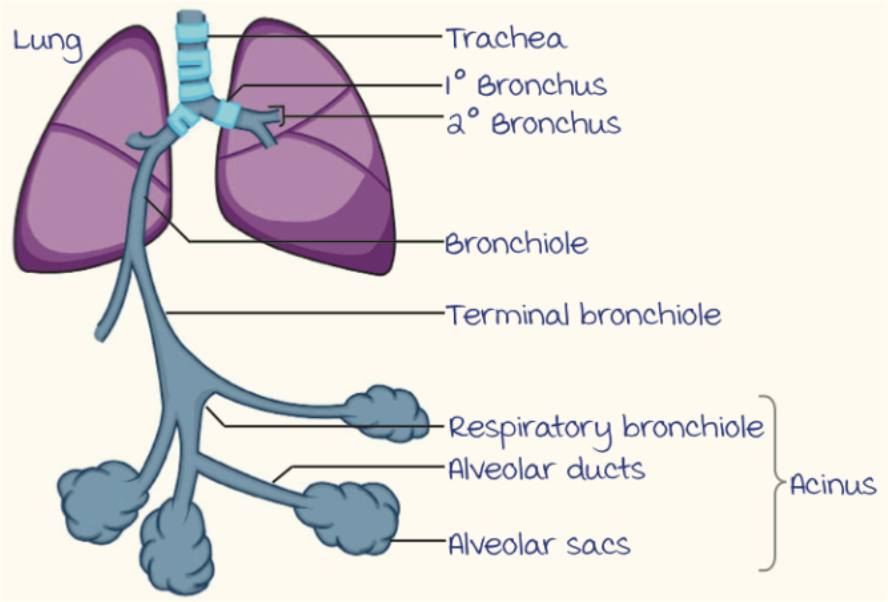
- Eisenmenger syndrome : long-standing L→R shunt → pulmonary HTN → reversal (R→L) → late cyanosis, clubbing, polycythemia.
- Tetralogy of Fallot : VSD + overriding aorta + RV outflow (pulmonary) obstruction (determines severity) + RVH → boot-shaped heart (coeur en sabot), tet spells (squatting ↑ SVR).
- PDA : machinery murmur, congenital rubella; closure with indomethacin (NSAIDs); keep open with PGE1.
- Coarctation : infantile (preductal) — Turner, with PDA ; adult (postductal) — upper-limb HTN, weak femoral pulses, rib notching (intercostal collaterals), bicuspid AV.

Filled : Embryology & associations

- TGA — maternal diabetes; TOF, truncus, interrupted arch — DiGeorge (22q11); ASD — Holt-Oram (TBX5); supravalvular AS — Williams; PDA — rubella; AV canal — Down; Ebstein anomaly — lithium; coarctation — Turner; Marfan — MVP, aortic root.
- VSD — membranous septum most common (90%).
- ASD types : secundum (most common, fossa ovalis), primum (Down, AV canal), sinus venosus (PAPVR).

RESPIRATORY SYSTEM

Structure of the Respiratory Tract



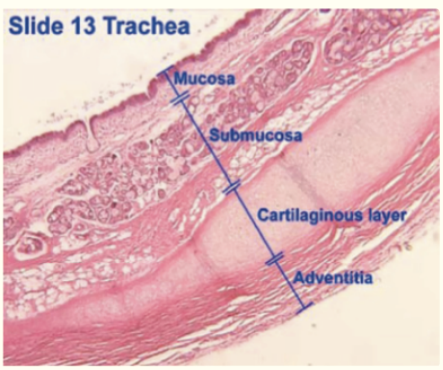
Bronchial tree : trachea → bronchi → bronchioles → acinus

- Acinus : part of lung distal to the terminal bronchiole — respiratory bronchiole + alveolar ducts + alveolar sacs (terminal respiratory unit). 3-5 acini = lobule.

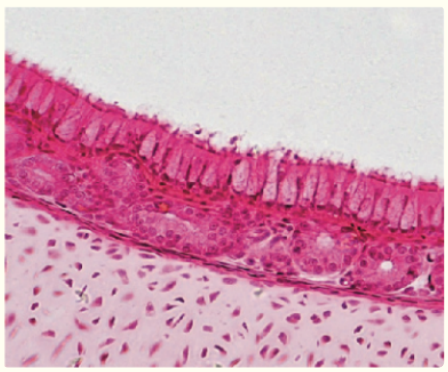
Layers of respiratory tract :

Layers of respiratory tract

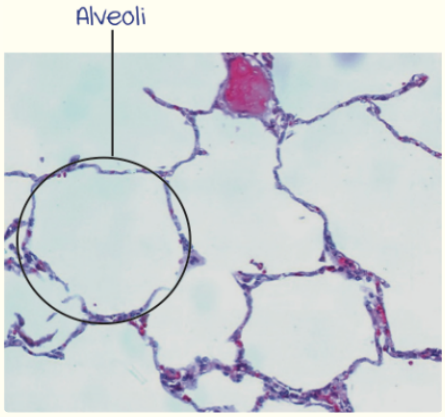
Mucosa	Submucosa	Muscularis	Cartilage
• Epithelium (pseudostratified ciliated columnar with goblet cells) • Lamina propria • Muscularis mucosa	• Submucosal glands (seromucous)		• C-shaped in trachea; plates in bronchi; absent in bronchioles



Respiratory tract (trachea) histology — mucosa, submucosa, cartilaginous layer, adventitia



Pseudostratified ciliated columnar epithelium



Alveoli — alveolar biopsy (circle marks one alveolus)

Alveoli — lined by :

1. Type I pneumocytes — 95% of alveolar surface, flat, gas exchange; cannot divide.
2. Type II pneumocytes — cuboidal; produce surfactant (dipalmitoyl phosphatidylcholine / lecithin; lamellar bodies); stem cells for type I (repair).

- Alveolar macrophages (dust cells); pores of Kohn (collateral ventilation, spread of bacteria in lobar pneumonia).
- Clara (club) cells — non-ciliated bronchiolar cells : CC10 protein, CYP450 detoxification, progenitors.

Lung Diseases — Classification

Lung diseases

Obstructive (↓ FEV1/FVC < 0.7)

- COPD : Emphysema, Chronic bronchitis
- Asthma
- Bronchiectasis

Restrictive (↓ TLC, FEV1/FVC normal or ↑)

- Pneumoconiosis : Coal worker's pneumoconiosis, Silicosis, Asbestosis
- Cryptogenic organising pneumonia
- Sarcoidosis
- IPF, chest wall disorders

Feature	Obstructive	Restrictive
FEV1	↓↓	↓
FVC	Normal / ↓	↓↓
FEV1/FVC	↓ (< 0.7)	Normal or ↑
TLC	↑ (air trapping)	↓
DLCO	↓ emphysema, normal bronchitis, ↑/normal asthma	↓ in ILD; normal in extrapulmonary (chest wall, neuromuscular)

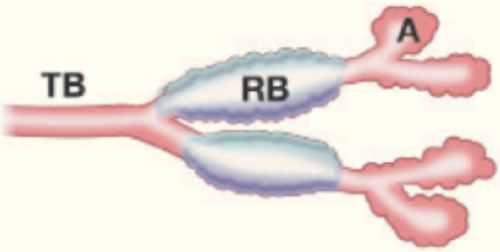
Emphysema

- Irreversible enlargement of air spaces distal to terminal bronchioles (acinus) with destruction of walls without obvious fibrosis.

Types :

1. Centrilobular / centriacinar :

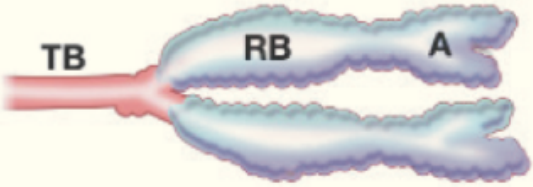
- M/c type (95%).
- Central acini affected, distal acini spared (respiratory bronchioles).
- Associated with smoking.
- Usually affects upper lobes of lung (apical segments).



Centriacinar — RB dilated, alveoli spared

2. Panacinar :

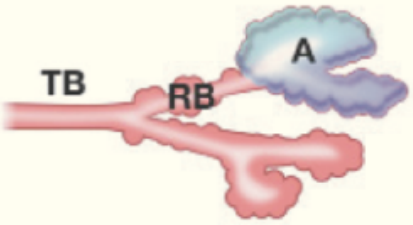
- Dilatation of the entire acinus (RB → alveoli).
- Associated with α1-antitrypsin deficiency.
- Usually affects lower lobes of lung (bases).



Panacinar — whole acinus uniformly dilated

3. Paraseptal / distal acinar :

- Distal acini affected, central acini spared (alveolar ducts & sacs, along pleura and septa).
- Associated with spontaneous pneumothorax in young adults (bullae).

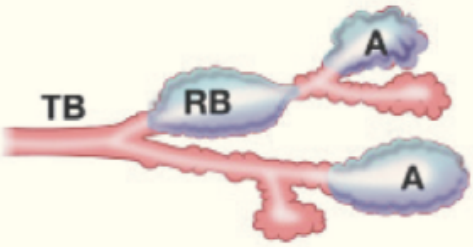


Paraseptal – distal alveoli dilated

4. Irregular :

- Common histologically – associated with scarring (healed inflammation); usually asymptomatic.

TB : Terminal bronchiole · RB : Respiratory bronchiole · A : Alveoli.



Irregular – acinus irregularly involved

Pathogenesis – protease-antiprotease & oxidant hypothesis :

Smoke / irritants → neutrophils & macrophages recruited (IL-8, LTB4, TNF)

↓

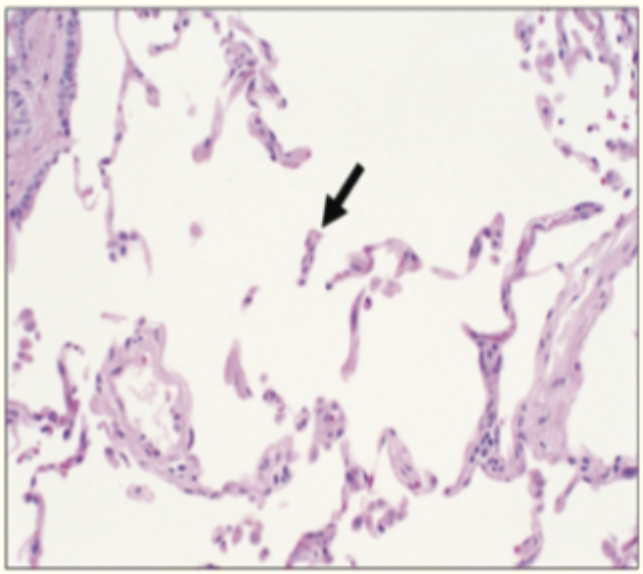
Neutrophil elastase, MMPs (macrophage elastase – MMP-12) | Oxidants in smoke + ROS → inactivate α1-antitrypsin

↓

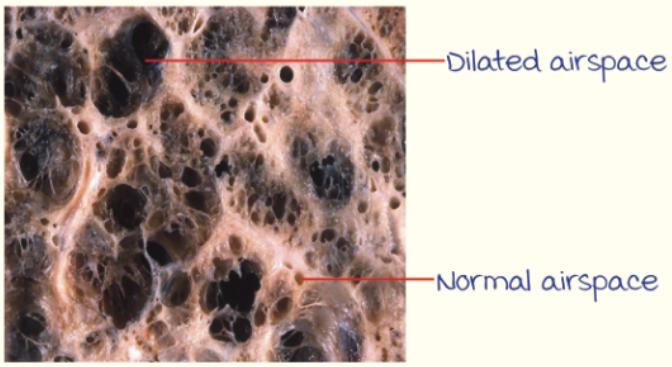
Protease > antiprotease → destruction of elastic tissue in alveolar walls

↓

Loss of radial traction on small airways → collapse during expiration → air trapping



Histology : broken alveoli / floating septae (arrow)



Gross : centriacinar emphysema – dilated vs normal airspaces

Note : α-1-antitrypsin deficiency :

- Genetics :
  - Chromosome 14 : gene for α-1-antitrypsin (α-1-AT; SERPINA1); autosomal codominant.
  - Genotype → Normal : PiMM. Diseased : PiZZ (Glu342Lys – misfolding, retained in ER).

- Organs affected :
  - Lungs : panacinar emphysema (loss of antiprotease; smoking accelerates).
  - Liver : cirrhosis (biopsy → PAS +ve, diastase-resistant globules in periportal hepatocytes — toxic gain of function); neonatal hepatitis, HCC.

Filled : Emphysema — rank boosters

- Pink puffers : emphysema — dyspnea, pursed-lip breathing, barrel chest, ↓ DLCO, hyperinflated lungs, flat diaphragm.
- Blue bloaters : chronic bronchitis — cyanosis, hypercapnia, cor pulmonale, edema.
- Bullous emphysema : bullae > 1 cm — subpleural, apex; rupture → pneumothorax.
- Compensatory hyperinflation (after lobectomy) and obstructive overinflation (foreign body — ball-valve) are not true emphysema (no destruction).
- Interstitial emphysema — air in connective tissue (mediastinum, subcutaneous) — ventilator, trauma, whooping cough.

Chronic Bronchitis

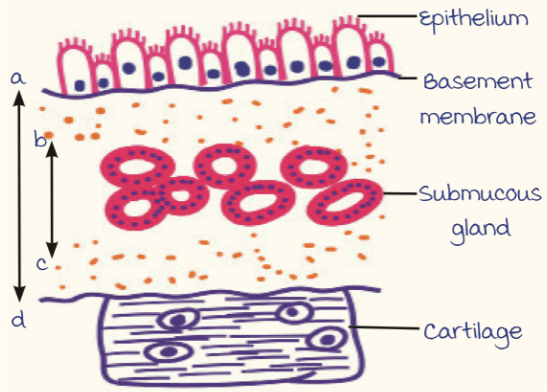
- Persistent productive cough for at least 3 consecutive months in each of 2 consecutive years, in the absence of other identifiable causes (D/d : tuberculosis).
- 90% patients → smokers; also air pollution (SO_2, NO_2), cold damp climate.

Reid index (RI) :

$$RI = \frac{\text{Thickness of submucous gland layer}}{\text{Thickness of wall b/w epithelium \& cartilage}}$$

$$RI = \frac{bc}{ad}$$

- Normal : 0.4.
- ↑ed in chronic bronchitis (> 0.5) : D/t submucosal gland hyperplasia (mucus hypersecretion — earliest feature).



Reid index — a-d : epithelium to cartilage; b-c : submucous gland layer

Morphology :

1. Hypertrophy of submucosal mucous glands (trachea, large bronchi) — ↑ Reid index
2. Goblet cell hyperplasia (small airways — chronic bronchiolitis, fibrosis → obstruction)
3. Chronic inflammation (lymphocytes), squamous metaplasia, dysplasia (→ carcinoma)

Bronchial Asthma

- Chronic inflammatory disorder of airways → episodic reversible bronchoconstriction, wheeze, ↑ airway responsiveness.

Feature	Atopic (extrinsic)	Non-atopic (intrinsic)
Trigger	Environmental allergens (dust mite, pollen)	Viral infections, pollutants, aspirin, cold, exercise
Mechanism	Type I hypersensitivity (Th2 — IL-4, IL-5, IL-13), IgE	Not IgE-mediated; airway hyperreactivity
Family history	Positive (atopy)	Negative
Serum IgE	↑	Normal

Morphology (airway remodelling) :

1. Thickened basement membrane (subepithelial collagen IV deposition) — most characteristic
2. Hypertrophy / hyperplasia of bronchial smooth muscle
3. ↑ submucosal glands, goblet cells; eosinophil infiltration; ↑ vascularity
4. Mucus plugs — occlude bronchi (status asthmaticus) ; overdistended lungs

Sputum findings :

Finding	Description
Curschmann spirals	Mucus plugs with whorled shed epithelium
Charcot-Leyden crystals	Crystalloids of eosinophil galectin-10 (lysophospholipase)
Creola bodies	Clusters of shed epithelial cells

Exam pearl

- Aspirin-exacerbated respiratory disease : asthma + nasal polyps + aspirin sensitivity (COX block → ↑ leukotrienes).
- ADAM33 (airway remodelling), IL-13, TSLP genes; hygiene hypothesis.
- Status asthmaticus — severe, unremitting; mucus plugs at autopsy.

Bronchiectasis

- Permanent dilation of bronchi and bronchioles caused by destruction of muscle and elastic tissue, from chronic necrotizing infection.

Causes :

1. Congenital / hereditary :
   - Cystic fibrosis (most common in children / West)
   - Primary ciliary dyskinesia — Kartagener syndrome (situs inversus + sinusitis + bronchiectasis + infertility) — dynein arm defect (DNAH5, DNAI1)
   - Immunodeficiency (hypogammaglobulinemia)
2. Post-infectious — necrotizing pneumonia (TB — most common in India), measles, pertussis, adenovirus
3. Bronchial obstruction — tumour, foreign body, mucus impaction
4. Allergic bronchopulmonary aspergillosis (ABPA) — central / proximal bronchiectasis
5. Others : RA, SLE, IBD, post-transplant (bronchiolitis obliterans)

Morphology :

- Lower lobes, bilateral, vertical air passages; airways dilated up to 4× (cylindroid, fusiform, saccular); can be followed to pleural surface.
- Clinical : copious foul-smelling purulent sputum, hemoptysis, clubbing; HRCT — signet ring sign, tram-track.
- Complications : lung abscess, brain abscess, amyloidosis (AA), cor pulmonale.

Pneumonias

Type	Organism	Features
Community-acquired typical	S. pneumoniae (most common), H. influenzae (COPD), Moraxella, S. aureus (post-influenza), Klebsiella (alcoholics), Pseudomonas (CF)	Lobar / bronchopneumonia
Atypical	Mycoplasma (most common), Chlamydophila, Legionella, viruses (influenza, RSV, SARS-CoV-2)	Interstitial pneumonia, patchy; cold agglutinins (Mycoplasma)
Hospital-acquired	Gram-negative (Klebsiella, Pseudomonas, E. coli), MRSA	Ventilator-associated

Type	Organism	Features
Aspiration	Anaerobes (oral flora) + aerobes	Right lower lobe (posterior segment of upper lobe / superior lower lobe when supine) — abscess

Lobar pneumonia — stages (Laennec) :

Stage	Time	Gross	Microscopy
Congestion	Day 1-2	Heavy, boggy, red	Vascular engorgement, intra-alveolar fluid with few neutrophils, many bacteria
Red hepatization	Day 2-4	Red, firm, airless, liver-like	Massive exudation of neutrophils, RBCs, fibrin filling alveoli
Grey hepatization	Day 4-8	Greyish-brown, dry	Disintegration of RBCs, persistence of fibrinosuppurative exudate
Resolution	Day 8+	—	Enzymatic digestion of exudate; macrophages; restoration

- Complications : fibrinous pleuritis → organization (pleural adhesions), empyema, lung abscess, bacteremia (meningitis, endocarditis, arthritis), organization → carnification.

Feature	Lobar pneumonia	Bronchopneumonia
Distribution	Entire lobe, uniform	Patchy, centred on bronchioles, bilateral, basal
Age	Adults (20-50 y)	Extremes of age, debilitated
Organism	S. pneumoniae (90%), Klebsiella	Staph, Strep, H. influenzae, Pseudomonas

Interstitial (atypical) pneumonia :

- Inflammation confined to alveolar septa (widened, edematous; mononuclear infiltrate); alveolar spaces free of exudate; hyaline membranes in severe cases (DAD).
- Mild symptoms disproportionate to X-ray changes ("walking pneumonia").

Pulmonary Suppuration — Lung Abscess

Causes :

1. Aspiration of infective material (most common) — alcoholics, unconscious, anesthesia, seizures, dental sepsis → anaerobes (Bacteroides, Fusobacterium, Peptostreptococcus)
2. Antecedent primary bacterial infection — S. aureus, Klebsiella, Pseudomonas (post-influenza)
3. Septic embolism — IE of right heart (IV drug users), thrombophlebitis — multiple abscesses
4. Neoplasia — post-obstructive (bronchogenic carcinoma — 10-15% of abscesses)
5. Others — penetrating trauma, spread from subphrenic abscess

- Site (aspiration) : right lung (more vertical main bronchus) — posterior segment of right upper lobe, apical segment of right lower lobe.
- Morphology : cavity with air-fluid level, necrotic debris surrounded by fibrous wall.
- Complications : empyema, brain abscess / meningitis, secondary AA amyloidosis, hemorrhage.

Pulmonary Tuberculosis — Lung Specifics

- Primary : Ghon focus (subpleural — lower upper lobe / upper lower lobe) + hilar node = Ghon complex.
- Secondary : apical (Simon focus) — cavitation; fibrocaseous TB; tuberculous bronchopneumonia; miliary TB.
- Pleural involvement : serous effusion (lymphocytic, ADA ↑), tuberculous empyema, obliterative fibrous pleuritis, pleural thickening.
- Complications : hemoptysis (Rasmussen aneurysm), aspergilloma, bronchiectasis, broncho-pleural fistula, laryngeal & intestinal TB (swallowed sputum), amyloidosis, cor pulmonale.

Atelectasis & Neonatal Respiratory Distress

Type	Mechanism	Example
Resorption (obstruction)	Complete airway obstruction → air resorbed	Mucus plug (post-operative), foreign body, tumour; mediastinum shifts toward atelectatic lung
Compression	Pleural cavity filled with fluid / air	Pleural effusion, pneumothorax; mediastinum shifts away
Contraction (cicatrization)	Local / generalized fibrosis	Irreversible
Patchy (microatelectasis)	Loss of surfactant	Neonatal RDS, ARDS

Hyaline membrane disease (Neonatal RDS) :

- Deficiency of surfactant (immaturity of type II pneumocytes) — prematurity (< 28 weeks: 60%); maternal diabetes (insulin suppresses surfactant), caesarean section before labour (no glucocorticoid surge), male sex, twins.
- Morphology : lungs solid, airless, reddish-purple (liver-like), sink in water; poorly developed atelectatic alveoli; eosinophilic hyaline membranes (fibrin + necrotic epithelium) lining respiratory bronchioles, alveolar ducts; little neutrophil inflammation.
- Prevention : antenatal corticosteroids (betamethasone) ; L/S ratio ≥ 2 (amniotic fluid), phosphatidylglycerol presence = lung maturity.
- Complications (O_2 / ventilation — ROS) : retinopathy of prematurity (VEGF), bronchopulmonary dysplasia (↓ alveolar septation — "alveolar hypoplasia"), PDA, IVH, NEC.

ARDS (diffuse alveolar damage) :

- Causes : sepsis (most common), diffuse pulmonary infections (viral — COVID-19), gastric aspiration, trauma, pancreatitis, transfusion (TRALI), fat embolism.
- Stages : exudative (hyaline membranes — day 3-7) → proliferative (type II pneumocyte hyperplasia, organization) → fibrotic.
- Berlin definition : acute (< 1 week), bilateral opacities, $PaO_2/FiO_2 \leq 300$, not cardiac.

Restrictive & Interstitial Lung Diseases

Disease	Key pathology
Idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis (UIP pattern)	Patchy interstitial fibrosis, temporal heterogeneity, fibroblastic foci, honeycombing — subpleural, lower lobes; > 50 y men, smokers; TERT, MUC5B; nintedanib, pirfenidone
Nonspecific interstitial pneumonia (NSIP)	Uniform (temporally homogeneous) inflammation / fibrosis; CTD-associated; better prognosis
Cryptogenic organizing pneumonia (BOOP)	Polypoid plugs of loose organizing connective tissue (Masson bodies) in alveolar ducts, alveoli, bronchioles; responds to steroids
Sarcoidosis	Non-caseating granulomas (lymphangitic distribution), bilateral hilar lymphadenopathy, asteroid & Schaumann bodies, ↑ ACE, hypercalcemia; Löfgren syndrome (erythema nodosum + BHL + arthritis); Heerfordt (uveoparotid fever); CD4:CD8 > 3.5 in BAL ; African-American women, non-smokers
Hypersensitivity pneumonitis	Type III + IV; farmer's lung (Saccharopolyspora / thermophilic actinomycetes), bird fancier's (pigeon), bagassosis (sugarcane), byssinosis (cotton — "Monday chest tightness"); poorly formed non-necrotizing granulomas, bronchiolocentric
Pulmonary eosinophilia	Loeffler (transient, parasites), tropical (microfilariae), chronic eosinophilic pneumonia, drug-induced
Pulmonary alveolar proteinosis	Anti-GM-CSF antibodies → defective macrophage clearance of surfactant; PAS + granular intra-alveolar material; "crazy paving" CT; whole-lung lavage
Langerhans cell histiocytosis (pulmonary)	Smokers, upper-lobe nodules & cysts; Birbeck granules, CD1a+

Disease	Key pathology
Goodpasture syndrome	Anti-GBM (α3 type IV collagen) → pulmonary hemorrhage + RPGN; linear IgG; young men, smokers

Occupational Lung Diseases (Pneumoconioses)

Disease	Agent	Key pathology
Coal worker's pneumoconiosis	Coal dust (carbon)	Anthracosis (asymptomatic, black pigment in macrophages along lymphatics) → simple CWP (coal macules 1-2 mm, upper lobes; coal nodules) → complicated CWP / progressive massive fibrosis (> 2 cm black scars); Caplan syndrome (RA + pneumoconiosis — rheumatoid nodules)
Silicosis	Crystalline silica (quartz) — most common occupational disease worldwide; mining, sand-blasting, stone cutting, glass, pottery, foundry	Upper lobes; silicotic nodules — concentric "onion-skin" hyalinized collagen with birefringent particles (weakly); eggshell calcification of hilar nodes; ↑ susceptibility to TB (silica kills macrophages — inflammasome); lung cancer (IARC group 1)
Asbestosis	Asbestos (amphiboles — crocidolite most pathogenic; serpentine — chrysotile) — shipyard, insulation, roofing, brake linings	Lower lobes, subpleural diffuse interstitial fibrosis (UIP-like); asbestos (ferruginous) bodies — golden-brown beaded dumbbell rods, Prussian blue +; pleural plaques (most common lesion — parietal pleura, dome of diaphragm, calcified, no asbestos bodies); bronchogenic carcinoma (most common malignancy; synergistic with smoking ×55), malignant mesothelioma
Berylliosis	Beryllium (aerospace, electronics)	Non-caseating granulomas (sarcoid-like), type IV hypersensitivity; lung cancer
Byssinosis	Cotton, flax, hemp	Monday fever; not granulomatous
Siderosis	Iron (welders)	Benign
Bagassosis	Sugarcane bagasse (thermophilic actinomycetes)	Hypersensitivity pneumonitis
Farmer's lung	Mouldy hay (Saccharopolyspora rectivirgula)	HP

Mnemonic : Upper vs lower lobe pneumoconioses

"Upper — SCB" : Silicosis, Coal, Berylliosis (and TB, sarcoid upper/mid) · "Lower — Asbestosis" (and IPF, scleroderma).

Lung Tumours

Classification (WHO) :

Type	Frequency	Key features
Adenocarcinoma	Most common overall (~40%); most common in women, non-smokers, young	Peripheral; glandular, mucin; TTF-1, Napsin A +; mutations : EGFR (Asian non-smoking women), ALK (EML4-ALK), ROS1, KRAS (smokers), BRAF, MET, RET; scar carcinoma; adenocarcinoma in situ (lepidic, < 3 cm, formerly BAC)
Squamous cell carcinoma	~25-30%; strongest smoking association (with SCLC); men	Central (hilar); keratin pearls, intercellular bridges; p40, p63, CK5/6 +; cavitation, PTHrP → hypercalcemia; SOX2, FGFR1 amplification, TP53, CDKN2A; arises from squamous metaplasia → dysplasia → CIS
Small cell carcinoma (SCLC)	~15%; almost exclusively smokers	Central; small round blue cells, scant cytoplasm, nuclear molding, salt-and-pepper chromatin, no nucleoli, crush artifact (Azzopardi effect), high mitotic rate; neuroendocrine (chromogranin, synaptophysin, CD56, INSM1); TP53 + RB1 loss (nearly 100%), L-MYC; most aggressive, early metastasis; ectopic ACTH, ADH, Lambert-Eaton; chemo-radiosensitive, not surgical

Type	Frequency	Key features
Large cell carcinoma	~10%	Undifferentiated, diagnosis of exclusion; large cells, prominent nucleoli; gynecomastia (hCG)
Carcinoid tumour	1-5%	Low-grade neuroendocrine; young (< 40 y), not smoking-related; central bronchus — polypoid "collar-button / mushroom" lesion; organoid / trabecular nests, salt-and-pepper chromatin; carcinoid syndrome rare; typical (< 2 mitoses/2 mm²) vs atypical

Risk factors :

1. Tobacco smoking — most important (85-90%) — dose (pack-years) related; benzo[a]pyrene, nitrosamines (NNK)
2. Radon — most common cause in non-smokers; uranium miners
3. Asbestos (synergistic with smoking)
4. Arsenic, chromium, nickel, vinyl chloride, bis-chloromethyl ether, mustard gas
5. Air pollution (PM2.5), indoor biomass fuel (India — women)
6. Genetic — CYP1A1 polymorphisms, CHRNA (nicotinic receptor)

Local effects & syndromes :

Syndrome	Mechanism
Pancoast (superior sulcus) tumour	Apical tumour → Horner syndrome (ptosis, miosis, anhidrosis — cervical sympathetic chain), C8-T1 brachial plexus (ulnar pain), rib destruction
Superior vena cava syndrome	SCLC (most common cause) — facial swelling, dilated neck veins
Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Hoarseness (left)
Phrenic nerve	Diaphragmatic paralysis
Pericardial / pleural	Effusion (malignant, hemorrhagic)

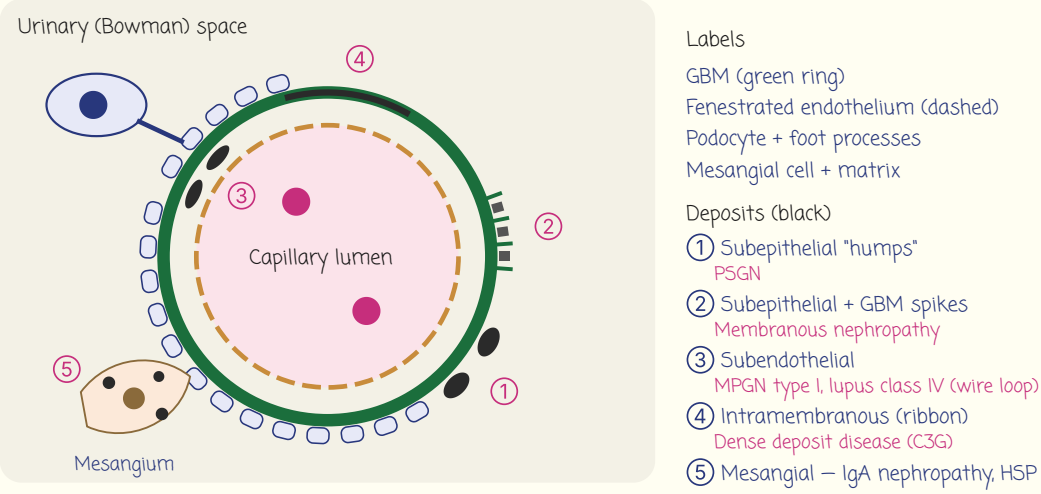
Filled : Rank boosters — lung tumours

- Most common lung tumour overall : metastasis (breast, colon, kidney — cannonball).
- Most common benign lung tumour : hamartoma — "popcorn" calcification, coin lesion, mature cartilage + fat + respiratory epithelium.
- Lung adenocarcinoma in never-smokers : EGFR exon 19 deletion / L858R → gefitinib, osimertinib.
- PD-L1 ≥ 50% → pembrolizumab first line.
- Mesothelioma : asbestos (latency 25-45 y; smoking NOT synergistic); encases lung like a rind; epithelioid (most common), sarcomatoid, biphasic; calretinin, WT1, D2-40, CK5/6 +; CEA, TTF-1 – (vs adenocarcinoma); long microvilli (EM); BAP1 loss, CDKN2A deletion.
- Solitary fibrous tumour of pleura — STAT6 + (NAB2-STAT6), hypoglycemia (IGF-2 — Doege-Potter).

KIDNEY & URINARY TRACT

Renal Structure & Function — Basics

- Glomerular filtration barrier : fenestrated endothelium → GBM (type IV collagen, laminin, heparan sulfate — negative charge) → podocyte foot processes with slit diaphragm (nephrin — NPHS1, podocin — NPHS2).
- Mesangial cells : contractile, phagocytic, secrete matrix; site of IgA deposits.
- Juxtaglomerular apparatus : JG cells (renin) + macula densa (DCT) + lacis cells.



Glomerular capillary loop — layers and sites of immune deposits (labelled)

Urine analysis — key findings :

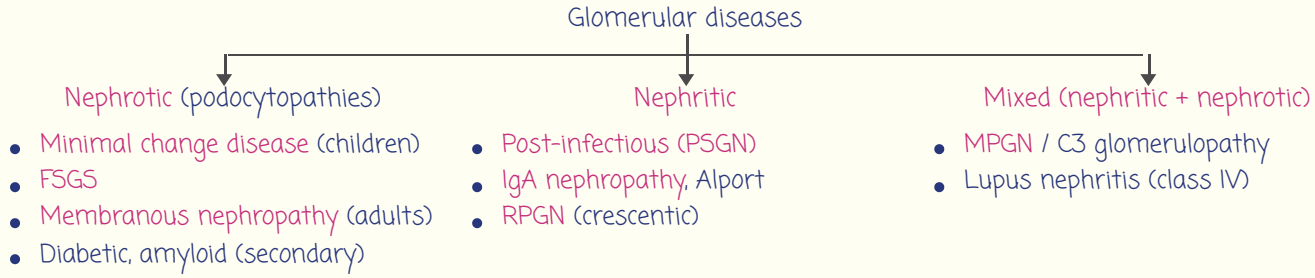
Finding	Significance
RBC casts	Glomerulonephritis (nephritic)
Dysmorphic RBCs (acanthocytes)	Glomerular hematuria
WBC casts	Pyelonephritis, interstitial nephritis
Fatty casts, oval fat bodies ("Maltese cross" under polarized light)	Nephrotic syndrome
Muddy brown granular casts	Acute tubular necrosis
Waxy (broad) casts	Advanced chronic renal failure
Hyaline casts	Normal / concentrated urine (Tamm-Horsfall protein — uromodulin)
Eosinophiluria	Acute interstitial nephritis (drug)
Bence Jones protein	Myeloma (not detected by dipstick)

Nephritic vs nephrotic :

Feature	Nephritic syndrome	Nephrotic syndrome
Mechanism	Inflammation (proliferation) → GBM rupture	Podocyte injury → ↑ permeability
Proteinuria	< 3.5 g/day (subnephrotic)	> 3.5 g/day (adult); > 40 mg/m²/h (child)
Hematuria	Present (RBC casts)	Usually absent
Edema	Mild (periorbital)	Massive, generalized (anasarca)
Hypertension	Present	Usually absent

Feature	Nephritic syndrome	Nephrotic syndrome
Others	Oliguria, azotemia	Hypoalbuminemia, hyperlipidemia, lipiduria, hypercoagulability (↓ ATIII → renal vein thrombosis), infections (↓ IgG)

Glomerulonephritis — Classification



- Minimal change disease (children)
- FSGS
- Membranous nephropathy (adults)
- Diabetic, amyloid (secondary)

- Post-infectious (PSGN)
- IgA nephropathy, Alport
- RPGN (crescentic)

- MPGN / C3 glomerulopathy
- Lupus nephritis (class IV)

Mechanisms of glomerular injury :

1. In situ immune complex — intrinsic antigen (anti-GBM — linear deposits; PLA2R in membranous) or planted antigen
2. Circulating immune complex deposition — granular (lumpy-bumpy) deposits (SLE, PSGN, IgA)
3. Cell-mediated (T cells) and complement alternative pathway (C3G, aHUS)
4. Podocyte injury — toxins, antibodies, genetic (nephrin, podocin, APOL1)
5. Nephron loss → secondary FSGS (hyperfiltration)

Nephrotic Syndrome — Primary Diseases

Disease	Key points	LM	IF	EM
Minimal change disease (lipoid nephrosis)	Most common cause in children (2-6 y); after URTI, immunization; Hodgkin lymphoma, NSAIDs; selective proteinuria (albumin); excellent steroid response	Normal glomeruli; lipid in PCT (lipoid nephrosis)	Negative	Diffuse effacement (fusion) of podocyte foot processes
FSGS	Most common cause of nephrotic syndrome in adults (USA, African-Americans); HIV (collapsing variant), heroin, APOL1, obesity, sickle cell, reflux; non-selective proteinuria, hematuria, HTN; poor steroid response; recurs in transplant	Segmental sclerosis & hyalinosis in some (focal) glomeruli — juxtamedullary first	IgM, C3 in sclerotic areas	Effacement of foot processes
Membranous nephropathy	Most common primary cause of nephrotic syndrome in adults (white / Asian); anti-PLA2R antibody (70-80%), THSD7A; secondary : SLE (class V), HBV, HCV, syphilis, malaria, drugs (penicillamine, gold, NSAIDs), solid tumours (lung, colon), ; renal vein thrombosis	Diffuse uniform thickening of GBM; "spikes" on silver (methenamine) stain	Granular IgG + C3 along GBM	Subepithelial deposits with GBM projections between ("spike and dome")
MPGN type I / immune complex	Mixed nephrotic-nephritic; HCV (cryoglobulins), HBV, SLE, chronic infections; ↓ C3	Hypercellular, lobulated glomeruli, GBM duplication — "tram-track" / double contour (silver, PAS)	IgG, C3 granular	Subendothelial deposits, mesangial interposition
C3 glomerulopathy (DDD — old MPGN II)	C3 nephritic factor (C3NeF) — stabilizes C3 convertase; ↓ C3; partial lipodystrophy, drusen	Membranoproliferative	C3 only (no Ig)	Dense ribbon-like intramembranous deposits (DDD)

Mnemonic : Nephrotic by age
"Minimal change for Minors · Membranous for Mature (white/Asian) adults · FSGS for Folks of African descent / HIV".

Nephritic Syndrome — Primary Diseases

Disease	Key points	LM	IF	EM
Post-streptococcal GN (PSGN) / acute proliferative	Children; 1-4 weeks after group A β-hemolytic streptococcal pharyngitis (or 3-6 weeks after skin — impetigo); nephritogenic strains (types 12, 4, 1); antigen : SpeB, NAPlr; ↑ ASO, anti-DNase B, ↓ C3 (normalizes in 6-8 weeks); 95% children recover	Enlarged, hypercellular glomeruli — proliferation + neutrophils	Granular "lumpy-bumpy" IgG, C3 (starry sky)	Subepithelial "humps"
IgA nephropathy (Berger disease)	Most common GN worldwide; recurrent gross hematuria 1-2 days after mucosal (URTI/GI) infection ("synpharyngitic"); galactose-deficient IgA1 + anti-glycan antibodies; ↑ in celiac, liver disease (cirrhosis — ↓ IgA clearance), HSP (systemic counterpart); normal C3	Mesangial proliferation	Mesangial IgA (± C3) — diagnostic	Mesangial deposits
Alport syndrome (hereditary nephritis)	Type IV collagen α5 (COL4A5 — X-linked, most common), α3/α4 (AR); hematuria + sensorineural deafness + ocular (anterior lenticonus) ; "Can't see, can't pee, can't hear high C"	Non-specific; foam cells	Negative (absent α5 staining)	GBM thinning, splitting & lamination — "basket-weave" appearance
Thin basement membrane disease	Benign familial hematuria; COL4A3/A4 heterozygous	Normal	Negative	Diffuse thinning of GBM

Rapidly progressive GN (RPGN — crescentic) :

- Clinical : rapid loss of renal function (days-weeks); histology : crescents in > 50% glomeruli.
- Crescents = proliferation of parietal epithelial cells + monocytes/macrophages + fibrin in Bowman space (fibrin is the stimulus).

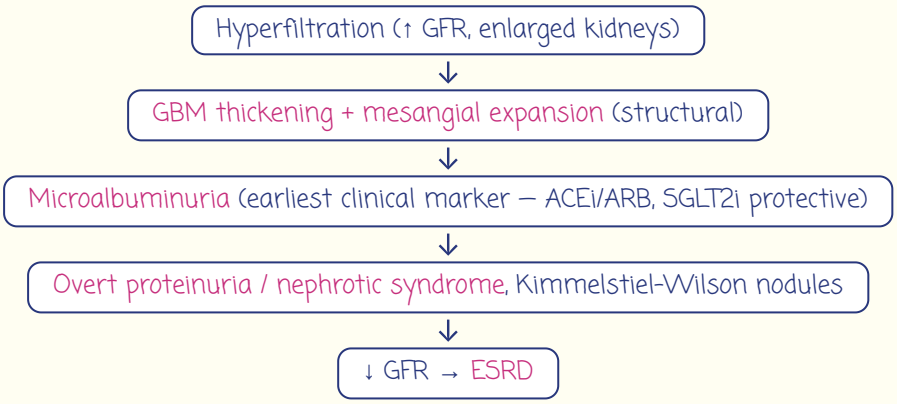
Type	Mechanism	IF	Examples
Type I — anti-GBM	Antibodies against α3 chain (NC1 domain) of type IV collagen	Linear IgG + C3	Goodpasture syndrome (+ pulmonary hemorrhage — HLA-DRB1*1501), renal-limited anti-GBM
Type II — immune complex	Any immune-complex GN	Granular	PSGN, lupus, IgA, HSP
Type III — pauci-immune	ANCA-associated (most common type in adults)	Little / no deposits	GPA (c-ANCA), MPA (p-ANCA), EGPA, idiopathic

Secondary (Systemic) Glomerular Disease

Disease	Key renal pathology
Lupus nephritis	Class IV diffuse proliferative (most common/severe) — wire-loop (subendothelial), full-house IF; class V membranous (nephrotic); hematoxylin bodies; see Immunopathology
Diabetic nephropathy	Most common cause of ESRD; earliest : GBM thickening (EM) & microalbuminuria (30-300 mg/day); diffuse mesangial sclerosis (most common); nodular glomerulosclerosis — Kimmelstiel-Wilson nodules (PAS +, specific); hyaline arteriolosclerosis of both afferent AND efferent arterioles; fibrin cap, capsular drop; Armanni-Ebstein lesion (glycogen in PCT); papillary necrosis, pyelonephritis; nonenzymatic glycation (AGEs)

Disease	Key renal pathology
Renal amyloidosis	Mesangial & subendothelial deposits, Congo red + apple-green birefringence; nephrotic; large pale kidneys (even in ESRD)
HSP (IgA vasculitis)	Mesangial IgA ; purpura, arthralgia, abdominal pain — children
PAN	Renal infarcts (medium arteries), no GN
Microscopic polyangiitis / GPA	Pauci-immune necrotizing crescentic GN
HIV-associated nephropathy	Collapsing FSGS, microcystic tubular dilation, tubuloreticular inclusions (EM — interferon)
Light chain cast nephropathy (myeloma kidney)	Fractured, waxy, "hard" casts surrounded by multinucleate giant cells in distal tubules; light chain proteinuria; also amyloid, LCDD, hypercalcemia
Sickle cell nephropathy	Papillary necrosis, hyposthenuria (inability to concentrate — earliest), FSGS
Preeclampsia	Glomerular endotheliosis (swollen endothelium, bloodless glomeruli)

Diabetic nephropathy — progression



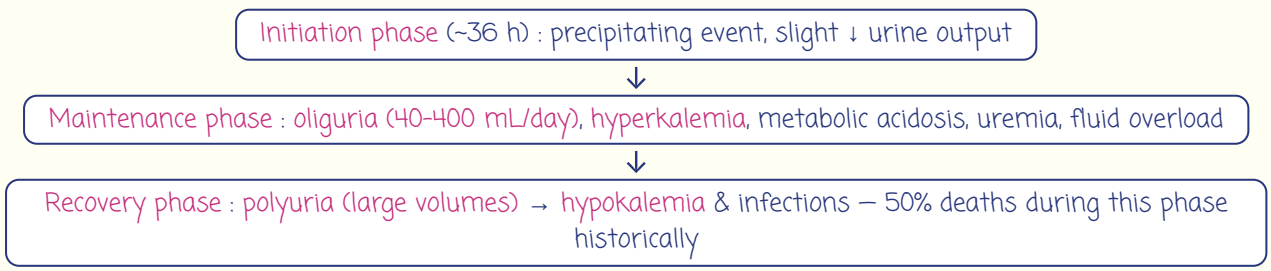
Tubular & Interstitial Diseases

Acute tubular injury / necrosis (ATN) :

- Most common cause of acute kidney injury (AKI).

Type	Causes	Morphology
Ischemic ATN	Hypotension, shock (sepsis, hemorrhage), burns, surgery	Patchy (skip) necrosis along nephron — straight portion of PCT (S3) and thick ascending limb; tubulorrhexis (basement membrane disruption); Tamm-Horsfall casts in distal tubules
Nephrotoxic ATN	Aminoglycosides, amphotericin B, radiocontrast, cisplatin, heavy metals (mercury), ethylene glycol (oxalate crystals — ballooning), myoglobin (rhabdomyolysis), hemoglobin, uric acid	Diffuse, extensive necrosis of PCT with basement membrane intact

Clinical course of ATN



- Muddy brown granular casts, FENa > 2% (vs prerenal < 1%).

Acute cortical necrosis :

- Bilateral, symmetric ischemic necrosis of the cortex (medulla & juxtamedullary spared) — obstetric emergencies (abruptio placentae — most common), septic shock, HUS, DIC; microvascular thrombosis + vasospasm → anuria; irreversible; "tram-track" cortical calcification on X-ray.

Pyelonephritis :

Feature	Acute pyelonephritis	Chronic pyelonephritis
Route	Ascending (most common — E. coli); hematogenous (S. aureus, TB)	Chronic obstructive or reflux nephropathy (VUR)
Morphology	Patchy interstitial suppurative inflammation, intratubular neutrophil aggregates, WBC casts; tubular necrosis; spares glomeruli	Coarse, irregular, asymmetric corticomedullary scars (U-shaped) over dilated, blunted, deformed calyces; polar scars (reflux — upper & lower poles)
Microscopy	Abscesses, neutrophils in tubules	Thyroidization of tubules (dilated tubules with eosinophilic hyaline casts, colloid-like), interstitial chronic inflammation, periglomerular fibrosis
Complications	Papillary necrosis (diabetics, obstruction, sickle cell, analgesics), pyonephrosis, perinephric abscess	Hypertension, CKD, FSGS

- Xanthogranulomatous pyelonephritis — Proteus, staghorn calculi, foamy macrophages (yellow nodules), mimics RCC.
- Emphysematous pyelonephritis — gas-forming, diabetics.

Mnemonic : Causes of renal papillary necrosis — "POSTCARDS"
Pyelonephritis · Obstruction · Sickle cell · TB · Cirrhosis · Analgesics (phenacetin, NSAIDs) · Renal vein thrombosis · Diabetes · Systemic vasculitis.

Acute (drug-induced) interstitial nephritis :

- Drugs : penicillins (methicillin), NSAIDs, PPIs, diuretics (thiazides), rifampicin, sulfonamides, allopurinol; type I / IV hypersensitivity, 2–40 days after exposure.
- Fever, rash, eosinophilia, eosinophiluria, sterile pyuria, hematuria; interstitial edema + eosinophils, lymphocytes, granulomas.
- Analgesic nephropathy — papillary necrosis + chronic interstitial nephritis; ↑ risk of urothelial carcinoma of renal pelvis.

Chronic Kidney Disease & ESRD

Causes (descending) :

1. Diabetic nephropathy (most common)
2. Hypertensive nephrosclerosis
3. Chronic glomerulonephritis
4. ADPKD, chronic pyelonephritis / reflux, obstructive uropathy
5. CKD of unknown etiology (Uddanam, Andhra Pradesh — agricultural workers)

- End-stage kidney : bilaterally contracted, granular (≤ 50 g); obsolescent glomeruli (hyalinized), interstitial fibrosis, thyroidization, acquired cystic disease (dialysis → RCC risk ↑).

Effects of uremia (systemic) :

System	Manifestation
Fluid & electrolytes	Metabolic acidosis, hyperkalemia, hyperphosphatemia, hypocalcemia

System	Manifestation
Bone	Renal osteodystrophy — osteitis fibrosa cystica (secondary HPT), osteomalacia (↓ 1,25-D), adynamic bone disease; metastatic calcification
Hematologic	Normocytic anemia (↓ EPO), bleeding (platelet dysfunction)
CVS	Fibrinous (uremic) pericarditis, HTN, CHF, accelerated atherosclerosis
GIT	Uremic gastroenteritis, fetor
Neuromuscular	Peripheral neuropathy, encephalopathy, asterixis
Skin	Uremic frost, pruritus, calciphylaxis
Lung	Uremic pneumonitis ("bat-wing" edema)

Renal Vascular Diseases

Disease	Key features
Benign nephrosclerosis	Benign HTN, aging, DM; hyaline arteriolosclerosis; symmetrically atrophic kidneys with finely granular "grain-leather" surface
Malignant nephrosclerosis	Malignant HTN; "flea-bitten" kidney (petechiae); fibrinoid necrosis of arterioles (necrotizing arteriolitis), onion-skin hyperplastic arteriolitis; papilledema, encephalopathy; ↑ renin
Renal artery stenosis	Atherosclerosis (70% — older men, ostium); fibromuscular dysplasia (young women — medial fibroplasia, "string of beads"); ischemic kidney small; contralateral kidney — hypertensive changes
Thrombotic microangiopathies	HUS (typical — E. coli O157:H7 Shiga toxin; children), atypical HUS (complement factor H/I, MCP), TTP (ADAMTS13 deficiency — large vWF multimers) ; fibrin/platelet thrombi in glomerular capillaries & arterioles, MAHA, thrombocytopenia
Renal infarcts	Emboli (mural thrombus — left heart); white, wedge-shaped
Sickle cell disease	Papillary necrosis, hematuria, hyposthenuria

Cystic Diseases of Kidney

Disease	Inheritance	Key features
ADPKD (adult)	AD — PKD1 (polycystin-1, chromosome 16p — 85%, severe), PKD2 (polycystin-2, 4q)	Bilateral, massively enlarged kidneys (up to 4 kg) with cysts throughout cortex & medulla; 4th-5th decade; flank pain, hematuria, HTN, UTI, stones; berry aneurysms (SAH — 10%), hepatic cysts (most common extrarenal), MVP, colonic diverticula; 10% of ESRD ; tolvaptan
ARPKD (childhood)	AR — PKHD1 (fibrocystin, 6p)	Bilateral symmetrically enlarged sponge-like kidneys; radially arranged cylindrical cysts (collecting ducts) at right angles to cortex ; Potter sequence (oligohydramnios); congenital hepatic fibrosis → portal HTN
Multicystic renal dysplasia	Sporadic, most common cystic disease in children	Unilateral, abnormal lobar organization, immature ducts + islands of undifferentiated mesenchyme / cartilage; associated with ureteropelvic obstruction
Medullary sponge kidney	Sporadic	Cystic dilatation of medullary collecting ducts; stones, hematuria; "paintbrush" urogram
Nephronophthisis	AR (NPHP)	Small kidneys, corticomedullary cysts; most common genetic cause of ESRD in children/adolescents; polyuria, salt wasting
Acquired cystic disease	Dialysis	↑ RCC (papillary)
Simple cysts	Common, benign	Smooth wall, cortex

Urolithiasis & Obstructive Uropathy

Stone	Frequency	Causes / features
Calcium oxalate / phosphate	~70-80% (most common)	Idiopathic hypercalciuria (most common cause), hypercalcemia, hyperoxaluria (enteric — Crohn, ileal resection), hypocitraturia, hyperuricosuria; radiopaque; envelope (dihydrate) / dumbbell (monohydrate) crystals
Struvite (magnesium ammonium phosphate)	~15%	Urease-producing bacteria (Proteus, Klebsiella) → alkaline urine; staghorn calculi; coffin-lid crystals
Uric acid	6-7%	Gout, leukemia/lymphoma (tumour lysis), acidic urine (pH < 5.5); radiolucent; rhomboid crystals
Cystine	1-2%	Cystinuria (AR — COLA reabsorption defect); hexagonal crystals; childhood; staghorn; sodium nitroprusside test

- Hydronephrosis : dilatation of renal pelvis & calyces with atrophy of parenchyma due to obstruction; causes — congenital PUJ obstruction, calculi, BPH (bilateral — most common in elderly men), tumours, pregnancy, retroperitoneal fibrosis, neurogenic bladder.

Renal Tumours

Renal cell carcinoma (RCC) :

- Most common primary malignant renal tumour in adults; 6th-7th decade, M > F; arises from tubular epithelium.
- Risk factors : tobacco (most important), obesity, HTN, unopposed estrogen, acquired cystic disease (dialysis), VHL, cadmium, asbestos.
- Classic triad (10%) : hematuria (most common symptom), flank pain, palpable mass.
- Paraneoplastic : polycythemia (EPO), hypercalcemia (PTHrP), HTN (renin), Cushing, feminization, amyloidosis, Stauffer syndrome (hepatic dysfunction without metastasis).
- Spread : renal vein invasion → IVC → right heart (tumour thrombus); hematogenous — lung (cannonball, most common), bone (lytic); left varicocele (left renal vein obstruction).

Type	Frequency	Genetics	Morphology
Clear cell RCC	65-70%	VHL loss (3p deletion) → ↑ HIF → VEGF; sporadic & VHL syndrome	Golden-yellow (lipid) solitary mass, hemorrhage, necrosis; clear cells (glycogen + lipid) in nests with delicate branching vasculature (chicken-wire); CA-IX, PAX8, vimentin +
Papillary RCC	10-15%	MET (type 1 — hereditary papillary RCC), trisomy 7, 17, loss of Y; type 2 — FH (HLRCC)	Multifocal, bilateral; papillae with foamy macrophages, psammoma bodies; dialysis-associated
Chromophobe RCC	5%	Hypodiploidy (multiple chromosome losses); Birt-Hogg-Dubé (folliculin)	Pale eosinophilic cells with prominent cell membranes, perinuclear halo ("raisinoid"); Hale colloidal iron +, CK7 diffuse, CD117 +; good prognosis
Collecting duct (Bellini)	< 1%	—	Medulla; aggressive
Renal medullary carcinoma	Rare	SMARCB1 (INI1) loss	Sickle cell trait, young

Mnemonic : RCC genetics — "3 words for 3 chromosomes"
Clear cell → 3p (VHL) — "clear has 3 letters + 2"; Papillary → 7 & 17 trisomy (MET); Chromophobe → loss of whole chromosomes (hypodiploid).

Benign renal tumours :

Tumour	Features
Oncocytoma	Mahogany-brown, central stellate scar; oncocytes (mitochondria-rich eosinophilic cells); benign; CD117 +, Hale's colloidal iron – negative/apical (vs chromophobe)
Angiomyolipoma	Blood vessels + smooth muscle + fat (PEComa, HMB-45 +); tuberous sclerosis (bilateral, multiple); spontaneous hemorrhage
Papillary adenoma	< 1.5 cm, cortex
Juxtaglomerular cell tumour (reninoma)	Young HTN + hypokalemia

Wilms tumour (Nephroblastoma) :

- Most common primary renal tumour of childhood (2-5 years); bilateral in 5-10%.
- Triphasic histology : blastemal (small blue cells), stromal (fibrocytic/myxoid, skeletal muscle), epithelial (abortive tubules & glomeruli); anaplasia (TP53) → poor prognosis.
- Nephrogenic rests – precursor lesions.
- Presents as large abdominal mass not crossing midline, hematuria, HTN.

Syndrome	Gene	Features
WAGR	WT1 deletion (11p13) (+ PAX6)	Wilms, Aniridia, Genitourinary anomalies, mental Retardation – 33% risk
Denys-Drash	WT1 dominant-negative point mutation	Gonadal dysgenesis (male pseudohermaphroditism), early nephropathy (diffuse mesangial sclerosis) – 90% risk
Beckwith-Wiedemann	WT2 (11p15.5) – IGF2 imprinting	Organomegaly, macroglossia, hemihypertrophy, omphalocele, hypoglycemia; also hepatoblastoma, adrenocortical tumours

Exam pearl

- Wilms vs neuroblastoma : Wilms – intrinsic renal, does not cross midline, rarely calcified, smooth; neuroblastoma – adrenal, crosses midline, calcified (85%), ↑ VMA/HVA, encases vessels, < 2 years.
- Mesoblastic nephroma – most common renal tumour in newborns / first 3 months (ETV6-NTRK3 in cellular type).

Urinary Bladder & Urothelial Tract

Cystitis :

Type	Key features
Acute bacterial	E. coli (most common); women; catheter
Hemorrhagic cystitis	Cyclophosphamide (acrolein – prevent with MESNA), adenovirus, radiation
Interstitial cystitis (Hunner ulcer)	Middle-aged women; chronic pelvic pain; mast cells; Hunner ulcers
Malakoplakia	Defective phagocytosis of E. coli, immunosuppressed; soft yellow plaques; von Hansemann histiocytes + Michaelis-Gutmann bodies (laminated, calcified, PAS +, von Kossa +)
Polypoid cystitis	Catheter irritation
Cystitis glandularis / cystica	Brunn nests → cysts / glandular metaplasia; intestinal metaplasia → adenocarcinoma (rare)
Schistosomal cystitis	S. haematobium – calcified eggs, squamous metaplasia → SCC
TB cystitis	Secondary to renal TB; sterile pyuria, contracted "thimble" bladder, golf-hole ureteric orifice

Bladder tumours :

- Urothelial (transitional cell) carcinoma – 90%; men > 50 y.

- Risk factors : cigarette smoking (most important), aromatic amines (β-naphthylamine — dye, rubber, leather industries), cyclophosphamide, phenacetin, arsenic, aristolochic acid (Balkan nephropathy, Chinese herbs — upper tract), Schistosoma (SCC), chronic irritation (catheter, stones).
- Two pathways :

Pathway	Genetics	Lesion
Papillary (low-grade, non-invasive) — 70%	FGFR3, HRAS, 9p/9q deletion	Papilloma, PUNLMP, low-grade papillary carcinoma — recur but rarely invade
Flat (carcinoma in situ) → invasive	TP53, RB	CIS (flat, high-grade), muscle-invasive carcinoma

- Presentation : painless hematuria (most common); field effect (multifocal, recurrence); intravesical BCG for CIS.
- Grading WHO : papilloma → PUNLMP → low-grade → high-grade papillary urothelial carcinoma.
- Other : SCC (Schistosoma, Egypt), adenocarcinoma (urachal remnant — dome; exstrophy), botryoid rhabdomyosarcoma (children — grape-like).

Urinary Tract Tuberculosis

- Hematogenous spread from lung (often latent primary); cortex → papillae (ulcerocavernous lesions) → caseation → calyces → descending to ureter, bladder, epididymis, seminal vesicles, prostate.
- Features : sterile pyuria (acid urine, WBCs, no growth on routine culture), hematuria, frequency (bladder contraction); putty (cement) kidney / autonephrectomy (calcified); ureteric strictures — "pipe-stem / beaded ureter"; "golf-hole" ureteric orifice; thimble bladder.
- Diagnosis : 3 early-morning urine samples for AFB culture, CBNAAT; IVU — moth-eaten calyx.

Filled : Rank boosters — kidney

- Fibrillary GN — DNAJB9 +; randomly arranged fibrils 12-24 nm (Congo red negative).
- Collapsing glomerulopathy — HIV, COVID-19 (APOL1), pamidronate.
- C1q nephropathy, IgM nephropathy — FSGS-like.
- Anti-PLA2R monitors therapy response in membranous nephropathy.
- Hypertension in children — most common cause : renal parenchymal disease (GN, reflux).
- Bartter (TAL — like loop diuretics), Gitelman (DCT — like thiazides; hypomagnesemia, hypocalciuria), Liddle (ENaC gain — HTN, hypokalemia, ↓ renin & aldosterone).
- Most common renal tumour in tuberous sclerosis : angiomyolipoma; VHL — clear cell RCC (bilateral, multifocal).

GASTROINTESTINAL TRACT & PANCREAS

Oral Cavity

Oral premalignant lesions :

Lesion	Features
Leukoplakia	White patch that cannot be scraped off and cannot be characterized clinically or pathologically as any other disease; tobacco (smoking, chewing — most common); 3-25% transform; histology — hyperkeratosis to dysplasia; floor of mouth, ventral tongue — highest risk
Erythroplakia	Red, velvety, flat/depressed; much higher malignant risk (> 50%) — severe dysplasia / CIS
Oral submucous fibrosis	Areca nut (betel quid) — arecoline; India; trismus (restricted mouth opening), juxtaepithelial fibrosis; premalignant
Speckled leukoplakia	Mixed red & white — high risk
Hairy leukoplakia	EBV, HIV/immunosuppression; lateral border of tongue, corrugated; not premalignant
Lichen planus (oral)	Reticular (Wickham striae); erosive type — slight risk

Oral squamous cell carcinoma :

- 95% of oral cancers; India — most common cancer in men (lip & oral cavity); gingivobuccal sulcus ("Indian oral cancer" — tobacco quid); West — lateral border of tongue.
- Risk factors : tobacco (smoked, chewed), alcohol (synergistic), areca nut, HPV 16 (oropharynx — tonsil, base of tongue; p16 + ; better prognosis), sharp teeth, Plummer-Vinson, syphilis, sunlight (lip — lower lip).
- Field cancerization — multiple primaries. Verrucous carcinoma — tobacco chewers, exophytic, well differentiated, pushing margins, rarely metastasizes.
- Metastasis : cervical lymph nodes (level I-III).

Odontogenic & other :

Lesion	Key point
Ameloblastoma	Mandible (molar-ramus), "soap-bubble"; peripheral palisading with reverse polarity, stellate reticulum; locally aggressive; BRAF V600E
Odontogenic keratocyst	PTCH (Gorlin syndrome); parakeratinized lining, palisaded basal layer; high recurrence
Dentigerous cyst	Crown of unerupted tooth (3rd molar)
Radicular (periapical) cyst	Most common odontogenic cyst; non-vital tooth

Salivary Gland Tumours

- Parotid (65-80%) — 15-30% malignant; submandibular 10% (40% malignant); sublingual & minor salivary glands — 70-90% malignant. "Smaller the gland, higher the chance of malignancy".

Tumour	Key features
Pleomorphic adenoma (mixed tumour)	Most common salivary tumour (60% of parotid); women 30-60 y; painless, slow, mobile; epithelial (ductal & myoepithelial) cells + mesenchymal-like myxoid, hyaline, chondroid (cartilage), osseous stroma; incompletely encapsulated — finger-like projections → recurrence after enucleation (superficial parotidectomy); PLAG1 (8q12), HMGA2 ; carcinoma ex pleomorphic adenoma (2-10%)

Tumour	Key features
Warthin tumour (papillary cystadenoma lymphomatosum)	2nd most common; almost exclusively parotid; men, smokers (8× risk); bilateral / multifocal (10%); double layer of oncocytic epithelium (eosinophilic, granular — mitochondria) over dense lymphoid stroma with germinal centres; hot spot on Tc-99m pertechnetate scan
Mucoepidermoid carcinoma	Most common malignant salivary tumour (parotid); most common salivary malignancy in children; mucous + epidermoid + intermediate cells; t(11;19) CRTC1-MAML2 (favourable); grade by mucin
Adenoid cystic carcinoma	Most common malignancy of minor salivary glands (palate) & submandibular; perineural invasion → pain, facial nerve palsy; cribriform "Swiss cheese" pattern with hyaline material (basement membrane); MYB-NFIB t(6;9); slow but relentless, late lung metastases
Acinic cell carcinoma	Parotid; serous acinar cells, bilateral (3%)
Oncocytoma, basal cell adenoma	Benign
Polymorphous adenocarcinoma	Palate; PRKD1
Mammary analogue secretory carcinoma	ETV6-NTRK3

Mnemonic : Salivary tumours
"Pleomorphic — Parotid, Painless, Pleomorphic stroma, Plag1" · "Warthin — Wise old men who smoke, with Lymphocytes" · "Adenoid Cystic — Chews nerves (perineural)".

Esophagus

Lesion	Key features
Achalasia	Loss of inhibitory ganglion cells (NO, VIP) in myenteric plexus; incomplete LES relaxation, ↑ LES tone, aperistalsis; "bird's beak" barium; secondary — Chagas disease; ↑ SCC risk
Plummer-Vinson syndrome	Esophageal webs + iron deficiency anemia + glossitis; women; ↑ postcricoid SCC
Schatzki ring	Lower esophageal mucosal ring (B ring) at squamocolumnar junction
Zenker diverticulum	False (pulsion) diverticulum — Killian triangle (above cricopharyngeus); halitosis, regurgitation
Mallory-Weiss tear	Longitudinal mucosal lacerations at GE junction — severe retching (alcoholics, bulimia); hematemesis
Boerhaave syndrome	Transmural rupture of distal esophagus — mediastinitis, subcutaneous emphysema
Esophageal varices	Portal HTN (cirrhosis) — left gastric vein; most common cause of death from GI bleeding in cirrhosis
Eosinophilic esophagitis	> 15 eosinophils/HPF, atopy, ringed "feline / trachealization" esophagus, food impaction; PPI-unresponsive (classically)
Infectious esophagitis	HSV — punched-out ulcers, multinucleate cells at margins; CMV — linear shallow ulcers, inclusions in endothelial/stromal cells (base); Candida — white pseudomembranes
Reflux esophagitis (GERD)	Eosinophils (earliest), basal zone hyperplasia (> 20%), elongation of lamina propria papillae (> 1/3), neutrophils

Barrett esophagus :

- Intestinal metaplasia — columnar epithelium with goblet cells replacing squamous epithelium of distal esophagus; complication of chronic GERD.
- Diagnosis : endoscopic salmon-pink velvety mucosa above GE junction + histologic goblet cells; long segment ≥ 3 cm.
- Premalignant for adenocarcinoma (30-40× risk); progression via dysplasia — TP53, CDKN2A.

Esophageal carcinoma :

Feature	Squamous cell carcinoma	Adenocarcinoma
Epidemiology	Most common worldwide & in India; > 45 y; "esophageal cancer belt" (Iran, China)	Most common in West (USA); white men
Site	Middle third (50%)	Distal third (lower)
Risk factors	Tobacco, alcohol, hot beverages, achalasia, Plummer-Vinson, tylosis (palmoplantar keratoderma — RHBDF2), caustic (lye) strictures, nitrosamines, HPV, poor diet (↓ vitamins)	Barrett esophagus (GERD), obesity, tobacco; ↓ H. pylori (protective?)
Genetics	TP53, CDKN2A, SOX2, cyclin D1	TP53, CDKN2A, ERBB2

- Symptoms : progressive dysphagia (solids → liquids), weight loss; spread to mediastinum early (no serosa).

Stomach

Gastritis :

Type	Features
Acute (erosive) gastritis	NSAIDs, alcohol, uremia, shock, stress ulcers : Curling ulcer (burns — hypovolemia), Cushing ulcer (intracranial lesions — vagal stimulation, ↑ acid)
Chronic H. pylori gastritis (type B)	Most common cause of chronic gastritis; antrum (antral-predominant) → hyperchlorhydria → duodenal ulcer; pangastritis → atrophy, intestinal metaplasia → adenocarcinoma, MALT lymphoma; neutrophils in pits + lymphoid follicles (germinal centres) ; curved rods in surface mucus (Giemsa, Warthin-Starry)
Autoimmune gastritis (type A)	Body & fundus (oxyntic mucosa), antrum spared; anti-parietal cell (H^+/K^+ ATPase) & anti-intrinsic factor antibodies ; achlorhydria, hypergastrinemia (G-cell hyperplasia), pernicious anemia (B12); neuroendocrine (ECL) hyperplasia → carcinoid tumours; ↑ adenocarcinoma
Chemical (reactive) gastropathy	Bile reflux, NSAIDs — foveolar hyperplasia, little inflammation
Ménétrier disease	↑ TGF-α (EGFR) → giant cerebriform rugal folds (foveolar hyperplasia), protein-losing enteropathy (hypoalbuminemia), ↓ acid
Zollinger-Ellison	Gastrinoma → parietal cell hyperplasia, multiple ulcers (jejunum), diarrhea

> Mnemonic : H. pylori virulence
>
> "CagA (cytotoxin-associated gene A — injected via type IV secretion, ↑ cancer) · VacA (vacuolating) · urease (NH_3 — basis of urea breath test, rapid urease (CLO) test) · flagella · adhesins (BabA)".

Peptic ulcer disease :

Feature	Duodenal ulcer	Gastric ulcer
Frequency	4× more common	Less
Site	First part of duodenum (anterior wall — perforation; posterior — bleeding from gastroduodenal artery)	Lesser curvature (antrum-body junction)
H. pylori	~70-90%	~60-70%
Acid	↑ acid	Normal / ↓ (mucosal defence ↓)
Pain	Relieved by food (night pain)	Worsened by food
Malignancy	Never malignant	Must biopsy to exclude cancer

- Other causes : NSAIDs (most common in H. pylori-negative), Zollinger-Ellison, smoking, steroids, cirrhosis, COPD, CKD, hyperparathyroidism, blood group O (DU).
- Morphology : round-oval, sharply punched-out, clean base, straight walls, overhanging margins NOT heaped up (vs carcinoma : heaped, irregular); 4 zones : necrotic fibrinoid debris → nonspecific inflammatory infiltrate → granulation tissue → fibrous scar (with endarteritis obliterans).

- Complications : bleeding (most common), perforation (most common cause of death — air under diaphragm), obstruction (gastric outlet), penetration (pancreas — ↑ amylase).

Gastric tumours :

Tumour	Key features
Hyperplastic polyp	Most common gastric polyp; chronic gastritis background
Fundic gland polyp	PPI use, FAP
Gastric adenoma	Intestinal-type dysplasia; risk ↑ with size
GIST	Most common mesenchymal tumour of GIT (stomach 60%); from interstitial cells of Cajal; c-KIT (CD117) & DOG-1 +, KIT (75-80%) or PDGFRA mutations; spindle / epithelioid cells; imatinib; Carney triad (GIST + paraganglioma + pulmonary chondroma — young women, SDH deficient), NF1
Leiomyoma	Desmin, SMA +; KIT negative; esophagus > stomach
Gastric lymphoma	Stomach = most common extranodal site of lymphoma; MALT lymphoma (H. pylori — regresses with eradication if no t(11;18)); t(11;18) API2-MALT1 → resistant to eradication; DLBCL
Gastric carcinoid (NET)	Autoimmune gastritis (type 1 — multiple, benign), ZES/MEN1 (type 2), sporadic (type 3 — aggressive)

Gastric adenocarcinoma :

- 90-95% of gastric cancers; Japan, Korea, Chile high; declining with refrigeration.
- Risk factors : H. pylori (most important), nitrates / nitrosamines (smoked, pickled, salted foods), chronic atrophic gastritis, intestinal metaplasia, partial gastrectomy (Billroth II), EBV (10%), blood group A, Ménétrier, adenomatous polyps, smoking, familial (CDH1 — diffuse), Lynch, FAP, Peutz-Jeghers.

Feature	Intestinal type	Diffuse type
Precursors	Intestinal metaplasia, H. pylori, dysplasia	No precursor lesion
Genetics	APC, β-catenin, MSI	CDH1 (E-cadherin) loss, RHOA
Morphology	Bulky, exophytic, glandular (mucin-secreting), ulcerated	Signet ring cells (mucin pushes nucleus) — discohesive, infiltrative; linitis plastica ("leather bottle" stomach — thick rigid wall)
Epidemiology	> 50 y, men, high-incidence areas	Younger, equal sex, uniform worldwide

- Spread / eponyms : Virchow node (left supraclavicular), Sister Mary Joseph nodule (umbilicus), Krukenberg tumour (bilateral ovarian — signet ring), Irish node (left axillary), Blumer shelf (rectovesical / rectouterine pouch).
- Paraneoplastic : acanthosis nigricans, Leser-Trélat sign, Trousseau.
- Early gastric cancer : confined to mucosa & submucosa, regardless of nodal status — excellent prognosis.

Small Intestine

Malabsorption :

Disease	Key features
Celiac disease (gluten-sensitive enteropathy)	HLA-DQ2 (95%) / DQ8; gliadin (deamidated by tTG) → CD4 T cells + IEL (CD8) via IL-15; anti-tTG IgA (best screening), anti-endomysial (most specific), anti-DGP (IgA-deficient, children < 2 y); distal duodenum & proximal jejunum; Marsh : ↑ intraepithelial lymphocytes (> 25/100 enterocytes) → crypt hyperplasia → villous atrophy (flat mucosa); dermatitis herpetiformis (IgA in dermal papillae); iron deficiency (most common extra-intestinal); ↑ enteropathy-associated T-cell lymphoma (EATL) & adenocarcinoma
Tropical sprue	Tropics (India); after infection; distal small bowel — B12 & folate deficiency; responds to antibiotics (tetracycline) + folate ; all levels involved

Disease	Key features
Whipple disease	Tropheryma whipplei; PAS + foamy macrophages in lamina propria (distended villi); lymphatic dilatation, arthralgia, CNS, cardiac; middle-aged white men
Abetalipoproteinemia	MTTP (apo B48/100 assembly) — AR; lipid-vacuolated enterocytes, acanthocytes, vitamin E deficiency (neuropathy, retinitis pigmentosa)
Lactase deficiency	Brush border; osmotic diarrhea; normal histology
Autoimmune enteropathy	Anti-enterocyte, anti-goblet cell antibodies; IPEX (FOXP3)
Giardiasis	Pear-shaped trophozoites (falling leaf motility, "owl face") on duodenal surface; IgA deficiency

Intestinal TB vs Crohn :

Feature	Intestinal TB	Crohn disease
Site	Ileocecal (most common)	Terminal ileum (most common), skip lesions
Ulcers	Transverse (girdle) — along lymphatics	Longitudinal (linear, serpiginous) — "cobblestone"
Granulomas	Large, confluent, caseating, submucosal, AFB +	Small, discrete, non-caseating, sparse
Strictures	Short, "hourglass"	Long ("string sign of Kantor")
Fistulae	Rare	Common (enterocutaneous, enterovesical, perianal)

Typhoid (small bowel) :

- Oval ulcers parallel to long axis over Peyer patches (ileum); perforation in 3rd week; mononuclear (macrophages) infiltrate — no neutrophils.

Inflammatory Bowel Disease

Feature	Crohn disease	Ulcerative colitis
Location	Mouth to anus — terminal ileum (± colon)	Colon only — rectum always involved, continuous proximal extension; backwash ileitis
Distribution	Skip lesions	Continuous
Inflammation	Transmural	Mucosa & submucosa only
Gross	Cobblestone mucosa, creeping fat, thick wall ("string sign"), strictures, fistulae, linear ulcers	Pseudopolyps, broad ulcers, loss of haustra — "lead pipe" colon, friable mucosa
Microscopy	Non-caseating granulomas (35%), lymphoid aggregates, fissures	Crypt abscesses (neutrophils), crypt distortion & branching, Paneth cell metaplasia (left colon), no granulomas
Genetics / immunity	NOD2 (CARD15), ATG16L1, IRGM; Th1, Th17	Th2 (IL-13); HLA-DRB1
Smoking	Worsens	Protective
Extra-intestinal	Migratory polyarthritis, erythema nodosum, uveitis, oxalate kidney stones, gallstones, B12 & bile salt malabsorption	Primary sclerosing cholangitis (p-ANCA), pyoderma gangrenosum, ankylosing spondylitis
Complications	Fistula, stricture, perianal abscess, malabsorption, carcinoma (less)	Toxic megacolon, colorectal carcinoma (↑ with duration & extent — flat dysplasia), hemorrhage
ANCA / ASCA	ASCA + (anti-Saccharomyces)	p-ANCA +

Other Colonic Disorders

Disease	Key features
Pseudomembranous colitis	Clostridioides difficile (toxins A & B) — after antibiotics (clindamycin, cephalosporins, fluoroquinolones); "volcano / mushroom" eruptions of fibrin + neutrophils + mucus from damaged crypts → yellow-white pseudomembranes; stool toxin (PCR) assay ; vancomycin / fidaxomicin
Ischemic colitis	Watershed areas : splenic flexure (Griffith point), rectosigmoid (Sudeck point); elderly; atrophic "withered" crypts, hyalinized lamina propria; pain out of proportion
Amoebic colitis	Flask-shaped ulcers (cecum, ascending colon), trophozoites with ingested RBCs; liver abscess
Bacillary dysentery (Shigella)	Rectosigmoid, superficial ulcers, pseudomembranes, HUS (S. dysenteriae type 1)
Necrotizing enterocolitis	Premature neonates (most common GI emergency), after enteral feeding; terminal ileum, ascending colon; pneumatosis intestinalis
Hirschsprung disease	Absence of ganglion cells (Meissner & Auerbach) — failed neural crest migration; RET (most common), EDNRB; rectum always involved, Down syndrome (10%); failure to pass meconium in 48 h; dilated proximal (normal) colon, narrow aganglionic segment; ↑ acetylcholinesterase-positive nerve fibres, calretinin negative on suction biopsy
Diverticular disease	Sigmoid colon (West), false diverticula (pulsion) at points where vasa recta penetrate muscularis; low-fibre diet, ↑ intraluminal pressure; bleeding (painless, right colon), diverticulitis (LLQ pain), fistula
Angiodysplasia	Cecum, right colon; > 60 y; aortic stenosis (Heyde syndrome — acquired vWD)
Microscopic colitis	Collagenous (thick subepithelial collagen band > 10 µm) & lymphocytic (↑ IEL); middle-aged women, watery diarrhea, normal colonoscopy
Hemorrhoids	Dilated anal & perianal venous plexus (portal HTN — internal)

Appendicitis :

- Obstruction (fecalith — most common, lymphoid hyperplasia in children, worms, tumour) → ↑ pressure → ischemia → bacterial invasion.
- Histology : neutrophilic infiltration of muscularis propria (diagnostic), mucosal ulceration, serositis; gangrenous → perforation.
- Appendiceal tumours : carcinoid (most common tumour of appendix, tip), low-grade appendiceal mucinous neoplasm → pseudomyxoma peritonei.

Intestinal Polyps & Colorectal Carcinoma

Polyps :

Polyp	Features	Malignant potential
Hyperplastic polyp	Most common polyp; rectosigmoid, small; "saw-tooth / serrated" crypt surface (upper half)	None (small, left-sided)
Sessile serrated lesion	Right colon, serration extending to crypt base (boot / L-shaped, dilated)	Yes — BRAF V600E, CIMP-high, MLH1 methylation (MSI)
Inflammatory (pseudo)polyp	IBD; solitary rectal ulcer syndrome — fibromuscular obliteration of lamina propria	No
Juvenile polyp	Children < 5 y; rectum; cystically dilated glands with inflammation, "Swiss cheese"; hamartomatous; sporadic single — no risk; juvenile polyposis syndrome (SMAD4, BMPR1A) — ↑ risk	
Peutz-Jeghers polyp	STK11 (LKB1) — AD; arborizing (tree-like) smooth muscle core with normal epithelium; small intestine (jejunum) — intussusception; mucocutaneous melanotic macules (lips); ↑ cancers (colon, pancreas, breast, lung, ovary — SCTAT, testis — Sertoli)	

Polyp	Features	Malignant potential
Adenoma (neoplastic)	Tubular (most common, < 25% villous), tubulovillous, villous (> 50% villous — highest risk; hypokalemia, mucus); dysplasia mandatory	Risk ↑ with size (> 4 cm — 40%), villous component, high-grade dysplasia

Familial syndromes :

Syndrome	Gene	Key features
FAP	APC (5q21) — AD	Hundreds-thousands of adenomas (> 100) by teens; 100% colorectal carcinoma by 40-50 y → prophylactic colectomy; CHRPE (congenital hypertrophy of retinal pigment epithelium), duodenal (ampullary) carcinoma, fundic gland polyps
Gardner syndrome	APC	FAP + osteomas (mandible, skull), epidermoid cysts, desmoid tumours, dental abnormalities, thyroid Ca
Turcot syndrome	APC → medulloblastoma; MMR → glioblastoma	Polyposis + CNS tumours
Attenuated FAP	APC (5′/3′ ends)	< 100 polyps, later onset
MUTYH-associated polyposis	MUTYH — AR (base excision repair)	Multiple adenomas; G:C → T:A
Lynch syndrome (HNPCC)	MMR genes (MSH2, MLH1 > MSH6, PMS2) — AD	Right-sided (proximal) colon cancer at young age, few polyps; endometrial (most common extracolonic), ovary, stomach, urothelium (upper tract), small bowel, sebaceous tumours (Muir-Torre); MSI-high, ↑ tumour-infiltrating lymphocytes, mucinous; Amsterdam II / Bethesda criteria

Colorectal carcinoma — pathways :

Adenoma-carcinoma sequence (chromosomal instability, ~80%)

Normal mucosa → loss of APC (first hit — "gatekeeper") → β-catenin accumulation (WNT)

↓

Small adenoma → KRAS mutation → large adenoma

↓

SMAD2/4 loss (18q — DCC) → dysplasia

↓

TP53 loss (17p) → carcinoma ; telomerase, other mutations → metastasis

Pathway	Genetics	Features
Chromosomal instability (APC/β-catenin)	APC, KRAS, SMAD4, TP53	Left-sided, tubular adenoma → carcinoma
Microsatellite instability (MMR)	MLH1 hypermethylation (sporadic) or germline MMR (Lynch), BRAF V600E (sporadic)	Right-sided, mucinous, signet ring, TILs, Crohn-like reaction; better prognosis, sessile serrated lesions; respond to immunotherapy (PD-1)
CIMP	Promoter hypermethylation	Serrated pathway

- Risk factors : age > 50, low-fibre, high red meat / fat diet, obesity, IBD (UC > Crohn), family history, polyposis syndromes, Streptococcus gallolyticus bacteremia, smoking, alcohol; aspirin/NSAIDs protective (COX-2).

Feature	Right-sided (proximal)	Left-sided (distal)
Gross	Exophytic, polypoid, fungating	Annular, "napkin-ring / apple-core" constriction

Feature	Right-sided (proximal)	Left-sided (distal)
Presentation	Iron deficiency anemia (occult bleeding), fatigue, weakness	Change in bowel habits, obstruction, hematochezia, thin "pencil" stools

- Spread : liver (most common distant site — portal vein), lung, peritoneum; CEA for recurrence monitoring.
- Staging : TNM (AJCC); Astler-Coller / Dukes : A (mucosa/submucosa), B (beyond muscularis), C (nodes), D (distant) — most important prognostic factor : stage (nodal status).

Carcinoid (neuroendocrine) tumours :

- Most common site : small intestine (ileum) > appendix (tip) > rectum; small intestine — most aggressive / metastasize; appendix — usually benign.
- Nests, cords, rosettes; uniform cells, "salt-and-pepper" chromatin; chromogranin, synaptophysin; desmoplastic mesenteric reaction (kinking).
- Carcinoid syndrome (10%) — only with liver metastases (or primary outside portal drainage — bronchus, ovary); serotonin, histamine, bradykinin : flushing, diarrhea, bronchospasm, right-sided valvular fibrosis (tricuspid regurgitation, pulmonary stenosis), pellagra (tryptophan diversion); ↑ urinary 5-HIAA; octreotide.

Small intestinal lymphoma :

- Western (MALT/DLBCL), Mediterranean / IPSID (immunoproliferative small intestinal disease — α heavy chain disease, Campylobacter jejuni), EATL (celiac), Burkitt (ileocecal — children).

Pancreas

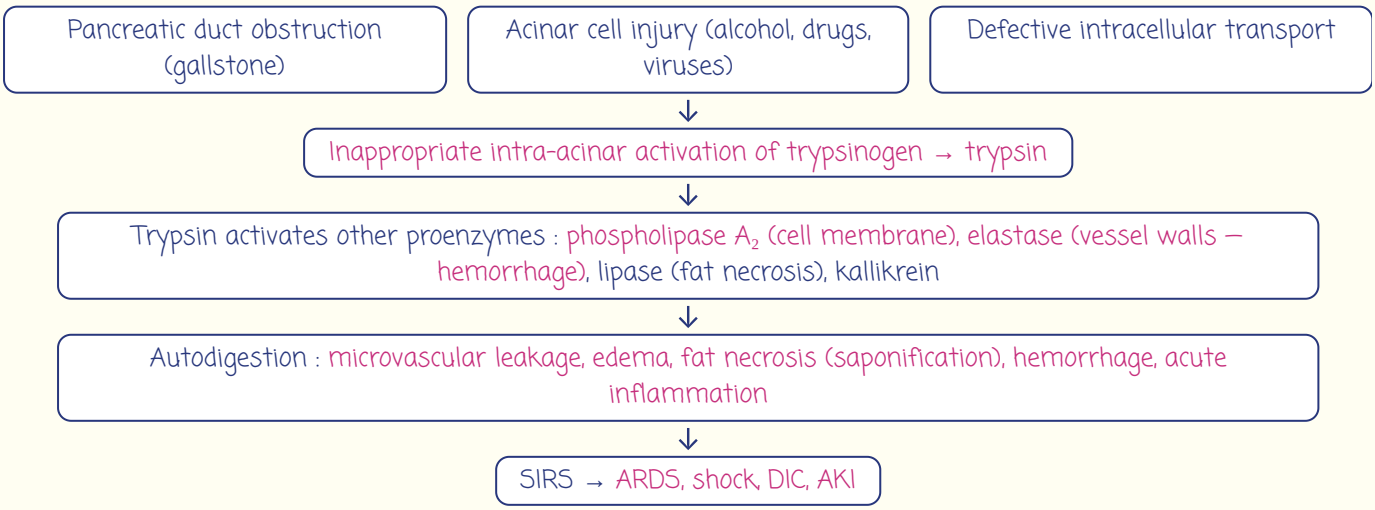
Acute pancreatitis :

Causes :

1. Gallstones (most common — 35-60%)
2. Alcohol (2nd most common; most common in Indian men)
3. Hypertriglyceridemia (> 1000 mg/dL), hypercalcemia
4. Drugs — azathioprine, valproate, didanosine, thiazides, estrogens, steroids, L-asparaginase
5. Post-ERCP, trauma, surgery
6. Infections — mumps, coxsackie, CMV
7. Hereditary — PRSS1 (cationic trypsinogen gain-of-function), SPINK1 (trypsin inhibitor loss), CFTR
8. Scorpion venom (Trinidad), ischemia, pancreas divisum, autoimmune

Mnemonic : Causes of acute pancreatitis — "I GET SMASHED"
Idiopathic · Gallstones · Ethanol · Trauma · Steroids · Mumps · Autoimmune · Scorpion sting · Hypercalcemia / Hypertriglyceridemia · ERCP · Drugs.

Pathogenesis



- Morphology : acute interstitial (edematous) pancreatitis vs acute necrotizing (hemorrhagic) pancreatitis; fat necrosis — chalky white areas (Ca soaps), ghost outlines of adipocytes.
- Lab : serum lipase (more specific, stays longer), amylase (rises in 2-12 h, normal in 3-5 days), hypocalcemia (poor prognosis — fat saponification), hyperglycemia, ↑ CRP.
- Signs : Grey-Turner (flank), Cullen (periumbilical) ecchymoses; Ranson criteria, BISAP, APACHE II.
- Complications : pseudocyst (most common; no epithelial lining — granulation/fibrous wall; > 4 weeks), abscess, infected necrosis, splenic vein thrombosis, ARDS, DIC.

Chronic pancreatitis :

- Alcohol (most common in adults), tropical calcific pancreatitis (India — Kerala; SPINK1, young, malnourished — "fibrocalculous pancreatic diabetes"), hereditary, CF, autoimmune (IgG4 — type 1; lymphoplasmacytic sclerosing, storiform fibrosis, obliterative phlebitis; "sausage-shaped" pancreas; steroid-responsive).
- Parenchymal fibrosis, ↓ acini, dilated ducts with protein plugs / calcified stones (intraductal calculi); islets relatively spared until late.
- Clinical : recurrent pain, steatorrhea (exocrine failure), diabetes (endocrine failure), calcification on X-ray, pseudocyst.

Pancreatic carcinoma (ductal adenocarcinoma) :

- 85%; 60-80 y; 4th leading cause of cancer death (West); 5-year survival < 10%.
- Risk factors : smoking (most important), chronic pancreatitis, diabetes, obesity, hereditary (BRCA2, CDKN2A (familial melanoma), PALB2, Lynch, Peutz-Jeghers).
- Precursors : PanIN (pancreatic intraepithelial neoplasia), IPMN (intraductal papillary mucinous neoplasm — GNAS, KRAS), mucinous cystic neoplasm (ovarian-type stroma — women).
- Genetics : KRAS (> 90% — earliest), CDKN2A (p16 — 95%), SMAD4 (55%), TP53 (70-75%).
- Site : head (60%) → painless obstructive jaundice, Courvoisier sign (palpable non-tender gallbladder); body/tail (15%) → late, pain, metastases.
- Morphology : hard, grey-white, poorly defined (desmoplastic); perineural & lymphovascular invasion.
- Features : Trousseau sign (migratory thrombophlebitis), weight loss, epigastric pain radiating to back; CA 19-9.

Periampullary & pancreatic endocrine tumours :

Tumour	Key features
Periampullary carcinoma	Ampulla, distal CBD, duodenum, pancreatic head — earlier jaundice → better prognosis; "silver stool" (jaundice + bleeding) ; FAP
Insulinoma	Most common pancreatic NET; Whipple triad (hypoglycemia symptoms, glucose < 50 mg/dL, relief with glucose); ↑ insulin & C-peptide; mostly benign; amyloid in stroma
Gastrinoma	Zollinger-Ellison; gastrinoma triangle (duodenum — most common site); MEN1 (25%); mostly malignant; secretin stimulation test ↑ gastrin
Glucagonoma	Necrolytic migratory erythema, DM, anemia, DVT, weight loss
VIPoma (Verner-Morrison)	WDHA — watery diarrhea, hypokalemia, achlorhydria
Somatostatinoma	Diabetes, gallstones, steatorrhea, hypochlorhydria
Solid pseudopapillary neoplasm	Young women (20s); CTNNB1 (β-catenin); solid + pseudopapillary + hemorrhagic cystic; low-grade
Serous cystadenoma	Elderly women; VHL; glycogen-rich clear cuboidal cells, central stellate scar ("sunburst calcification"); benign
Pancreatoblastoma	Most common pancreatic tumour in children; squamoid nests

Filled : Rank boosters — GIT

- Most common site of GI tract carcinoid in older studies : appendix; current data : small intestine (ileum).
- Most common site of GIST : stomach; GI lymphoma : stomach; colorectal carcinoma : rectosigmoid.
- Cowden syndrome (PTEN) — hamartomatous polyps + breast, thyroid (follicular), endometrial cancers, trichilemmomas.
- Cronkhite-Canada — non-hereditary polyposis + alopecia, nail atrophy, hyperpigmentation.
- Meckel diverticulum — true diverticulum (all layers), vitelline duct; rule of 2s; ectopic gastric mucosa → painless bleeding (Tc-99m pertechnetate scan).
- Celiac IEL count > 25/100 enterocytes; refractory celiac → EATL.
- Most common cause of small bowel obstruction : adhesions (adults); intussusception (infants).

HEMATOPOIESIS & RED CELL DISORDERS

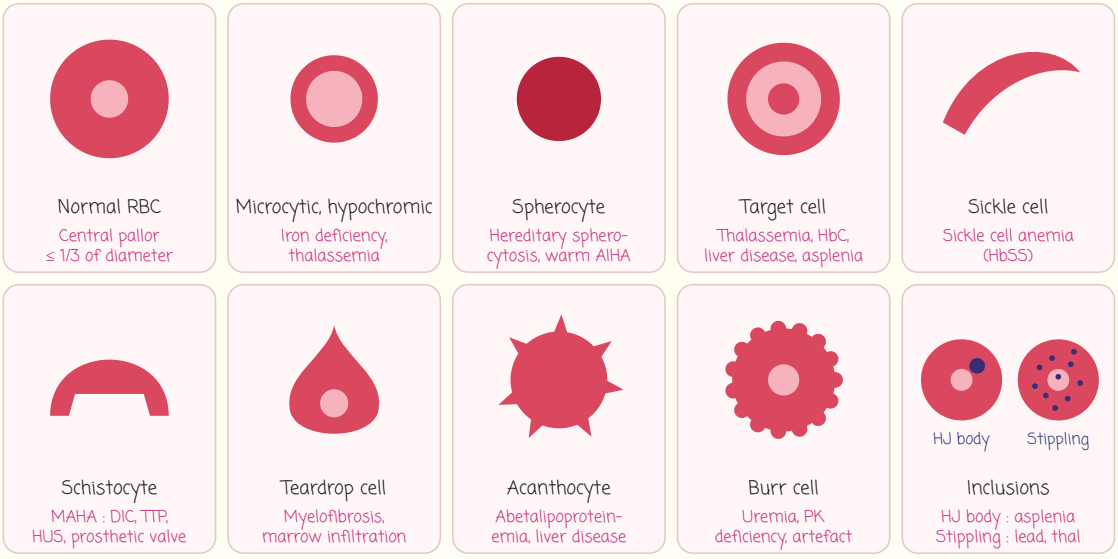
Hematopoiesis

Period	Site
3rd week - 2 months	Yolk sac (mesoblastic)
6 weeks - birth (peak 3rd-6th month)	Liver (main fetal site), spleen
From 5th month onward	Bone marrow (sole site after birth)
Adult	Axial skeleton — vertebrae, ribs, sternum, skull, pelvis, proximal femur/humerus

- Hematopoietic stem cells : CD34 +; regulation by EPO (kidney — peritubular interstitial cells, hypoxia → HIF), TPO (liver — platelets), G-CSF, GM-CSF, IL-3, IL-5 (eosinophils), IL-7 (lymphoid), SCF (KIT ligand).
- Extramedullary hematopoiesis : thalassemia, myelofibrosis, marrow infiltration — liver, spleen, paravertebral masses.
- Bone marrow : M:E ratio 2:1 - 4:1; biopsy — cellularity (100 - age)%; aspirate — morphology; dry tap — myelofibrosis, hairy cell leukemia, metastases, aplastic anemia.

Normal adult values :

Parameter	Value
Hemoglobin	Men 13.5-17.5 g/dL; women 12-15.5 g/dL
MCV	80-100 fL
MCH / MCHC	27-32 pg / 32-36 g/dL (↑ only in spherocytosis)
RDW	11.5-14.5% (↑ in iron deficiency; normal in thalassemia trait)
Reticulocytes	0.5-1.5% (corrected reticulocyte count / RPI > 2 = adequate marrow response)
RBC lifespan	120 days



Red cell morphology on peripheral smear (labelled with associations)

Anemia — Classification & Approach

Anemia (by MCV)

Microcytic (< 80 fL)
- Iron deficiency
- Thalassemia
- Anemia of chronic disease (late)
- Sideroblastic (lead, B6)

Normocytic (80–100 fL)
- ↑ Retic : hemolysis, acute bleed
- ↓ Retic : aplastic, ACD, CKD, marrow infiltration

Macrocytic (> 100 fL)
- Megaloblastic : B12, folate, drugs
- Non-megaloblastic : liver disease, alcohol, hypothyroidism, MDS, reticulocytosis

Differentiating microcytic anemias :

Test	Iron deficiency	Anemia of chronic disease	β-thalassemia trait	Sideroblastic
Serum iron	↓	↓	Normal	↑
TIBC (transferrin)	↑	↓	Normal	Normal / ↓
Transferrin saturation	↓ (< 16%)	↓ / N	Normal	↑
Serum ferritin	↓ (< 15 ng/mL — first to fall, most specific)	↑ / Normal (acute phase)	Normal	↑
Marrow iron	Absent	↑ in macrophages, ↓ in erythroblasts	Normal	Ringed sideroblasts
RDW	↑	Normal	Normal	↑ (dimorphic)
Mentzer index (MCV/RBC count)	> 13	—	< 13	—
HbA2	Normal / ↓	Normal	↑ (> 3.5%)	Normal

- Soluble transferrin receptor (sTfR) — ↑ in iron deficiency, normal in ACD.
- Free erythrocyte protoporphyrin / ZPP ↑ in iron deficiency and lead poisoning.

Iron Deficiency Anemia

- Most common anemia worldwide & in India (NFHS : > 50% women).
- Iron absorption : duodenum (DMT1 for Fe^{2+}, ferroportin exit); regulated by hepcidin (↓ ferroportin).

Causes :

1. Chronic blood loss — most common cause in adults :
   - GI : hookworm (most common in tropics — Ancylostoma), peptic ulcer, colon carcinoma (elderly men — must exclude), hemorrhoids, NSAIDs
   - Genitourinary : menorrhagia (women)
2. Increased demand — pregnancy, infancy, adolescence
3. Dietary deficiency — vegetarian diet (non-heme), infants on cow's milk
4. Impaired absorption — celiac disease, gastrectomy, achlorhydria, H. pylori, PPIs

Stages & features :

Storage iron depletion (↓ ferritin) → Iron-deficient erythropoiesis (↓ serum iron, ↑ TIBC) → Microcytic hypochromic anemia

- Smear : microcytic hypochromic RBCs, anisocytosis (↑ RDW), pencil cells (elliptocytes), target cells (few); thrombocytosis.
- Clinical : koilonychia (spoon nails), pica (pagophagia — ice), angular stomatitis, glossitis, Plummer-Vinson, restless legs.
- Response to oral iron : reticulocytosis in 5–10 days (peak), Hb rises 1 g/dL per week.

Anemia of Chronic Disease (Inflammation)

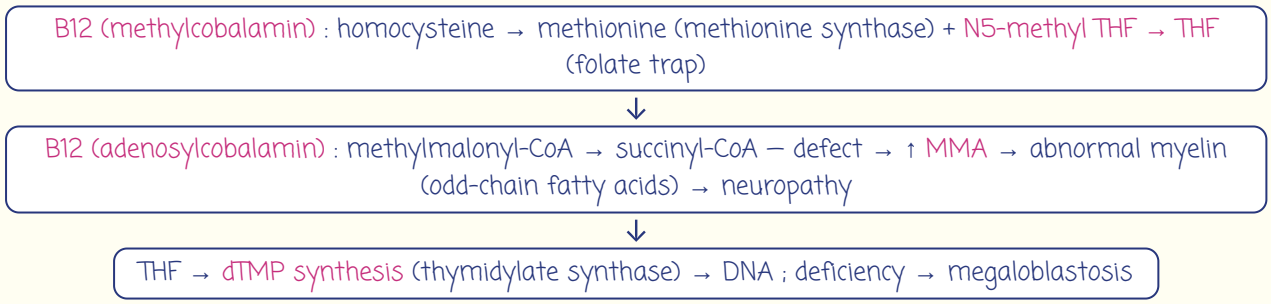
- Chronic infections (TB, osteomyelitis), autoimmune (RA), malignancy, CKD.
- Mechanism : IL-6 → ↑ hepcidin → ↓ ferroportin → iron trapped in macrophages + ↓ absorption; ↓ EPO response; ↓ RBC survival.
- Normocytic normochromic (or mildly microcytic), ↓ serum iron, ↓ TIBC, ↑ ferritin.

Megaloblastic Anemia

- Impaired DNA synthesis (thymidine) with normal RNA/protein synthesis → nuclear-cytoplasmic asynchrony (nucleus immature, cytoplasm mature).

Feature	Vitamin B12 (cobalamin)	Folate
Source	Animal products only (vegans at risk)	Green leafy vegetables, fruits
Stores	2-5 years (liver)	3-4 months
Absorption	Terminal ileum (with intrinsic factor from parietal cells)	Jejunum
Causes	Pernicious anemia (most common in West), gastrectomy, ileal resection / Crohn, Diphyllobothrium latum (fish tapeworm), blind loop (bacterial overgrowth), vegan diet, metformin, PPIs, nitrous oxide, TC2 deficiency	Poor diet (alcoholics, elderly), pregnancy, hemolytic anemia (↑ demand), drugs (methotrexate, trimethoprim, phenytoin, pyrimethamine), tropical sprue, celiac
Neurological symptoms	Present — subacute combined degeneration (posterior + lateral columns), peripheral neuropathy, dementia	Absent
Methylmalonic acid	↑	Normal
Homocysteine	↑	↑

Biochemistry



Morphology :

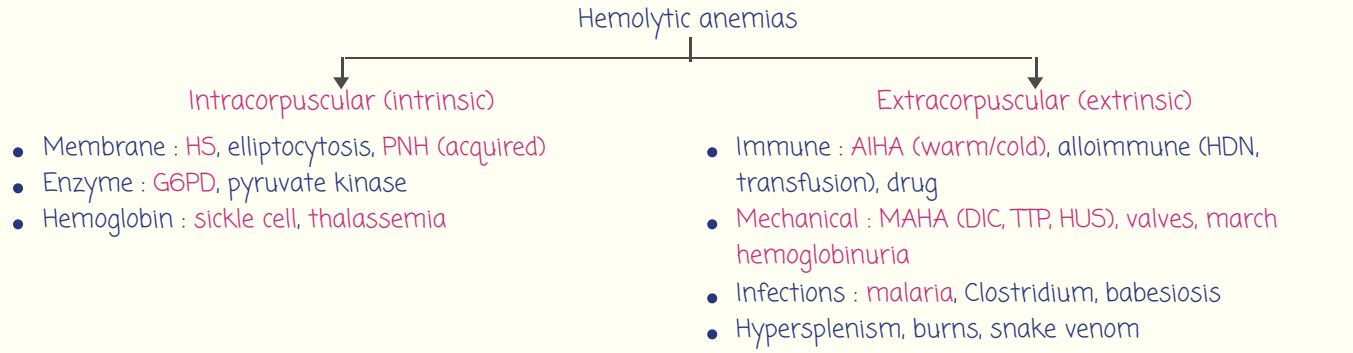
- Peripheral smear : macro-ovalocytes (oval macrocytes, MCV > 100, often > 110), anisopoikilocytosis, hypersegmented neutrophils (≥ 5 lobes in > 5% or any 6 lobes) — earliest & most specific sign, pancytopenia, Howell-Jolly bodies, basophilic stippling, Cabot rings.
- Marrow : hypercellular, megaloblasts (large, open "sieve-like" chromatin), giant metamyelocytes & band forms, ineffective erythropoiesis (intramedullary hemolysis → ↑ LDH, ↑ indirect bilirubin).
- Clinical : lemon-yellow complexion (pallor + mild jaundice), beefy red tongue (atrophic glossitis).

Pernicious anemia :

- Autoimmune gastritis (body/fundus) — anti-parietal cell (90%, sensitive) and anti-intrinsic factor antibodies (specific); type I blocking antibody most common.
- Associations : Hashimoto, vitiligo, Addison, T1DM, ↑ gastric carcinoma, carcinoid; HLA-DR5, blood group A.
- Schilling test (historic) — corrected by IF.

Hemolytic Anemias — Overview

Feature	Extravascular	Intravascular
Site	Spleen & liver (macrophages)	Within vessels
Examples	HS, sickle cell, thalassemia, warm AIHA	PNH, G6PD (acute), mismatched transfusion (ABO), MAHA, cold AIHA (some), malaria, prosthetic valves
Splenomegaly	Present	Absent
Haptoglobin	↓ (mild)	↓↓ (absent)
Hemoglobinemia, hemoglobinuria, hemosiderinuria	Absent	Present
Common to both	↑ Reticulocytes, ↑ LDH, ↑ unconjugated bilirubin, pigment gallstones (chronic), erythroid hyperplasia (↓ M:E)	



Hereditary Spherocytosis (HS)

- Defects in vertical interactions of membrane skeleton : ankyrin (most common), band 3, spectrin, protein 4.2 → loss of membrane → spherocytes → trapped in splenic cords (cannot deform) → extravascular hemolysis.
- AD (75%); most common inherited hemolytic anemia in Northern Europeans.
- Features : anemia, splenomegaly, jaundice, pigment (bilirubin) gallstones (40–50%), aplastic crisis (parvovirus B19), hemolytic crises.
- Lab : spherocytes (no central pallor), ↑ MCHC (only condition with ↑ MCHC), ↑ RDW, ↑ osmotic fragility (incubated), EMA (eosin-5-maleimide) binding test — ↓ fluorescence (flow cytometry — most sensitive/specific), negative Coombs (vs AIHA).
- Treatment : splenectomy (spherocytes persist, anemia corrected; Howell-Jolly bodies appear post-splenectomy).

G6PD Deficiency

- X-linked recessive; most common enzyme deficiency (~400 million); protects against P. falciparum malaria.
- ↓ NADPH → ↓ reduced glutathione → oxidant damage to Hb → Heinz bodies (denatured Hb precipitates) → bite cells (degmacytes) removed by splenic macrophages; intravascular + extravascular hemolysis.
- Triggers : infections (most common), drugs (primaquine, dapsone, sulfonamides, nitrofurantoin, rasburicase, chloroquine, methylene blue), fava beans (favism — Mediterranean variant), naphthalene (mothballs), DKA.
- Variants : G6PD A− (Africa — mild, self-limited, older RBCs), G6PD Mediterranean (severe, favism).
- Smear : bite cells, blister cells, Heinz bodies (supravital stain — crystal violet / brilliant cresyl blue).
- Enzyme assay falsely normal during acute hemolysis (reticulocytes have high G6PD) — repeat after 2–3 months; screening — fluorescent spot test.

Feature	G6PD deficiency	Pyruvate kinase deficiency
Inheritance	X-linked	AR
Pathway	HMP shunt	Glycolysis (↓ ATP)

Feature	G6PD deficiency	Pyruvate kinase deficiency
Hemolysis	Episodic (oxidant)	Chronic, extravascular
Smear	Bite cells, Heinz bodies	Echinocytes (burr / prickle cells)
2,3-BPG	Normal	↑ (better O_2 delivery)

Sickle Cell Disease

- Point mutation β-globin (chromosome 11) — glutamic acid → valine at position 6 (β6 Glu→Val) → HbS.
- Deoxygenated HbS polymerizes → sickling → membrane damage, ↑ rigidity, microvascular occlusion; irreversibly sickled cells.
- Factors ↑ sickling : ↑ HbS concentration, deoxygenation, acidosis, dehydration (↑ MCHC), ↓ HbF, ↑ transit time (slow flow — spleen, marrow). HbF inhibits polymerization (hydroxyurea ↑ HbF). HbC (β6 Glu→Lys) in HbSC — milder.
- India : central India tribal belt (Odisha, Chhattisgarh, MP, Gujarat, Maharashtra) — Arab-Indian haplotype (high HbF — milder).

Clinical features :

1. Vaso-occlusive (pain) crises — bones (hand-foot syndrome / dactylitis — earliest in infants), acute chest syndrome (most common cause of death in adults), priapism, stroke (children), avascular necrosis of femoral head, retinopathy, leg ulcers
2. Sequestration crisis — massive splenic pooling in children → shock (before autosplenectomy)
3. Aplastic crisis — parvovirus B19
4. Hemolytic crisis; chronic hemolysis — pigment gallstones, ↑ bilirubin
5. Autosplenectomy (fibrotic, shrunken spleen — Gamna-Gandy bodies) by adolescence → infections by encapsulated organisms (S. pneumoniae, H. influenzae); Salmonella osteomyelitis
6. Renal : papillary necrosis, hyposthenuria, hematuria; renal medullary carcinoma (trait)
7. Bone : "hair-on-end" skull (less than thal), "H-shaped / fish-mouth" vertebrae, marrow hyperplasia

- Lab : sickle cells (ISCs), target cells, HJ bodies (asplenia); sickling test (sodium metabisulfite — 2%), solubility test (dithionite); Hb electrophoresis / HPLC (confirmatory — HbS).
- Sickle cell trait (HbAS) — usually asymptomatic; hematuria, hyposthenuria, renal medullary carcinoma, splenic infarct at high altitude, exertional rhabdomyolysis; malaria protection.

Thalassemia

- Reduced or absent synthesis of normal globin chains → imbalance — excess unpaired chains precipitate → ineffective erythropoiesis (marrow) + hemolysis (spleen).

β-thalassemia :

- Point mutations (splice site — most common in India : IVS 1-5 G→C); β^0 (no β) / β^+ (reduced). Chromosome 11.

Syndrome	Genotype	Features
β-thalassemia major (Cooley anemia)	β^0/β^0, β^0/β^+, β^+/β^+	Severe transfusion-dependent anemia from 6-9 months (HbF → HbA switch); excess α-chains precipitate → ineffective erythropoiesis; marrow expansion — "crew-cut / hair-on-end" skull X-ray, chipmunk facies (frontal bossing, maxillary prominence); hepatosplenomegaly, extramedullary hematopoiesis; iron overload (transfusions + ↑ absorption) → cardiac failure (most common cause of death), liver, endocrine (DM, hypogonadism); ↑ HbF (up to 90%), ↑ HbA2, HbA absent / ↓
β-thalassemia intermedia	Variable	Not transfusion-dependent; moderate anemia
β-thalassemia minor (trait)	β/β^0 or β/β^+	Usually asymptomatic; mild microcytic anemia with ↑ RBC count, target cells, basophilic stippling; ↑ HbA2 (> 3.5%) — diagnostic; Mentzer < 13; NESTROF screening ; often misdiagnosed as iron deficiency

α-thalassemia :

- Gene deletions (most common); 4 α-genes on chromosome 16 (2 per chromosome); cis deletion (Asians) — risk of hydrops in offspring; trans (Africans).

Genes deleted	Syndrome	Features
1	Silent carrier	Normal
2	α-thalassemia trait	Mild microcytic anemia, normal HbA2
3	HbH disease (β4 tetramers)	Moderate hemolytic anemia; HbH inclusions — "golf-ball" (brilliant cresyl blue)
4	Hydrops fetalis (Hb Barts — γ4)	Intrauterine death; Hb Barts has very high O_2 affinity

Exam pearl

- Smear in thalassemia major : microcytic hypochromic, target cells, nucleated RBCs (normoblasts), basophilic stippling, anisopoikilocytosis.
- HbE (β26 Glu→Lys) — North-East India (Assam), Bengal ; HbE/β-thalassemia — common cause of thal intermedia/major in eastern India.
- Prenatal diagnosis : chorionic villus sampling (10-12 weeks); HPLC — screening test of choice for hemoglobinopathies.
- Iron chelators : desferrioxamine (SC), deferiprone (oral — agranulocytosis), deferasirox (oral); T2* MRI for cardiac iron.

Immune Hemolytic Anemias

Feature	Warm AIHA	Cold agglutinin disease	Paroxysmal cold hemoglobinuria
Antibody	IgG (Rh antigens)	IgM (anti-I / i)	IgG (Donath-Landsteiner, anti-P) — biphasic
Temperature	37 °C	< 30 °C (cold)	Binds cold, lyses warm
Hemolysis	Extravascular (spleen) — spherocytes	Intravascular (complement) + extravascular (liver); RBC agglutination on smear, acrocyanosis	Intravascular
Causes	Idiopathic (60%), SLE, CLL, lymphomas, drugs (α-methyldopa, penicillin)	Mycoplasma pneumoniae (anti-I), infectious mononucleosis (anti-i), lymphomas (Waldenström)	Syphilis (historic), viral infections in children
Coombs (DAT)	IgG ± C3	C3 only	C3

- Direct Coombs test (DAT) — antibodies / complement on patient's RBCs (AIHA, HDN, transfusion reaction). Indirect Coombs (IAT) — antibodies in patient's serum (cross-matching, antenatal screening).
- Drug-induced : hapten (penicillin, cephalosporins), immune complex (quinidine), autoantibody (α-methyldopa — true autoimmune).
- Hemolytic disease of newborn : Rh (anti-D, IgG) — 2nd pregnancy; severe; anti-D prophylaxis at 28 weeks & within 72 h postpartum; ABO (O mother, A/B baby) — 1st pregnancy, mild, more common; kernicterus, hydrops fetalis (Rh).

Mechanical & Infection-related Hemolysis

Disease	Key features
Microangiopathic hemolytic anemia (MAHA)	Schistocytes (helmet cells), thrombocytopenia — DIC, TTP (ADAMTS13), HUS (Shiga toxin), malignant HTN, HELLP, SLE, disseminated cancer
Prosthetic valves	Macroangiopathic — schistocytes, iron deficiency (hemosiderinuria)
March hemoglobinuria	Runners, soldiers — foot trauma

Disease	Key features
Malaria	Intravascular & extravascular hemolysis; P. falciparum – blackwater fever; splenomegaly
Clostridium perfringens	Lecithinase (α-toxin) – massive hemolysis, spherocytes

Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria (PNH)

- Acquired mutation of PIGA gene (X-linked) in a hematopoietic stem cell → deficiency of GPI-anchored proteins : CD55 (DAF), CD59 (MIRL – most important), C8-binding protein → complement-mediated intravascular hemolysis.
- Triad : hemolytic anemia + pancytopenia + venous thrombosis (hepatic – Budd-Chiari, portal, cerebral – most common cause of death).
- Nocturnal hemoglobinuria (mild respiratory acidosis during sleep); iron deficiency (hemosiderinuria).
- Associations : aplastic anemia, MDS, AML.
- Diagnosis : flow cytometry – absent CD55, CD59 on RBCs; FLAER (fluorescent aerolysin) on WBCs – gold standard; Ham (acid serum) test & sucrose lysis test – historic.
- Treatment : eculizumab (anti-C5) – ↑ meningococcal risk (vaccinate).

Aplastic Anemia

- Pancytopenia with hypocellular (fatty) marrow (< 25% cellularity), no splenomegaly, no abnormal cells.

Causes :

1. Idiopathic (most common – ~65%) – autoimmune T-cell (IFN-γ, TNF) destruction of stem cells; telomerase mutations
2. Drugs – dose-related : alkylating agents, antimetabolites, benzene; idiosyncratic : chloramphenicol (most notorious), phenylbutazone, carbamazepine, gold, sulfonamides, felbamate
3. Viral – seronegative hepatitis (non-A to E), EBV, HIV, parvovirus B19 (pure red cell aplasia)
4. Whole-body radiation
5. Inherited – Fanconi anemia (DNA crosslink repair – short stature, absent radii/thumbs, café-au-lait, ↑ chromosomal breakage with diepoxybutane / mitomycin C), dyskeratosis congenita (telomerase), Shwachman-Diamond
6. PNH, pregnancy

- Treatment : HSCT (young), immunosuppression (ATG + cyclosporine + eltrombopag).

Feature	Aplastic anemia	Pure red cell aplasia
Lineages	All (pancytopenia)	Erythroid only
Causes	As above	Thymoma, parvovirus B19 (giant pronormoblasts), Diamond-Blackfan (congenital – RPS19, macrocytosis, thumb anomalies, ↑ eADA), drugs, large granular lymphocytic leukemia

Myelodysplastic Syndromes (MDS)

- Clonal stem-cell disorders with ineffective hematopoiesis (cytopenias), dysplasia & risk of AML; elderly (> 70 y); therapy-related (alkylating agents – 5-10 years; 5q-/7q-).
- Hypercellular marrow with peripheral cytopenias; blasts < 20%.
- Dysplastic features : ringed sideroblasts (≥ 15%), megaloblastoid erythroid precursors, nuclear budding; pseudo-Pelger-Huët neutrophils (bilobed "pince-nez"), hypogranular neutrophils; micromegakaryocytes (monolobed / small nuclei).
- 5q- syndrome : elderly women, macrocytic anemia, normal/↑ platelets, hypolobated megakaryocytes, good prognosis – lenalidomide responsive.
- Genetics : SF3B1 (ring sideroblasts – good), TP53 (poor), TET2, ASXL1, DNMT3A. Prognosis : IPSS-R.

Filled : Rank boosters — RBC

- Sideroblastic anemia : ringed sideroblasts (iron-laden mitochondria around nucleus; Prussian blue) — X-linked (ALAS2 — B6 responsive), alcohol, lead, isoniazid (B6), copper deficiency (zinc excess), MDS.
- Lead poisoning : coarse basophilic stippling (ribosomal RNA — inhibition of pyrimidine 5′-nucleotidase), ↑ ZPP.
- Hereditary elliptocytosis — horizontal (spectrin dimer-dimer) interactions; Southeast Asian ovalocytosis (band 3, malaria protection).
- Hereditary stomatocytosis — mouth-like pallor; Rh-null.
- Anemia of CKD : ↓ EPO; normocytic, burr cells.
- Polycythemia (relative vs absolute) : secondary — high altitude, COPD, cyanotic CHD, smokers (↑ COHb), EPO tumours (RCC, HCC, cerebellar hemangioblastoma, leiomyoma); primary — PV (low EPO).
- Reticulocyte stain : new methylene blue / brilliant cresyl blue (supravital).

BLEEDING DISORDERS & BLOOD TRANSFUSION

Approach to Bleeding Disorders

Feature	Platelet / vascular (primary hemostasis)	Coagulation factor (secondary hemostasis)
Site	Skin & mucous membranes	Deep tissues — joints (hemarthrosis), muscles
Lesions	Petechiae, purpura, ecchymoses (small, superficial), epistaxis, gum bleeding, menorrhagia	Large hematomas, hemarthroses
Bleeding after cuts	Immediate, profuse	Delayed, prolonged
Examples	ITP, vWD, Glanzmann, scurvy	Hemophilia, vitamin K deficiency

Screening tests :

Test	Measures	Prolonged in
Platelet count	Number (150,000–450,000/µL)	Thrombocytopenia
Bleeding time (BT) / PFA-100	Platelet function + vessel (2–7 min)	ITP, vWD, Glanzmann, Bernard-Soulier, aspirin, uremia
Prothrombin time (PT / INR)	Extrinsic + common (VII, X, V, II, fibrinogen)	Warfarin, vitamin K deficiency, liver disease, factor VII deficiency, DIC
aPTT	Intrinsic + common (XII, XI, IX, VIII, X, V, II, fibrinogen)	Hemophilia A & B, heparin, vWD (low VIII), lupus anticoagulant, factor XI / XII deficiency, DIC
Thrombin time (TT)	Fibrinogen → fibrin	Heparin, hypo/dysfibrinogenemia, FDPs (DIC), dabigatran
Mixing study	Corrects → factor deficiency; does not correct → inhibitor (lupus anticoagulant, factor VIII inhibitor)	

Exam pearl
- Factor XII deficiency → prolonged aPTT but NO bleeding (↑ thrombosis tendency).
- Factor XIII deficiency → normal PT, aPTT, TT — delayed bleeding, umbilical stump bleeding; urea (5 M) clot solubility test.
- Isolated ↑ PT — factor VII deficiency, early warfarin, early vitamin K deficiency, liver disease (early).
- Monitoring : heparin → aPTT (or anti-Xa); warfarin → PT/INR (target 2–3).

Vascular Purpuras

1. Infections — meningococcemia, rickettsiae, IE (vasculitis)
2. Drug reactions — leukocytoclastic vasculitis
3. Scurvy, Ehlers-Danlos, Cushing / steroids, senile purpura — weak vessel support
4. Henoch-Schönlein purpura (IgA vasculitis) — palpable purpura
5. Hereditary hemorrhagic telangiectasia (Osler-Weber-Rendu) — AD, endoglin (ENG), ALK1; epistaxis, GI bleed, AVMs
6. Amyloidosis — pinch purpura, periorbital (raccoon eyes)

Thrombocytopenia

Causes :

1. Decreased production — aplastic anemia, leukemia, marrow infiltration, megaloblastic anemia, drugs (thiazides, alcohol, chemotherapy), viral (HIV, measles), MDS
2. Decreased survival (immune) — ITP, drug-induced (heparin, quinine, quinidine, sulfonamides, vancomycin), SLE, post-transfusion purpura (anti-HPA-1a), neonatal alloimmune thrombocytopenia, HIV, CLL
3. Decreased survival (non-immune) — DIC, TTP, HUS, prosthetic valves
4. Sequestration — hypersplenism (cirrhosis)
5. Dilutional — massive transfusion
6. Pseudothrombocytopenia — EDTA-induced clumping (check citrate sample / smear)

Immune thrombocytopenic purpura (ITP) :

Feature	Acute ITP	Chronic ITP
Age	Children (2-6 y)	Adults — women 20-40 y
Onset	Abrupt, 1-2 weeks after viral infection	Insidious
Course	Self-limited (80% resolve in 6 months)	Chronic, relapsing
Associations	Post-viral	SLE, HIV, HCV, CLL, H. pylori

- Antibodies against GpIIb/IIIa or GpIb-IX → splenic destruction (spleen — site of antibody production & destruction; normal-sized spleen).
- Isolated thrombocytopenia, large platelets (megathrombocytes), normal PT/aPTT; marrow — ↑ megakaryocytes (normal or increased); diagnosis of exclusion.
- Treatment : steroids, IVIG, anti-D, TPO agonists (eltrombopag, romiplostim), rituximab, splenectomy.

Heparin-induced thrombocytopenia (HIT) :

- Type II — immune (IgG against heparin-PF4 complex) → platelet activation → thrombocytopenia + paradoxical thrombosis (venous & arterial); 5-14 days after heparin (earlier if prior exposure); UFH > LMWH.
- Diagnosis : 4T score, anti-PF4 ELISA, serotonin release assay (gold standard).
- Management : stop all heparin; use argatroban / bivalirudin / fondaparinux; avoid warfarin initially (venous limb gangrene).

TTP vs HUS :

Feature	TTP	HUS
Mechanism	↓ ADAMTS13 (vWF-cleaving protease) — acquired autoantibody (most common) or congenital (Upshaw-Schulman) → ultra-large vWF multimers → platelet microthrombi	Endothelial injury — Shiga-like toxin (E. coli O157:H7) — typical; complement dysregulation (factor H, I, MCP) — atypical
Patients	Adult women	Children (bloody diarrhea)
Pentad / triad	Pentad : fever, MAHA, thrombocytopenia, neurological symptoms (prominent), renal failure (mild)	Triad : MAHA, thrombocytopenia, acute renal failure (prominent)
Coagulation	Normal PT, aPTT (vs DIC)	Normal
Treatment	Plasma exchange (plasmapheresis) + steroids, caplacizumab, rituximab	Supportive (typical); eculizumab (atypical)

Qualitative Platelet Disorders

Disorder	Defect	Lab
Bernard-Soulier syndrome	GpIb-IX-V (vWF receptor) — AR	Giant platelets, thrombocytopenia, ↑ BT; no aggregation with ristocetin (not corrected by normal plasma)
Glanzmann thrombasthenia	GpIIb/IIIa (fibrinogen receptor) — AR	Normal count & size, ↑ BT; no aggregation with ADP, collagen, epinephrine, thrombin; normal ristocetin agglutination; absent clot retraction

Disorder	Defect	Lab
Storage pool disease (δ-granule)	Hermansky-Pudlak (albinism), Chédiak-Higashi, Wiskott-Aldrich	↓ 2nd wave aggregation
Gray platelet syndrome	α-granule deficiency (NBEAL2)	Large grey (agranular) platelets, myelofibrosis
Acquired	Aspirin (irreversible COX-1), clopidogrel (P2Y12), uremia, myeloproliferative neoplasms, cardiopulmonary bypass	

Coagulation Factor Disorders

Von Willebrand disease (vWD) :

- Most common inherited bleeding disorder (1%); mostly AD; chromosome 12.
- vWF : platelet adhesion (GpIb to subendothelial collagen) + carrier / stabilizer of factor VIII.

Type	Defect	Frequency
Type 1	Quantitative ↓ vWF (mild-moderate)	Most common (70%)
Type 2 (2A, 2B, 2M, 2N)	Qualitative; 2A — loss of large multimers; 2B — gain of function (↑ GpIb binding → thrombocytopenia); 2N — ↓ VIII binding (mimics hemophilia A)	25%
Type 3	Severe near-total absence (AR) — low VIII → hemarthroses	Rare

- Lab : ↑ BT (PFA-100), ↑ / normal aPTT (↓ VIII), normal platelet count, ↓ vWF antigen, ↓ ristocetin cofactor activity (vWF:RCo), abnormal ristocetin aggregation — corrected by normal plasma (vs Bernard-Soulier).
- Treatment : desmopressin (DDAVP — releases vWF from Weibel-Palade bodies; type 1), vWF concentrates, tranexamic acid.
- Acquired vWD — aortic stenosis (Heyde syndrome), LVAD, Wilms tumour, hypothyroidism.

Hemophilia :

Feature	Hemophilia A	Hemophilia B (Christmas disease)
Factor	VIII	IX
Inheritance	X-linked recessive (30% new mutations)	X-linked recessive
Frequency	1 in 5000 males (80-85%)	1 in 30,000
Common mutation	Intron 22 inversion (severe — 40%)	Point mutations

- Severity by factor level : severe < 1% (spontaneous hemarthrosis), moderate 1-5%, mild 5-40% (bleeding after trauma/surgery).
- Features : hemarthrosis (knee most common) → hemophilic arthropathy, deep muscle hematomas (iliopsoas — femoral nerve), intracranial hemorrhage (major cause of death), no petechiae.
- Lab : ↑ aPTT (corrected by mixing), normal PT, BT, platelet count; specific factor assay.
- Complications : inhibitor development (alloantibodies — 20-30% in severe A); historic HIV/HCV via concentrates.
- Treatment : recombinant factor, emicizumab (bispecific — mimics VIIIa; prophylaxis even with inhibitors), gene therapy, DDAVP (mild A).

Mnemonic : Hemophilia C & others

- Hemophilia C — factor XI deficiency — AR, Ashkenazi Jews, mild bleeding after surgery.
- Vitamin K-dependent factors : "1972" — X, IX, VII, II + protein C & S.

Vitamin K deficiency & liver disease :

Condition	PT	aPTT	Platelets	Fibrinogen	Factor VIII
Vitamin K deficiency	↑↑	↑	N	N	N
Liver disease	↑↑	↑	↓ (hypersplenism)	↓ (late)	N / ↑ (made in endothelium)
DIC	↑	↑	↓	↓	↓

- Hemorrhagic disease of newborn : classic 2-7 days; early (< 24 h — maternal drugs : anticonvulsants, warfarin, rifampicin); late (2-12 weeks — exclusively breastfed, malabsorption) — ICH; prevented by 1 mg IM vitamin K at birth.

DIC — lab (summary) :

- ↓ platelets, ↑ PT, ↑ aPTT, ↓ fibrinogen, ↑ D-dimer & FDPs (most useful), schistocytes. See Hemodynamics chapter for causes & pathogenesis.

Thrombophilia — Laboratory

Test	Detects
APC resistance (aPTT-based) + PCR	Factor V Leiden
PCR	Prothrombin G20210A
Functional assays	Protein C, S, antithrombin deficiency (test when off anticoagulation — warfarin ↓ C & S; heparin ↓ AT)
dRVVT, LA-sensitive aPTT, anticardiolipin, anti-β2GPI (repeat at 12 weeks)	Antiphospholipid syndrome

- Warfarin-induced skin necrosis — protein C deficiency (short half-life) → transient hypercoagulable state in first days; prevented by heparin bridging.

Blood Groups & Transfusion

ABO system :

Group	Antigen on RBC	Antibodies in plasma	Frequency (India)
A	A	Anti-B (IgM)	~23%
B	B	Anti-A	~32% (commonest in North India)
AB	A + B	None — universal recipient (RBCs)	~8%
O	None (H antigen)	Anti-A, anti-B (IgG + IgM)	~37% (commonest overall in India)

- Universal donor of RBCs : O negative; universal plasma donor : AB.
- Bombay phenotype (Oh) — absence of H antigen (FUT1), anti-H in serum → can receive only Bombay blood; first described in Mumbai (Bhende, 1952); LAD-2 association.
- Rh system : D antigen — most immunogenic after A & B; Rh-negative ~5% in India (15% Caucasians); anti-D is IgG (crosses placenta) — formed only after exposure.
- Naturally occurring antibodies (ABO) = IgM (do not cross placenta); immune antibodies = IgG.

Pre-transfusion testing :

1. ABO & Rh grouping — forward (cell) grouping + reverse (serum) grouping
2. Antibody screening (indirect antiglobulin test with screening cells)
3. Cross-matching — major cross-match : donor RBCs + recipient serum (most important); minor : donor plasma + recipient cells (not routinely done)
4. Type & screen / electronic cross-match
5. Mandatory screening of donated blood (India) : HIV 1 & 2, HBsAg, HCV, syphilis (VDRL/RPR), malaria — NAT testing reduces window period

Blood components :

Component	Storage	Indication / notes
Packed RBCs	2–6 °C, 35 days (CPDA-1), 42 days (SAGM)	Anemia; 1 unit ↑ Hb by ~1 g/dL
Platelet concentrate	20–24 °C with continuous agitation, 5 days	Highest risk of bacterial contamination (room temp); 1 unit (RDP) ↑ by 5,000–10,000; SDP (apheresis) ↑ 30,000–50,000
Fresh frozen plasma (FFP)	−18 to −30 °C (or colder), 1 year	All coagulation factors; warfarin reversal (if PCC unavailable), DIC, TTP (plasma exchange), liver disease with bleeding
Cryoprecipitate	−18 °C, 1 year	Fibrinogen (most important — DIC), factor VIII, vWF, factor XIII, fibronectin
Whole blood	2–6 °C, 35 days	Massive hemorrhage (rarely used)

- Leukoreduction — ↓ febrile reactions, ↓ CMV transmission, ↓ HLA alloimmunization.
- Irradiation (25 Gy) — prevents transfusion-associated GVHD — immunodeficient recipients, blood from first-degree relatives, HLA-matched platelets, IUT, HSCT.
- Washed RBCs — IgA deficiency (anaphylaxis), PNH, recurrent allergic reactions.

Transfusion reactions :

Reaction	Mechanism	Key features
Febrile non-hemolytic	Cytokines from donor leukocytes / anti-HLA antibodies	Most common reaction; fever, chills within 1–6 h; prevented by leukoreduction
Allergic (urticarial)	Recipient IgE against donor plasma proteins	Urticaria, pruritus; antihistamines
Anaphylactic	Anti-IgA in IgA-deficient recipient	Hypotension, bronchospasm within minutes; washed products / IgA-deficient donor
Acute hemolytic (immediate)	ABO incompatibility (IgM) — clerical error (most common cause) → complement → intravascular hemolysis	Fever, chills, flank/back pain, hypotension, hemoglobinuria, DIC, AKI; DAT +; stop transfusion immediately
Delayed hemolytic	Anamnestic IgG response (Kidd — Jk, Rh, Kell, Duffy)	3–10 days later; extravascular hemolysis, jaundice, ↓ Hb, DAT +
TRALI	Donor anti-HLA / anti-HNA antibodies (multiparous female donors) → neutrophil activation in recipient lungs	Within 6 h — non-cardiogenic pulmonary edema, hypoxemia, fever, hypotension; leading cause of transfusion-related death
TACO	Volume overload	Hypertension, ↑ JVP, cardiogenic edema, ↑ BNP; elderly, cardiac disease; diuretics
Transfusion-associated GVHD	Donor T cells in immunodeficient recipient	Fatal (> 90%); pancytopenia; prevented by irradiation
Post-transfusion purpura	Anti-HPA-1a (multiparous women)	Severe thrombocytopenia 7–10 days after transfusion; IVIG
Bacterial contamination	Platelets (Staph. epidermidis), RBCs (Yersinia enterocolitica — grows at 4 °C, iron-loving)	Septic shock
Massive transfusion (≥ 10 units / 24 h)	Dilution, citrate, cold	Hypocalcemia (citrate toxicity), hyperkalemia, hypothermia, dilutional coagulopathy & thrombocytopenia, metabolic alkalosis (later)

Transfusion-transmitted infections :

1. HIV 1 & 2 (window period : ELISA 3–4 weeks; NAT ~7–11 days)
2. Hepatitis B (most common TTI in India), hepatitis C, HDV
3. Syphilis, malaria
4. CMV (leukocytes — prevented by leukoreduction), HTLV, parvovirus B19, EBV, West Nile, babesiosis, Chagas, variant CJD (prion)

Filled : Rank boosters — transfusion

- Storage lesion : ↓ 2,3-BPG, ↑ K^+, ↓ pH in stored RBCs.
- Kell antigen — most immunogenic after D; anti-Kell — HDN (suppresses erythropoiesis).
- Lewis antibodies — IgM, do not cause HDN (Lewis antigens adsorbed, poorly developed at birth); P antigen — receptor for parvovirus B19; Duffy null — resistance to P. vivax.
- Autologous transfusion — pre-deposit, hemodilution, cell salvage.
- Blood bag anticoagulant : CPDA-1 (citrate — anticoagulant, phosphate — buffer, dextrose — energy, adenine — ATP; 35 days).
- O-negative uncross-matched blood in emergencies; switch to group-specific ASAP.

WHITE CELL DISORDERS, LEUKEMIAS & PLASMA CELL NEOPLASMS

Non-neoplastic Leukocyte Disorders

Disorder	Causes
Neutrophilia	Acute bacterial infections, tissue necrosis (MI, burns), steroids (demargination), stress, smoking, CML
Eosinophilia	Allergy (asthma, hay fever), parasites (tissue-invasive helminths), drugs, Hodgkin lymphoma, Churg-Strauss, Addison, Loeffler, hypereosinophilic syndrome (PDGFRA)
Basophilia	Myeloproliferative neoplasms (CML)
Monocytosis	TB, brucellosis, SABE, malaria, recovery phase, IBD, CMML
Lymphocytosis	Viral (EBV, CMV, hepatitis), pertussis (very high), TB, brucellosis, CLL
Neutropenia / agranulocytosis	Drugs (most common — clozapine, carbimazole, sulfonamides, chemotherapy), viral, typhoid, aplastic anemia, SLE, Felty syndrome, benign ethnic neutropenia, cyclic neutropenia (ELANE — every 21 days), Kostmann (HAX1)

Leukemoid reaction vs CML :

Feature	Leukemoid reaction	CML
Cause	Severe infection, TB, hemolysis, tumours	BCR-ABL
TLC	> 50,000/µL	Often > 100,000/µL
Differential	Mostly mature, "left shift" (bands, metamyelocytes)	Full spectrum, ↑ myelocytes & neutrophils ("bimodal peak")
LAP score (NAP)	↑ (high)	↓ (low)
Basophils	Normal	↑ (basophilia)
Toxic changes	Toxic granules, Döhle bodies, cytoplasmic vacuoles	Absent
Splenomegaly	Absent / mild	Massive
Philadelphia chromosome	Absent	Present (95%)

- Leukoerythroblastic picture (immature WBCs + nucleated RBCs + teardrops) : marrow infiltration (metastatic Ca, myelofibrosis, TB, myeloma), severe hemolysis/bleeding.

Reactive lymphadenitis & infectious mononucleosis :

- Infectious mononucleosis (EBV) — fever, pharyngitis, posterior cervical lymphadenopathy, splenomegaly, atypical lymphocytes (> 10%, CD8 T cells — "ballerina-skirt" cytoplasm indented by RBCs); heterophile antibodies (Paul-Bunnell, Monospot), EBV VCA-IgM; ampicillin rash; splenic rupture.

Leukemia — General

Feature	Acute leukemia	Chronic leukemia
Blasts	≥ 20% in marrow / blood (WHO)	< 20% (chronic phase)
Cells	Immature (blasts)	Mature-appearing
Onset	Abrupt; bone pain, fever, bleeding, infections	Insidious; often incidental

Acute leukemias — diagnosis :

Test	AML	ALL
Blast morphology	Larger, more cytoplasm, granules, Auer rods, 3-5 nucleoli	Small, scant cytoplasm, condensed chromatin, 1-2 nucleoli
Myeloperoxidase (MPO)	+ (≥ 3% blasts)	–
Sudan black B	+	–
Non-specific esterase (NSE, α-naphthyl acetate)	+ in monocytic (M4, M5) — fluoride-sensitive	–
PAS	– (except erythroleukemia — M6, block)	+ (block / coarse granular positivity)
TdT	–	+ (precursor B & T)
Markers	CD13, CD33, CD117, CD34, MPO; CD14/CD64 (mono); CD41/CD61 (mega)	B-ALL : CD19, CD10 (CALLA), CD22, cytoplasmic CD79a; T-ALL : CD3, CD7, CD1a, CD2, CD5

Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia (ALL)

- Most common cancer of childhood (peak 2-5 years); B-ALL (85%), T-ALL (15% — adolescent males, mediastinal (thymic) mass, high WBC).
- Features : bone pain & tenderness (marrow expansion), CNS involvement (headache, cranial nerve palsy) — sanctuary site, testicular involvement (relapse), lymphadenopathy, hepatosplenomegaly, pancytopenia.
- Associations : Down syndrome (↑ 10-20×), ataxia telangiectasia, Bloom, radiation.

Prognostic factor	Favourable	Unfavourable
Age	2-10 years	< 1 year (KMT2A / MLL rearrangement), > 10 years (adolescents, adults)
TLC at diagnosis	< 50,000/μL	> 50,000/μL
Cytogenetics	Hyperdiploidy (> 50 chromosomes), t(12;21) ETV6-RUNX1 (most common translocation in children)	t(9;22) Philadelphia (adults — 25%), t(4;11) KMT2A-AFF1, hypodiploidy, Ph-like (BCR-ABL1-like), iAMP21
Response	Rapid early response, MRD negative at end of induction	MRD positive
Others	Female, B-cell	T-cell (historically), CNS / testis involvement

Acute Myeloid Leukemia (AML)

- Adults (median ~65 y); most common acute leukemia in adults; ↑ with benzene, radiation, alkylating agents (5-10 y; 5q/7q), topoisomerase II inhibitors (etoposide — 1-3 y; 11q23 KMT2A), MDS/MPN, Down syndrome (AML-M7 < 3 y), Fanconi.

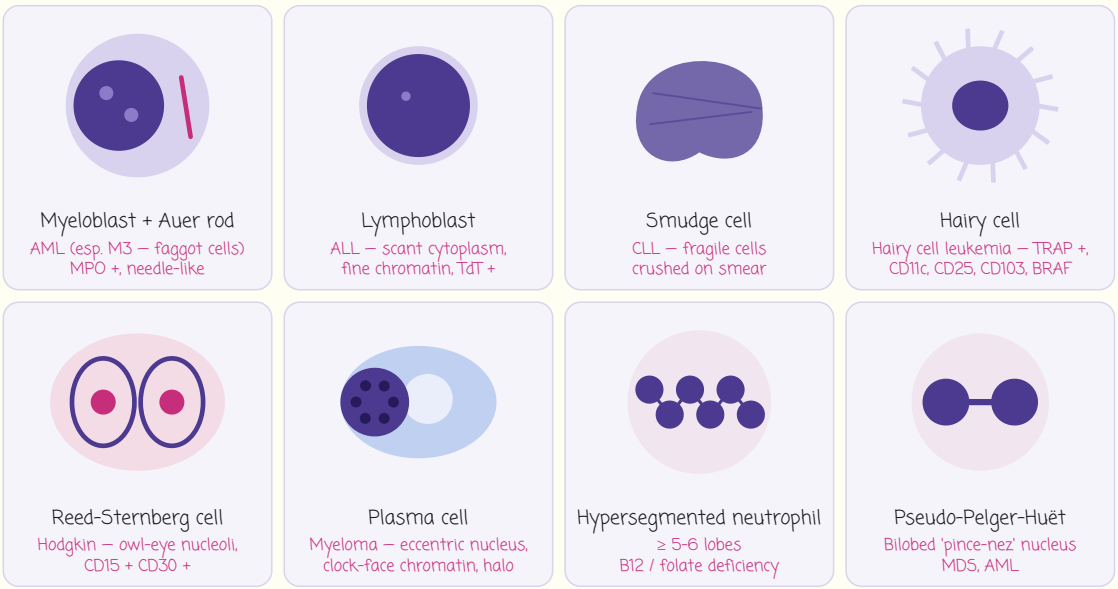
WHO classification (key entities) :

Category	Genetics	Key features / prognosis
APL (acute promyelocytic, FAB M3)	t(15;17) PML-RARA	Hypergranular promyelocytes with multiple Auer rods (faggot cells); DIC (tissue factor, annexin II); ATRA + arsenic trioxide — excellent prognosis; differentiation syndrome; younger adults
Core binding factor AML	t(8;21) RUNX1-RUNX1T1 (M2); inv(16) / t(16;16) CBFB-MYH11 (M4Eo — abnormal eosinophils)	Good prognosis; t(8;21) — myeloid sarcoma (chloroma), Auer rods; KIT mutations worsen
NPM1 mutated (without FLT3-ITD)	NPM1 (cytoplasmic)	Good — most common mutation in normal karyotype AML; "cup-like" nuclei
Biallelic CEBPA	CEBPA	Good
FLT3-ITD	FLT3	Poor (midostaurin, gilteritinib)

Category	Genetics	Key features / prognosis
KMT2A (MLL) rearranged	11q23 — t(9;11)	Monocytic, infants, post-topoisomerase II; poor
Complex karyotype, −5/5q−, −7, TP53, inv(3)	—	Poor
AML with myelodysplasia-related changes / therapy-related	—	Poor
AML-M7 (megakaryoblastic)	GATA1 (Down)	Myelofibrosis ; Down syndrome — good response
Monocytic (M4/M5)	—	Gum hypertrophy, skin infiltration (leukemia cutis), CNS, NSE +

FAB classification — quick recall :

FAB	Type	Clue
M0	Minimally differentiated	MPO −, CD13/33 +
M1	Without maturation	—
M2	With maturation	t(8;21), most common FAB type
M3	Promyelocytic	t(15;17), DIC, faggot cells
M4	Myelomonocytic	inv(16) — eosinophils (M4Eo)
M5	Monocytic	Gum infiltration, NSE +
M6	Erythroleukemia	PAS + erythroblasts
M7	Megakaryoblastic	Down syndrome, CD41/CD61, myelofibrosis



Key white-cell morphology for spotters (labelled)

Myeloproliferative Neoplasms (MPN)

- Clonal stem-cell disorders with ↑ production of one or more mature myeloid lineages; constitutively activated tyrosine kinases; splenomegaly (extramedullary hematopoiesis); may progress to spent phase (myelofibrosis) or acute leukemia.

Disease	Mutation	Key features
CML	BCR-ABL1 — t(9;22)(q34;q11) — Philadelphia chromosome (shortened 22)	p210 (CML), p190 (Ph+ ALL); massive splenomegaly (dragging sensation), ↑↑ WBC with myelocytes, basophilia, ↓ LAP, ↑ platelets; phases : chronic → accelerated → blast crisis (2/3 myeloid, 1/3 lymphoid); imatinib (TKI); monitor by RT-PCR (BCR-ABL transcript)

Disease	Mutation	Key features
Polycythemia vera (PV)	JAK2 V617F (> 95%), JAK2 exon 12	↑ RBC mass (panmyelosis — ↑ WBC, platelets too), ↓ EPO (vs secondary); aquagenic pruritus (histamine — basophils), plethora, thrombosis (Budd-Chiari), erythromelalgia, gout, hypertension, peptic ulcer; spent phase (myelofibrosis), AML (2%); phlebotomy, aspirin, hydroxyurea
Essential thrombocythemia (ET)	JAK2 (50%), CALR (30%), MPL (5-10%)	Platelets ≥ 450,000/μL, large megakaryocytes in clusters (staghorn nuclei); thrombosis & bleeding (acquired vWD); erythromelalgia; diagnosis of exclusion (iron deficiency, inflammation)
Primary myelofibrosis (PMF)	JAK2 (50%), CALR (30%), MPL	Marrow fibrosis (reticulin, collagen — TGF-β, PDGF from megakaryocytes) → dry tap; leukoerythroblastic smear + teardrop cells (dacrocytes); massive splenomegaly (extramedullary hematopoiesis); atypical, clustered megakaryocytes (cloud-like nuclei); osteosclerosis; ruxolitinib
Chronic neutrophilic leukemia	CSF3R	Neutrophilia
Systemic mastocytosis	KIT D816V	Urticaria pigmentosa (Darier sign), ↑ tryptase
Myeloid neoplasms with eosinophilia	PDGFRA (FIP1L1-PDGFRA), PDGFRB, FGFR1	Imatinib-responsive (PDGFR)

Mnemonic : MPN mutations

"CML — BCR-ABL · PV — JAK2 (almost always) · ET & PMF — JAK2 / CALR / MPL". Triple-negative ET/PMF — worse.

Exam pearl

- Polycythemia vera vs secondary polycythemia : EPO ↓ in PV, ↑ in secondary (hypoxia, tumours); splenomegaly only in PV; ↑ WBC & platelets only in PV.
- Gaisböck syndrome (relative / stress polycythemia) — ↓ plasma volume; obese hypertensive smokers.

Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia / Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma (CLL/SLL)

- Most common leukemia in adults in the West (> 60 y); rare in Asia.
- Mature B cells : CD5 + CD19 + CD20 (dim) CD23 +, dim surface Ig; absolute B-lymphocytosis ≥ 5000/μL (monoclonal).
- Smear : small mature lymphocytes with clumped "soccer-ball" chromatin + smudge (basket) cells.
- Lymph node (SLL) : diffuse effacement with pale proliferation centres (prolymphocytes, para-immunoblasts) — pathognomonic.
- Complications : hypogammaglobulinemia (infections — most common cause of death), autoimmune hemolytic anemia (warm) & ITP, Richter transformation (to DLBCL — 5-10%).
- Genetics : del 13q14 (most common — good, miR-15/16), trisomy 12 (intermediate), del 11q (ATM — poor), del 17p / TP53 (worst); unmutated IGHV (ZAP-70 +, CD38 +) — poor.
- Staging : Rai (0-IV), Binet (A-C); ibrutinib (BTK), venetoclax (BCL-2).

Other mature lymphoid leukemias :

Disease	Key features
Hairy cell leukemia	Middle-aged men; massive splenomegaly (red pulp), pancytopenia (monocytopenia), no lymphadenopathy; dry tap (reticulin fibrosis); "fried egg" appearance in marrow; TRAP + (tartrate-resistant acid phosphatase), CD11c, CD25, CD103, annexin A1, BRAF V600E; cladribine (excellent response)
Prolymphocytic leukemia	Marked lymphocytosis (> 100,000), prominent nucleolus, massive splenomegaly
Adult T-cell leukemia/lymphoma (HTLV-1)	Hypercalcemia (lytic lesions), skin lesions, "flower cells" (cloverleaf nuclei), CD4 + CD25 +

Disease	Key features
Mycosis fungoides / Sézary syndrome	CD4 + skin T-cell lymphoma; Pautrier microabscesses (epidermis); cerebriform nuclei; Sézary : erythroderma + leukemic phase (Sézary cells)
Large granular lymphocytic leukemia	CD8 / NK; neutropenia, RA (Felty-like), pure red cell aplasia; STAT3

Plasma Cell Neoplasms

Multiple myeloma :

- Malignant proliferation of plasma cells in marrow with monoclonal Ig (M-protein) — IgG (55%) > IgA (25%) > light chain only (Bence Jones); > 60 y, men, African descent.
- Pathogenesis : IL-6 (growth factor); translocations to IgH (14q32) — t(11;14) cyclin D1 (most common), t(4;14) FGFR3/MMSET, t(14;16) MAF; del 17p (poor); hyperdiploidy.
- RANKL ↑, DKK1 (inhibits osteoblasts) ↑ → lytic bone lesions ("punched-out" — skull, vertebrae, ribs), pathological fractures, hypercalcemia; bone scan negative (no osteoblastic activity) — use skeletal survey / PET-CT / MRI; ALP normal.

Mnemonic : Myeloma — "CRAB" (+ SLiM)
Calcium ↑ · Renal failure · Anemia (normocytic) · Bone lesions (lytic) — plus Sixty % marrow plasma cells, Light chain ratio ≥ 100, MRI > 1 focal lesion (myeloma-defining events).

- Diagnosis : clonal marrow plasma cells ≥ 10% + CRAB / SLiM; M-spike on serum protein electrophoresis (gamma region), serum immunofixation, serum free light chain ratio, 24-h urine (Bence Jones — heat test : precipitates at 40-60 °C, redissolves at 100 °C).
- Smear : rouleaux formation (↑ ESR); plasma cells (Mott cells — grape-like Russell bodies; flame cells (IgA); Dutcher bodies (intranuclear)).
- Myeloma kidney (cast nephropathy) : light chain casts with giant-cell reaction in distal tubules; also AL amyloid, hypercalcemia, light-chain deposition disease, Fanconi syndrome.
- Infections (↓ normal Ig — encapsulated bacteria) — most common cause of death.
- β2-microglobulin & albumin — ISS staging.

Related disorder	Key features
MGUS	M-protein < 3 g/dL, marrow plasma cells < 10%, no CRAB; 1% per year → myeloma ; most common plasma cell dyscrasia (> 50 y : 3%)
Smoldering myeloma	M-protein ≥ 3 g/dL or plasma cells 10-60%, no CRAB
Solitary plasmacytoma	Bone (→ myeloma) or extramedullary (upper respiratory tract — better)
Waldenström macroglobulinemia (lymphoplasmacytic lymphoma)	IgM M-protein → hyperviscosity (visual disturbance, retinal "sausage" veins, headache, bleeding), cryoglobulinemia, cold agglutinins; MYD88 L265P (> 90%); lymphadenopathy, hepatosplenomegaly; no lytic lesions; Dutcher bodies
POEMS syndrome	Polyneuropathy, Organomegaly, Endocrinopathy, M-protein (λ), Skin changes; osteosclerotic myeloma, ↑ VEGF
Heavy chain diseases	α (IPSID — Mediterranean), γ (Franklin), μ
Primary (AL) amyloidosis	λ light chains — see Amyloidosis

Filled : Rank boosters — leukemias

- Most common leukemia : children — ALL; adults (overall/India) — AML (acute), CML (chronic in India), CLL (West).
- Chloroma (myeloid sarcoma) — green colour due to MPO; orbit, t(8;21).
- Juvenile myelomonocytic leukemia — NF1, PTPN11 (Noonan), RAS; ↑ HbF, monocytosis.
- CMML — persistent monocytosis ≥ 1000/μL, MDS/MPN overlap.
- Transient abnormal myelopoiesis — Down neonates (GATA1), resolves; 20–30% later AML-M7.
- Tumour lysis syndrome — ↑ K^+, ↑ PO_4, ↑ uric acid, ↓ Ca^{2+} → AKI; Burkitt, ALL; rasburicase, allopurinol.
- Gingival hyperplasia : AML-M4/M5, phenytoin, cyclosporine, nifedipine.

LIVER, GALLBLADDER & BILIARY TRACT

Liver Architecture

Model	Description
Classic lobule	Hexagon — central vein at centre, portal tracts at corners
Acinus (Rappaport)	Functional unit — zone 1 (periportal — best O_2), zone 2 (midzonal), zone 3 (centrilobular — least O_2, most CYP450)

Zone	Injured by
Zone 1 (periportal)	Phosphorus, eclampsia (periportal fibrin), cocaine (some), viral hepatitis (interface), iron (hemochromatosis — first)
Zone 2	Yellow fever (Councilman bodies)
Zone 3 (centrilobular)	Ischemia/shock, right heart failure (nutmeg), acetaminophen, CCl_4, halothane, alcohol, Budd-Chiari

Liver function tests — patterns :

Pattern	Features	Examples
Hepatocellular	↑↑ ALT, AST (ALT > AST in viral hepatitis)	Viral, drug, ischemic (> 1000 U/L — ischemic, acetaminophen, viral)
Alcoholic	AST : ALT > 2 : 1, ↑ GGT	Alcoholic liver disease
Cholestatic	↑↑ ALP, GGT, conjugated bilirubin	Obstruction, PBC, PSC, drugs
Synthetic failure	↓ albumin, ↑ PT/INR (best acute marker)	Cirrhosis, acute liver failure

Jaundice & Bilirubin Metabolism

Senescent RBCs → heme → biliverdin → unconjugated bilirubin (macrophages)

↓

Bound to albumin → hepatocyte uptake (OATP)

↓

Conjugation by UGT1A1 (glucuronidation) → conjugated (water-soluble) bilirubin

↓

Excretion into bile (MRP2 — ATP-dependent; rate-limiting) → intestine → urobilinogen (10–20% enterohepatic) / stercobilin

Feature	Pre-hepatic (hemolytic)	Hepatic	Post-hepatic (obstructive)
Bilirubin	Unconjugated ↑	Both ↑	Conjugated ↑
Urine bilirubin	Absent (acholuric jaundice)	Present	Present (dark urine)
Urine urobilinogen	↑	↑ / variable	Absent / ↓
Stool	Dark	Normal / pale	Clay-coloured (pale)
ALP	Normal	Mild ↑	↑↑
Pruritus	Absent	±	Present (bile salts)

Hereditary hyperbilirubinemias :

Syndrome	Defect	Bilirubin	Key features
Gilbert syndrome	↓ UGT1A1 activity (TATA box promoter — A(TA)7TAA) ; AR	Unconjugated	Most common (3–10%); mild jaundice with fasting, stress, infection; benign; irinotecan toxicity
Crigler-Najjar type I	Absent UGT1A1 ; AR	Unconjugated (↑↑ > 20 mg/dL)	Kernicterus, fatal in infancy; phenobarbital — no response; liver transplant
Crigler-Najjar type II (Arias)	↓ UGT1A1 ; AR/AD	Unconjugated	Responds to phenobarbital; milder
Dubin-Johnson syndrome	MRP2 (ABCC2) — canalicular excretion ; AR	Conjugated	Black (dark) liver — epinephrine metabolite pigment in lysosomes (centrilobular); ↑ urinary coproporphyrin I (> 80%); GB not visualized on oral cholecystogram; benign
Rotor syndrome	OATP1B1/1B3 (hepatic uptake / storage) ; AR	Conjugated	Normal liver colour; milder; total urinary coproporphyrin ↑; GB visualized

Mnemonic : Conjugated hereditary hyperbilirubinemia

"Dubin-Johnson is Dark (black liver) · Rotor is Regular (normal) liver".

Neonatal jaundice :

- Physiological jaundice : appears after 24 h (day 2–3), peaks day 3–5, resolves by 2 weeks; immature UGT1A1, ↑ RBC turnover.
- Pathological : within 24 h (hemolysis — Rh/ABO, G6PD, HS), > 2 weeks (cholestasis), conjugated > 20% of total.
- Biliary atresia — most common cause of neonatal cholestasis requiring surgery / liver transplant in children; progressive fibro-obliterative destruction of extrahepatic bile ducts; ductular proliferation, bile plugs, portal fibrosis; Kasai portoenterostomy before 60 days.
- Neonatal hepatitis — multinucleated giant cell transformation of hepatocytes; α1-AT deficiency, CMV, idiopathic.

Viral Hepatitis

Feature	HAV	HBV	HCV	HDV	HEV
Virus	RNA (Picorna)	DNA (Hepadna) — partially dsDNA, reverse transcriptase	RNA (Flavi)	Defective RNA (needs HBsAg)	RNA (Hepe)
Transmission	Fecal-oral	Parenteral, sexual, perinatal (vertical — most common in endemic areas)	Parenteral (IV drug use — most common)	Parenteral	Fecal-oral (water-borne epidemics)
Incubation	2–6 weeks	2–26 weeks (longest)	4–26 weeks	Same as HBV	2–8 weeks
Chronicity	Never	5–10% adults; 90% neonates	> 80% (most likely to become chronic)	Superinfection — 80% chronic; coinfection — < 5%	Only in immunocompromised (genotype 3)
Fulminant	Rare	1%	Rare	Superinfection — highest risk	Pregnant women — 20% mortality (3rd trimester)
HCC	No	Yes (even without cirrhosis — integration)	Yes (with cirrhosis)	Yes	No
Vaccine	Yes	Yes	No	HBV vaccine	Yes (China)

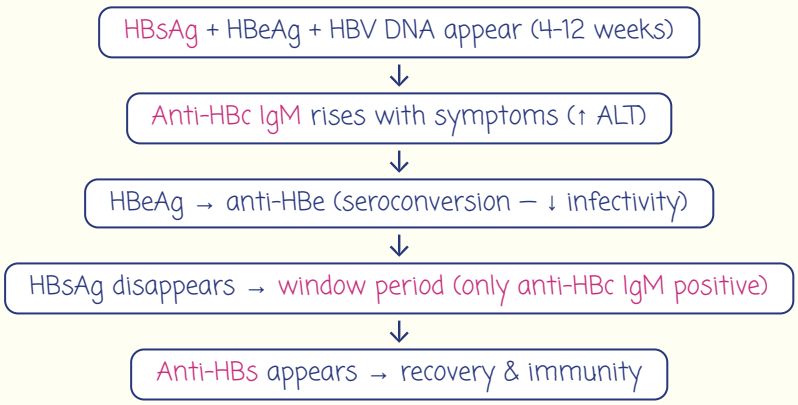
Exam pearl

- HEV — most common cause of acute viral hepatitis & acute liver failure in India; epidemics (Delhi 1955-56).
- HCV — extrahepatic : mixed cryoglobulinemia, MPGN, porphyria cutanea tarda, lichen planus, B-cell NHL, insulin resistance.
- HBV extrahepatic : PAN, membranous GN.
- HCV genotype 3 — most common in India (genotype 1 worldwide); steatosis with genotype 3.

HBV serology :

Marker	Significance
HBsAg	First marker to appear (before symptoms); > 6 months = chronic carrier
Anti-HBs	Immunity (recovery or vaccination); appears after HBsAg disappears
HBeAg	Active replication, high infectivity
Anti-HBc IgM	Acute infection — only marker during "window period"
Anti-HBc IgG	Past or chronic infection (not after vaccination)
HBV DNA	Viral load — most sensitive marker of replication (precore mutants — HBeAg – but DNA +)

HBV serologic course (acute, resolving)



Morphology of hepatitis :

Acute hepatitis	Chronic hepatitis
Ballooning degeneration, apoptotic hepatocytes (Councilman / acidophil bodies), lobular disarray, spotty necrosis, bridging necrosis (severe), cholestasis, Kupffer cell hyperplasia; mononuclear portal & lobular infiltrate	Portal inflammation, interface hepatitis (piecemeal necrosis), bridging fibrosis → cirrhosis; HBV : ground-glass hepatocytes (HBsAg in ER — Shikata orcein +), sanded nuclei (HBcAg); HCV : lymphoid aggregates / follicles in portal tracts, bile duct damage, macrovesicular steatosis

- Grading (inflammation) & staging (fibrosis) : METAVIR, Ishak, Batts-Ludwig; non-invasive : FibroScan (transient elastography), APRI, FIB-4.

Autoimmune & other hepatitis :

- Autoimmune hepatitis — young/middle-aged women; type 1 : ANA, anti-smooth muscle (anti-actin); type 2 (children) : anti-LKM1, anti-LC1; ↑ IgG; interface hepatitis with abundant plasma cells, rosettes, emperipolesis; steroid-responsive.
- Drug-induced liver injury : acetaminophen (zone 3 necrosis, NAPQI; antidote N-acetylcysteine), isoniazid (hepatitis — slow acetylators), halothane, amiodarone (Mallory bodies, phospholipidosis), OCPs (cholestasis, hepatic adenoma, Budd-Chiari), methotrexate (fibrosis), valproate (microvesicular), anabolic steroids (peliosis hepatis, adenoma), chlorpromazine (cholestasis).

Alcoholic & Fatty Liver Disease

Lesion	Morphology
Hepatic steatosis (fatty liver)	Macrovesicular — centrilobular first; reversible on abstinence; large, yellow, greasy liver
Alcoholic (steato)hepatitis	Hepatocyte ballooning, Mallory-Denk bodies (tangled cytokeratin 8 & 18 — eosinophilic cytoplasmic inclusions, ubiquitin +), neutrophilic infiltration (around ballooned cells — "satellitosis"), pericellular / perivenular "chicken-wire" fibrosis (zone 3), megamitochondria
Alcoholic cirrhosis	Micronodular (Laennec) — nodules < 3 mm, "hobnail liver"; later mixed / macronodular; brown, shrunken

- Mechanisms : acetaldehyde (adducts, lipid peroxidation), ↑ NADH → ↑ FA synthesis, ↓ β-oxidation, CYP2E1 → ROS, endotoxin (gut leak) → Kupffer TNF, ↓ GSH.
- Hepatic stellate (Ito) cells — main collagen producers (perisinusoidal space of Disse) → myofibroblasts (TGF-β).
- NAFLD / MASLD : metabolic syndrome, obesity, T2DM; steatosis → NASH (steatohepatitis — ballooning, Mallory bodies less common, lobular inflammation) → cirrhosis, HCC; most common chronic liver disease worldwide; PNPLA3 variant; ALT > AST.

Cirrhosis

- Diffuse process characterized by (1) bridging fibrous septa, (2) parenchymal nodules (regenerating hepatocytes encircled by fibrosis), (3) disruption of architecture of entire liver.

Type	Nodule size	Causes
Micronodular	< 3 mm, uniform	Alcohol, hemochromatosis, biliary obstruction, Wilson, venous outflow obstruction, ICC
Macronodular	> 3 mm, variable	Post-necrotic : chronic viral hepatitis (HBV, HCV), Wilson, α1-AT, autoimmune hepatitis
Mixed	Both	—

Causes of cirrhosis :

1. Alcohol (most common in West & North India — along with HBV)
2. Chronic viral hepatitis (HBV, HCV)
3. NAFLD / NASH (MASLD) — rising
4. Biliary — PBC, PSC, biliary atresia, secondary biliary
5. Metabolic — hemochromatosis, Wilson disease, α1-antitrypsin deficiency, galactosemia, tyrosinemia, glycogen storage
6. Autoimmune hepatitis
7. Vascular — Budd-Chiari, cardiac cirrhosis
8. Drugs (methotrexate), Indian childhood cirrhosis (copper), cryptogenic

Metabolic liver diseases :

Disease	Key features
Hereditary hemochromatosis	HFE (C282Y homozygous) — AR, chromosome 6; ↓ hepcidin → ↑ iron absorption; micronodular cirrhosis, DM, skin pigmentation (bronze diabetes), cardiomyopathy, arthropathy (2nd-3rd MCP), hypogonadism; ↑ transferrin saturation (> 45%), ↑ ferritin; hepatocyte & bile duct iron (Prussian blue); HCC (200×); phlebotomy
Wilson disease (hepatolenticular degeneration)	ATP7B — chromosome 13, AR → ↓ copper excretion into bile, ↓ incorporation into ceruloplasmin; liver (fatty change, acute/chronic hepatitis, cirrhosis), brain (basal ganglia — putamen atrophy/cavitation; dysarthria, tremor, psychiatric), eye (Kayser-Fleischer rings — Descemet membrane), hemolysis; ↓ ceruloplasmin, ↑ 24-h urine copper (> 100 μg), ↑ hepatic copper (> 250 μg/g dry weight — gold standard); rhodanine/orcein stain; penicillamine, trientine, zinc
α1-antitrypsin deficiency	PiZZ — PAS +, diastase-resistant globules in periportal hepatocytes; neonatal hepatitis, cirrhosis, HCC, panacinar emphysema

Disease	Key features
Indian childhood cirrhosis	Copper (brass vessels for milk); Mallory hyaline, pericellular fibrosis

Complications of cirrhosis / hepatic failure :

1. Portal hypertension — ascites, varices, splenomegaly, caput medusae
2. Hepatic encephalopathy (↑ ammonia) — asterixis (flapping tremor); Alzheimer type II astrocytes
3. Hepatorenal syndrome — functional renal failure (normal kidney morphology) — splanchnic vasodilation, renal vasoconstriction
4. Hepatopulmonary syndrome (intrapulmonary vasodilation — platypnea, orthodeoxia) & portopulmonary hypertension
5. Coagulopathy (↓ factors, ↑ PT), hypoalbuminemia
6. Hyperestrogenism — palmar erythema, spider angiomas (spider nevi), gynecomastia, testicular atrophy, hypogonadism
7. Jaundice, fetor hepaticus, spontaneous bacterial peritonitis (E. coli)
8. Hepatocellular carcinoma

Portal Hypertension

Site	Causes
Pre-hepatic	Portal vein thrombosis (neonatal umbilical sepsis, hypercoagulable, pancreatitis), splenic vein thrombosis, massive splenomegaly
Intrahepatic — presinusoidal	Schistosomiasis (pipe-stem fibrosis), non-cirrhotic portal fibrosis (NCPF / idiopathic portal HTN — India), congenital hepatic fibrosis, sarcoidosis, PBC (early)
Intrahepatic — sinusoidal	Cirrhosis (most common cause overall)
Intrahepatic — postsinusoidal	Sinusoidal obstruction syndrome (veno-occlusive disease — pyrrolizidine alkaloids, HSCT, busulfan)
Post-hepatic	Budd-Chiari syndrome (hepatic vein thrombosis — PV, PNH, OCPs, pregnancy, HCC; IVC web — India), right heart failure, constrictive pericarditis

- Non-cirrhotic portal fibrosis (NCPF) : young adults in India, massive splenomegaly, well-tolerated variceal bleeds, normal LFTs; obliterative portal venopathy (phlebosclerosis), no cirrhosis ; arsenic, infections, immunologic.
- Extrahepatic portal vein obstruction (EHPVO) — most common cause of portal HTN in Indian children; portal cavernoma.

Portosystemic collaterals :

Site	Veins	Result
Esophagus (lower end)	Left gastric (coronary) → azygos	Esophageal varices (bleeding — most important)
Rectum	Superior rectal → middle/inferior rectal	Anorectal varices
Umbilicus	Paraumbilical → epigastric	Caput medusae
Retroperitoneum	Retzius veins	—

- Ascites : SAAG ≥ 1.1 g/dL → portal HTN (transudate); < 1.1 → TB, malignancy, pancreatitis, nephrotic.

Biliary Diseases

Feature	Primary biliary cholangitis (PBC)	Primary sclerosing cholangitis (PSC)
Patients	Middle-aged women	Young men (30s)
Ducts	Small intrahepatic (interlobular) bile ducts	Intra- & extrahepatic, large ducts

Feature	Primary biliary cholangitis (PBC)	Primary sclerosing cholangitis (PSC)
Antibodies	Anti-mitochondrial antibody (AMA-M2 – PDC-E2) in 95%	p-ANCA (atypical, 65%)
Lesion	Florid duct lesion – lymphocytic, granulomatous destruction of interlobular ducts	Concentric "onion-skin" periductal fibrosis → fibro-obliterative "tombstone" scars
Imaging	Normal	"Beaded" appearance on MRCP / ERCP (strictures + dilatation)
Associations	Sjögren, scleroderma (CREST), thyroiditis, RA, celiac	Ulcerative colitis (70%)
Complications	Pruritus (first), xanthelasma, osteoporosis, ↑ ALP, ↑ IgM, cirrhosis	Cholangiocarcinoma (10-15%), cirrhosis, colon cancer
Treatment	Ursodeoxycholic acid, obeticholic acid	Liver transplant

- Secondary biliary cirrhosis – prolonged extrahepatic obstruction (stones, strictures, biliary atresia, pancreatic Ca); bile lakes, bile infarcts, bile ductular proliferation.
- Cholestasis morphology : bile plugs in canaliculi, feathery degeneration of hepatocytes, bile lakes.

Liver Tumours

Tumour	Key features
Metastasis	Most common malignant liver tumour (colon, breast, lung, pancreas); multiple nodules with central umbilication
Hemangioma (cavernous)	Most common benign liver tumour; subcapsular, blood-filled; avoid biopsy
Focal nodular hyperplasia (FNH)	Young women; central stellate scar with abnormal thick vessels; polyclonal, not neoplastic; not related to OCPs (mildly)
Hepatocellular adenoma	Young women on OCPs, anabolic steroids, GSD; subtypes : HNF1α-inactivated (steatotic), β-catenin activated (→ HCC risk!), inflammatory (IL-6/JAK-STAT, obesity); rupture & intraperitoneal hemorrhage (especially in pregnancy)
Hepatoblastoma	Most common liver tumour of childhood (< 3 y); fetal & embryonal epithelial cells ± mesenchymal (osteoid); WNT/β-catenin; FAP, Beckwith-Wiedemann; ↑ AFP
Angiosarcoma	Vinyl chloride, arsenic, Thorotrast
Cholangiocarcinoma	Liver fluke (Opisthorchis, Clonorchis), PSC, Caroli disease, choledochal cyst, HBV/HCV; adenocarcinoma with desmoplasia (CK7 +, CK19 +); Klatskin tumour – hilar (junction of hepatic ducts) ; CA 19-9

Hepatocellular carcinoma (HCC) :

Risk factors :

1. Chronic HBV infection (most common worldwide; Asia, Africa – HBx protein, integration) – HCC even without cirrhosis
2. Chronic HCV (with cirrhosis) – most common in West / Japan
3. Alcoholic cirrhosis, NAFLD/NASH
4. Aflatoxin B1 (Aspergillus flavus – TP53 codon 249 mutation)
5. Hereditary hemochromatosis, α1-AT deficiency, Wilson (less), tyrosinemia (very high)
6. Smoking, obesity, diabetes

- Morphology : unifocal / multifocal / diffusely infiltrative; vascular invasion (portal vein – "tumour thrombus"); trabecular (thick plates), pseudoglandular; bile production – pathognomonic for hepatocellular origin; Mallory bodies, hyaline globules.
- Markers : ↑ serum AFP (> 400 ng/mL in 50-75%), glypican-3, HepPar-1, arginase-1; des-γ-carboxy prothrombin (PIVKA-II).
- Paraneoplastic : hypoglycemia (IGF-2), erythrocytosis (EPO), hypercalcemia.

- Fibrolamellar carcinoma : young adults (20–40 y), no cirrhosis / no risk factors; large eosinophilic oncocytic cells in lamellar collagen bundles; DNAJB1–PRKACA fusion; AFP normal, ↑ neurotensin, ↑ vitamin B12–binding capacity; better prognosis.

Gallbladder

Cholelithiasis :

Feature	Cholesterol stones (80%, West)	Pigment stones
Composition	> 50% cholesterol monohydrate	Black (sterile gallbladder — calcium bilirubinate); brown (infected ducts — Asia; E. coli β-glucuronidase, Ascaris, Clonorchis)
Appearance	Pale yellow, hard, faceted; radiolucent (10–20% radiopaque)	Black — small, multiple, radiopaque (50–75%); brown — soft, greasy
Risk factors	"5 Fs" : female, fat, fertile, forty, fair; OCPs/estrogens, pregnancy, rapid weight loss, clofibrate, ileal disease (↓ bile salts), Native Americans (Pima), ABCG8	Chronic hemolysis (HS, sickle cell, thalassemia), cirrhosis, ileal disease, infection (brown)

- Pathogenesis (cholesterol) : supersaturation + gallbladder hypomotility + accelerated nucleation (mucin) + mucus hypersecretion.
- Cholesterolosis (strawberry gallbladder) — lipid-laden foamy macrophages in lamina propria.
- Mucocele / hydrops, porcelain gallbladder (calcified wall — ↑ carcinoma risk).

Cholecystitis :

- Acute calculous (90%) — stone obstructing neck / cystic duct → chemical irritation (lysolecithin) → secondary infection; Murphy sign.
- Acute acalculous (10%) — critically ill (sepsis, burns, trauma, post-op), diabetes, vasculitis — ischemia; higher mortality.
- Chronic cholecystitis — almost always with stones; Rokitansky-Aschoff sinuses (outpouchings of mucosa through muscle wall), wall thickening, lymphocytes.
- Xanthogranulomatous cholecystitis — mimics carcinoma.
- Complications : empyema, gangrene, perforation, cholecystoenteric fistula → gallstone ileus (Rigler triad), Mirizzi syndrome (stone in Hartmann pouch compressing CHD), ascending cholangitis (Charcot triad : fever, jaundice, RUQ pain; Reynolds pentad + shock + confusion).

Carcinoma of gallbladder :

- Most common malignancy of biliary tract; women (2×), > 60 y; India — North (Gangetic belt : UP, Bihar, West Bengal) — among highest incidence worldwide.
- Risk factors : gallstones (95%), porcelain GB, anomalous pancreaticobiliary duct junction, chronic typhoid carriers, adenomatous polyps > 1 cm, choledochal cyst, heavy metals.
- Adenocarcinoma (most common); fundus (60%); infiltrating (diffuse thickening) or exophytic; early direct spread to liver (segments IV, V); poor prognosis.
- Genetics : TP53, KRAS (less), ERBB2 amplification.

Filled : Rank boosters — liver

- Most common cause of acute liver failure : India — HEV / HBV; West — acetaminophen.
- Reye syndrome — aspirin in viral infection (influenza, varicella) in children → microvesicular steatosis + encephalopathy; mitochondrial dysfunction.
- Acute fatty liver of pregnancy — LCHAD deficiency in fetus, 3rd trimester, microvesicular.
- HELLP — hemolysis, elevated liver enzymes, low platelets (preeclampsia) — periportal fibrin deposition, hemorrhage.
- Peliosis hepatis — blood-filled cystic spaces — anabolic steroids, Bartonella (bacillary), OCPs.
- Nodular regenerative hyperplasia — non-cirrhotic portal HTN, no fibrosis — reticulin stain.
- Choledochal cyst — Todani type I (most common, fusiform CBD dilation); Caroli disease (type V — intrahepatic, ARPKD association).

LYMPH NODES, LYMPHOMAS, SPLEEN & THYMUS

Lymph Node — Structure & Reactive Patterns

Compartment	Cells	Reactive pattern & causes
Cortex — follicles (germinal centres)	B cells, follicular dendritic cells, tingible-body macrophages	Follicular hyperplasia : RA, toxoplasmosis, early HIV, syphilis
Paracortex	T cells, dendritic cells (high endothelial venules)	Paracortical hyperplasia : viral (EBV — infectious mononucleosis), drugs (phenytoin), post-vaccination
Medulla / sinuses	Macrophages (histiocytes), plasma cells	Sinus histiocytosis : nodes draining cancers, Rosai-Dorfman (emperipolesis, S100 +)

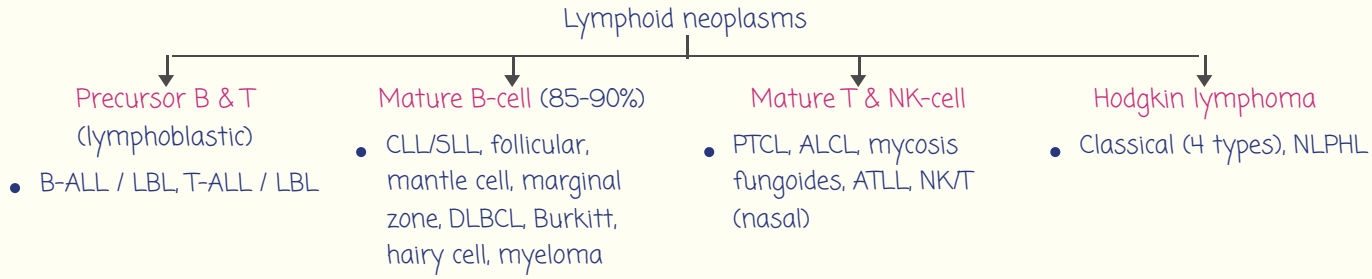
Reactive follicular hyperplasia vs follicular lymphoma :

Feature	Reactive hyperplasia	Follicular lymphoma
Follicles	Varying size & shape, in cortex	Uniform, back-to-back, throughout node
Mantle zone	Well-formed	Attenuated / absent
Germinal centre	Polarized (dark & light zones), tingible-body macrophages, many mitoses	No polarity, no tingible-body macrophages, few mitoses
BCL-2 in germinal centre	Negative	Positive (t(14;18))
Clonality	Polyclonal (κ & λ)	Monoclonal (light-chain restriction)

Lymphadenitis — specific :

Type	Key features
Acute nonspecific	Pyogenic — swollen, tender; neutrophils in follicles; abscess
Tuberculous	Caseating granulomas; cervical (scrofula); matted nodes, sinuses, collar-stud abscess
Sarcoidosis	Non-caseating granulomas, asteroid, Schaumann bodies
Toxoplasmosis (Piringer-Kuchinka)	Triad : follicular hyperplasia + small clusters of epithelioid histiocytes (encroaching on follicles) + monocytoid B-cell hyperplasia (sinuses)
Cat-scratch disease	Bartonella henselae — stellate (necrotizing) granulomas with central neutrophils (suppurative)
Kikuchi (histiocytic necrotizing) lymphadenitis	Young Asian women; paracortical necrosis with karyorrhectic debris, no neutrophils, crescentic histiocytes, plasmacytoid dendritic cells; self-limited; SLE mimic
Castleman disease	Hyaline-vascular (unicentric — "lollipop" follicles, onion-skin mantle); plasma cell / multicentric — HHV-8, IL-6 (POEMS)
Dermatopathic lymphadenitis	Melanin-laden macrophages + Langerhans cells — chronic skin disease
Kimura disease	Young Asian men, head & neck; eosinophils, ↑ IgE, follicular hyperplasia
HIV	Florid follicular hyperplasia → follicle lysis → lymphocyte depletion

Lymphoid Neoplasms — WHO Classification



Hodgkin vs Non-Hodgkin lymphoma :

Feature	Hodgkin lymphoma	Non-Hodgkin lymphoma
Nodes	Localized to single axial group (cervical, mediastinal, para-aortic)	Multiple peripheral nodes
Spread	Orderly, contiguous	Non-contiguous
Mesenteric nodes, Waldeyer ring	Rarely involved	Commonly involved
Extranodal	Uncommon	Common (40%)
Neoplastic cells	Rare (< 1-5%) Reed-Sternberg cells in reactive background	Sheets of neoplastic cells
B symptoms	Common (fever, night sweats, > 10% weight loss), Pel-Ebstein fever, alcohol-induced pain, pruritus	Less
Age	Bimodal (young adults & > 55 y)	Increasing with age

Hodgkin Lymphoma

- Reed-Sternberg cell (germinal centre B-cell origin) : large, bilobed / multinucleated ("mirror-image"), owl-eye eosinophilic nucleoli with perinucleolar halo.
- Immunophenotype (classical) : CD15 + , CD30 + , PAX5 (weak) +; CD45 (LCA) −, CD20 − (usually).
- EBV — mixed cellularity (70%), lymphocyte-depleted (HIV); NF-κB activation, JAK2/PD-L1 amplification (9p24).

Type	Frequency	Key features
Nodular sclerosis	Most common (65-70%); young women (adolescents)	Lacunar cells (RS variant — retraction of cytoplasm); collagen bands dividing node into nodules; mediastinal, cervical, supraclavicular; EBV − (rarely) ; excellent prognosis
Mixed cellularity	25%; most common in India / developing countries; men, > 50 y	Classic RS cells, mixed background (eosinophils, plasma cells, histiocytes); EBV + (70%); B symptoms; advanced stage
Lymphocyte-rich	5%	Reactive lymphocytes, classic RS; good prognosis
Lymphocyte-depleted	< 5%	Paucity of lymphocytes, abundant RS / pleomorphic variants; older, HIV, EBV +; worst prognosis
Nodular lymphocyte predominant (NLPHL)	5%	LP cells — "popcorn" (lymphohistiocytic) cells — multilobed nuclei; CD20 +, CD45 +, BCL6 +, CD15 −, CD30 −; EBV −; may transform to DLBCL ; not "classical"

Mnemonic : Hodgkin types

"Nodular sclerosis — Numero uno (most common), Lacunar" · "Mixed cellularity — Most EBV, Male" · "Lymphocyte Depleted — Deadliest" · "Popcorn — Predominant (NLPHL)".

- Staging : Ann Arbor (Lugano) — I (one node region), II (≥ 2 same side of diaphragm), III (both sides), IV (disseminated extranodal); A/B symptoms; bulky disease (X).
- Treatment : ABVD ± RT; late effects : secondary AML, breast cancer (RT), lung cancer, cardiac disease, hypothyroidism.

Non-Hodgkin Lymphomas — Key Entities

Lymphoma	Genetics	Immunophenotype	Key features
Follicular lymphoma	t(14;18) IGH-BCL2	CD10 +, BCL6 +, BCL2 +, CD20 +	Most common indolent NHL in West; > 50 y; painless generalized lymphadenopathy; centrocytes (cleaved) + centroblasts (grade by number); incurable but indolent; transforms to DLBCL
Diffuse large B-cell lymphoma (DLBCL)	BCL6 rearrangement (most common), BCL2, MYC ; double-hit (MYC + BCL2) — high-grade	CD20 +; GCB (CD10+) vs ABC (MUM1+, worse)	Most common NHL overall (& in India); rapidly enlarging mass, often extranodal (GIT, CNS); aggressive but curable (R-CHOP); EBV + in elderly / immunodeficient; primary mediastinal (thymic B) — young women
Burkitt lymphoma	t(8;14) IGH-MYC (also t(2;8), t(8;22))	CD10 +, BCL6 +, BCL2 −, Ki-67 ~100%	Endemic (Africa — jaw/orbit, EBV ~100%), sporadic (ileocecal, abdomen; EBV 15-20%), HIV-associated; starry-sky pattern (tingible-body macrophages); fastest growing human tumour; tumour lysis syndrome; children & young adults
Mantle cell lymphoma	t(11;14) IGH-CCND1 (cyclin D1)	CD5 +, CD23 −, cyclin D1 +, SOX11 +	Older men; generalized lymphadenopathy, splenomegaly, GI involvement — lymphomatous polyposis; aggressive, incurable
Marginal zone (MALT) lymphoma	t(11;18) API2-MALT1 (H. pylori-resistant), t(14;18) IGH-MALT1	CD5 −, CD10 −, CD20 +	Extranodal sites of chronic inflammation : stomach (H. pylori), salivary (Sjögren), thyroid (Hashimoto), orbit (Chlamydia psittaci), skin (Borrelia), small bowel (Campylobacter — IPSID); lymphoepithelial lesions; regresses with H. pylori eradication
SLL / CLL	del $13q_{}$ +12	CD5 +, CD23 +, CD20 dim	Proliferation centres
Lymphoplasmacytic (Waldenström)	MYD88 L265P	CD20 +, IgM	Hyperviscosity
Hairy cell leukemia	BRAF V600E	CD11c, CD25, CD103, annexin A1, TRAP	Splenomegaly, pancytopenia
Peripheral T-cell lymphoma, NOS	Heterogeneous	CD3 +, CD4 + often	Aggressive; most common T-cell lymphoma
Anaplastic large cell lymphoma (ALCL)	t(2;5) NPM-ALK (ALK + — children/young; better prognosis)	CD30 + (strong), ALK + / −	Hallmark cells (horseshoe / kidney-shaped nuclei, perinuclear eosinophilic Golgi); breast implant-associated ALCL (ALK −)
Extranodal NK/T-cell lymphoma (nasal type)	EBV +	CD56 +, CD3ε (cytoplasmic)	Asians; destructive midline facial lesion ("lethal midline granuloma"), angiocentric with necrosis
Enteropathy-associated T-cell lymphoma	—	CD3 + , CD103 +	Celiac disease — small bowel
Mycosis fungoides / Sézary	—	CD4 +	Pautrier microabscesses, cerebriform cells
Adult T-cell leukemia/lymphoma	HTLV-1 (Tax)	CD4 +, CD25 +	Hypercalcemia, skin, flower cells

Lymphoma	Genetics	Immunophenotype	Key features
Lymphoblastic lymphoma (T)	NOTCH1	TdT +, CD3 +	Adolescent males, mediastinal mass

Mnemonic : Lymphoma translocations — "8-14 Burkitt, 11-14 Mantle, 14-18 Follicular"

- Burkitt — t(8;14) MYC (8 = "B-for-8 / MYC drives fastest growth")
- Mantle — t(11;14) cyclin D1 ("11 players line the mantle")
- Follicular — t(14;18) BCL-2 ("18 = adult → indolent lymphoma of adults")
- MALT — t(11;18) API2-MALT1; ALCL — t(2;5) NPM-ALK; APL — t(15;17); CML — t(9;22).

Histiocytic & dendritic cell neoplasms :

- Langerhans cell histiocytosis — BRAF V600E (50%); CD1a, langerin (CD207), S100 +; Birbeck granules (tennis-racket shaped — EM); coffee-bean (grooved) nuclei, eosinophils.
  - Unifocal (eosinophilic granuloma) — lytic bone lesion (skull), older children/adults.
  - Multifocal unisystem (Hand-Schüller-Christian) — triad : calvarial defects, diabetes insipidus, exophthalmos.
  - Multisystem (Letterer-Siwe) — < 2 years, skin rash (seborrheic), hepatosplenomegaly, lymphadenopathy, pancytopenia — aggressive.
  - Pulmonary LCH — adult smokers.
- Hemophagocytic lymphohistiocytosis (HLH) — fever, cytopenias, splenomegaly, ↑↑ ferritin, ↑ triglycerides, ↓ fibrinogen, ↑ sCD25, hemophagocytosis; familial (perforin) or secondary (EBV, lymphoma).

Spleen

Splenomegaly — causes :

Category	Examples
Massive (> 1000 g / crosses midline)	CML, myelofibrosis, hairy cell leukemia, malaria (chronic — tropical splenomegaly syndrome), kala-azar, Gaucher, thalassemia major, NCPF, splenic lymphomas
Moderate (500-1000 g)	Portal HTN (congestive), acute leukemia, lymphomas, hemolytic anemias, IM, storage diseases
Mild (< 500 g)	Acute infections (typhoid, septicemia — "acute splenic tumour"), IE, SLE, RA (Felty), CHF

Mnemonic : Massive splenomegaly in India — "Kala-azar, CML, Malaria, Myelofibrosis, Thal"

"Kill Cows Make More Troubles" — Kala-azar · CML · Malaria · Myelofibrosis · Thalassemia (+ NCPF, hairy cell, Gaucher).

- Hypersplenism : splenomegaly + cytopenias + compensatory marrow hyperplasia → corrected by splenectomy.
- Splenic infarcts — emboli (IE), sickle cell, CML, myelofibrosis — pale, wedge-shaped, subcapsular.
- Gamna-Gandy bodies — congestive splenomegaly, sickle cell (iron + calcium on fibrous tissue).
- Sago spleen (amyloid in follicles) / lardaceous spleen (red pulp) — amyloidosis.
- Spontaneous rupture — infectious mononucleosis, malaria, typhoid, leukemia.
- Post-splenectomy : Howell-Jolly bodies, target cells, Pappenheimer bodies, thrombocytosis, leukocytosis; OPSI (overwhelming post-splenectomy infection — S. pneumoniae, H. influenzae, N. meningitidis) — vaccinate; babesiosis, malaria severe.
- Asplenia / polysplenia — heterotaxy syndromes (Ivemark), congenital heart disease.
- Accessory spleen (splenunculus) — 20-35%; hilum — causes relapse after splenectomy for ITP.
- Most common primary splenic tumour : hemangioma; malignant : lymphoma (splenic marginal zone — villous lymphocytes).

Thymus

Lesion	Key features
Thymic hypoplasia / aplasia	DiGeorge syndrome (22q11 — 3rd & 4th pouches) — T-cell deficiency, hypocalcemia, cardiac defects
Thymic atrophy	Physiological after puberty (fatty involution); stress, steroids, malnutrition, HIV
Thymic (follicular) hyperplasia	Lymphoid follicles with germinal centres — myasthenia gravis (65–75%), Graves, SLE, RA
Thymoma	Neoplasm of thymic epithelial cells + non-neoplastic immature T cells; > 40 y; anterior mediastinum (most common anterior mediastinal mass in adults); WHO types A (spindle — best), AB, B1, B2, B3 (worst); thymic carcinoma (C — SCC, CD5 + , KIT +) ; invasion (capsule) = most important prognostic factor
Thymic carcinoma	Cytologically malignant; CD5, CD117 +; aggressive

Thymoma — paraneoplastic associations :

1. Myasthenia gravis (30–45% of thymomas; 10–15% of MG patients have thymoma) — anti-AChR
2. Pure red cell aplasia
3. Hypogammaglobulinemia (Good syndrome)
4. SLE, polymyositis, Cushing, paraneoplastic encephalitis, GVHD-like (thymoma-associated multiorgan autoimmunity)

> Exam pearl
>
> - Anterior mediastinal masses — "4 Ts" : Thymoma, Teratoma (germ cell), Thyroid (retrosternal goitre), Terrible lymphoma (Hodgkin NS, lymphoblastic).
> - Middle mediastinum : lymph nodes, bronchogenic cysts, pericardial cysts. Posterior : neurogenic tumours (schwannoma, neuroblastoma in children), esophageal.

FEMALE GENITAL TRACT & BREAST

Cervix

Cervicitis :

- Acute – Chlamydia trachomatis (most common bacterial STI), N. gonorrhoeae, HSV, Trichomonas (strawberry cervix), Mycoplasma genitalium.
- Chronic cervicitis – nabothian cysts (blocked endocervical glands), squamous metaplasia, endocervical polyps (most common cervical growth).
- Transformation zone – junction of ectocervical squamous and endocervical columnar epithelium; site of squamous metaplasia and > 90% of cervical neoplasia.

HPV & cervical neoplasia :

- High-risk HPV 16 (most common – SCC), 18 (adenocarcinoma, small cell), 31, 33, 45, 52, 58; low-risk 6, 11 → condyloma acuminatum.
- E6 degrades p53 (via E6AP ubiquitin ligase); E7 binds RB → releases E2F; also E7 ↑ cyclin; p16 overexpression (surrogate marker of high-risk HPV); viral integration into host genome (high-risk).
- Cofactors : early first intercourse, multiple partners, smoking (most important cofactor), immunosuppression (HIV), long-term OCPs, high parity, Chlamydia.

Natural history

HPV infection (mostly transient – cleared in 1-2 y)
↓
Koilocytes – perinuclear halo, raisinoid (wrinkled) hyperchromatic nuclei, binucleation
↓
LSIL (CIN I) – dysplasia in lower 1/3 ; regresses in 60%
↓
HSIL (CIN II, III) – dysplasia in lower 2/3 / full thickness (CIS) ; p16 block positivity
↓
Invasive carcinoma – takes ~10-20 years (window for screening)

Cervical carcinoma :

Type	Frequency	Key features
Squamous cell carcinoma	~75-80% (most common)	HPV 16; large cell non-keratinizing (most common); peak 45 y; 2nd most common cancer in Indian women
Adenocarcinoma	~15-20% (rising)	HPV 18; adenocarcinoma in situ ; less detected by Pap
Adenosquamous, neuroendocrine (small cell)	Rare	HPV 18; aggressive

- Clinical : post-coital bleeding (most common early symptom), intermenstrual bleeding, discharge; advanced – ureteric obstruction → hydronephrosis, uremia (most common cause of death), fistulae.
- Staging : FIGO (2018) – imaging & pathology allowed; stage IIIC – pelvic / para-aortic nodes.

Screening & prevention :

1. Pap smear (exfoliative cytology) – Bethesda system 2014 : NILM, ASC-US, ASC-H, LSIL, HSIL, AGC, SCC; sample from transformation zone (Ayre spatula + cytobrush)
2. HPV DNA testing (primary screening – preferred, from 30 y every 5 y); co-testing

3. VIA (visual inspection with acetic acid — acetowhite areas) & VILI (Lugol's iodine — Schiller test; abnormal areas iodine-negative / mustard-yellow) — low-resource settings (India)
4. Colposcopy & directed biopsy
5. HPV vaccination — bivalent (16, 18), quadrivalent (6, 11, 16, 18 — Gardasil), nonavalent (+31, 33, 45, 52, 58), Cervavac (India — qHPV); 9-14 y — 2 doses (single dose also endorsed by WHO)

Filled

- WHO 90-70-90 target (2030) : 90% girls vaccinated by 15 y; 70% women screened by 35 & 45 y; 90% treated.
- Pap stain : Papanicolaou (EA-36 / OG-6 / hematoxylin) — alcohol (95% ethanol) fixation; liquid-based cytology (ThinPrep, SurePath) — fewer unsatisfactory smears, allows HPV testing.
- Clue cells (bacterial vaginosis — Gardnerella), "cottage cheese" pseudohyphae (Candida), pear-shaped flagellate (Trichomonas) on Pap.

Uterus — Endometrium

Menstrual cycle histology :

Phase	Days	Hormones	Histology
Menstrual	1-4	↓ E & P	Fragmented glands, stromal breakdown ("blue balls" — stromal clusters), fibrin thrombi
Proliferative	5-14	Estrogen	Straight → tubular glands, pseudostratified nuclei, mitoses in glands & stroma
Early secretory (ovulation + 48 h)	Day 16-17	Progesterone	Subnuclear vacuoles (earliest histologic evidence of ovulation — day 17)
Mid secretory	Day 18-22	Progesterone	Supranuclear vacuoles, intraluminal secretion (peak day 21-22), stromal edema
Late secretory	Day 23-28	Progesterone ↓	Saw-toothed glands, predecidual change (around spiral arteries, day 23), stromal neutrophils & granular lymphocytes

- Arias-Stella reaction — hypersecretory glands with large hyperchromatic nuclei — pregnancy (intrauterine or ectopic).
- Endometrial dating — premenstrual biopsy for luteal phase defect (infertility).

Abnormal uterine bleeding & endometrial lesions :

Lesion	Key features
Anovulatory cycle	Most common cause of dysfunctional uterine bleeding (menarche, perimenopause, PCOS) — unopposed estrogen
Acute endometritis	Post-partum / post-abortion, retained products; Group A strep, Staph
Chronic endometritis	Plasma cells in endometrial stroma (diagnostic); IUD, PID, retained POC; TB (granulomas in late secretory — infertility, India)
Endometrial polyp	Dilated glands, thick-walled vessels; tamoxifen
Adenomyosis	Endometrial glands & stroma within myometrium (> 2.5 mm / half low-power field below endometrium); diffusely enlarged, globular, boggy uterus; multiparous women 40s; menorrhagia, dysmenorrhea
Endometriosis	Endometrial glands & stroma outside uterus — ovary (most common — "chocolate cyst / endometrioma"), uterine ligaments, rectovaginal septum, pouch of Douglas, pelvic peritoneum (powder-burn, gunpowder lesions); infertility, dysmenorrhea, dyspareunia, pelvic pain; theories : regurgitation (Sampson — retrograde menstruation), metaplasia (coelomic), benign metastasis, extrauterine stem cells; ↑ estrogen (aromatase), PGE_2; ARID1A — risk of endometrioid & clear cell ovarian carcinoma

Endometrial hyperplasia :

- Unopposed estrogen : obesity (peripheral aromatization), PCOS, estrogen-secreting tumours (granulosa cell), estrogen therapy, anovulation, tamoxifen.
- WHO 2014 : (1) hyperplasia without atypia (1-3% progress), (2) atypical hyperplasia / endometrioid intraepithelial neoplasia (EIN — 25-40% progress to carcinoma).
- ↑ gland:stroma ratio (crowded glands); atypia = nuclear enlargement, rounding, loss of polarity, nucleoli. PTEN loss (early event).

Endometrial carcinoma :

- Most common invasive gynaecological cancer in developed countries; postmenopausal bleeding (cardinal symptom).

Feature	Type I (endometrioid)	Type II (serous)
Frequency	80%	15%
Age	55-65 y (perimenopausal)	65-75 y (older)
Setting	Unopposed estrogen, obesity, DM, HTN, infertility, nulliparity, Lynch syndrome	Endometrial atrophy ; thin elderly
Precursor	Atypical hyperplasia (EIN)	Serous endometrial intraepithelial carcinoma (SEIC)
Genetics	PTEN (most common), PIK3CA, KRAS, ARID1A, MSI (MMR), CTNNB1	TP53 (> 90%), ERBB2, PPP2R1A
Histology	Gland-forming, resembles endometrium; squamous morules	Papillae, high-grade nuclei, psammoma bodies ; clear cell carcinoma also type II
Behaviour	Indolent, good prognosis	Aggressive, spreads via fallopian tubes to peritoneum, poor

- TCGA molecular groups : POLE ultramutated (best prognosis), MSI-hypermutated, copy-number low, copy-number high (p53 abnormal — worst).
- Protective : OCPs, smoking (anti-estrogenic), parity.

Myometrial tumours :

Feature	Leiomyoma (fibroid)	Leiomyosarcoma
Frequency	Most common tumour in women (30-50% of reproductive-age women); most common benign uterine tumour	Rare; arises de novo (not from leiomyoma — practically)
Genetics	MED12 (70%), HMGA2; FH (HLRCC — fumarate hydratase)	Complex karyotype, TP53, RB
Gross	Well-circumscribed, firm, grey-white, whorled (trabeculated) cut surface; multiple; intramural (most common), submucosal (bleeding, infertility), subserosal	Soft, fleshy, hemorrhagic, necrotic, infiltrative; solitary; postmenopausal
Microscopy	Bundles of uniform smooth muscle cells, "whorled"; rare mitoses	Atypia, ↑ mitoses (≥ 10/10 HPF), coagulative tumour cell necrosis — (2 of 3 = malignant)
Hormone	Estrogen-dependent — grow in pregnancy, regress after menopause	—

- Degenerations of fibroid : hyaline (most common), cystic, myxoid, red (carneous) degeneration — pregnancy (hemorrhagic infarction), calcific (postmenopausal), sarcomatous (< 0.1%).
- Variants : cellular, bizarre (symplastic), lipoleiomyoma, intravenous leiomyomatosis, benign metastasizing leiomyoma, disseminated peritoneal leiomyomatosis.
- Endometrial stromal sarcoma (low grade — JAZF1-SUZ12, "tongue-like" myometrial invasion, worm-like plugs in vessels); carcinosarcoma (malignant mixed Müllerian tumour — MMMT).

Gestational Trophoblastic Disease

Feature	Complete mole	Partial mole
Karyotype	46,XX (90% — androgenetic, empty egg + duplicated sperm); 46,XY (dispermy)	Triploid 69,XXY / XXX (normal egg + 2 sperm)
Fetal parts	Absent	Present (fetus with anomalies)
Villi	All villi hydropic (swollen) — "bunch of grapes"; central cisterns	Some villi hydropic; scalloped villi with trophoblastic inclusions
Trophoblast proliferation	Diffuse, circumferential	Focal, mild
p57 (KIP2) immunostain	Negative (paternally imprinted, maternally expressed)	Positive
β-hCG	Markedly ↑↑	Mildly ↑
Uterus	Large for dates	Small / normal
Complications	Persistent GTD (15–20%), choriocarcinoma (2–3%), theca-lutein cysts, hyperemesis, preeclampsia < 20 weeks, hyperthyroidism (hCG — TSH-like)	Persistent GTD (5%), choriocarcinoma rare

Lesion	Key features
Invasive mole	Hydropic villi penetrate myometrium ; locally destructive; may embolize (lung) but no true metastasis
Gestational choriocarcinoma	50% after complete mole, 25% abortion, 22% normal pregnancy, ectopic; sheets of malignant cytotrophoblast + syncytiotrophoblast with NO chorionic villi, extensive hemorrhage & necrosis; very high β-hCG; early hematogenous metastasis — lungs (50%, cannonball), vagina, brain, liver; highly chemosensitive (methotrexate — cure ~100%)
Placental site trophoblastic tumour (PSTT)	Intermediate (implantation-site) trophoblast; hPL + , low β-hCG; chemoresistant — hysterectomy
Epithelioid trophoblastic tumour	Chorionic-type intermediate trophoblast

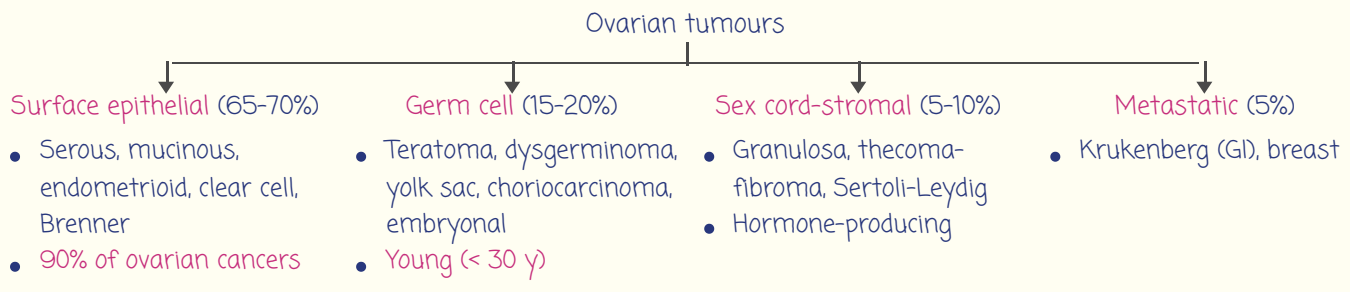
- Non-gestational (ovarian / testicular) choriocarcinoma — germ cell origin; chemoresistant (poorer response).

Ovary

Non-neoplastic cysts :

- Follicular cysts (most common), corpus luteum cysts (hemorrhage), theca lutein cysts (hCG — mole, choriocarcinoma, multiple pregnancy).
- Polycystic ovarian syndrome (PCOS) : hyperandrogenism, oligo-/anovulation, polycystic ovaries (Rotterdam : 2 of 3); ↑ LH:FSH (> 2:1), insulin resistance, obesity, hirsutism, endometrial hyperplasia / carcinoma risk; enlarged ovaries with thick capsule ("oyster" ovaries), multiple subcapsular follicular cysts (> 20, "string of pearls"), hyperthecosis.

Ovarian tumours — classification :



Surface epithelial tumours :

Tumour	Key features
Serous tumours	Most common ovarian epithelial tumour (benign & malignant); bilateral (malignant 65%); ciliated tubal-type epithelium; psammoma bodies; CA-125 ↑, WT1 +, PAX8 +
Low-grade serous carcinoma	KRAS, BRAF; from serous borderline tumour; indolent
High-grade serous carcinoma (HGSC)	Most common ovarian cancer (70%); TP53 (~100%), BRCA1/2 (germline/somatic), HRD; origin from fallopian tube fimbria — STIC (serous tubal intraepithelial carcinoma); aggressive, peritoneal spread; PARP inhibitors (olaparib)
Mucinous tumours	Large, multiloculated, unilateral (95%); KRAS; can be massive (> 20 kg); pseudomyxoma peritonei — usually from appendix (low-grade appendiceal mucinous neoplasm); CK7 + / CK20 + (primary) — exclude GI metastasis (bilateral, CK20 +, CDX2 +)
Endometrioid carcinoma	Endometriosis-associated (15–20%); PTEN, ARID1A, CTNNB1, MSI; synchronous endometrial carcinoma (15–30%)
Clear cell carcinoma	Endometriosis-associated; ARID1A, PIK3CA; hobnail cells, clear glycogen-rich cytoplasm; hypercalcemia, thrombosis; Napsin A + , HNF-1β +
Brenner tumour	Transitional (urothelial-like) epithelium nests with "coffee-bean" nuclei in fibrous stroma; usually benign, unilateral

- Risk factors for ovarian carcinoma : nulliparity, BRCA1 (40–50% lifetime) / BRCA2 (10–20%), Lynch syndrome, family history, endometriosis, talc, HRT; protective : OCPs (most important), multiparity, breastfeeding, tubal ligation, salpingectomy.

Germ cell tumours :

Tumour	Key features	Marker
Mature cystic teratoma (dermoid cyst)	Most common ovarian tumour overall (and most common benign tumour of young women); unilocular cyst with hair, sebum, teeth, bone, cartilage; Rokitansky protuberance (dermoid plug); bilateral 10–15%; 46,XX (parthenogenetic — meiosis I error); complications : torsion (most common), rupture, malignant transformation (SCC — elderly), anti-NMDA encephalitis	—
Struma ovarii	Monodermal teratoma — mature thyroid tissue → hyperthyroidism	—
Ovarian carcinoid	Monodermal; carcinoid syndrome without liver metastasis	5-HIAA
Immature teratoma	Immature neuroepithelium (rosettes, primitive tubules) — grade by amount	AFP (mild)
Dysgerminoma	Most common malignant germ cell tumour; counterpart of seminoma; young (2nd–3rd decade); bilateral (10–15%); sheets of large clear cells with fibrous septa infiltrated by lymphocytes (± granulomas); OCT3/4, SALL4, PLAP, CD117 +; gonadal dysgenesis (Swyer, Turner with Y), radiosensitive	LDH, PLAP
Yolk sac (endodermal sinus) tumour	Most common malignant germ cell tumour in children (testis); Schiller-Duval bodies (glomeruloid — central vessel enveloped by germ cells within a space), hyaline globules (PAS + , diastase resistant, AFP +), reticular pattern	AFP
Choriocarcinoma (non-gestational)	Cyto + syncytiotrophoblast, no villi; chemoresistant	β-hCG
Embryonal carcinoma	Primitive large cells; CD30 +	AFP, hCG

Sex cord-stromal tumours :

Tumour	Key features	Hormone / marker
Adult granulosa cell tumour	Postmenopausal women; FOXL2 (C134W — ~100%); Call-Exner bodies (small follicle-like spaces with eosinophilic secretion), coffee-bean (grooved) nuclei; estrogen → endometrial hyperplasia / carcinoma, precocious puberty (juvenile type); late recurrence	Estrogen; inhibin, FOXL2, calretinin, SF-1
Thecoma	Lipid-laden theca cells; estrogen	Estrogen
Fibroma	Meigs syndrome — ovarian fibroma + ascites + right-sided hydrothorax (resolves after removal); Gorlin syndrome (PTCH)	Inactive
Sertoli-Leydig cell tumour (androblastoma)	Young women; DICER1; virilization (hirsutism, clitoromegaly, amenorrhea); Reinke crystals (Leydig cells)	Androgens
Sex cord tumour with annular tubules (SCTAT)	Peutz-Jeghers	—
Steroid (lipid) cell tumour	Virilization	Androgens

Metastatic tumours :

- Krukenberg tumour — bilateral ovarian metastasis of mucin-producing signet ring cells, primary : stomach (most common), colon, breast (lobular), appendix; transcoelomic / lymphatic; pseudosarcomatous stroma.

> Mnemonic : Ovarian tumour markers
>
> "AFP — Yolk sac · hCG — Chorio · LDH — Dysgerminoma · Inhibin — Granulosa · CA-125 — Serous · CEA / CA 19-9 — Mucinous".

Fallopian Tube & PID

- Pelvic inflammatory disease (PID) — ascending infection : N. gonorrhoeae, C. trachomatis (most common), polymicrobial (post-abortion/postpartum — staph, strep, anaerobes); acute salpingitis → pyosalpinx → tubo-ovarian abscess → hydrosalpinx (chronic).
- Complications : infertility (tubal), ectopic pregnancy (most important risk factor — previous PID/salpingitis), chronic pelvic pain, Fitz-Hugh-Curtis (perihepatitis — "violin-string" adhesions).
- Salpingitis isthmica nodosa — diverticula of tube (infertility, ectopic).
- Ectopic pregnancy — ampulla (most common site); Arias-Stella reaction in endometrium, decidual cast; rupture at 2-6 weeks.

Genital tuberculosis :

- Almost always secondary (hematogenous from lungs); fallopian tubes involved in nearly 100% → endometrium (50-60%), ovaries, cervix.
- Important cause of infertility in India (~5-10%); amenorrhea, Asherman syndrome (intrauterine adhesions).
- Morphology : tubercles, caseation, tobacco-pouch tubal blockage, beaded tubes, "lead-pipe" tubes on HSG; endometrial biopsy in premenstrual phase (granulomas best seen in late secretory endometrium); menstrual blood culture / CBNAAT.

Vulva & Vagina

Lesion	Key features
Lichen sclerosus	Thin "parchment-like" white plaques, homogenized dermal collagen + band-like lymphocytes; postmenopausal; slight ↑ SCC risk
Lichen simplex chronicus	Squamous hyperplasia (acanthosis, hyperkeratosis)
Vulvar SCC	HPV-related (younger — basaloid/warty; VIN usual type) vs HPV-independent (older — lichen sclerosus, differentiated VIN, TP53)

Lesion	Key features
Extramammary Paget disease	Vulva; large pale cells with mucin (PAS +, CK7 +) in epidermis; usually no underlying carcinoma (vs breast)
Bartholin cyst / abscess	Duct obstruction; gonococcal
Clear cell adenocarcinoma of vagina	DES exposure in utero — vaginal adenosis precursor
Sarcoma botryoides (embryonal rhabdomyosarcoma)	Girls < 5 y; grape-like polypoid mass; cambium layer (subepithelial condensation of tumour cells); desmin, myogenin +

Breast

Inflammatory & benign lesions :

Lesion	Key features
Acute mastitis / breast abscess	Lactation (first month) — S. aureus (abscess), streptococci (cellulitis) via nipple cracks
Periductal mastitis (subareolar abscess, Zuska)	Smokers, keratinizing squamous metaplasia of lactiferous ducts → keratin plug → recurrent subareolar abscess, fistula
Duct ectasia (plasma cell mastitis)	Perimenopausal multiparous women; dilated ducts with inspissated secretions, periductal plasma cells; nipple retraction (mimics carcinoma)
Fat necrosis	Trauma / surgery; painless firm mass, skin retraction, calcification (mimics carcinoma) ; foamy macrophages, giant cells
Granulomatous mastitis	Idiopathic, TB, sarcoid; Corynebacterium kroppenstedtii (cystic neutrophilic)

Fibrocystic changes :

Category	Lesions	Relative risk of carcinoma
Non-proliferative	Cysts (blue-domed), apocrine metaplasia, fibrosis, adenosis	No increase (1.0)
Proliferative without atypia	Usual ductal hyperplasia (epithelial hyperplasia), sclerosing adenosis, papilloma, complex sclerosing lesion (radial scar), fibroadenoma (complex)	1.5–2×
Proliferative with atypia	Atypical ductal hyperplasia (ADH), atypical lobular hyperplasia (ALH)	4–5× (both breasts)
Carcinoma in situ	DCIS (8–10×, same breast), LCIS (8–10×, both breasts)	—

- Sclerosing adenosis — ↑ acini compressed by stroma, myoepithelial layer preserved; mimics carcinoma (radiologically calcified).
- Radial scar — central nidus of entrapped glands in hyalinized stroma with radiating ducts — mimics carcinoma.
- Intraductal papilloma — most common cause of bloody (serous/sanguineous) nipple discharge in women < 50 y; large ducts beneath areola; fibrovascular cores with myoepithelial layer.

Fibroadenoma vs phyllodes :

Feature	Fibroadenoma	Phyllodes tumour
Age	Young (< 30 y — most common benign breast tumour in young women)	Older (6th decade)
Size	Small (2–3 cm), "breast mouse" — highly mobile	Larger, rapid growth
Histology	Intracanalicular (compressed slit-like ducts) / pericanalicular (round ducts); stroma bland, low cellularity	Leaf-like (phyllodes) projections lined by epithelium into cystic spaces; hypercellular stroma with atypia & mitoses
Genetics	MED12 (stromal)	MED12, TERT promoter

Feature	Fibroadenoma	Phyllodes tumour
Behaviour	Benign; juvenile fibroadenoma (adolescents); grows in pregnancy	Benign, borderline, malignant; local recurrence (wide excision); malignant — hematogenous metastasis (not lymphatic)

Carcinoma breast — epidemiology & risk factors :

- Most common cancer in women worldwide & India (overtook cervix); most common cancer overall worldwide (GLOBOCAN 2020).

Risk factors :

1. Female sex, ↑ age (most important)
2. Germline mutations — BRCA1 (17q21 — triple-negative, medullary-like, ovary), BRCA2 (13q12 — male breast, ER +), TP53 (Li-Fraumeni), PTEN (Cowden), CHEK2, ATM, PALB2, CDH1 (lobular), STK11
3. Family history — first-degree relatives
4. Prolonged estrogen exposure — early menarche (< 11 y), late menopause (> 55 y), nulliparity, late first full-term pregnancy (> 30 y), no breastfeeding
5. Postmenopausal obesity (aromatization), alcohol, HRT (estrogen + progestin)
6. Proliferative breast disease with atypia, carcinoma in situ
7. Radiation to chest (Hodgkin lymphoma — mantle field)
8. Contralateral breast carcinoma / endometrial carcinoma, ↑ breast density

- Most common site : upper outer quadrant (50%); left > right.

Carcinoma in situ :

Feature	DCIS (ductal)	LCIS (lobular)
Detection	Mammographic microcalcifications	Incidental (no calcification, no mass)
Patterns	Comedo (central necrosis, high grade, calcification), cribriform, solid, papillary, micropapillary	Uniform, small, discohesive cells filling & distending acini
E-cadherin	Positive	Negative (CDH1 loss)
Risk	Invasive carcinoma in same breast, same quadrant	Both breasts equally (risk marker + precursor)
Paget disease of nipple	Extension of DCIS (underlying carcinoma in ~100%) into nipple epidermis — eczematous, scaly nipple; large cells with clear halo (PAS +, CK7 +, HER2 +)	—

Invasive carcinoma — histologic types :

Type	Frequency	Key features
Invasive carcinoma of no special type (ductal, NST)	Most common (70-80%)	Hard, gritty, "cut like an unripe pear", chalky streaks, desmoplasia (scirrhous); skin retraction, nipple retraction, peau d'orange (dermal lymphatic block), fixation
Invasive lobular carcinoma	10%	Single-file ("Indian-file") discohesive cells, targetoid (concentric) around ducts, signet ring cells; E-cadherin –; bilateral, multicentric; metastasizes to peritoneum, retroperitoneum, GIT, ovaries (Krukenberg), meninges; ER +
Medullary pattern (now "NST with medullary features")	< 5%	Syncytial sheets of large pleomorphic cells, pushing borders, prominent lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate; BRCA1, triple-negative; better prognosis than NST
Mucinous (colloid) carcinoma	2%	Older women; tumour cells floating in pools of mucin; soft, gelatinous; good prognosis
Tubular carcinoma	2%	Well-formed angulated tubules with single layer, apical snouts, no myoepithelium; excellent prognosis

Type	Frequency	Key features
Inflammatory carcinoma	Clinical	Dermal lymphatic tumour emboli → erythema, edema, peau d'orange (> 1/3 of breast); T4d — worst prognosis
Metaplastic carcinoma	Rare	Triple-negative; squamous / spindle

Molecular classification :

Subtype	Markers	Features
Luminal A	ER + , PR + , HER2 −, low Ki-67	Most common (40-55%), best prognosis, endocrine therapy
Luminal B	ER +, (PR low), HER2 ± , high Ki-67	Worse than A
HER2-enriched	ER −, PR −, HER2 + (amplified)	Aggressive; trastuzumab, pertuzumab, T-DM1
Triple-negative / basal-like	ER −, PR −, HER2 −; CK5/6, EGFR +	BRCA1, young, African-American women; aggressive; chemo, PARP inhibitors, pembrolizumab

- HER2 testing : IHC 3+ positive; 2+ equivocal → FISH (HER2/CEP17 ratio ≥ 2).

Prognostic factors :

1. Lymph node status (most important prognostic factor in absence of distant metastasis) — axillary nodes; sentinel node biopsy
2. Tumour size
3. Distant metastasis (bone > lung > liver > brain)
4. Histologic grade (Nottingham — tubule formation, nuclear pleomorphism, mitoses)
5. ER/PR status (predictive), HER2 status, Ki-67, lymphovascular invasion, Oncotype DX (21-gene recurrence score)
6. Inflammatory carcinoma, locally advanced disease

Filled : Rank boosters — breast

- Male breast cancer — BRCA2, Klinefelter, gynecomastia (not premalignant), estrogen exposure; mostly ER +.
- Gynecomastia — puberty, aging, cirrhosis (hyperestrogenism), Klinefelter, drugs (spironolactone, digoxin, cimetidine, ketoconazole), testicular tumours (hCG — Leydig); ductal epithelial hyperplasia with micropapillary tufts + periductal edematous stroma.
- Mammography : clustered pleomorphic microcalcifications, spiculated mass — BI-RADS.
- Triple assessment : clinical + imaging + FNAC / core biopsy.
- Phyllodes metastasizes via blood (lungs), not lymphatics — axillary dissection not needed.
- Secretory carcinoma — ETV6-NTRK3; adenoid cystic — MYB-NFIB (triple-negative but good prognosis).

MALE GENITAL TRACT

Penis

Lesion	Key features
Condyloma acuminatum	HPV 6, 11 — koilocytes; benign; giant condyloma (Buschke-Löwenstein — verrucous)
Bowen disease	SCC in situ of penile shaft / scrotum — solitary grey-white plaque; older men
Erythroplasia of Queyrat	SCC in situ of glans / prepuce — red velvety plaques
Bowenoid papulosis	Young sexually active men, multiple reddish-brown papules, HPV 16; histologically CIS but regresses, rarely invasive
Peyronie disease	Fibrous plaque of tunica albuginea — penile curvature
Balanitis xerotica obliterans	Lichen sclerosus of glans — phimosis

Carcinoma of penis :

- Squamous cell carcinoma (95%); 40-70 y; India, Asia, Africa (uncircumcised).
- Risk factors : lack of circumcision (smegma, phimosis — most important), HPV 16, 18 (50%), poor hygiene, smoking, PUVA, lichen sclerosus.
- Glans / inner prepuce (most common); grey crusted papule → ulcerated, fungating; inguinal lymph nodes (superficial).
- Neonatal circumcision is protective.

Testis & Scrotum

Non-neoplastic :

Lesion	Key features
Cryptorchidism	Undescended testis (1% at 1 year); inguinal canal (most common site); atrophy, infertility, ↑ germ cell tumour risk (3-5×; also contralateral); orchidopexy before 1 year (6-12 months) — doesn't eliminate cancer risk
Orchitis	Mumps (post-pubertal — 20-30%; unilateral; rarely sterility); TB (begins in epididymis); syphilis (begins in testis — gumma, interstitial orchitis with plasma cells); granulomatous (autoimmune) orchitis
Epididymitis	< 35 y — C. trachomatis, N. gonorrhoeae ; > 35 y — E. coli, Pseudomonas (UTI)
Testicular torsion	Neonatal / adolescent — "bell-clapper" deformity (bilateral); absent cremasteric reflex; hemorrhagic infarction; salvage if < 6 h
Varicocele	Left (90%) — left gonadal → left renal vein; sudden right varicocele / left in elderly — RCC
Hydrocele	Most common cause of scrotal swelling; transilluminates; filariasis (India)

Testicular Tumours

- Germ cell tumours (95%) — most common malignancy in men 15-34 y; sex cord-stromal (5%); lymphoma — most common testicular tumour in men > 60 y (DLBCL, bilateral).
- Risk factors : cryptorchidism (most important), testicular dysgenesis (Klinefelter, androgen insensitivity), family history, previous contralateral GCT, i(12p) — isochromosome 12p (in nearly all GCT).
- Precursor : germ cell neoplasia in situ (GCNIS — formerly ITGCN) — except spermatocytic tumour & prepubertal teratoma/yolk sac.
- Painless testicular mass that does not transilluminate; do not biopsy trans-scrotally — radical inguinal orchiectomy (scrotal lymphatics → inguinal).
- Lymphatic spread : retroperitoneal para-aortic nodes first ; hematogenous : lungs, liver (choriocarcinoma early).

Testicular germ cell tumours

Seminomatous (~50%)

- Seminoma
- Spermatocytic tumour (elderly, no GCNIS)

Non-seminomatous (NSGCT)

- Embryonal carcinoma
- Yolk sac tumour
- Choriocarcinoma
- Teratoma
- Mixed (most common NSGCT — 60%)

Tumour	Age	Gross / microscopy	Markers
Seminoma	30s (peak 40)	Most common GCT (50%); homogeneous grey-white, lobulated, no hemorrhage/necrosis; sheets of uniform large cells with clear cytoplasm (glycogen), central nuclei, prominent nucleoli, delicate fibrous septa with lymphocytes, granulomas; syncytiotrophoblasts in 15%	PLAP, OCT3/4, SALL4, CD117 (KIT), D2-40 +; AFP normal ; ↑ hCG (mild, 10-15%); LDH
Spermatocytic tumour	> 65 y	Three cell sizes (small, intermediate, giant); no lymphocytes / granulomas; no GCNIS, no i(12p); excellent prognosis	Negative
Embryonal carcinoma	20-30 y	Hemorrhage, necrosis; primitive anaplastic cells in glands/sheets; aggressive	CD30 +, OCT3/4 +, cytokeratin +; AFP, hCG may ↑
Yolk sac tumour	Infants & children < 3 y (most common testicular tumour in children) ; adults (mixed)	Schiller-Duval bodies, hyaline globules, reticular (microcystic) pattern	AFP ↑↑, glypican-3
Choriocarcinoma	20-30 y	Small, hemorrhagic; cyto- + syncytiotrophoblast, no villi; early hematogenous spread (lung, brain)	β-hCG ↑↑ → gynecomastia, hyperthyroidism
Teratoma	Children (pure — benign) ; adults — malignant regardless of maturity (postpubertal teratoma)	Mature / immature elements of ≥ 2 germ layers; teratoma with somatic-type malignancy	Normal (or mildly ↑)

Mnemonic : Tumour markers in testicular GCT

"Seminoma — no AFP (never!)" · "Yolk sac — AFP" · "Chorio — hCG" · "Embryonal — both may be raised". Raised AFP in a "seminoma" = NSGCT component — treat as NSGCT.

Feature	Seminoma	NSGCT
Radiosensitivity	Highly radiosensitive & chemosensitive	Radioresistant (chemo — BEP)
Spread	Lymphatic, late	Earlier hematogenous
Prognosis	Excellent (> 95% cure)	Good, depends on markers

Sex cord-stromal tumours :

Tumour	Key features
Leydig cell tumour	Androgens / estrogens → precocious puberty (children), gynecomastia (adults); golden-brown; Reinke crystals (rod-shaped, eosinophilic); inhibin +; mostly benign
Sertoli cell tumour	Hormonally silent, tubules; large-cell calcifying (Carney, Peutz-Jeghers)

Prostate

Prostatitis :

- Acute bacterial — E. coli (catheterization, reflux); chronic bacterial (recurrent UTI); chronic abacterial / pelvic pain syndrome (most common); granulomatous (BCG instillation, TB, idiopathic).

Benign prostatic hyperplasia (nodular hyperplasia) :

- Extremely common : 50% > 50 y; 90% > 80 y.
- Dihydrotestosterone (DHT — 5α-reductase type 2 in stromal cells) → growth factors (FGF) → proliferation of stromal and epithelial cells.
- Transition zone & periurethral zone (inner) → urethral compression; not premalignant.
- Microscopy : nodules of hyperplastic glands (two cell layers — luminal secretory + basal) with papillary infoldings, corpora amylacea; fibromuscular stromal nodules.
- Clinical : LUTS — frequency, nocturia, hesitancy, poor stream, dribbling, acute urinary retention, bladder trabeculation & diverticula (hypertrophy), hydronephrosis, UTI, stones.
- Treatment : finasteride / dutasteride (5α-reductase inhibitors), α1-blockers (tamsulosin), TURP.

Carcinoma prostate :

- Most common visceral cancer in men (West); 2nd leading cause of cancer death in men (West); > 50 y, African-American men (highest); latent / incidental carcinoma common at autopsy.
- Risk factors : age, race, family history (BRCA2, HOXB13), androgens, diet (red meat, fat); ERG fusion (TMPRSS2-ERG — 50%), PTEN loss, AR amplification (castration-resistant).
- Peripheral zone (70%) — posterior — palpable on DRE (hard, nodular).
- Precursor : high-grade prostatic intraepithelial neoplasia (HGPIN).

Histologic diagnosis :

1. Small, crowded, infiltrative glands with a single cell layer — ABSENCE of basal cell layer (p63, HMWCK / 34βE12 negative)
2. Prominent nucleoli (most important cytologic feature)
3. Perineural invasion (diagnostic of malignancy)
4. Intraluminal crystalloids, blue mucin, pink amorphous secretions
5. AMACR (P504S) — positive in carcinoma

Grading	Details
Gleason score	Architectural patterns 1-5 (only 3-5 used now); score = primary + secondary pattern (6-10)
ISUP Grade Group	GG1 : ≤ 6 · GG2 : 3+4 = 7 · GG3 : 4+3 = 7 · GG4 : 8 · GG5 : 9-10

- PSA (kallikrein-3 — serine protease, liquefies semen) — organ-specific, not cancer-specific; ↑ in BPH, prostatitis, infarction, instrumentation, ejaculation; PSA > 4 ng/mL; PSA density, velocity, free/total PSA (↓ free PSA → cancer), PCA3, PHI, 4Kscore; PSMA PET.
- Spread : local (seminal vesicles, bladder base), lymphatic — obturator nodes, hematogenous — bone (lumbar spine, pelvis, femur) — osteoblastic (sclerotic) metastases, ↑ ALP; Batson vertebral venous plexus.
- Treatment : active surveillance (GG1), radical prostatectomy, RT, androgen deprivation (GnRH agonists/antagonists, abiraterone, enzalutamide), PARP inhibitors (BRCA2).

Filled : Rank boosters — male genital

- Most common testicular tumour : overall — seminoma; children — yolk sac tumour; elderly — lymphoma (DLBCL); bilateral — lymphoma, spermatocytic tumour.
- Klinefelter → mediastinal GCT (NSGCT); Down syndrome — ↑ testicular GCT.
- Most common site of extragonadal GCT : anterior mediastinum.
- Adenomatoid tumour — most common benign paratesticular tumour (mesothelial, epididymis).
- Paratesticular rhabdomyosarcoma (spindle cell) — children.
- Prostatic ductal adenocarcinoma, small cell carcinoma (post-ADT — neuroendocrine transdifferentiation).
- Corpora amylacea — laminated eosinophilic bodies in benign prostate lumen (normal / BPH).

BONES, JOINTS & SOFT TISSUE

Bone — General

- Cells : osteoblasts (RUNX2, osterix; ALP; make osteoid — type I collagen), osteocytes (sclerostin, FGF23 — mechanosensors), osteoclasts (monocyte-macrophage lineage, multinucleate; TRAP +; Howship lacunae).
- RANK-RANKL-OPG : osteoblasts/stromal cells express RANKL → binds RANK on osteoclast precursors (+ M-CSF) → osteoclastogenesis; OPG (decoy receptor) inhibits ; denosumab (anti-RANKL).
- Woven bone (haphazard collagen — fetal, fracture callus, tumours, Paget) vs lamellar bone (parallel, stronger — adult).
- Bone healing (fracture) — see Repair chapter : hematoma → soft callus (procallus, ~1 week) → hard (bony) callus (2-3 weeks) → remodelling (months).

Developmental disorders :

Disorder	Defect	Key features
Achondroplasia	FGFR3 gain-of-function (AD; 80% new mutations, ↑ paternal age)	Most common skeletal dysplasia — short limbs (rhizomelic), normal trunk, large head, trident hands; impaired endochondral ossification, normal intelligence ; thanatophoric dysplasia — lethal FGFR3
Osteogenesis imperfecta (brittle bone disease)	COL1A1 / COL1A2 (type I collagen) — AD (most)	Multiple fractures, blue sclerae, hearing loss (otosclerosis), dentinogenesis imperfecta, joint laxity; type II — lethal in utero ; mimics child abuse
Osteopetrosis (marble bone disease)	Defective osteoclast function — carbonic anhydrase II (with RTA, cerebral calcification), CLCN7, TCIRG1	Dense but brittle bones ("bone-in-bone", Erlenmeyer flask); pancytopenia (marrow obliteration), extramedullary hematopoiesis, cranial nerve palsies (narrow foramina), osteomyelitis; HSCT (malignant infantile AR)
Mucopolysaccharidoses	Lysosomal	Short stature, chondrocyte vacuoles, dysostosis multiplex

Osteomyelitis

Acute pyogenic osteomyelitis :

- Hematogenous (children — long bones, metaphysis), contiguous, direct implantation.

Setting	Organism
Most common overall	Staphylococcus aureus (80-90%)
Sickle cell disease	Salmonella (also S. aureus)
Neonates	Group B Streptococcus, E. coli (also S. aureus)
IV drug users	Pseudomonas (vertebrae, sternoclavicular)
Puncture wound through shoe	Pseudomonas
Diabetic foot, decubitus	Polymicrobial, anaerobes
Cat / dog bite	Pasteurella multocida
Children (< 4 y, unvaccinated)	Kingella kingae, H. influenzae

Pathogenesis & morphology

Bacteria lodge in metaphysis (sluggish flow in sinusoidal vessels near growth plate) → acute inflammation

↓

Pressure, ↑ bone resorption → necrosis — dead bone = SEQUESTRUM

↓

Pus spreads through Haversian & Volkmann canals → subperiosteal abscess (children — loosely attached periosteum)

↓

New reactive bone around dead bone = INVOLUCRUM ; sinus tracts (cloaca) to skin

↓

Infants — spreads through epiphysis into joint → septic arthritis (vessels cross growth plate)

- Brodie abscess — small intraosseous abscess walled off by reactive bone (subacute; distal tibia).
- Sclerosing osteomyelitis of Garré — jaw, extensive new bone.
- Complications : pathological fracture, secondary amyloidosis (AA), endocarditis, sepsis, SCC in sinus tract (Marjolin), chronic osteomyelitis.
- X-ray changes appear after 10-14 days; MRI — earliest.

Tuberculous osteomyelitis :

- 1-3% of TB; hematogenous; spine (Pott disease — thoracolumbar, T10-L1) — most common site, knees, hips.
- Destroys intervertebral disc space (early) & vertebral bodies (anterior) → gibbus (kyphosis), cold abscess (psoas abscess), paraplegia (Pott paraplegia).
- Caseating granulomas, less reactive new bone (vs pyogenic).
- Tuberculous arthritis — monoarticular, hip / knee; Phemister triad (juxta-articular osteoporosis, peripheral erosions, gradual joint-space narrowing).

Mycetoma (Madura foot) :

- Chronic granulomatous infection of subcutaneous tissue → bone; triad : tumefaction (painless swelling), sinuses, grains (granules).
- Eumycetoma (fungi — Madurella mycetomatis — black grains) vs actinomycetoma (bacteria — Nocardia, Actinomadura, Streptomyces — yellow/white/red grains; respond to antibiotics); barefoot farmers, thorn pricks; Splendore-Hoeppli phenomenon around grains.

Metabolic Bone Disease

Disease	Key features
Osteoporosis	↓ bone mass with normal mineralization; postmenopausal (↓ estrogen → ↑ RANKL, IL-1, IL-6) & senile; vertebral (crush) fractures, hip (femoral neck), distal radius (Colles); thin trabeculae, normal osteoid; serum Ca, PO_4, ALP normal; DEXA T-score ≤ −2.5 ; secondary : steroids, hyperthyroidism, heparin, immobilization
Rickets / osteomalacia	Defective mineralization (↓ vitamin D, ↓ PO_4) → excess unmineralized osteoid (wide osteoid seams); ↓ / N Ca, ↓ PO_4, ↑ ALP, ↑ PTH; rickets — growth plate disorganization (failure of provisional calcification), rachitic rosary, bowing, craniotabes, Harrison sulcus; osteomalacia — Looser zones (pseudofractures)
Primary hyperparathyroidism (bone)	Osteitis fibrosa cystica (von Recklinghausen disease of bone) — subperiosteal resorption (radial side of middle phalanges — most specific), "salt-and-pepper" skull, brown tumours (hemosiderin + osteoclasts + fibrous tissue — reactive), dissecting osteitis (tunnelling resorption); ↑ Ca, ↓ PO_4, ↑ ALP, ↑ PTH
Renal osteodystrophy	↑ PO_4, ↓ Ca, ↑ PTH; osteitis fibrosa + osteomalacia + adynamic + metastatic calcification ; "rugger-jersey" spine

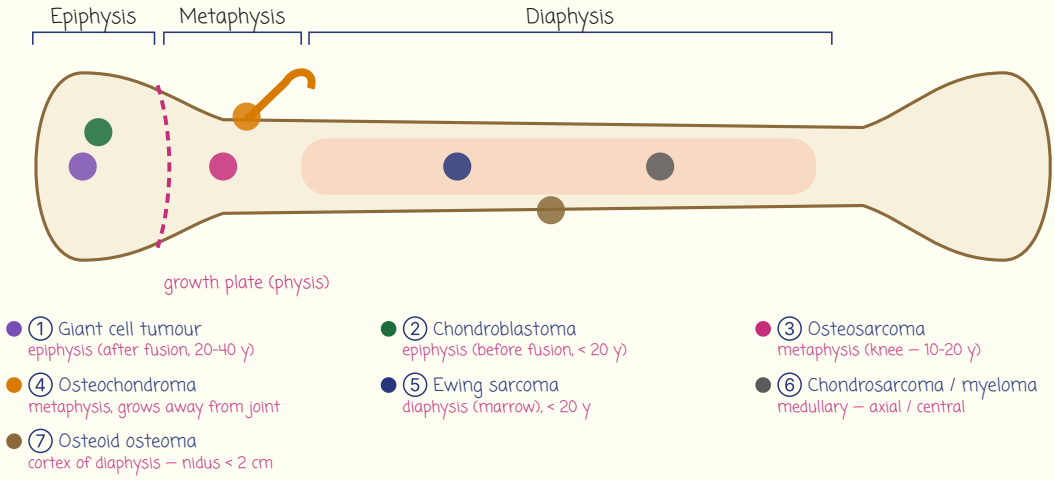
Disease	Key features
Paget disease (osteitis deformans)	> 40 y, Anglo-Saxon; SQSTM1 (p62), ? paramyxovirus; three phases : osteolytic → mixed osteoclastic-osteoblastic → osteosclerotic (burnt-out); mosaic pattern of lamellar bone (cement lines — "jigsaw puzzle"), huge osteoclasts (up to 100 nuclei); isolated ↑↑ ALP (normal Ca, PO_4), ↑ hydroxyproline; skull (↑ hat size), tibia (saber shin), pelvis, spine; hearing loss, high-output cardiac failure (AV shunts), osteosarcoma (1%), fractures (chalk-stick); bisphosphonates

Mnemonic : Ca / PO_4 / ALP / PTH patterns

Disorder	Ca	PO_4	ALP	PTH
Osteoporosis	N	N	N	N
Osteomalacia / rickets	↓/N	↓	↑	↑
Primary hyperparathyroidism	↑	↓	↑	↑
Secondary HPT (CKD)	↓	↑	↑	↑↑
Paget disease	N	N	↑↑	N

- Osteonecrosis (avascular necrosis) : steroids (most common non-traumatic), femoral neck fracture, alcohol, sickle cell, Gaucher, decompression sickness, SLE; subchondral wedge-shaped infarct, "crescent sign"; Legg-Calvé-Perthes (femoral head, boys 4-8 y), Kienböck (lunate), Freiberg (2nd metatarsal), Osgood-Schlatter (tibial tubercle — traction apophysitis).

Bone Tumours



Typical location of bone tumours in a long bone (labelled)

Tumour	Age	Site	Key features
Osteoma	Adults	Skull, facial bones (sinuses)	Gardner syndrome (multiple)
Osteoid osteoma	Young (10-20 y), males	Cortex of diaphysis — femur, tibia	< 2 cm radiolucent nidus with surrounding dense sclerosis; nocturnal pain relieved by aspirin / NSAIDs (PGE_2)
Osteoblastoma	Young	Posterior elements of vertebrae	> 2 cm; dull pain, not relieved by aspirin

Tumour	Age	Site	Key features
Osteosarcoma	Bimodal : 10–20 y (75%) & elderly (Paget, radiation)	Metaphysis of long bones — around knee (distal femur > proximal tibia), proximal humerus	Most common primary malignant bone tumour (excluding myeloma); malignant cells producing osteoid (lace-like) — diagnostic; Codman triangle (periosteal elevation), sunburst ("sun-ray") appearance; RB (retinoblastoma survivors — 1000×), TP53 (Li-Fraumeni), MDM2/CDK4 (low-grade); hematogenous lung metastasis; ↑ ALP; telangiectatic variant (ABC-like); parosteal (surface, low-grade, posterior distal femur — MDM2)
Osteochondroma (exostosis)	Adolescents (most common benign bone tumour)	Metaphysis near growth plate (distal femur, proximal tibia)	Bony stalk with cartilage cap — medullary cavity continuous with host bone; grows away from the joint; EXT1/EXT2 (hereditary multiple exostoses) → chondrosarcoma (5–20% in multiple)
Enchondroma	20–50 y	Small bones of hands & feet (medullary)	Hyaline cartilage; Ollier disease (multiple), Maffucci syndrome (multiple + soft-tissue hemangiomas — high sarcoma risk); IDH1/IDH2
Chondroblastoma	10–20 y (before growth plate closure)	Epiphysis (distal femur, proximal tibia, proximal humerus)	Chondroblasts with "chicken-wire" calcification, nuclear grooves; H3F3B (H3.3 K36M)
Chondromyxoid fibroma	Young	Metaphysis	Rare
Chondrosarcoma	> 40–60 y	Axial skeleton — pelvis, shoulder girdle, ribs, proximal femur (medullary)	Malignant cartilage — "popcorn / ring-and-arc" calcification; 2nd most common malignant bone-matrix tumour; IDH1/2, EXT; chemo- & radioresistant (surgery); grade most important; dedifferentiated, clear cell (epiphysis), mesenchymal variants
Giant cell tumour (osteoclastoma)	20–40 y (after fusion), women	Epiphysis (extending to metaphysis) — distal femur, proximal tibia (around knee — 50%), distal radius	Lytic, eccentric, "soap-bubble" appearance, expands to subchondral bone; numerous osteoclast-type giant cells (up to 100 nuclei) in sheets of mononuclear stromal cells (neoplastic — RANKL +); H3F3A (H3.3 G34W); locally aggressive, recurs; "benign" lung metastasis (2–4%); denosumab
Aneurysmal bone cyst	< 20 y	Metaphysis, vertebrae	Blood-filled spaces separated by septa with giant cells, "blue bone"; USP6 rearrangement; "fluid-fluid levels"
Simple (unicameral) bone cyst	Children	Proximal humerus / femur metaphysis	Fallen-fragment sign (pathological fracture)
Fibrous dysplasia	Children/young	Ribs (most common), femur, craniofacial	Curvilinear "Chinese-letter" woven bone trabeculae without osteoblastic rimming in fibrous stroma; "ground-glass", shepherd's crook deformity (femur); GNAS — McCune-Albright (polyostotic + café-au-lait "coast of Maine" + precocious puberty); Mazabraud (+ intramuscular myxomas)
Non-ossifying fibroma (fibrous cortical defect)	Children (most common bone lesion)	Metaphysis, eccentric, cortical	Storiform spindle cells, giant cells, foamy macrophages; self-limiting
Ewing sarcoma / PNET	< 20 y (10–15 y), boys, white	Diaphysis of long bones (femur), pelvis	Small round blue cells, Homer Wright rosettes (PNET), PAS + (glycogen); CD99 (MIC2) membranous +, FLI-1, NKX2.2; t(11;22)(q24;q12) EWSR1-FLI1 (85%); "onion-skin" periosteal reaction; fever, ↑ ESR, leukocytosis (mimics osteomyelitis); radiosensitive
Multiple myeloma	> 60 y	Axial (vertebrae, skull, ribs, pelvis)	Most common primary malignant tumour of bone overall; punched-out lytic lesions

Tumour	Age	Site	Key features
Metastases	Adults	Axial skeleton (vertebrae — most common), proximal femur, humerus	Most common malignant tumour of bone overall; osteolytic : kidney, lung, thyroid, GIT, melanoma, myeloma; osteoblastic : prostate (most), breast (mixed), carcinoid, SCLC, Hodgkin; children — neuroblastoma, Wilms, rhabdomyosarcoma

Exam pearl

- Periosteal reactions : Codman triangle & sunburst — osteosarcoma; onion-skin (lamellated) — Ewing; soap-bubble — GCT, ABC, ameloblastoma; ground-glass — fibrous dysplasia; popcorn calcification — chondroid tumours, pulmonary hamartoma.
- Bone tumours below 5 y — metastatic neuroblastoma; 5-20 y — osteosarcoma / Ewing; > 40 y — metastasis / myeloma / chondrosarcoma.

Joints

Osteoarthritis vs Rheumatoid arthritis :

Feature	Osteoarthritis (degenerative)	Rheumatoid arthritis
Primary lesion	Articular cartilage degeneration (chondrocyte injury)	Synovium (immune-mediated synovitis)
Age	> 50 y; obesity, trauma	30-50 y; F : M = 3 : 1
Joints	Weight-bearing — knees, hips, spine; DIP (Heberden nodes), PIP (Bouchard nodes), 1st CMC	Small joints of hands & feet symmetrically — MCP, PIP (spares DIP), wrists, cervical (atlantoaxial)
Morning stiffness	< 30 min; pain worsens with use	> 1 hour; improves with activity
Pathology	Fibrillation, fissuring, eburnation (polished ivory bone), subchondral cysts, osteophytes (bone spurs), joint mice (loose bodies)	Pannus (inflamed proliferating synovium + granulation tissue) → erodes cartilage & bone; villous synovial hyperplasia, lymphoid follicles, plasma cells, fibrin (rice bodies); fibrous / bony ankylosis
Deformities	Varus knee	Ulnar deviation, swan-neck, boutonnière, Z-thumb
Systemic	None	Rheumatoid nodules (palisading granulomas around fibrinoid necrosis — extensor surfaces), vasculitis, ILD, pleuritis, pericarditis, Felty syndrome (RA + splenomegaly + neutropenia), Sjögren, Caplan, anemia, AA amyloidosis, scleritis
Lab	Normal	RF (IgM anti-IgG Fc — 80%), anti-CCP (most specific), ↑ ESR/CRP; synovial fluid : inflammatory (WBC 5,000-50,000, neutrophils)
Genetics	—	HLA-DR4 (shared epitope), PTPN22; smoking — citrullination (PAD)

Gout & pseudogout :

Feature	Gout	Pseudogout (CPPD)
Crystal	Monosodium urate	Calcium pyrophosphate dihydrate
Shape	Needle-shaped	Rhomboid / rod-shaped
Birefringence	Strongly negative (yellow when parallel to slow ray of compensator)	Weakly positive (blue when parallel)
Joints	1st MTP (podagra), ankle, knee	Knee (most common), wrist

Feature	Gout	Pseudogout (CPPD)
Other	Tophi (urate with foreign-body giant cells — ear helix, olecranon, Achilles; dissolve in formalin → use alcohol fixation); urate nephropathy, stones; Lesch-Nyhan (HGPRT), tumour lysis, diuretics, alcohol, purine-rich food	Chondrocalcinosis (radiograph); hemochromatosis, hyperparathyroidism, hypothyroidism, hypomagnesemia, hypophosphatasia

- Septic arthritis — N. gonorrhoeae (young sexually active — migratory polyarthritis, tenosynovitis, pustules), S. aureus (most common overall), H. influenzae (children < 2 y), Salmonella (sickle cell); synovial WBC > 50,000, neutrophils, low glucose.
- Lyme arthritis — Borrelia burgdorferi (large joints).
- Seronegative spondyloarthropathies (HLA-B27) : ankylosing spondylitis (sacroiliitis, "bamboo spine", enthesitis, uveitis, aortitis), reactive arthritis (post-urethritis (Chlamydia) or dysentery — "can't see, can't pee, can't climb a tree"), psoriatic (DIP, "pencil-in-cup"), enteropathic.

Tumour-like joint lesions :

- Ganglion cyst — wrist (dorsal), no true lining; synovial cyst (Baker cyst — popliteal).
- Tenosynovial giant cell tumour — localized (giant cell tumour of tendon sheath — fingers, most common) & diffuse (pigmented villonodular synovitis — knee, hemosiderin, foamy cells; CSF1 translocation).

Soft Tissue Tumours

Tumour	Key features
Lipoma	Most common soft-tissue tumour of adults; mature fat; HMGA2
Liposarcoma	Well-differentiated (MDM2 amplification — "giant marker / ring chromosome 12q"), myxoid (t(12;16) FUS-DDIT3 — "chicken-wire" capillaries, signet ring lipoblasts), pleomorphic; retroperitoneum, thigh; > 50 y; lipoblasts (scalloped nuclei) — diagnostic
Nodular fasciitis	Rapidly growing, reactive-appearing — "tissue culture" fibroblasts, forearm; USP6; self-limited
Fibromatosis (desmoid)	Abdominal wall (postpartum women), Gardner (intra-abdominal); β-catenin (CTNNB1 / APC) nuclear; locally aggressive, no metastasis
Rhabdomyosarcoma	Most common soft-tissue sarcoma of childhood; embryonal (head & neck, GU — sarcoma botryoides — cambium layer), alveolar (adolescents, extremities — t(2;13) PAX3-FOXO1, t(1;13) PAX7-FOXO1 — worse), pleomorphic (adults); rhabdomyoblasts (strap / tadpole cells with cross-striations); desmin, myogenin, MyoD1 +
Synovial sarcoma	Young adults (20–40 y); around knee — NOT from synovium; biphasic (spindle + epithelial glands) or monophasic; t(X;18) SS18-SSX (SYT-SSX); TLE1 +, cytokeratin + , EMA + ; calcification; lymph node metastasis
Undifferentiated pleomorphic sarcoma (old MFH)	Most common soft-tissue sarcoma of late adult life; storiform, pleomorphic; diagnosis of exclusion
Leiomyosarcoma	Retroperitoneum, uterus, vessels (IVC)
Alveolar soft part sarcoma	t(X;17) ASPSCR1-TFE3; PAS + diastase-resistant crystals; young, thigh
Dermatofibrosarcoma protuberans	Storiform, CD34 +, t(17;22) COL1A1-PDGFB ; imatinib; locally aggressive
Clear cell sarcoma	Melanoma of soft parts — t(12;22) EWSR1-ATF1, S100, HMB-45 +; tendons, feet
Schwannoma, neurofibroma, MPNST	See CNS / Neoplasia

Mnemonic : Sarcoma translocations

"Ewing 11;22 · Synovial X;18 · Myxoid liposarcoma 12;16 · Alveolar rhabdo 2;13 · Clear cell 12;22 · DFSP 17;22 · ASPS X;17".

Filled : Rank boosters — bone & soft tissue

- Most common benign bone tumour : osteochondroma; most common primary malignant (excluding myeloma) : osteosarcoma; most common malignant bone tumour overall : metastasis.
- Adamantinoma — anterior tibia (diaphysis), epithelial islands, keratin +; osteofibrous dysplasia association.
- Chordoma — notochord remnant; sacrum (most common), clivus; physaliferous cells (bubbly vacuolated cytoplasm), brachyury +, keratin +, S100 +.
- Langerhans cell histiocytosis — "punched-out" skull lesions, vertebra plana.
- Hypertrophic osteoarthropathy — periosteal new bone + clubbing — lung adenocarcinoma, mesothelioma, cyanotic heart disease.
- Myositis ossificans — zonation : mature lamellar bone at periphery, immature fibroblastic centre ; osteosarcoma — reverse (most atypical, immature tissue at periphery).

ENDOCRINE SYSTEM

Endocrine Control & Investigations

- Negative feedback (hypothalamus → pituitary → target gland); disease = hyperfunction, hypofunction, or mass effect.
- Investigations : basal hormone levels, stimulation tests (for hypofunction — e.g., ACTH stimulation for Addison), suppression tests (for hyperfunction — dexamethasone suppression for Cushing, glucose suppression for acromegaly), imaging, FNAC (thyroid), autoantibodies.

Pituitary

Pituitary adenomas :

- Most common cause of hyperpituitarism; 30-50 y; microadenoma < 1 cm, macroadenoma ≥ 1 cm; GNAS (GH — gsp), MEN1, AIP (familial).
- Mass effects : bitemporal hemianopia (optic chiasm), headache, hypopituitarism, pituitary apoplexy (acute hemorrhage — emergency).
- Histology : monomorphic cells, loss of acinar architecture (reticulin stain); PIT-1 (GH, PRL, TSH), TPIT (ACTH), SF-1 (gonadotroph) lineage transcription factors.

Adenoma	Frequency	Features
Prolactinoma (lactotroph)	Most common (30%)	Galactorrhea, amenorrhea, infertility, ↓ libido; psammoma-like calcification; dopamine agonists (cabergoline, bromocriptine) ; stalk effect — ↑ PRL from any mass (loss of dopamine inhibition)
Somatotroph (GH)	2nd most common	Gigantism (before epiphyseal closure), acromegaly (after); ↑ IGF-1; failure of GH suppression by oral glucose (diagnostic); DM, cardiomyopathy, colon polyps; densely / sparsely granulated (fibrous bodies — keratin)
Corticotroph (ACTH)	10-15%	Cushing disease; Nelson syndrome (after bilateral adrenalectomy — enlarging adenoma + hyperpigmentation); Crooke hyaline change in normal corticotrophs (glucocorticoid excess)
Gonadotroph	10-15%	Usually non-functioning — mass effects in middle-aged
Thyrotroph	1%	Hyperthyroidism with ↑ TSH
Null cell	—	Non-functioning

Hypopituitarism :

1. Non-secretory pituitary adenomas (most common)
2. Sheehan syndrome — postpartum necrosis (enlarged pituitary in pregnancy + hypovolemic shock) → failure of lactation (first sign), amenorrhea, hypothyroidism, adrenal insufficiency
3. Empty sella syndrome
4. Craniopharyngioma (children), other tumours, Rathke cleft cyst
5. Trauma, surgery, radiation, apoplexy
6. Infiltrations — sarcoidosis, TB, LCH (diabetes insipidus), hemochromatosis, lymphocytic hypophysitis (pregnancy)

- Order of loss with compression : GH → FSH/LH → TSH → ACTH → PRL (last) — "Go Look For The Adenoma Please".

Posterior pituitary :

Disorder	Key features
Diabetes insipidus	Central (↓ ADH — trauma, tumours, LCH, idiopathic) vs nephrogenic (resistance — lithium, hypercalcemia, hypokalemia, AVPR2/AQP2 mutations); polyuria, dilute urine, hypernatremia; water deprivation + desmopressin test

Disorder	Key features
SIADH	Small cell lung carcinoma (most common cause), CNS lesions, pulmonary infections, drugs (carbamazepine, SSRIs, cyclophosphamide, vincristine); euvolemic hyponatremia, concentrated urine (inappropriately), ↑ urinary Na; fluid restriction, tolvaptan; avoid rapid correction (ODS)

- Craniopharyngioma : Rathke pouch remnant; suprasellar; bimodal (5–15 y, > 65 y); adamantinomatous (children — CTNNB1, calcification, "wet keratin", machinery-oil fluid) & papillary (adults — BRAF V600E); visual defects, DI, growth failure.

Thyroid

Thyroid function :

Condition	TSH	Free T4	Examples
Primary hyperthyroidism	↓	↑	Graves, toxic MNG, toxic adenoma
Primary hypothyroidism	↑ (most sensitive screening test)	↓	Hashimoto, iodine deficiency
Secondary hypothyroidism	↓ / N	↓	Pituitary disease
Subclinical hypothyroidism	↑	N	Early Hashimoto

Hyperthyroidism (thyrotoxicosis) — causes :

1. Graves disease (most common — 85%)
2. Toxic multinodular goitre (Plummer) — elderly
3. Toxic (functioning) adenoma — TSHR, GNAS mutations; "hot" nodule
4. Thyroiditis (release of stored hormone — subacute, painless, postpartum) — ↓ radioiodine uptake
5. Exogenous (factitious) — ↓ thyroglobulin, ↓ uptake
6. Struma ovarii, hCG (mole, choriocarcinoma), TSH adenoma, iodine-induced (Jod-Basedow), amiodarone

Graves disease :

- Autoimmune — TSH receptor-stimulating antibodies (TSI / TRAb — IgG); women 20–40 y; HLA-DR3, CTLA-4, PTPN22.
- Triad : hyperthyroidism + infiltrative ophthalmopathy (exophthalmos — orbital fibroblasts express TSHR; GAG deposition, lymphocytes) + localized infiltrative dermopathy (pretibial myxedema) ; thyroid acropachy.
- Morphology : diffuse symmetric enlargement, beefy-red; tall columnar hyperplastic follicular cells crowded into papillae (no fibrovascular cores), pale scalloped colloid ("scalloping" at periphery), lymphoid infiltrates with germinal centres.
- ↑ diffuse radioiodine uptake.

Hypothyroidism — causes :

1. Iodine deficiency (most common worldwide)
2. Hashimoto thyroiditis (most common in iodine-sufficient areas)
3. Post-ablative (surgery, radioiodine), drugs (lithium, amiodarone, antithyroid)
4. Congenital — thyroid dysgenesis (most common), dyshormonogenesis (TPO defect, Pendred syndrome — SLC26A4 + deafness) → cretinism (mental retardation, short stature, coarse facies, macroglossia, umbilical hernia) — neonatal TSH screening
5. Secondary (pituitary), tertiary (hypothalamic)

- Myxedema (adults) : non-pitting edema (GAG/hyaluronic acid accumulation), cold intolerance, weight gain, bradycardia, delayed relaxation of reflexes, hoarse voice, hypercholesterolemia, pericardial effusion, myxedema coma.

Thyroiditis :

Type	Key features
Hashimoto (chronic lymphocytic) thyroiditis	Most common cause of hypothyroidism in iodine-sufficient areas; women 45-65 y; anti-TPO (most sensitive), anti-thyroglobulin; CD8 cytotoxicity, Fas-FasL, Th1 (IFN-γ); diffuse, painless, firm, rubbery goitre; dense lymphoplasmacytic infiltrate with well-formed germinal centres + Hürthle (oncocytic / Askanazy) cells (eosinophilic granular cytoplasm — mitochondria); transient hashitoxicosis ; ↑ risk of B-cell (MALT) lymphoma, papillary carcinoma (debated); HLA-DR3, DR5, CTLA-4, PTPN22 ; IgG4-related variant (fibrous)
Subacute granulomatous (de Quervain) thyroiditis	Post-viral (coxsackie, mumps, adenovirus), women 40-50 y; painful tender thyroid, fever, ↑↑ ESR; transient hyperthyroidism → hypothyroidism → recovery ; ↓ radioiodine uptake; granulomatous inflammation with multinucleated giant cells engulfing colloid; self-limited (6-8 weeks)
Subacute lymphocytic (painless / silent / postpartum) thyroiditis	Postpartum (within 1 year) or painless; anti-TPO +; lymphocytic infiltrate without germinal centres / Hürthle cells; transient
Riedel thyroiditis	Extensive fibrosis extending into adjacent neck structures — "woody / stony hard", mimics carcinoma; IgG4-related disease (retroperitoneal fibrosis, sclerosing cholangitis)
Acute suppurative	Bacterial; pyriform sinus fistula (left)

Goitre :

- Diffuse nontoxic (simple) goitre → multinodular goitre : iodine deficiency (endemic — sub-Himalayan belt, > 10% population), goitrogens (cabbage, cassava, Brassica — thiocyanates), dyshormonogenesis.
- Phases : hyperplastic (↑ TSH) → colloid involution (colloid goitre).
- Multinodular goitre — multilobulated asymmetric enlargement (up to 2000 g); colloid-rich follicles, hemorrhage, fibrosis, calcification, cystic change; retrosternal extension (tracheal compression), toxic MNG (Plummer), incidental carcinoma.

Thyroid neoplasms :

- Solitary nodule — more likely neoplastic in : young patients, males, solid, "cold" (non-functioning) nodules on scan, history of radiation to neck. Most solitary nodules are benign (> 90%).
- FNAC — first investigation (Bethesda system I-VI).

Tumour	Key features
Follicular adenoma	Encapsulated, solitary; uniform follicles; RAS, PAX8-PPARG; capsular & vascular invasion must be excluded (cannot be distinguished from follicular carcinoma on FNAC — Bethesda IV) ; Hürthle cell (oncocytic) adenoma
Papillary carcinoma	Most common thyroid cancer (85%); 25-50 y, women; ionizing radiation (children — Chernobyl); BRAF V600E (most common, 45%), RET/PTC rearrangements (radiation); diagnosed by NUCLEAR features : ground-glass (Orphan Annie eye) nuclei, intranuclear pseudo-inclusions (cytoplasmic invaginations), nuclear grooves (coffee-bean), overlapping; papillae with fibrovascular cores, psammoma bodies; lymphatic spread — cervical nodes (often first presentation — "lateral aberrant thyroid"); excellent prognosis (> 95% 10-year); variants : follicular variant, tall cell (aggressive, BRAF), diffuse sclerosing (young), columnar, hobnail, NIFTP (non-invasive follicular neoplasm with papillary-like nuclear features — no longer "carcinoma")
Follicular carcinoma	5-15%; iodine-deficient areas (↑ relative frequency); 40-60 y; RAS (most common), PAX8-PPARG t(2;3), PIK3CA, PTEN (Cowden); diagnosis requires capsular and/or vascular invasion (not by FNAC); hematogenous spread — bones (lytic), lungs, liver; metastases take up radioiodine; minimally invasive vs widely invasive
Medullary carcinoma	5%; parafollicular C cells (neuroendocrine) ; calcitonin (marker), CEA; sporadic (80% — somatic RET) & familial (MEN 2A, 2B, FMTC — germline RET; bilateral, multicentric; preceded by C-cell hyperplasia); polygonal / spindle cells in nests with amyloid stroma (procalcitonin — Congo red +); diarrhea (VIP, serotonin, calcitonin), Cushing (ACTH); prophylactic thyroidectomy in RET carriers ; not radioiodine responsive
Anaplastic (undifferentiated) carcinoma	< 5%; elderly (> 65 y), iodine-deficient areas; TP53 (most), BRAF, RAS, TERT; arise from differentiated carcinoma (dedifferentiation); giant / spindle / squamoid pleomorphic cells; rapidly enlarging bulky neck mass, invasion of trachea, esophagus; almost uniformly fatal (death < 1 year)

Tumour	Key features
Primary thyroid lymphoma	Hashimoto background; DLBCL / MALT; elderly women, rapidly enlarging goitre

Mnemonic : Thyroid carcinoma

- Papillary — "P" : Popular (most common), Palpable nodes, Psammoma, Positive prognosis, Orphan Annie ("Pale" nuclei).
- Follicular — "F" : Far (hematogenous) spread, FNAC can't diagnose (invasion needed).
- Medullary — "M" : MEN 2, aMyloid, calcitonin (Marker).
- Anaplastic — "A" : Aged, Aggressive, All die.

Parathyroid

Disorder	Key features
Primary hyperparathyroidism	Adenoma (85-95% — single, chief cells, rim of compressed normal tissue, ↓ fat), hyperplasia (5-10% — all four glands; MEN1, MEN2A), carcinoma (< 1% — invasion, metastasis; HRPT2/CDC73); most common cause of asymptomatic hypercalcemia (outpatient); ↑ Ca, ↑ PTH, ↓ PO_4, hypercalciuria; "stones, bones, abdominal groans, psychic moans" — nephrolithiasis (most common symptom), nephrocalcinosis, osteitis fibrosa cystica (brown tumours), pancreatitis, peptic ulcer, constipation, depression, metastatic calcification; cyclin D1 (PRAD1) rearrangement, MEN1
Secondary hyperparathyroidism	CKD (most common), vitamin D deficiency, malabsorption → ↓ Ca → parathyroid hyperplasia; ↑ PTH, ↓/N Ca, ↑ PO_4 (CKD); renal osteodystrophy, calciphylaxis
Tertiary hyperparathyroidism	Autonomous hyperfunction after long-standing secondary (post-renal transplant) — ↑ Ca, ↑ PTH
Hypoparathyroidism	Surgical removal (thyroidectomy — most common), autoimmune (APS-1 — AIRE), DiGeorge, Mg deficiency; tetany (Chvostek, Trousseau), seizures, prolonged QT, basal ganglia calcification, cataract
Pseudohypoparathyroidism	End-organ resistance to PTH (GNAS — Gsα); ↑ PTH, ↓ Ca, ↑ PO_4; Albright hereditary osteodystrophy (short stature, short 4th/5th metacarpals, round face, obesity) (type 1a — maternal) ; pseudopseudohypoparathyroidism — AHO phenotype with normal labs (paternal)

- Hypercalcemia — inpatients : malignancy (PTHrP — most common); outpatients : primary hyperparathyroidism.

Endocrine Pancreas — Diabetes Mellitus

Diagnostic criteria (ADA) :

1. Fasting plasma glucose ≥ 126 mg/dL
2. 2-hour plasma glucose ≥ 200 mg/dL (75 g OGTT)
3. HbA1c ≥ 6.5%
4. Random glucose ≥ 200 mg/dL with classic symptoms

- Prediabetes : FPG 100-125 (IFG), 2-h 140-199 (IGT), HbA1c 5.7-6.4%.

Feature	Type 1 DM	Type 2 DM
Mechanism	Autoimmune destruction of β cells (T-cell mediated) → absolute insulin deficiency	Insulin resistance + β-cell dysfunction (relative deficiency)
Onset	Childhood / adolescence (< 20 y) ; LADA in adults	Adults (> 40 y), obesity (increasingly young in India)
Body habitus	Normal / thin	Obese (central)
Genetics	HLA-DR3/DR4, DQ8 (strongest), CTLA-4, PTPN22, insulin gene VNTR; concordance in twins 30-50%	Polygenic; concordance in identical twins 60-80% (TCF7L2 — most important)
Autoantibodies	GAD65, islet cell (ICA), IA-2, insulin, ZnT8	Absent

Feature	Type 1 DM	Type 2 DM
Islet pathology	Insulitis (lymphocytic infiltrate — CD8 T cells), ↓ β cells	Islet amyloid (amylin — IAPP), subtle ↓ β-cell mass
Acute complication	Diabetic ketoacidosis (DKA)	Hyperosmolar hyperglycemic state (HHS)
Insulin / C-peptide	↓↓ / absent	↑ early, ↓ late

- Insulin resistance : obesity (FFAs, adipokines — ↓ adiponectin, ↑ resistin, inflammation — TNF, IL-1 inflammasome), ↓ GLUT4 translocation, ↑ serine phosphorylation of IRS-1; acanthosis nigricans.
- MODY (monogenic) — AD; glucokinase (MODY 2 — mild), HNF1α (MODY 3 — most common, sulfonylurea-sensitive); neonatal diabetes (KCNJ11).
- Gestational DM — macrosomia, ↑ future T2DM.

Pathogenesis of complications :

1. Advanced glycation end products (AGEs) → bind RAGE → inflammation, ROS, cross-link collagen (↑ basement membrane thickness)
2. Polyol (aldose reductase) pathway → sorbitol accumulation → osmotic damage (lens — cataract; Schwann cells — neuropathy; pericytes — retinopathy)
3. Protein kinase C activation (diacylglycerol) → VEGF, TGF-β, PAI-1
4. Hexosamine pathway → TGF-β, PAI-1
5. Nonenzymatic glycation of Hb (HbA1c) — reflects 2-3 months control

Morphology of chronic complications :

Site	Lesions
Basement membranes	Diffuse thickening of capillary BM (most consistent morphologic feature) — diabetic microangiopathy
Large vessels	Accelerated atherosclerosis — MI (most common cause of death), stroke, gangrene of lower limbs (100×) ; hyaline arteriolosclerosis
Kidney	Diffuse & nodular (Kimmelstiel-Wilson) glomerulosclerosis, afferent & efferent hyaline arteriolosclerosis, pyelonephritis, papillary necrosis, Armanni-Ebstein
Eye	Retinopathy — non-proliferative (microaneurysms — earliest, dot-blot hemorrhages, hard exudates, cotton-wool spots) → proliferative (neovascularization — VEGF); cataract, glaucoma
Nerves	Symmetric distal sensorimotor polyneuropathy (glove & stocking) — most common; autonomic; mononeuropathy (CN III — pupil sparing)
Infections	Mucormycosis, malignant otitis externa (Pseudomonas), emphysematous pyelonephritis / cholecystitis, Fournier gangrene, TB, candidiasis
Pancreas (T1)	Insulitis, ↓ islets; (T2) amyloid; infant of diabetic mother — islet hyperplasia (hypoglycemia)

Adrenal Gland

Cushing syndrome (hypercortisolism) :

Cause	Frequency	Key points
Exogenous (iatrogenic) glucocorticoids	Most common overall	Bilateral cortical atrophy (↓ ACTH)
Cushing disease (pituitary ACTH microadenoma)	Most common endogenous (70%); women 20-40 y	Bilateral nodular / diffuse cortical hyperplasia; suppresses with high-dose dexamethasone

Cause	Frequency	Key points
Ectopic ACTH	10–15%	Small cell lung carcinoma, carcinoid, medullary thyroid, pancreatic NET; no suppression, hypokalemia, hyperpigmentation; men
Primary adrenal (adrenal adenoma / carcinoma / micronodular hyperplasia)	10–20%	↓ ACTH, contralateral atrophy; PPNAD (Carney complex – PRKAR1A), macronodular (ARMC5)

- Features : central obesity, moon facies, buffalo hump, purple abdominal striae, proximal myopathy, hypertension, hyperglycemia, osteoporosis, hirsutism, menstrual irregularity, psychiatric, infections, poor wound healing.
- Tests : 24-h urinary free cortisol, late-night salivary cortisol, overnight 1 mg dexamethasone suppression (screening); ACTH level (dependent vs independent); high-dose dex suppression / CRH test (pituitary vs ectopic); inferior petrosal sinus sampling.
- Crooke hyaline change – pituitary corticotrophs (cytokeratin).

Hyperaldosteronism :

- Primary (Conn syndrome) – bilateral idiopathic hyperplasia (60%), aldosterone-producing adenoma (35% – KCNJ5 mutation; "spironolactone bodies" after treatment), glucocorticoid-remediable (CYP11B1/B2 fusion), carcinoma; hypertension + hypokalemia (muscle weakness), metabolic alkalosis, ↓ renin, ↑ aldosterone (ARR > 20–30); no edema (aldosterone escape); most common cause of secondary (endocrine) hypertension.
- Secondary – ↑ renin : renal artery stenosis, CHF, cirrhosis, nephrotic, pregnancy.

Congenital adrenal hyperplasia (CAH) :

Enzyme	Frequency	Features
21-hydroxylase (CYP21A2)	> 90%	↓ cortisol & aldosterone, ↑ androgens → salt-wasting (hyponatremia, hyperkalemia, hypotension – neonates), virilization (ambiguous genitalia in females – most common cause), precocious puberty in males; ↑ 17-OH progesterone (newborn screening)
11β-hydroxylase (CYP11B1)	5%	↑ 11-deoxycorticosterone (mineralocorticoid) → hypertension, hypokalemia + virilization
17α-hydroxylase (CYP17)	Rare	↓ androgens & cortisol, ↑ mineralocorticoids → hypertension, hypokalemia, sexual infantilism / ambiguous male genitalia

- Bilateral adrenal hyperplasia (↑ ACTH – loss of cortisol feedback); AR.

Adrenal insufficiency :

Type	Causes	Features
Acute	Waterhouse-Friderichsen syndrome (meningococcemia – massive bilateral adrenal hemorrhage + DIC; also Pseudomonas, pneumococcus, H. influenzae); abrupt withdrawal of long-term steroids (most common); anticoagulation, postpartum	Shock, hypoglycemia, hyperkalemia
Chronic primary (Addison disease)	Autoimmune adrenalitis (most common in West – 21-hydroxylase antibodies; APS-1 (AIRE) & APS-2 (Schmidt – with thyroid, T1DM)); TB (most common in India / developing countries – caseous necrosis, enlarged then fibrosed/calcified); AIDS (CMV, MAC), metastatic cancer (lung, breast), histoplasmosis, amyloidosis, adrenoleukodystrophy	Weakness, weight loss, hypotension, GI symptoms, hyperpigmentation (↑ ACTH/POMC → MSH – skin creases, buccal mucosa), hyponatremia, hyperkalemia, hypoglycemia, eosinophilia; ACTH stimulation (Synacthen) test
Secondary	Pituitary / hypothalamic disease, exogenous steroid withdrawal	No hyperpigmentation, no hyperkalemia (aldosterone preserved – RAAS)

Adrenal cortical tumours :

- Adenoma — most common adrenal mass (incidentaloma); yellow, well-circumscribed, lipid-rich clear cells; usually non-functional; functional → Cushing or Conn.
- Adrenocortical carcinoma — large (> 6 cm, > 100 g), invasive, hemorrhagic, necrotic; functional (virilization, Cushing); Li-Fraumeni (TP53), Beckwith-Wiedemann; Weiss criteria; poor prognosis.

Adrenal medulla :

Tumour	Key features
Pheochromocytoma	Chromaffin cells; "rule of 10s" (historic) : 10% extra-adrenal (paraganglioma — now ~15-20%), 10% bilateral, 10% malignant, 10% familial (now ~25-40% germline!), 10% not hypertensive; MEN2A/2B (RET), VHL, NF1, SDH (SDHB — malignant paraganglioma); paroxysmal/sustained hypertension, headache, palpitations, sweating (classic triad); Zellballen (nests of polygonal cells surrounded by sustentacular cells — S100 +); chromogranin, synaptophysin +; chromaffin reaction (brown with dichromate); malignancy only by metastasis; plasma free / urinary fractionated metanephrines (best), VMA; α-blockade (phenoxybenzamine) before β-blockade & surgery
Neuroblastoma	Most common extracranial solid tumour of childhood; most common tumour of infancy; adrenal medulla (40%), paravertebral sympathetic chain; < 2 years; small round blue cells, Homer Wright pseudorosettes (neuropil centre), ganglionic differentiation (ganglioneuroblastoma → ganglioneuroma); N-MYC amplification (poor prognosis), 1p deletion, 17q gain, ALK, hyperdiploidy (good); ↑ urinary VMA & HVA; abdominal mass crossing midline, calcification, periorbital ecchymoses ("raccoon eyes" — orbital metastasis), "blueberry muffin" skin (infants), Hutchinson (bone) vs Pepper (liver) syndromes, opsoclonus-myoclonus ("dancing eyes, dancing feet"); stage MS (4S) — < 18 months, spontaneous regression; Shimada classification; NSE, synaptophysin, PHOX2B +

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN)

Syndrome	Gene	Components
MEN 1 (Wermer)	MEN1 (menin) — 11q13	3 Ps : Parathyroid (hyperplasia — 95%, first manifestation), Pancreas / duodenal NETs (gastrinoma — ZES, most common cause of death; insulinoma), Pituitary (prolactinoma); also adrenal adenomas, foregut carcinoids, angiofibromas, lipomas
MEN 2A (Sipple)	RET (germline, gain of function) — 10q11	Medullary thyroid carcinoma (100%), pheochromocytoma (50%), parathyroid hyperplasia (20-30%); cutaneous lichen amyloidosis, Hirschsprung
MEN 2B (MEN 3)	RET (M918T)	Medullary thyroid carcinoma (aggressive, early — thyroidectomy in 1st year), pheochromocytoma, mucosal neuromas (lips, tongue — "blubbery lips"), marfanoid habitus, intestinal ganglioneuromatosis; no hyperparathyroidism
MEN 4	CDKN1B (p27)	MEN1-like

Mnemonic : MEN

"MEN 1 = 3 Ps (diamond)" · "MEN 2A = 2 Ps + M (square) — Pheo, Parathyroid, Medullary" · "MEN 2B = 1 P + M + Marfanoid + Mucosal neuroma (triangle)".

Filled : Rank boosters — endocrine

- Most common thyroid cancer in children & after radiation : papillary; in iodine deficiency — follicular (relatively more).
- Hürthle cell carcinoma — oncocytic, mitochondrial DNA mutations, poor iodine uptake.
- Thyroglossal duct cyst — moves with tongue protrusion; may harbour papillary carcinoma.
- Ectopic thyroid — lingual (most common).
- Sick euthyroid syndrome — ↓ T3 (↓ deiodinase), normal TSH — severe illness.
- Hyperthyroidism → osteoporosis, AF, high-output failure; thyroid storm.
- APS-1 (APECED — AIRE) : mucocutaneous candidiasis + hypoparathyroidism + Addison; APS-2 (Schmidt) : Addison + autoimmune thyroid + T1DM (HLA-DR3/4).
- Paraganglioma — carotid body (chemodectoma) — SDHD (paternal transmission), high altitude.

CENTRAL NERVOUS SYSTEM, NERVE & MUSCLE

Cells & Reaction Patterns

Cell	Reaction to injury
Neuron	Acute neuronal injury ("red neurons") — 12–24 h after hypoxia : shrinkage, eosinophilic cytoplasm, pyknosis, loss of Nissl substance ; axonal reaction — central chromatolysis (swollen cell body, Nissl dispersed to periphery, eccentric nucleus); neuronal inclusions (Lewy, Negri, Pick, tangles); Wallerian degeneration
Astrocyte	Gliosis — most important indicator of CNS injury (no fibroblasts); gemistocytes (reactive — abundant pink cytoplasm, GFAP +); Rosenthal fibres (pilocytic astrocytoma, Alexander disease — GFAP mutation); corpora amylacea (aging); Alzheimer type II astrocytes (hyperammonemia — liver failure, Wilson)
Microglia	CNS macrophages — rod cells (neurosyphilis), microglial nodules (viral encephalitis), neuronophagia
Oligodendrocyte	Myelin; viral inclusions in PML (JC virus); glial cytoplasmic inclusions (MSA — α-synuclein)
Ependyma	Granular ependymitis (CMV)

Cerebral Edema, Raised ICP & Herniation

Type	Mechanism	Examples
Vasogenic	Disruption of blood-brain barrier → ↑ extracellular fluid (white matter)	Tumours, abscess, trauma, inflammation — responds to steroids
Cytotoxic	Cell membrane injury → intracellular fluid (grey & white matter)	Ischemia / hypoxia (early), toxic, metabolic
Interstitial (hydrocephalic)	Transependymal CSF flow	Hydrocephalus — periventricular

- Gross : flattened gyri, narrowed sulci, compressed ventricles.

Hydrocephalus :

- Non-communicating (obstructive) — obstruction within ventricular system (aqueductal stenosis — most common congenital, colloid cyst of 3rd ventricle, tumours, Arnold-Chiari).
- Communicating — impaired CSF resorption by arachnoid granulations (post-meningitis, subarachnoid hemorrhage).
- Normal pressure hydrocephalus — elderly : "wet, wobbly, wacky" — urinary incontinence, gait apraxia, dementia.
- Hydrocephalus ex vacuo — compensatory ventricular enlargement due to brain atrophy (Alzheimer).

Herniation :

Type	Structure	Consequence
Subfalcine (cingulate)	Cingulate gyrus under falx	Compression of anterior cerebral artery → infarct
Transtentorial (uncal)	Uncus of temporal lobe over tentorium	CN III compression (ipsilateral dilated pupil — "blown pupil", ptosis, down & out), PCA compression (occipital infarct), Kernohan notch (contralateral cerebral peduncle → ipsilateral hemiparesis — false localizing), Duret hemorrhages (midbrain & pons — stretching of paramedian arteries) — fatal
Tonsillar	Cerebellar tonsils through foramen magnum	Brainstem compression → respiratory & cardiac arrest (fatal) ; never do LP with raised ICP

CSF findings :

Condition	Appearance	Cells	Protein	Glucose
Normal	Clear	0-5 lymphocytes/ µL	15-45 mg/dL	50-80 (2/3 of blood)
Pyogenic (bacterial) meningitis	Turbid / purulent	↑↑ neutrophils (> 1000)	↑↑	↓↓
Tuberculous meningitis	Clear / "cobweb" (pellicle) on standing	↑ lymphocytes (100-500)	↑↑ (very high)	↓ ; ↑ ADA, chloride ↓
Viral (aseptic) meningitis	Clear	↑ lymphocytes	Mild ↑ / normal	Normal
Fungal (cryptococcal)	Clear	↑ lymphocytes	↑	↓ ; India ink, CrAg
Subarachnoid hemorrhage	Bloody / xanthochromic (> 12 h)	RBCs	↑	Normal
Guillain-Barré syndrome	Clear	Normal	↑↑ — albuminocytologic dissociation	Normal
Multiple sclerosis	Clear	Mild ↑ lymphocytes	Mild ↑ ; oligoclonal bands (IgG), ↑ IgG index	Normal
Froin syndrome	Xanthochromic, clots spontaneously	—	↑↑ (below spinal block)	—

Infections of the CNS

Meningitis — organisms by age :

Age	Organisms
Neonates (< 1 month)	Group B Streptococcus (S. agalactiae), E. coli, Listeria monocytogenes
Children (1 month - 6 y)	S. pneumoniae, N. meningitidis, H. influenzae b (unvaccinated)
Adolescents & young adults	N. meningitidis (epidemics — petechial rash, Waterhouse-Friderichsen)
Adults & elderly	S. pneumoniae (most common), N. meningitidis, Listeria (> 60 y, immunocompromised)
Post-neurosurgery / shunt	Staph. epidermidis, S. aureus, Gram-negatives

- Acute pyogenic meningitis — purulent exudate in leptomeninges (subarachnoid space); pneumococcal — over convexities (thick exudate); H. influenzae — basal; meningococcal — vertex; complications : ventriculitis, hydrocephalus (communicating), arachnoid fibrosis, cerebritis, venous sinus thrombosis, deafness (children), SIADH.
- Tuberculous meningitis — basal meninges — gelatinous / fibrinous exudate obliterating cisterns, cranial nerve palsies (VI, III), obliterative endarteritis (Heubner arteritis) → infarcts (basal ganglia), communicating hydrocephalus; Rich focus (subpial / subependymal tubercle) ruptures into subarachnoid space; tuberculoma (intracranial mass — ring-enhancing; most common intracranial mass lesion in India along with NCC).

Brain abscess :

- Sources : direct spread (otitis media / mastoiditis → temporal lobe & cerebellum; frontal / ethmoid sinusitis → frontal lobe), hematogenous (lung abscess, bronchiectasis, IE — multiple, MCA territory), cyanotic congenital heart disease (R→L shunt — TOF), trauma.
- Organisms : Streptococci (most common), Staph, anaerobes; Toxoplasma & Nocardia (immunocompromised).
- Morphology : central liquefactive necrosis, surrounding fibrous capsule (fibroblasts from vessels), reactive gliosis with gemistocytes, edema → ring-enhancing lesion.

Viral encephalitis :

Virus	Key pathology
HSV-1	Most common sporadic fatal encephalitis; hemorrhagic necrotizing — inferior & medial temporal lobes, orbital gyri; Cowdry A inclusions ; PCR CSF ; acyclovir
Japanese encephalitis	India (Gorakhpur, Assam) — Culex mosquito, pigs (amplifier), herons; thalamus, basal ganglia, substantia nigra
Rabies	Negri bodies (Purkinje, hippocampal pyramidal); minimal inflammation; hydrophobia
Polio	Anterior horn cells (lower motor neuron), medullary — bulbar
HIV	Microglial nodules with multinucleated giant cells ; HAND; vacuolar myelopathy
JC virus — PML	Immunosuppressed (AIDS, natalizumab, rituximab); demyelination (white matter) — oligodendrocyte infection with ground-glass intranuclear inclusions, bizarre astrocytes
Measles — SSPE	Years after measles (< 2 y infection); ↑↑ anti-measles antibodies in CSF, inclusions in neurons & oligodendrocytes, periodic EEG complexes
CMV	Periventricular, ependymitis (AIDS / congenital)
Arboviruses	Perivascular cuffing, microglial nodules, neuronophagia

Prion diseases :

- Misfolded PrP^{sc} (β-sheet) induces conformational change in PrP^{c} (α-helix) ; protease-resistant; transmissible; no inflammation.
- Spongiform change (vacuoles in neuropil & neurons — grey matter), neuronal loss, gliosis, kuru plaques (amyloid — vCJD — "florid plaques").
- Sporadic CJD (most common, 85%) — rapidly progressive dementia + myoclonus, periodic sharp-wave EEG, ↑ 14-3-3 protein & RT-QuIC (CSF); variant CJD (BSE — young, psychiatric, pulvinar sign); familial (PRNP), iatrogenic (corneal transplant, growth hormone, dura); fatal familial insomnia (thalamus), GSS, kuru (cannibalism — Fore tribe).

Cerebrovascular Disease

Hypoxia / ischemia :

- Global ischemia (cardiac arrest, shock) : most vulnerable — CA1 hippocampus (Sommer sector), Purkinje cells, pyramidal neurons of neocortex (layers 3, 5, 6) → laminar necrosis; watershed (border-zone) infarcts — between ACA & MCA territories ("parasagittal").
- Focal ischemia — infarction :

Time	Changes
First 6-12 h	Little change
12-48 h	Red (eosinophilic) neurons, edema, neutrophils (24 h)
2-3 days onward	Macrophages (gitter cells — lipid-laden "foamy") ; liquefactive necrosis
Weeks - months	Cyst (cavity) surrounded by reactive gliosis

- Thrombotic infarcts — atherosclerosis (carotid bifurcation, MCA, basilar) — pale (anemic).
- Embolic infarcts — cardiac mural thrombi (AF, MI), valve disease, carotid plaques; MCA (most common); hemorrhagic (red) infarcts — reperfusion of damaged vessels.
- Lacunar infarcts — small (< 15 mm), deep (lenticular nucleus, thalamus, internal capsule, pons); hypertension — hyaline arteriolosclerosis / lipohyalinosis of penetrating arteries; pure motor / pure sensory stroke.

Intracranial hemorrhage :

Type	Cause	Key features
Hypertensive intracerebral hemorrhage	Charcot-Bouchard microaneurysms / arteriolosclerosis — lenticulostriate arteries	Basal ganglia — putamen (most common, 50-60%), thalamus, pons, cerebellum

Type	Cause	Key features
Cerebral amyloid angiopathy	Aβ amyloid in leptomeningeal & cortical vessels	Lobar hemorrhages in elderly (recurrent), Alzheimer; ApoE ε2, ε4
Subarachnoid hemorrhage	Ruptured berry (saccular) aneurysm (most common non-traumatic cause); AVM	"Worst headache of my life" (thunderclap), neck stiffness; berry aneurysm — anterior circulation (90%) — ACom junction (most common); ADPKD, EDS, Marfan, coarctation, NF1; vasospasm (day 3-14) → ischemia, hydrocephalus
Arteriovenous malformation	Tangled vessels without capillary bed — MCA territory (posterior)	Young (10-30 y), males — seizures, hemorrhage; gliosis between vessels
Cavernous malformation	Back-to-back dilated vessels without intervening brain	CCM1/2/3; cerebellum, pons
Venous angioma	Most common vascular malformation, benign	—

Traumatic lesions :

Lesion	Key features
Epidural (extradural) hematoma	Skull fracture (temporal — pterion) → middle meningeal artery rupture ; lucid interval; biconvex (lentiform) on CT, does not cross sutures; neurosurgical emergency
Subdural hematoma	Rupture of bridging veins (superior sagittal sinus) ; elderly (atrophy), alcoholics, infants (shaken baby); crescent-shaped, crosses sutures (not falx); acute (48 h) / chronic (weeks — granulation tissue membrane, rebleeding)
Contusion	Coup (at impact) & contrecoup (opposite) — crests of gyri, frontal & temporal poles (orbital surfaces); "plaque jaune" (old contusion — yellow, hemosiderin)
Laceration	Penetrating injury; torn brain
Diffuse axonal injury	Acceleration-deceleration (rotational); axonal swellings (β-APP stain), corpus callosum, brainstem, periventricular; persistent vegetative state
Chronic traumatic encephalopathy	Repeated concussions (boxers — "dementia pugilistica"); perivascular tau tangles at sulcal depths
Spinal cord injury	Cervical (C4-C6) & thoracolumbar (T11-L2)

Demyelinating Diseases

Multiple sclerosis (MS) :

- Autoimmune (CD4 Th1 & Th17) demyelination ; women 20-40 y, higher latitudes; HLA-DRB1*1501 (DR2), IL-2R, IL-7R; EBV, low vitamin D, smoking.
- Relapsing-remitting (most common), primary progressive, secondary progressive.
- Morphology : plaques — well-circumscribed, grey, glassy lesions in white matter — periventricular (Dawson fingers — perivenular), corpus callosum, optic nerves & chiasm, brainstem, spinal cord; active plaques — demyelination with lipid-laden macrophages & perivascular lymphocytes; axons relatively preserved; inactive — gliosis; shadow plaques (remyelination).
- Clinical : optic neuritis (often first), internuclear ophthalmoplegia (MLF — bilateral in young = MS), Lhermitte sign, Uhthoff phenomenon (heat worsens), Charcot triad (nystagmus, intention tremor, scanning speech), sensory, bladder; McDonald criteria (dissemination in space & time); MRI (T2 / FLAIR), CSF oligoclonal bands.

Other demyelinating disorders	Key features
Neuromyelitis optica (Devic)	Anti-aquaporin-4 (astrocyte) ; severe optic neuritis + longitudinally extensive transverse myelitis (≥ 3 segments); Asian women
MOG antibody disease	Children; ADEM-like

Other demyelinating disorders	Key features
Acute disseminated encephalomyelitis (ADEM)	Post-viral / post-vaccination (monophasic); perivenular demyelination of same age
Acute hemorrhagic leukoencephalitis (Hurst)	Fulminant ADEM, young
Central pontine myelinolysis (osmotic demyelination)	Rapid correction of hyponatremia; central pons — "locked-in"
Leukodystrophies	Metachromatic (arylsulfatase A), Krabbe (galactocerebrosidase — globoid cells), X-linked adrenoleukodystrophy (ABCD1 — VLCFA ↑ + adrenal insufficiency)

Neurodegenerative Diseases

Disease	Protein	Key pathology
Alzheimer disease	Aβ (amyloid plaques) + tau (tangles)	Most common cause of dementia; cortical atrophy (frontal, temporal, parietal) — widened sulci, ex vacuo hydrocephalus; hippocampus (earliest); neuritic (senile) plaques — Aβ42 core + dystrophic neurites (silver stain); neurofibrillary tangles (hyperphosphorylated tau — "flame-shaped"; paired helical filaments); granulovacuolar degeneration, Hirano bodies (actin); cerebral amyloid angiopathy; loss of cholinergic neurons — nucleus basalis of Meynert; genetics : APP (chr 21 — Down), PSEN1 (chr 14 — most common familial early-onset), PSEN2 (chr 1), ApoE ε4 (chr 19 — ↑ risk sporadic late-onset; ε2 protective)
Frontotemporal lobar degeneration (Pick disease)	Tau (Pick bodies — round, silver-staining), TDP-43, FUS	Knife-edge atrophy of frontal & temporal lobes; personality / behavioural change, aphasia — early (before memory loss); ballooned neurons (Pick cells); C9orf72
Parkinson disease	α-synuclein (Lewy bodies)	Loss of pigmented dopaminergic neurons of substantia nigra (pars compacta) — pallor ; Lewy bodies — eosinophilic intracytoplasmic inclusions with pale halo; TRAP : tremor (resting, pill-rolling), rigidity (cogwheel), akinesia/bradykinesia, postural instability; SNCA, LRRK2 (most common AD), parkin (PRKN — AR juvenile), PINK1, DJ-1, GBA; MPTP
Lewy body dementia	α-synuclein	Cortical Lewy bodies — dementia, visual hallucinations, fluctuating cognition, parkinsonism; neuroleptic sensitivity
Multiple system atrophy	α-synuclein	Glial cytoplasmic inclusions in oligodendrocytes (Papp-Lantos); autonomic failure
Progressive supranuclear palsy	Tau	Vertical gaze palsy, axial rigidity, falls — "hummingbird sign", tufted astrocytes
Huntington disease	Huntingtin (CAG repeat, chr 4, AD, anticipation — paternal)	Atrophy of caudate nucleus (& putamen) — "box-car" ventricles; loss of GABAergic medium spiny neurons; chorea, dementia, psychiatric (depression, suicide)
Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis	TDP-43 (most), SOD1 (familial — 20% of fALS), C9orf72 (most common genetic)	Upper + lower motor neuron degeneration — loss of anterior horn cells & corticospinal tracts (pallor of lateral columns); Bunina bodies; no sensory, eye or bladder involvement; riluzole
Friedreich ataxia	Frataxin (GAA, AR)	Spinocerebellar tracts, posterior columns, dorsal root ganglia; hypertrophic cardiomyopathy (most common cause of death), DM, pes cavus, kyphoscoliosis
Spinal muscular atrophy	SMN1 (AR)	Anterior horn cell loss — floppy infant (Werdnig-Hoffmann) ; nusinersen, onasemnogene

CNS Tumours

- Children : 2nd most common malignancy (after leukemia) & most common solid tumour; mostly infratentorial (posterior fossa); adults — supratentorial.

- Metastases — most common CNS tumours in adults : lung > breast > melanoma > kidney > GIT; grey-white junction, multiple, well-circumscribed; hemorrhagic metastases — melanoma, choriocarcinoma, RCC, thyroid.

Tumour	Age / site	Key features
Glioblastoma (IDH-wildtype), WHO grade 4	Most common primary malignant brain tumour in adults (> 50 y); cerebral hemispheres, "butterfly glioma" crossing corpus callosum	Pseudopalisading necrosis + microvascular (glomeruloid) proliferation; EGFR amplification, TERT promoter mutation, +7/−10, PTEN loss, CDKN2A deletion; MGMT promoter methylation — better response to temozolomide; GFAP +; ring-enhancing, hemorrhagic, "variegated" mass; median survival ~15 months
Astrocytoma, IDH-mutant (grades 2-4)	Young adults (30-40 y)	IDH1 R132H, ATRX loss, TP53; diffuse infiltration; better than IDH-wildtype
Oligodendroglioma, IDH-mutant, 1p/19q-codeleted	Adults 40-50 y, frontal lobe (white matter)	Round nuclei with perinuclear halo — "fried-egg" cells, "chicken-wire" capillaries, calcifications; seizures; best prognosis among diffuse gliomas (chemosensitive)
Pilocytic astrocytoma (grade 1)	Most common CNS tumour in children; cerebellum (posterior fossa), optic nerve (NF1), hypothalamus	Cystic with mural nodule; bipolar "hair-like" piloid cells, Rosenthal fibres, eosinophilic granular bodies; BRAF (KIAA1549-BRAF fusion); excellent prognosis
Medulloblastoma (grade 4, embryonal)	Most common malignant brain tumour in children; cerebellum (vermis — midline in children)	Small round blue cells, Homer Wright rosettes (neuroblastic); synaptophysin +; CSF seeding — "drop metastases" (spine); molecular groups : WNT (best prognosis), SHH (PTCH — Gorlin), group 3 (MYC — worst), group 4; radiosensitive
Ependymoma	Children — 4th ventricle (posterior fossa); adults — spinal cord (NF2, myxopapillary — filum terminale)	Perivascular pseudorosettes (most common), true ependymal rosettes (canals); GFAP +, EMA dot-like; hydrocephalus; ZFTA (C11orf95)-RELA fusion (supratentorial)
Meningioma	Adults (40-60 y), women (2:1 — progesterone receptors); parasagittal, convexity, sphenoid wing, olfactory groove; extra-axial, dural-based	Most common primary intracranial tumour overall (benign); whorls of meningothelial cells, psammoma bodies; EMA +, PR +, SSTR2A +; NF2 (22q); dural tail sign, hyperostosis of adjacent bone; radiation (prior); grade 2 — atypical / clear cell / chordoid; grade 3 — anaplastic / papillary / rhabdoid
Schwannoma (neurilemmoma)	Cerebellopontine angle — vestibular (8th nerve) schwannoma — "acoustic neuroma"; bilateral in NF2	Antoni A (cellular, Verocay bodies — nuclear palisades) & Antoni B (loose, myxoid) areas, hyalinized vessels; S100 + (diffuse); encapsulated, eccentric to nerve; tinnitus, sensorineural hearing loss
Neurofibroma	NF1 (plexiform — pathognomonic)	Unencapsulated, nerve passes through; mixed Schwann cells, fibroblasts, "shredded-carrot" collagen; plexiform → MPNST
Craniopharyngioma	Children & elderly — suprasellar	See Endocrine; calcified, "machinery oil"
Primary CNS lymphoma	Immunosuppressed (AIDS — EBV+), elderly	DLBCL, periventricular, angiocentric; steroid-responsive ("ghost tumour")
Hemangioblastoma	Cerebellum, retina, spinal cord; VHL	Cyst with mural nodule; foamy stromal cells + capillaries; EPO → polycythemia
Choroid plexus papilloma	Children — lateral ventricles; adults — 4th ventricle	CSF overproduction → hydrocephalus
Atypical teratoid/rhabdoid tumour	Infants	SMARCB1 (INI1) loss; highly aggressive
Pituitary adenoma	See Endocrine	—
Pineal tumours	Germinoma (most common pineal tumour)	Parinaud syndrome (vertical gaze palsy), precocious puberty (hCG)

Mnemonic : Posterior fossa tumours in children — "MEP"
Medulloblastoma (midline vermis, solid) · Ependymoma (4th ventricle) · Pilocytic astrocytoma (cerebellar hemisphere, cystic + mural nodule) · (+ brainstem glioma — diffuse midline glioma, H3 K27M — worst).

Familial tumour syndromes :

Syndrome	Gene	CNS features
NF1 (von Recklinghausen)	NF1 (17q) — neurofibromin	Neurofibromas (plexiform), optic glioma (pilocytic), Lisch nodules (iris hamartomas), café-au-lait spots (≥ 6), axillary freckling (Crowe sign), MPNST, pheochromocytoma, GIST, JMML, sphenoid dysplasia
NF2	NF2 (22q) — merlin	Bilateral vestibular schwannomas (hallmark), multiple meningiomas, spinal ependymomas, juvenile cataract
Tuberous sclerosis	TSC1 (hamartin, 9q), TSC2 (tuberin, 16p) → mTOR ↑	Cortical tubers, subependymal nodules ("candle-guttering"), subependymal giant cell astrocytoma (SEGA); seizures (infantile spasms), intellectual disability; facial angiofibromas (adenoma sebaceum), ash-leaf macules, shagreen patch, periungual fibromas; cardiac rhabdomyoma, renal angiomyolipoma, pulmonary LAM ; everolimus
von Hippel-Lindau	VHL (3p)	Hemangioblastomas (cerebellum, retina, cord), clear cell RCC (bilateral), pheochromocytoma, pancreatic cysts / NETs
Sturge-Weber	GNAQ (somatic)	Port-wine stain (V1), leptomeningeal angiomatosis, "tram-track" calcification, seizures, glaucoma
Li-Fraumeni, Turcot, Gorlin	TP53, APC/MMR, PTCH	Gliomas, medulloblastoma

Peripheral Nerve

Pattern	Pathology	Examples
Axonal neuropathy	Wallerian-like degeneration, axon loss	Diabetes (distal symmetric), alcohol, toxins (vincristine, arsenic), uremia, B12/B1 deficiency
Demyelinating neuropathy	Segmental demyelination, onion bulbs (repeated de-/remyelination)	Guillain-Barré, CIDP, Charcot-Marie-Tooth 1 (PMP22 duplication), diphtheria, leprosy

- Guillain-Barré syndrome (acute inflammatory demyelinating polyneuropathy) : post-infection (Campylobacter jejuni — most common; CMV, EBV, Zika, Mycoplasma), vaccines; molecular mimicry (anti-GM1 — axonal AMAN; anti-GQ1b — Miller Fisher : ophthalmoplegia, ataxia, areflexia); ascending symmetric flaccid paralysis, areflexia, respiratory failure (most dangerous), autonomic instability; albuminocytologic dissociation; endoneurial lymphocytes & macrophages stripping myelin; IVIG / plasmapheresis.
- Leprous neuritis — commonest treatable cause of neuropathy worldwide (India); thickened nerves (ulnar, common peroneal, great auricular).
- Traumatic (amputation) neuroma — disorganized axon regrowth; Morton neuroma (interdigital, 3rd-4th toes).

Skeletal Muscle

Feature	Neurogenic atrophy	Myopathy
Pattern	Grouped atrophy (angular fibres), fibre-type grouping (reinnervation), target fibres	Random fibre size variation, necrosis, regeneration, internalized nuclei, fibrosis & fat replacement
Enzymes	Normal CK	↑ CK

Muscular dystrophies :

Feature	Duchenne (DMD)	Becker (BMD)
Gene	Dystrophin (Xp21 — largest human gene); frameshift deletions (absent dystrophin)	In-frame deletions (reduced / abnormal dystrophin)
Onset	2-5 years	Adolescence / adulthood, milder
Features	Proximal weakness (pelvic girdle first), Gowers sign, waddling gait, calf pseudohypertrophy (fat & fibrous replacement), cardiomyopathy, respiratory failure, intellectual disability (1/3) ; ↑↑ CK (from birth); death by 20s-30s	Survival into 40s-50s; cardiomyopathy
Biopsy	Absent dystrophin (immunostain), fibre necrosis, regeneration, endomysial fibrosis, fatty infiltration	Patchy / reduced dystrophin

- Myotonic dystrophy (DM1) — CTG repeat, DMPK (chr 19), AD, anticipation (maternal); myotonia (sustained contraction — handshake), distal weakness, frontal balding, cataracts, testicular atrophy, cardiac conduction defects, "hatchet face"; ring fibres, chains of central nuclei.
- Others : limb-girdle (sarcoglycans, calpain), facioscapulohumeral (DUX4), Emery-Dreifuss (emerin — contractures, cardiac).

Other muscle disorders :

Disease	Key features
Myasthenia gravis	Anti-AChR antibodies (85%) / anti-MuSK → fatigable weakness (ptosis, diplopia first), worsens with use; thymic hyperplasia (65%), thymoma (15%); decremental response on repetitive nerve stimulation, edrophonium (Tensilon) / ice pack test; normal muscle biopsy (simplification of postsynaptic folds — EM)
Lambert-Eaton syndrome	Anti-presynaptic VGCC; small cell lung carcinoma; proximal weakness improving with repeated use (incremental response), autonomic, ↓ reflexes
Inflammatory myopathies	Dermatomyositis (perifascicular atrophy, complement on capillaries, CD4 / B cells; malignancy), polymyositis (endomysial CD8 T cells), inclusion body myositis (> 50 y, rimmed vacuoles, quadriceps & finger flexors — refractory)
Mitochondrial myopathies	Ragged red fibres (Gomori trichrome — subsarcolemmal mitochondria) ; MERRF, MELAS, Kearns-Sayre (ophthalmoplegia, retinitis pigmentosa, heart block)
Toxic myopathies	Statins (necrotizing — anti-HMGCR), steroids (type 2 fibre atrophy), alcohol, chloroquine (vacuolar), zidovudine (mitochondrial)
Periodic paralysis	Hypo-/hyperkalemic (channelopathies)
Rhabdomyolysis	Crush, exertion, statins; myoglobinuria → AKI, ↑↑ CK

Filled : Rank boosters — CNS

- Most common primary brain tumour in adults : meningioma (overall); most common primary malignant : glioblastoma; children : pilocytic astrocytoma (overall), medulloblastoma (malignant).
- CNS tumours rarely metastasize outside the CNS (except medulloblastoma via shunt).
- Diffuse midline glioma, H3 K27-altered — children's pontine glioma (DIPG); worst prognosis.
- Colloid cyst of 3rd ventricle — foramen of Monro obstruction → positional headache, sudden death.
- Wernicke encephalopathy — mammillary bodies, periaqueductal grey (hemorrhage & necrosis); subacute combined degeneration — posterior & lateral columns (B12); tabes dorsalis — posterior columns & dorsal roots (syphilis); syringomyelia — cape-like loss of pain & temperature (crossing fibres), Chiari I.
- Neural tube defects — ↑ maternal serum AFP & acetylcholinesterase (amniotic); folic acid 400 µg (4 mg if previous NTD) prevents; Arnold-Chiari II — myelomeningocele + hydrocephalus; Dandy-Walker — cystic 4th ventricle, vermis agenesis.

PRACTICAL SPOTTERS & RAPID REVIEW

Microscopy Buzzwords

Buzzword	Diagnosis
Orphan Annie eye nuclei, nuclear grooves, psammoma bodies	Papillary carcinoma thyroid
Amyloid stroma (Congo red +) in thyroid	Medullary carcinoma thyroid
Hürthle (Askanazy) cells + lymphoid follicles	Hashimoto thyroiditis
Owl-eye nucleoli, mirror-image nuclei	Reed-Sternberg cell — Hodgkin lymphoma
Lacunar cells	Nodular sclerosis Hodgkin
Popcorn cells	NLPHL
Starry-sky pattern	Burkitt lymphoma (also T-ALL)
Fried-egg cells, chicken-wire capillaries	Oligodendroglioma
Pseudopalisading necrosis	Glioblastoma
Rosenthal fibres, piloid cells	Pilocytic astrocytoma
Homer Wright rosettes	Neuroblastoma, medulloblastoma, PNET
Flexner-Wintersteiner rosettes	Retinoblastoma
Perivascular pseudorosettes	Ependymoma
Verocay bodies (Antoni A / B)	Schwannoma
Whorls + psammoma bodies	Meningioma
Call-Exner bodies, coffee-bean nuclei	Granulosa cell tumour
Schiller-Duval bodies, hyaline globules	Yolk sac tumour
Reinke crystals	Leydig cell tumour (also hilus cells)
Fibrous septa with lymphocytes, clear cells	Seminoma / dysgerminoma
Signet ring cells	Diffuse gastric carcinoma, Krukenberg, lobular breast
Indian-file pattern, targetoid	Invasive lobular carcinoma breast
Keratin pearls, intercellular bridges	Squamous cell carcinoma
Koilocytes	HPV infection (condyloma, CIN)
Chicken-wire vasculature + clear cells	Clear cell RCC (also myxoid liposarcoma)
Hobnail cells	Clear cell carcinoma (ovary/endometrium), hemangioma variants
Leaf-like (phyllodes) fronds, cellular stroma	Phyllodes tumour
Cribriform "Swiss cheese" + perineural invasion	Adenoid cystic carcinoma
Chondromyxoid stroma + epithelial cells	Pleomorphic adenoma
Oncocytic bilayer + lymphoid stroma	Warthin tumour
Small round blue cells	Ewing, neuroblastoma, Wilms (blastema), medulloblastoma, rhabdomyosarcoma, lymphoma, small cell carcinoma, retinoblastoma
Triphasic histology	Wilms tumour
Cambium layer	Botryoid rhabdomyosarcoma
Strap / tadpole cells with cross-striations	Rhabdomyosarcoma
Lipoblasts	Liposarcoma

Buzzword	Diagnosis
Storiform pattern	DFSP, UPS, IgG4-related disease, fibrous histiocytoma
Physaliferous cells	Chordoma
Chinese-letter trabeculae	Fibrous dysplasia
Mosaic (jigsaw) bone	Paget disease
Lace-like osteoid between malignant cells	Osteosarcoma
Chicken-wire calcification	Chondroblastoma
Osteoclast-like giant cells in sheets	Giant cell tumour of bone
Aschoff bodies, Anitschkow (caterpillar) cells	Rheumatic heart disease
Wire-loop lesions, hematoxylin bodies	SLE (lupus nephritis IV)
Kimmelstiel-Wilson nodules	Diabetic nephropathy
Spike & dome	Membranous nephropathy
Tram-track (GBM duplication)	MPGN
Crescents	RPGN
Thyroidization of tubules	Chronic pyelonephritis
Michaelis-Gutmann bodies	Malakoplakia
Mallory-Denk bodies	Alcoholic hepatitis, NASH, Wilson, PBC, HCC
Councilman (acidophil) bodies	Viral hepatitis, yellow fever
Ground-glass hepatocytes	HBV (HBsAg)
Onion-skin periductal fibrosis	Primary sclerosing cholangitis
Florid duct lesion	Primary biliary cholangitis
Crypt abscesses, pseudopolyps	Ulcerative colitis
Transmural inflammation, non-caseating granulomas	Crohn disease
Volcano lesions / pseudomembranes	C. difficile colitis
Flask-shaped ulcers	Amoebic colitis
Arborizing smooth muscle	Peutz-Jeghers polyp
Goblet cells in esophagus	Barrett esophagus
Curschmann spirals, Charcot-Leyden crystals	Bronchial asthma
Ferruginous (asbestos) bodies	Asbestosis
Hyaline membranes	ARDS / HMD (diffuse alveolar damage)
Heart failure cells	Chronic venous congestion of lung
Nutmeg pattern	CVC liver (right heart failure)
Lines of Zahn	Antemortem thrombus
Contraction bands	Reperfusion injury (MI)
Gaucher cells (crumpled tissue paper)	Gaucher disease
Foam cells (zebra bodies)	Niemann-Pick
Smudge cells	CLL
Auer rods / faggot cells	AML / APL (M3)
Hairy projections, TRAP +	Hairy cell leukemia
Flower cells	ATLL (HTLV-1)
Cerebriform nuclei, Pautrier microabscesses	Mycosis fungoides

Buzzword	Diagnosis
Negri bodies	Rabies
Owl-eye inclusions	CMV
Warthin-Finkeldey cells	Measles
LD bodies	Kala-azar
Globi, foamy (lepra) cells	Lepromatous leprosy
Sulfur granules	Actinomycosis
Spherules with endospores	Coccidioides
Broad aseptate hyphae (90°)	Mucormycosis
Septate acute-angle hyphae	Aspergillus
Capsule on India ink	Cryptococcus
Cysts — crushed ping-pong ball (GMS)	Pneumocystis
Laminated membrane + protoscolices	Hydatid cyst
Psammoma bodies	Papillary thyroid Ca, serous ovarian Ca, meningioma, mesothelioma, papillary RCC, prolactinoma

Special Stains — Quick Table

Stain	Substance / use
Congo red (apple-green birefringence)	Amyloid
PAS	Glycogen (diastase-sensitive), mucin, fungi, basement membrane, Whipple, α1-AT (diastase-resistant)
Oil Red O / Sudan black / Sudan IV	Lipids (frozen section)
Perls Prussian blue	Hemosiderin (iron)
Masson-Fontana	Melanin
Von Kossa / Alizarin red	Calcium
Masson trichrome	Collagen (blue/green), muscle (red) — fibrosis
Reticulin (Gordon & Sweet)	Reticulin fibres — liver architecture, myelofibrosis, pituitary adenoma
Verhoeff-van Gieson	Elastic fibres
Mucicarmine / Alcian blue	Mucin, Cryptococcus
Rhodanine / orcein	Copper (Wilson) / HBsAg (orcein)
Gomori trichrome (modified)	Ragged red fibres
Toluidine blue	Mast cells (metachromasia)
MPO / Sudan black B	Myeloid blasts
NSE (α-naphthyl esterase)	Monocytic cells
TRAP	Hairy cell leukemia, osteoclasts
LAP (NAP) score	↓ CML, ↑ leukemoid reaction & PV
Supravital (new methylene blue)	Reticulocytes, Heinz bodies
Ziehl-Neelsen / Fite-Faraco	Mycobacteria / M. leprae
GMS / PAS	Fungi, Pneumocystis
Warthin-Starry	Spirochetes, Bartonella, H. pylori
Giemsa	Malaria, Leishmania, H. pylori

Gross Specimen Spotters

Gross appearance	Diagnosis
Bread-and-butter pericardium	Fibrinous pericarditis (RF, uremia, MI)
Fish-mouth (buttonhole) mitral valve	Chronic rheumatic mitral stenosis
Verrucous vegetations along closure line	Acute rheumatic valvulitis
Friable bulky vegetations with perforation	Infective endocarditis
Tigered (thrush-breast) myocardium	Fatty change of heart
Yellow-tan soft infarct with hyperemic border	MI (3–10 days)
Boot-shaped heart	Tetralogy of Fallot
Tree-bark aorta	Syphilitic aortitis
Nutmeg liver	Chronic venous congestion
Hobnail (micronodular) liver	Alcoholic cirrhosis
Green-black liver	Dubin–Johnson syndrome
Anchovy-sauce pus	Amoebic liver abscess
Sago / lardaceous spleen	Amyloidosis
Grey hepatization lung	Lobar pneumonia (day 4–8)
Apical cavity with caseation	Secondary pulmonary TB
Honeycomb lung	IPF / end-stage interstitial fibrosis
Encasing rind on lung	Malignant mesothelioma
Golden-yellow renal mass with hemorrhage	Clear cell RCC
Flea-bitten kidney	Malignant hypertension, IE (focal GN)
Granular contracted kidney	Benign nephrosclerosis / CKD
Bilateral huge cystic kidneys	ADPKD
Staghorn calculus	Struvite (Proteus)
Linitis plastica (leather bottle)	Diffuse gastric carcinoma
Napkin-ring stricture	Left-sided colon carcinoma
Cobblestone mucosa, skip lesions	Crohn disease
Strawberry gallbladder	Cholesterolosis
Porcelain gallbladder	Chronic cholecystitis (↑ carcinoma)
Chocolate cyst of ovary	Endometrioma
Dermoid cyst with hair & teeth	Mature cystic teratoma
Bunch-of-grapes vesicles	Complete hydatidiform mole
Whorled grey-white uterine nodules	Leiomyoma
Unripe-pear gritty breast mass	Invasive breast carcinoma (NST)
Peau d'orange	Breast carcinoma (dermal lymphatic block)
Homogeneous grey-white testicular mass	Seminoma
Variegated hemorrhagic testicular mass	NSGCT (embryonal / choriocarcinoma)
Butterfly lesion across corpus callosum	Glioblastoma
Dural-based firm mass	Meningioma
Basal gelatinous exudate	Tuberculous meningitis
Sunburst bone lesion at knee	Osteosarcoma
Soap-bubble epiphyseal lesion	Giant cell tumour of bone
Sequestrum + involucrum	Chronic osteomyelitis

"Most Common" — One-Liners

- MC cause of death in RF (acute) : myocarditis
- MC valve in RHD : mitral
- MC congenital heart disease : VSD ; cyanotic : TOF
- MC site of atherosclerosis : abdominal aorta
- MC primary cardiac tumour (adult) : myxoma; (child) : rhabdomyoma
- MC vasculitis in elderly : giant cell arteritis
- MC lung cancer : adenocarcinoma
- MC lung tumour overall : metastasis
- MC GN worldwide : IgA nephropathy
- MC cause of nephrotic syndrome (child) : minimal change disease
- MC renal tumour (adult) : clear cell RCC; (child) : Wilms
- MC salivary tumour : pleomorphic adenoma
- MC malignant salivary : mucoepidermoid carcinoma
- MC gastric polyp : hyperplastic
- MC site of GIST : stomach
- MC site of carcinoid : small intestine (ileum)
- MC anemia : iron deficiency
- MC inherited bleeding disorder : vWD
- MC leukemia (child) : ALL
- MC NHL : DLBCL ; MC Hodgkin : nodular sclerosis (India — mixed cellularity)
- MC liver tumour : metastasis ; benign : hemangioma
- MC thyroid cancer : papillary
- MC pituitary adenoma : prolactinoma
- MC benign bone tumour : osteochondroma
- MC primary malignant bone tumour : osteosarcoma (overall myeloma)
- MC brain tumour (adult) : metastasis ; primary : meningioma
- MC brain tumour (child) : pilocytic astrocytoma
- MC ovarian tumour : mature cystic teratoma ; malignant : HGSC
- MC testicular tumour : seminoma
- MC breast lump (young) : fibroadenoma
- MC cause of cirrhosis (India) : alcohol / HBV
- MC extrapulmonary TB : lymph node

Exam pearl : Last-minute pearls

- Point of no return in cell injury : mitochondrial dysfunction + membrane damage (amorphous densities).
- Hallmark of acute inflammation : increased vascular permeability; of chronic : mononuclear infiltrate + tissue destruction + repair.
- Single most important feature of malignancy : metastasis.
- Most important prognostic factor : breast — nodes; colon — stage; melanoma — Breslow thickness; sarcoma — grade; prostate — Gleason/grade group.